

NIETZSCHE ON THE PHYSIOLOGY OF GREAT CULTURES

An Anthology of Key Passages

Translations Used

- **Beyond Good and Evil** — Translated by Ian Johnston
 - **On the Genealogy of Morals** — Translated by Ian Johnston
 - **Twilight of the Idols / The Antichrist** — Translated by R.J. Hollingdale
 - **Ecce Homo** — Translated by R.J. Hollingdale
 - **Thus Spoke Zarathustra** — Translated by Graham Parkes
 - **The Gay Science** — Translated by Adrian Del Caro / Josefine Nauckhoff
 - **The Birth of Tragedy** — Translated by Ian Johnston
 - **The Use and Abuse of History for Life** — Translated by Ian Johnston
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Introduction

By Costin

You have come to Nietzsche not for arguments but for weapons. Good. This anthology collects the passages that matter for the question you are pursuing — what soil makes a civilization great. Not philosophy as a system of ideas, but philosophy as physiology: the blood, the breeding, the climate, the pathos of distance that produces high culture. Nietzsche is not a thinker to be debated; he is a physician to be consulted. These pages contain his diagnosis.

The passages gathered here trace a single arc: from the foundation of rank and master morality, through the breeding of types and the pathos of distance, to the flowering of great individuals and the decadence that undoes them. Nietzsche's question is not "What is good?" but "What is strong? What is ascending? What presses toward higher forms?" The answers are not comfortable. They were not meant to be. The user who opens this book should prepare to have his democratic certainties examined, his humanitarian pieties tested, and his understanding of 'culture' deepened beyond the merely academic.

Keep the raw Nietzsche. Do not soften him. The Introduction frames the inquiry; what follows is the man himself speaking — through his translators, but with his voice undiminished. Read these passages as a physiognomist reads a face: looking for the signs of ascending or descending life. The rest is commentary.

PART I: The Foundation of Rank and Master Morality

I.1 — Beyond Good and Evil §257

BEYOND GOOD AND EVIL §257 (Translated by Ian Johnston)

Every enhancement in the type “man” up to this point has been the work of an aristocratic society—and that’s how it will always be, over and over again: a society that believes in a long scale of rank ordering and differences in worth between one person and another and that, in some sense or other, requires slavery. Without the pathos of distance, the sort which grows out of the deeply rooted difference between the social classes, out of the constant gazing outward and downward of the ruling caste on the subjects and work implements, and out of their equally sustained practice of obedience and command, holding down and holding at a distance, that other more mysterious pathos would have no chance of growing at all, that longing for an ever new widening of distances inside the soul itself, the development of ever higher, rarer, more distant, more expansive, more comprehensive states, in short, simply the enhancement in the type “man,” the constant “self-surmounting of man,” to cite a moral formula in a supra-moral sense. Of course, where the history of the origins of aristocratic society is concerned (and thus the precondition for that raising of the type “man”—), we should not surrender to humanitarian illusions: truth is hard. So without further consideration, let’s admit to ourselves how up to this point every higher culture on earth has started! People with a still natural nature, barbarians in every dreadful sense of the word, predatory men still in possession of an unbroken power of the will and a desire for power, threw themselves on weaker, more civilized, more peaceful, perhaps trading or cattle-raising races, or on old, worn cultures, in which at that very moment the final forces of life were flickering out in a dazzling fireworks display of spirit and corruption. At the start the noble caste has always been the barbarian caste: its superiority has lain not primarily in physical might but in spiritual power—it has been a matter of more complete human beings (which at every level also means “more complete beasts”).

I.2 — Beyond Good and Evil §258

BEYOND GOOD AND EVIL §258 (Translated by Ian Johnston)

Corruption as the expression of the fact that within the instincts anarchy is threatening and that the foundation of the affects, what we call “life,” has been shaken: according to the living structure in which it appears, corruption is something fundamentally different. When, for example, an aristocracy, like that in France at the start of the Revolution, throws away its privileges with a sublime disgust and sacrifices itself to a dissipation of its moral feelings, this is corruption:—essentially it was only the final act in that centuries-long corruption, thanks to which the aristocracy step-by-step gave up its ruling authority and reduced itself to a function of the monarchy (finally even to the monarch’s finery and display pieces). The essential thing in a good and healthy aristocracy, however, is that it feels itself not as a function (whether of a monarchy or of a community) but as its significance and highest justification—that it therefore with good conscience accepts the sacrifice of an enormous number of people, who for its sake must be oppressed and reduced to incomplete men, to slaves and instruments of work. Its fundamental belief must, in fact, be that the society should exist, not for the sake of the society, but only as a base and framework on which an exceptional kind of nature can raise itself to its higher function and, in general, to a higher form of being, comparable to those heliotropic climbing plants on Java—people call them sipo matador—whose tendrils clutch an oak tree so much and for so long until finally, high over the tree but supported by it, they can unfold their crowns in the open light and make a display of their happiness.—

I.3 — Beyond Good and Evil §259

BEYOND GOOD AND EVIL §259 (Translated by Ian Johnston)

Mutually refraining from wounding each other, from violence, and from exploitation, and setting one’s will on the same level as others—these can in a certain crude sense become good habits among individuals, if conditions exist for that (namely, a real similarity in the quality of their power and their estimates of value, as well as their belonging together within a single body). However, as soon as people wanted to take this principle further and, where possible, establish it as the basic principle of society, it would immediately show itself for what it is, as the willed denial of life, as the principle of disintegration and decay. Here we must think through to the fundamentals and push away all sentimental weakness: living itself is essentially appropriation

from and wounding and overpowering strangers and weaker people, oppression, hardness, imposing one's own forms, annexing, and at the very least, in its mildest actions, exploitation—but why should we always use these precise words, which have from ancient times carried the stamp of a slanderous purpose? Even that body in which, as previously mentioned, individuals deal with each other as equals—and that happens in every healthy aristocracy—must itself, if it is a living body and not dying out, do to other bodies all those things which the individuals in it refrain from doing to each other: it will have to be the living will to power, it will seek to grow, grab things around it, pull to itself, and acquire predominance—not because of some morality or immorality, but because it is alive and because living is simply the will to power. But in no point is the common consciousness of the European more reluctant to be instructed than here. Nowadays people everywhere, even those in scientific disguises, are raving about the coming conditions of society from which “the exploitative character” is to have disappeared:—to my ears that sounds as if people had promised to invent a life which abstained from all organic functions. The “exploitation” is not part of a depraved or incomplete and primitive society: it belongs to the essential nature of what is living, as a basic organic function; it is a consequence of the real will to power, which is simply the will to life.—Assuming that this is something new as a theory—it is, nonetheless, in reality the fundamental fact of all history: we should at least be honest with ourselves to this extent!

I.4 — Beyond Good and Evil §260

BEYOND GOOD AND EVIL §260 (Translated by Ian Johnston)

As the result of a stroll through the many more sophisticated and cruder moral systems which up to this point have ruled or still rule on earth, I found certain characteristics routinely return with each other, bound up together, until finally two basic types revealed themselves to me and a fundamental difference sprang up. There is master morality, and there is slave morality—to this I immediately add that in all higher and more mixed cultures attempts at a mediation between both moralities make an appearance as well, even more often, a confusion and mutual misunderstanding between the two, in fact, sometimes their close juxtaposition—even in the same person, within a single soul. Distinctions in moral value have arisen either among a ruling group which was happily conscious of its difference with respect to the ruled—or among the ruled, the slaves and dependent people of every degree. In the first case, when it's the masters who establish the idea of the “good,” the elevated and proud conditions of the soul emotionally register as the distinguishing and defining

order of rank. The noble man separates his own nature from that of people in whom the opposite of such exalted and proud states expresses itself. He despises them. We should notice at once that in this first kind of morality the opposites "good" and "bad" mean no more than "noble" and "despicable"—the opposition between "good" and "evil" has another origin. The despised one is the coward, the anxious, the small, the man who thinks about narrow utility, also the suspicious man with his inhibited look, the self-abasing man, the species of human dogs who allow themselves to be mistreated, the begging flatterer, and, above all, the liar:—it is a basic belief of all aristocrats that the common folk are liars. "We tellers of the truth"—that's what the nobility called itself in ancient Greece. It's evident that distinctions of moral worth everywhere were first applied to men and then later, by extension, were established for actions; hence, it is a serious mistake when historians of morality take as a starting point questions like "Why was the compassionate action praised?" The noble kind of man experiences himself as a person who determines value and who does not need other people's approval. He makes the judgment "What is harmful to me is harmful in itself." He understands himself as something which in general first confers honour on things, as something which creates values. Whatever he recognizes in himself he honours. Such a morality is self-glorification. In the foreground stands the feeling of fullness, the power which wants to overflow, the happiness of high tension, the consciousness of riches which wants to give presents and provide:—the noble man also helps the unfortunate, however not, or hardly ever, from pity, but more in response to an impulse which the excess of power produces. The noble person honours the powerful man in himself and also the man who has power over himself, who understands how to speak and how to keep silent, who takes delight in dealing with himself severely and toughly, and who respects, above all, severity and toughness. "Wotan set a hard heart in my breast," it says in an old Scandinavian saga: that's poetry emerging from the soul of a proud Viking—and justifiably so. A man of this sort is simply proud of the fact that he has not been made for pity. That's why the hero of the saga adds a warning, "In a man whose heart is not hard when he is still young it will never become hard." Noble and brave men who think this way are furthest removed from that morality which sees the badge of morality specifically in pity or in actions for others or in *désintéressement* [disinterestedness]. The belief in oneself, pride in oneself, a fundamental hostility and irony against "selflessness" belong to noble morality, just as much as an easy contempt and caution before feelings of pity and the "warm heart." Powerful men are the ones who understand how to honour; that is their art, their realm of invention. The profound reverence for age and for ancestral tradition—all justice stands on this double reverence—the belief and the prejudice favouring forefathers

and working against newcomers are typical in the morality of the powerful, and when, by contrast, the men of "modern ideas" believe almost instinctively in "progress" and the "future" and increasingly lack any respect for age, then in that attitude the ignoble origin of these "ideas" already reveals itself well enough. However, a morality of the rulers is most alien and embarrassing to present taste because of the severity of its basic principle that man has duties only with respect to those like him, that man should act towards those beings of lower rank, towards everything foreign, at his own discretion, or "as his heart dictates," and, in any case, "beyond good and evil." Here pity and things like that may belong. The capacity for and obligation to a long gratitude and a long revenge—both only within the circle of one's peers—the sophistication in paying back again, the refined idea in friendship, a certain necessity to have enemies (as, so to speak, drainage ditches for the feelings of envy, quarrelsomeness, and high spirits—basically in order to be capable of being a good friend): all those are typical characteristics of a noble morality, which, as indicated, is not the morality of "modern ideas" and which is thus nowadays difficult to sympathize with, as well as difficult to dig up and expose. Things are different with the second type of moral system, slave morality. Suppose the oppressed, depressed, suffering and unfree people, those ignorant of themselves and tired out, suppose they moralize: what will be the common feature of their moral estimates of value? Probably a pessimistic suspicion directed at the entire human situation will express itself, perhaps a condemnation of man, along with his situation. The gaze of a slave is not well disposed towards the virtues of the powerful; he possesses scepticism and mistrust; he has a subtlety of mistrust of everything "good" that is honoured in those virtues—he would like to persuade himself that even happiness is not genuine there. By contrast, those characteristics will be pulled forward and flooded with light which serve to mitigate existence for those who suffer: here respect is given to pity, to the obliging hand ready to help, to the warm heart, to patience, diligence, humility, and friendliness—for these are here the most useful characteristics and almost the only means to endure the pressure of existence. Slave morality is essentially a morality of utility. Here is the focus for the origin of that famous opposition of "good" and "evil":—people sense power and danger within evil, a certain terror, subtlety, and strength that does not permit contempt to spring up. According to slave morality, the "evil" man thus inspires fear; according to master morality, it is precisely the "good" man who inspires and desires to inspire fear, while the "bad" man is felt as despicable. This opposition reaches its peak when, in accordance with the consequences of slave morality, finally a trace of disregard is also attached to the "good" of this morality—it may be light and benevolent—because within the way of thinking of the slave the good person must definitely be the harmless person: he is good

natured, easy to deceive, perhaps a bit stupid, un bonhomme [a good fellow]. Wherever slave morality gains predominance the language reveals a tendency to bring the words “good” and “stupid” into closer proximity. A final basic difference: the longing for freedom, the instinct for happiness, and the refinements of the feeling for freedom belong just as necessarily to slave morality and morals as art and enthusiasm in reverence and in devotion are the regular symptoms of an aristocratic way of thinking and valuing. From this we can without further ado understand why love as passion—which is our European specialty—must clearly have a noble origin: as is well known, its invention belongs to the Provencal knightly poets, those splendidly inventive men of the “gay saber” [gay science] to whom Europe owes so much—almost its very self.

I.5 — On the Genealogy of Morals, First Essay §2

ON THE GENEALOGY OF MORALS, FIRST ESSAY §2 (Translated by Ian Johnston)

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So all respect to the good spirits that may govern in these historians of morality! But it’s certainly a pity that they lack the historical spirit, that they’ve been left in the lurch especially by all the good spirits of history itself! As a group they all think essentially unhistorically, in what is now the traditional manner of philosophers. Of that there is no doubt. The incompetence of their genealogies of morals reveals itself at the very beginning, where the issue is to determine the origin of the idea and of the judgment “good.” “People,” so they proclaim, “originally praised unegoistic actions and called them good from the perspective of those for whom they were done, that is, those for whom such actions were useful. Later people forgot how this praise began, and simply because unegoistic actions had, according to custom, always been praised as good, people also felt them as good—as if they were something inherently good.” We perceive right away that this initial derivation already contains all the typical characteristics idiosyncrasies of English psychologists—we have “usefulness,” “forgetting,” “habit,” and finally “error,” all as the foundation for an evaluation in which the higher man up to this time has taken pride, as if it were a sort of privilege of men generally. This pride is to be humbled, this evaluation of worth emptied of value. Has that been achieved? . . . Now, first of all, it’s obvious to me that from this theory the essential source for the origin of the idea “good” has been sought for and established in the wrong place: the judgment “good” does not originate from those to whom “goodness” was

shown! On the contrary, it was the “good people” themselves, that is, the noble, powerful, higher-ranking, and higher-thinking people who felt and set themselves and their actions up as good, that is to say, of the first rank, in opposition to everything low, low-minded, common, and vulgar. From this pathos of distance they first arrogated to themselves the right to create values, to stamp out the names for values. What did they care about usefulness! Particularly in relation to such a hot pouring out of the highest rank-ordering, rank-setting judgments of value, the point of view which considers utility is as foreign and inappropriate as possible. Here the feeling has reached the very opposite of the low level of warmth which is a condition for that calculating shrewdness, that reckoning by utility—and not just for a moment, not for one exceptional hour, but permanently. The pathos of nobility and distance, as I mentioned, the lasting and dominating feeling, something total and fundamental, of a higher ruling nature in relation to a lower type, to a “beneath”—that is the origin of the opposition between “good” and “bad.” (The right of the master to give names extends so far that we could permit ourselves to grasp the origin of language itself as an expression of the power of the rulers: they say “That is such and such”; they seal every object and event with a sound, and in the process, as it were, take possession of it.) Given this origin, the word “good” is from the start in no way necessarily tied up with “unegoistic” actions, as it is in the superstition of those genealogists of morality. Instead that occurs for the first time with the decline of aristocratic value judgments, when this entire contrast between “egoistic” and “unegoistic” presses itself ever more strongly into the human conscience—it is, to use my own words, the instinct of the herd which, through this contrast, finally gets its word (and its words). And even then, it takes a long time until this instinct in the masses becomes master, so that moral evaluation remains thoroughly hung up on and bogged down in that opposition (as is the case, for example, in modern Europe: today the prejudice that takes “moralistic,” “unegoistic,” and “*désintéressé* [disinterested]” as equally valuable ideas already governs with the force of a “fixed idea” and a disease of the brain).

I.6 — On the Genealogy of Morals, First Essay §4-5

ON THE GENEALOGY OF MORALS, FIRST ESSAY §4-5 (Translated by Ian Johnston)

I was given a hint of the right direction by the following question: What, from an etymological perspective, do the meanings of “good,” as manifested in different languages, really signify? There I found that all of them lead back to the same transformation of ideas—that everywhere “noble” and “aristocratic”

in a social sense is the fundamental idea out of which “good” in the sense of “spiritually noble,” “aristocratic,” “spiritually high-minded,” “spiritually privileged” necessarily develops, a process which always runs in parallel with that other one that finally transforms “common,” “vulgar,” and “low” into the concept “bad.” The most eloquent example of the latter is the German word “(schlecht [bad])” itself, which is identical with the word “schlicht [plain]” — compare “schlechtweg [simply]” and “schlechterdings [simply]”—and which originally designated the plain, common man, still without any suspicious side glance, simply in contrast to the noble man. Around the time of the Thirty Years War approximately, hence late enough, this sense changed into the one used now.(2) As far as the genealogy of morals is concerned, this point strikes me as a fundamental insight; that it was first discovered so late we can ascribe to the repressive influence which democratic prejudice in the modern world exercises concerning all questions of origin. And this occurs in what appears to be the most objective realm of natural science and physiology, a point I can only hint at here. But the sort of mischief this prejudice can cause, once it has become unleashed and turned into hatred, particularly where morality and history are concerned, is revealed in the well-known case of Buckle: the plebeian nature of the modern spirit, which originated in England, broke out once again on its home turf, as violently as a muddy volcano and with that salty, over-loud, and common eloquence with which all previous volcanoes have spoken up to now. (3)

With respect to our problem—which for good reasons we can call a quiet problem and which addresses in a refined manner only a few ears—there is no little interest in establishing the point that often in those words and roots which designate “good” there still shines through the main nuance of what made the nobility feel they were men of higher rank. It’s true that in most cases they perhaps name themselves simply after their superiority in strength (as “the powerful,” “the masters,” “those in command”) or after the most visible sign of this superiority, for example, as “the rich” or “the owners” (that is the meaning of *arya* [noble], and the corresponding words in Iranian and Slavic). But they also name themselves after a typical characteristic, and this is the case which is our concern here. For instance, they call themselves “the truthful,” above all the Greek nobility, whose mouthpiece is the Megarian poet Theognis.(4) The word developed for this characteristic, *ἔσθλος* [*esthlos*: fine, noble], indicates, according to its root meaning, a man who is, who possesses reality, who really exists, who is true. Then, with a subjective transformation, it indicates the true man as the truthful man. In this phase of conceptual transformation it becomes the slogan and catch phrase for the nobility, and its sense shifts entirely over to mean “aristocratic,” to mark a distinction from the

lying common man, as Theogonis takes and presents him—until finally, after the decline of the nobility, the word remains as a designation of spiritual noblesse [nobility] and becomes, as it were, ripe and sweet.

In the word

κακός

[kakos: weak, worthless], as in the word δειλός

[deilos: cowardly] (the plebeian in contrast to the αγαθός

[agathos: good man]), the cowardice is emphasized. This perhaps provides a hint about the direction in which we have to seek the etymological origin for the multiple meanings of αγαθός [agathos: good]. In the Latin word malus [bad] (which I place alongside μέλας

[melas: black, dark]) the common man could be designated as the dark-coloured, above all as the dark-haired (“hic niger est” [“this man is dark”]), as the pre-Aryan inhabitant of Italian soil, who through this colour stood out most clearly from those who became dominant, the blonds, that is, the conquering races of Aryans. At any rate, Gaelic offers me an exactly corresponding example—the word fin (for example, in the name Fin-Gal), the term designating nobility and finally the good, noble, and pure, originally referred to the blond-headed man in contrast to the dusky, dark-haired original inhabitants. Incidentally, the Celts were a thoroughly blond race. People are wrong when they link those traces of a basically dark-haired population, which are noticeable on the carefully prepared ethnographic maps of Germany, with any Celtic origin and mixing of blood, as Virchow still does.(5) It is much rather the case that in these places the pre-Aryan population of Germany predominates. (The same is true for almost all of Europe: essentially the conquered races have finally attained the upper hand for themselves once again in colour, shortness of skull, perhaps even in the intellectual and social instincts. Who can confirm for us that modern democracy, the even more modern anarchism, and indeed that preference for the “Commune,” for the most primitive form of society, which all European socialists now share, does not indicate for the most part a monstrous throwback [Nachschlag]—and that the conquering master race, the race of Aryans, is not being physiologically defeated, too?). The Latin word bonus [good] I believe I can explicate as “the warrior,” provided that I am correct in tracing bonus back to an older word duonus (compare (T)bellum [war] = duellum [war] = duen-lum, which seems to me to contain that word duonus). Hence, bonus as a man of war, of division (duo [two]), as a warrior. We see what constituted a man’s “goodness” in ancient Rome. What about our

German word “Gut” [good] itself? Doesn’t it indicate “den Göttlichen” [the god-like man], the man of “göttlichen Geschlechts” [“the family of gods”]? And isn’t that identical to the people’s (originally the nobles’) name for the Goths? The reasons for this hypothesis do not belong here.—

I.7 — On the Genealogy of Morals, First Essay §7

ON THE GENEALOGY OF MORALS, FIRST ESSAY §7 (Translated by Ian Johnston)

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With these ideas, by the way, I have no desire whatsoever to give our pessimists grist for their discordant mills grating with weariness of life. On the contrary, I want to state very clearly that in that period when human beings had not yet become ashamed of their cruelty, life on earth was happier than it is today, now that we have our pessimists. The darkening of heaven over men’s heads has always increased alarmingly in proportion to the growth of human beings’ shame before human beings. The tired, pessimistic look, the mistrust of the riddle of life, the icy denial stemming from disgust with life—these are not the signs of the wickedest eras of human beings. It’s much more the case that they first come to light as the swamp plants they are when the swamp to which they belong is there—I mean the sickly mollycoddling and moralizing, thanks to which the animal “man” finally learns to feel shame about all his instincts. On his way to becoming an “angel” (not to use a harsher word here), man cultivated for himself that upset stomach and that furry tongue which not only made the joy and innocence of the animal repulsive but also made life itself distasteful:—so that now and then he stands there before himself, holds his nose, and with Pope Innocent III disapproves and makes a catalogue of his nastiness (“conceived in filth, disgustingly nourished in his mother’s body, developed out of evil material stuff, stinking horribly, a secretion of spit, urine, and excrement”).(3) Now, when suffering always has to march out as the first among the arguments against existence, as its most serious question mark, it’s good for us to remember the times when people judged things the other way around, because they couldn’t do without making people suffer and saw a first-class magic in it, a really tempting enticement for living. Perhaps, and let me say this as a consolation for the delicate, at that time pain did not yet hurt as much as it does nowadays. That at least could be the conclusion of a doctor who had treated a Negro (taking the latter as a representative of pre-historical man) for a bad case of inner inflammation, which drives the European, even one with the best constitution, almost to despair, but which does not have the

same effect on the Negro. (The graph of the human sensitivity to pain seems in fact to sink down remarkably and almost immediately after one has moved beyond the first ten thousand or ten million of the top members of the higher culture. And I personally have no doubt that, in comparison with one painful night of a single hysterical well-educated female, the total suffering of all animals which up to now have been interrogated by the knife in search of scientific answers is simply not worth considering). Perhaps it is even permissible to concede the possibility that that pleasure in cruelty does not really need to have died out. It would only require a certain sublimation and subtlety, in proportion to the way pain hurts more nowadays; in other words, it would have to appear translated into the imaginative and spiritual and embellished with nothing but names so unobjectionable that they arouse no suspicion in even the most delicate hypocritical conscience ("tragic pity" is one such name; another is "les nostalgies de la croix" [nostalgias for the cross]). What truly enrages people about suffering is not the suffering itself, but the meaninglessness of suffering. But neither for the Christian, who has interpreted into suffering an entire secret machinery for salvation, nor for the naive men of older times, who understood how to interpret all suffering in relation to the spectator or to the person inflicting the suffering, was there generally any such meaningless suffering. In order for the hidden, undiscovered, unwitnessed suffering to be removed from the world and for people to be able to deny it honestly, they were then almost compelled to invent gods and intermediate beings at all levels, high and low—briefly put, something that also roamed in hidden places, that also looked into the darkness, and that would not readily permit an interesting painful spectacle to escape its attention. For with the help of such inventions life then understood and has always understood how to justify itself by a trick, how to justify its "evil." Nowadays perhaps it requires other helpful inventions for that purpose (for example, life as riddle, life as a problem of knowledge). "Every evil a glimpse of which edifies a god is justified": that's how the pre-historical logic of feeling rang out—and was that really confined only to prehistory? The gods conceived of as friends of cruel spectacle—O how widely this primitive idea still rises up even within our European humanity! We might well seek advice from, say, Calvin and Luther on this point. At any rate it is certain that even the Greeks knew of no more acceptable snack to offer their gods to make them happy than the joys of cruelty. With what sort of expression, do you think, did Homer allow his gods to look down on the fates of men? What final sense was there basically in the Trojan War and similar tragic terrors? We cannot entertain the slightest doubts about this: they were intended as celebrations for the gods: and, to the extent that the poet is in these matters more "godlike" than other men, as festivals for the poets as well. . . . Later the Greek moral philosophers in the

same way imagined the eyes of god no differently, still looking down on the moral struggles, on heroism and the self-mutilation of the virtuous: the “Hercules of duty” was on a stage, and he knew he was there. Without someone watching, virtue for this race of actors was something entirely inconceivable. Surely such a daring and fateful philosophical invention, first made for Europe at that time, the invention of the “free will,” of the absolutely spontaneous nature of human beings in matters of good and evil, was created above all to justify the idea that the interest of gods in men, in human virtue, could never run out? On this earthly stage there was never to be any lack of really new things, really unheard of suspense, complications, and catastrophes. A world conceived of as perfectly deterministic would have been predictable to the gods and therefore also soon boring for them—reason enough for these friends of the gods, the philosophers, not to ascribe such a deterministic world to their gods! All of ancient humanity is full of sensitive consideration for “the spectator,” for a truly public, truly visible world, which did not know how to imagine happiness without dramatic performances and festivals. And, as I have already said, in great punishment there is also so much celebration!

I.8 — On the Genealogy of Morals, First Essay §10-11

ON THE GENEALOGY OF MORALS, FIRST ESSAY §10-11 (Translated by Ian Johnston)

The slave revolt in morality begins when the resentment itself becomes creative and gives birth to values: the resentment of those beings who are prevented from a

genuine reaction, that is, something active, and who compensate for that with a merely imaginary vengeance.⁽⁹⁾ Whereas all noble morality grows out of a triumphant affirmation of one’s own self, slave morality from the start says “No” to what is “outside,” “other,” “not itself.” And this “No” is its creative act. This transformation of the glance which confers value—this necessary projection towards what is outer instead of back onto itself—that is inherent in resentment. In order to arise, slave morality always requires first an opposing world, a world outside itself. Psychologically speaking, it needs external stimuli in order to act at all—its action is basically reaction. The reverse is the case with the noble method of valuing: it acts and grows spontaneously. It seeks its opposite only to affirm its own self even more thankfully, with even more rejoicing—its negative concept of “low,” “common,” “bad” is merely a pale contrasting image after the fact in relation to its positive basic concept, thoroughly saturated with life and passion, “We are noble, good, beautiful, and

happy!" When the noble way of evaluating makes a mistake and abuses reality, this happens with reference to the sphere which it does not know well enough, indeed, the sphere it has strongly resisted learning the truth about: under certain circumstances it misjudges the sphere it despises, the sphere of the common man, of the low people. On the other hand, even if we assume that the feeling of contempt, of looking down, or of looking superior falsifies the image of the person despised, we should note that such distortion will fall short by a long way of the distortion with which the suppressed hatred and vengeance of the powerless man assaults his opponent—naturally, in effigy. In fact, contempt contains too much negligence, too much lack of concern, too much looking away and impatience mixed in with it, even too much of a personal feeling of joy, for it to be capable of converting its object into a truly distorted image and monster. We should not fail to hear the almost benevolent nuances which, for example, the Greek nobility places in all the words with which it separates itself from the lower people—how a constant form of pity, consideration, and forbearance is mixed in there, sweetening the words, to the point where almost all words referring to the common man finally remain as expressions for "unhappy" and "worthy of pity" (compare δειλός

[deilos: cowardly], δέλαιος

[delaïos: mean, low], πονηρός

[poneros: oppressed by toil, wretched],

μοχθηρός

[mochtheros: suffering, wretched]—the last two basically designating the common man as a slave worker and beast of burden—and how, on the other hand, for the Greek ear the words "bad," "low," and "unhappy" have never stopped echoing a single note, one tone colour, in which "unhappy" predominates. This is the inheritance of the old, nobler, and aristocratic way of evaluating, which does not betray its principles even in contempt. (—Philologists should recall the sense in which

οἷζυρος [oizuros: miserable],

άνολβος [anolbos: unblest], τλήμων [tlemon: wretched]

δυστυχεῖν

[dystychein: unfortunate] and

ξυμφορά [xymfora: misfortune] were used). The “well born” simply felt they were “the happy ones”; they did not have to construct their happiness artificially first by looking at their enemies, or in some circumstances to talk themselves into it, to lie to themselves into it (the way all men of resentment habitually do). Similarly they knew, as complete men overloaded with power and thus necessarily active, that they must not separate action from happiness—they considered being active necessarily associated with happiness (that’s where the phrase εὖ πράττειν

[eu prattein: do well, succeed] derives its origin)—all this is very much the opposite of “happiness” at the level of the powerless and oppressed, those festering with poisonous and hostile feelings, among whom happiness comes out essentially as a narcotic, an anaesthetic, quiet, peace, “Sabbath,” relaxing the soul, and stretching one’s limbs, in short, as something passive. While the noble man lives for himself with trust and candour (γενναῖος

[gennaios], meaning “of noble birth,” stresses the nuance “upright” and also probably “naive”), the man of resentment is neither upright nor naive, nor honest and direct with himself. His soul squints. His spirit loves hiding places, secret paths, and back doors. Everything furtive attracts him as his world, his security, his refreshment. He understands about remaining silent, not forgetting, waiting, temporarily diminishing himself, humiliating himself. A race of such men of resentment will inevitably end up cleverer than any noble race. It will also value cleverness to a completely different extent, that is, as a condition of existence of the utmost importance; whereas, cleverness among noble men easily acquires a delicate aftertaste of luxury and sophistication about it:—here it is simply far less important than the complete functional certainty of the ruling unconscious instincts or even a certain lack of cleverness, something like brave recklessness, whether in the face of danger or of an enemy, or those wildly enthusiastic, sudden fits of anger, love, reverence, thankfulness, and vengeance, by which in all ages noble souls have recognized each other. The resentment of the noble man himself, if it comes over him, consumes and exhausts itself in an immediate reaction and therefore does not poison. On the other hand, in countless cases it just does not appear at all; whereas, in the case of all weak and powerless people it is unavoidable. Being unable to take one’s enemies, one’s misfortunes, even one’s bad deeds seriously for any length of time—that is the mark of strong, complete natures, in whom there is a surplus of plastic, creative, healing power, as well as the power to make one forget (a good example for that from the modern world is Mirabeau, who had no memory of the insults and the maliciousness people directed at him and who therefore could not forgive, merely because he—

forgot). Such a man with a single shrug simply throws off himself the many worms which eat into other men.(10) Only here is the real “love for one’s enemy” even possible—provided that it is at all possible on earth.—How much respect a noble man already has for his enemies!—and such a respect is already a bridge to love. . . . In fact, he demands his enemy for himself, as his mark of honour. Indeed, he has no enemy other than one in whom there is nothing to despise and a great deal to respect! By contrast, imagine for yourself “the enemy” as a man of resentment conceives him—and right here we have his action, his creation: he has conceptualized “the evil enemy,” “the evil one,” as, in fact, a fundamental idea from which he now also thinks his way to a complementary image and counterpart, a “good man”—himself! . . .

We see exactly the opposite with the noble man, who conceives the fundamental idea “good” in advance and spontaneously, that is, from himself, and from there he first creates a picture of “bad” for himself! This “bad” originating from the noble man and that “evil” arising out of the stew pot of insatiable hatred—of these the first is a later creation, an afterthought, a complementary colour; by contrast, the second is the original, the beginning, the essential act in the conception of a slave morality—although the two words “bad” and “evil” both seem opposite to the same idea of “good,” how different they are! But it is not the same idea of “good.” Instead we should ask who the “evil person” really is in the sense of the morality of resentment. The strict answer to that is as follows: simply the “good person” of the other morality, the noble man, the powerful, the ruling man, only coloured over, only re-interpreted, only looked at again through the poisonous eyes of resentment. Here there is one thing we will be the last to deny: whoever has come to know those “good men” only as enemies, has known them also as nothing but evil enemies, and the same people who are kept within such strict limits by custom, honour, habit, gratitude, and even more by mutual surveillance and jealousy inter pares [among equals] and who, by contrast, demonstrate in relation to each other such resourceful consideration, self-control, refinement, loyalty, pride, and friendship—to the outside, where the strange world, the world of what is foreign to them, begins, these men are not much better than beasts of prey turned loose. Here they enjoy freedom from all social constraints. In the wilderness they make up for the tension which a long fenced-in confinement within the peace of the community brings about. They go back to the innocent conscience of a beast of prey, as joyful monsters, who perhaps walk away from a dreadful sequence of murder, arson, rape, and torture with an exhilaration and spiritual equilibrium, as if they had merely pulled off a student prank, convinced that now the poets once again have something to sing about and praise for a long time to come. At the bottom of all these noble races we cannot

fail to recognize the beast of prey, the blond beast splendidly roaming around in its lust for loot and victory. This hidden basis from time to time needs to be discharged: the beast must come out again, must go back into the wilderness once more,—Roman, Arab, German, Japanese nobility, Homeric heroes, Scandinavian Vikings—in this need they are all alike. It is the noble races that left behind the concept of the “barbarian” in all their tracks, wherever they went. A consciousness of and even a pride in this fact still reveals itself in their highest culture (for example, when Pericles says to his Athenians, in that famous funeral speech, “our audacity has broken a way through to every land and sea, putting up permanent memorials to itself for good and ill”). This “audacity” of the noble races, mad, absurd, and sudden in the way it expresses itself, its unpredictability, even the improbability of its undertakings—Pericles emphatically praises the

ῥαθυμία

[rathumia: freedom of anxiety] of the Athenians—their indifference to and contempt for safety, body, life, comfort, their fearsome cheerfulness and the depth of their joy in all destruction, in all the physical pleasures of victory and cruelty—all this was summed up for those who suffered from such audacity in the image of the “barbarian,” of the “evil enemy,” of something like the “Goth” or “Vandal.”(11) The deep, icy mistrust which the German evokes, as soon as he comes to power, once more again today—is still an after-effect of that unforgettable terror with which for centuries Europe confronted the rage of the blond Germanic beast (although there is hardly any idea linking the old Germanic tribes and we Germans, let alone any blood relationship). Once before I have remarked on Hesiod’s dilemma

when he thought up his sequence of cultural periods and sought to express them as Gold, Silver, and Iron.(12) He didn’t know what to do with the contradiction presented to him by the marvellous but, at the same time, so horrifying and violent world of Homer, other than to make two cultural ages out of one and then place one after the other—first the Age of Heroes and Demigods from Troy and Thebes, just as that world remained in the memories of the noble families who had their own ancestors in it, and then the Age of Iron as that same world appeared to the descendants of the downtrodden, exploited, ill treated, and those carried off and sold—an age of iron, as mentioned: hard, cold, cruel, empty of feeling and scruples, with everything crushed and covered with blood.(13) Assuming as true what in any event is taken as “the truth” nowadays, that it is the point of all culture simply to breed a tame and civilized animal, a domestic pet, out of the beast of prey “man,” then we would undoubtedly have to consider all those instincts of reaction and

of resentment with whose help the noble races and all their ideals were finally disgraced and overpowered as the essential instruments of culture—though to do that would not yet be to claim that the bearers of these instincts also in themselves represented culture. Instead, the opposite would not only be probable—no! nowadays it is visibly apparent! These people carrying instincts of oppression and of a lust for revenge, the descendants of all European and non-European slavery, of all pre-Aryan populations in particular—they represent the regression of mankind! These “instruments of culture” are a disgrace to humanity and more a reason to be suspicious of or a counterargument against “culture” in general! We may well be right when we hang onto our fear of the blond beast at the bottom of all noble races and keep up our guard. But who would not find it a hundred times better to fear, if he could at the same time admire, rather than not fear but in the process no longer be able to rid himself of the disgusting sight of the failures, the stunted, the emaciated, and the poisoned? And is not that our fate? Today what is it that constitutes our aversion to “man”?—For we suffer from man. There’s no doubt of that. It is not a matter of fear. Rather it’s the fact that we have nothing more to fear from man, that the maggot “man” is in the foreground swarming around, that the “tame man,” the hopelessly mediocre and unedifying man, has already learned to feel that he is the goal, the pinnacle, the meaning of history, “the higher man,”—yes indeed, that he has a certain right to feel that about himself, insofar as he feels separate from the excessive number of failed, sick, tired, and spent people, who are nowadays beginning to make Europe stink, so that he senses that he is at least relatively successful, at least still capable of life, of at least saying “Yes” to life.

I.9 — Beyond Good and Evil §265

BEYOND GOOD AND EVIL §265 (Translated by Ian Johnston)

At the risk of annoying innocent ears, I propose the following: egoism belongs to the nature of the noble soul; I mean that unshakeable faith that to a being such as “we are” other beings must be subordinate by nature and have to sacrifice themselves. The noble soul takes this fact of its egoism without any question mark and without the feeling that there is anything harsh, compelled, or arbitrary in it, much more as something that may be established in the fundamental law of things. If he sought out a name for this, he would say “It is justice itself.” In some circumstances which make him hesitate at first, he admits that there are those with rights equal to his own. As soon as he has cleared up this question of rank, he moves among these equals who have the same rights as his with the same confident modesty and sophisticated

reverence which he has in his dealings with himself—in accordance with an inborn heavenly mechanism which all the stars understand. It is one more part of his egoism, this sophistication and self-restraint in his relations with his equals—every star is such an egoist—: his soul honours itself in them and in the rights which it concedes to them. It has no doubt that the exchange of respect and rights, as the essential quality of all interactions, also belongs to the natural condition of things. The noble soul gives as it takes, out of the passionate and sensitive instinct for repayment, which lies deep within it. The idea “favour” has no sense and agreeable fragrance *inter pares* [among equals]; there may be a sublime manner of allowing presents from above to wash over one, as it were, and of drinking them up thirstily like water drops, but for these arts and gestures the noble soul has no skill. Here its egoism hinders it: in general, it is not happy to look “up above”—instead it looks either directly forward, horizontally and slowly, or down—it knows that it is on a height.

PART II: The Pathos of Distance

II.1 — Beyond Good and Evil §257

(See Part I, Section I.1 — Already extracted above.)

The pathos of distance — "that other more mysterious pathos," the longing for an ever-new widening of distances inside the soul itself — is first named here. Without the social distance between classes, the spiritual distance within the soul cannot grow.

II.2 — Beyond Good and Evil §263

BEYOND GOOD AND EVIL §263 (Translated by Ian Johnston)

There is an instinct for rank which, more than anything, is already an indication of a high rank. There is a delight in the nuances of respect which permits us to surmise a noble origin and habits. The refinement, goodness, and loftiness of a soul are put to a dangerous test when something goes past in front of it which is of the first rank, but which is not yet protected by the fear of authority from prying clutches and crudities: something that goes its way unmarked, undiscovered, tentative, perhaps arbitrarily disguised and hidden, like a living touchstone. The man whose task and practice is to investigate souls will use precisely this art in a number of different forms in order to establish the ultimate value of a soul, the unalterable innate order of rank to which it belongs: he will put it to the test for its instinct of reverence. *Différence engendre haine* [Difference engenders hatred]: the nastiness of some natures suddenly spurts out like dirty water when some sacred container, some precious object from a locked shrine, or some book with marks of a great destiny is carried by. On the other hand, there is an involuntary falling silent, a hesitation in the eye, an end to all gestures, things which express that a soul feels close to something most worthy of reverence. The way in which reverence for the Bible in Europe has, on the whole, been maintained so far is perhaps the best piece of discipline and refinement of habits for which Europe owes a debt of thanks to Christianity: such books of profundity and ultimate significance need for their protection an externally imposed tyranny of authority in order to last for those thousands of years necessary to exhaust them and sort out what they mean. Much has been achieved when in the great

mass of people (the shallow ones and all sorts of people with diarrhoea) the feeling has finally been cultivated that they are not permitted to touch everything, that there are sacred experiences before which they have to pull off their shoes and which they must keep their dirty hands off—this is almost the highest intensification of their humanity. By contrast, perhaps nothing makes the so-called educated people, those who have faith in “modern ideas,” so nauseating as their lack of shame, the comfortable impudence in their eyes and hands, with which they touch, lick, and grope everything, and it is possible that these days among a people, one still finds in the common folk, particularly among the peasants, more relative nobility of taste and tactful reverence than among the newspaper-reading demi-monde of the spirit, among the educated.

II.3 — Beyond Good and Evil §264

BEYOND GOOD AND EVIL §264 (Translated by Ian Johnston)

One cannot erase from a human being’s soul those actions which his ancestors loved most and carried out most steadfastly: whether they were, for example, industrious savers attached to a writing table and money box, modest and bourgeois in their desires, as well as modest in their virtues, or whether they were accustomed to live giving orders from morning until night, fond of harsh entertainment and, along with that, perhaps of even harsher duties and responsibilities; or whether, finally, they had at some time or other once sacrificed the old privileges of their birth and possessions in order to live entirely for their faith—for their “god”—as men of an unrelenting and delicate conscience, which blushes when confronted with any compromise. It is in no way possible that a man does not possess in his body the characteristics and preferences of his parents and forefathers, no matter what appearance might say to the contrary. This is the problem of race. If we know something about the parents, then we may draw a conclusion about the child: some unpleasant excess or other, some lurking envy, a crude habit of self-justification—these three together have at all times made up the essential type of the rabble—something like that must be passed onto the child as surely as corrupt blood, and with the help of the best education and culture people will succeed only in deceiving others about such heredity. And nowadays what else do education and culture want! In our age, one very much of the people—I mean to say our uncouth age—“education” and “culture” must basically be the art of deception—to mislead about the origin of the inherited rabble in one’s body and soul. Today an educator who preached truthfulness above everything else and constantly shouted at his students “Be true! Be natural! Act as you really are!”—even such a virtuous and true-hearted jackass would after some time

learn to take hold of that furca [pitchfork] of Horace, in order to naturam expellere [drive out nature]. With what success? “Rabble” usque recurret [will always return].(1)

II.4 — Beyond Good and Evil §268

BEYOND GOOD AND EVIL §268 (Translated by Ian Johnston)

Ultimately, what does it mean to be ignoble?—Words are sound signals for ideas, but ideas are more or less firm image signs for sensations which return frequently and occur together, for groups of sensations. To understand each other, it is not yet sufficient that people use the same words; they must also use the same words for the same form of inner experiences; in the end they must hold their experience in common with each other. That’s why human beings belonging to a single people understand each other better among themselves than associations of different peoples, even when they use the same language; or rather, when human beings have lived together for a long time under similar conditions (climate, soil, danger, needs, work), then something arises out of that which “understands itself”—a people. In all souls, a similar number of frequently repeating experiences have won the upper hand over those which come more rarely; people understand each other on the basis of the former quickly and with ever-increasing speed—the history of language is the history of a process of abbreviation, and on the basis of this rapid understanding, people bind with one another, closely and with ever-increasing closeness. The greater the danger, the greater the need quickly and easily to come to agreement over what needs to be done; not to misunderstand each other when in danger is what people simply cannot do without in their interactions. With every friendship or love affair people still make this test: nothing of that sort lasts as soon as people reach the point where, with the same words, one of the two feels, means, senses, wishes, or fears something different from the other one. (The fear of the “eternal misunderstanding”: that is the benevolent genius which so often prevents people of different sexes from over-hasty unions, to which their senses and hearts urge them—and not some Schopenhauerish “genius of the species”!). Which groups of sensations within the soul wake up most rapidly, seize the word, give the order—that decides about the whole rank ordering of its values, that finally determines its tables of goods. The assessments of value in a man reveal something about the structure of his soul and where it looks for its conditions of life, its essential needs. Now, assume that need has always brought together only such people as could indicate with similar signs similar requirements and similar experiences, then it generally turns out that the easy ability to communicate need, that is, in

the last analysis, familiarity with only average and common experiences, must have been the most powerful of all the forces which have so far determined things among human beings. People who are more similar and more ordinary have been and always are at an advantage; the more exceptional, more refined, rarer, and more difficult to understand easily remain isolated; in their isolation they are subject to accidents and rarely propagate themselves. People have to summon up huge counter-forces to check this natural, all-too-natural progressus in simile [advance into similarity], the further development of human beings into what's similar, ordinary, average, herd-like—into what's common.

II.5 — On the Genealogy of Morals, Second Essay §1-3

ON THE GENEALOGY OF MORALS, SECOND ESSAY §1-3 (Translated by Ian Johnston)

To breed an animal that is entitled to make promises—is that not precisely the paradoxical task nature has set itself where human beings are concerned? Isn't that the real problem of human beings? . . . The fact that this problem has to a great extent been solved must seem all the more astonishing to a person who knows how to appreciate fully the power which works against this promise-making, namely forgetfulness. Forgetfulness is not merely a vis interia [a force of inertia], as superficial people think. Is it much rather an active capability to repress, something positive in the strongest sense, to which we can ascribe the fact that while we are digesting what we alone live through and experience and absorb into ourselves (we could call the process mental ingestion [Einverseelung]), we are conscious of what is going on as little as we are with the entire thousand-fold process which our bodily nourishment goes through (so-called physical ingestion [Einverleibung]). The doors and windows of consciousness are shut temporarily; they remain undisturbed by the noise and struggle with which the underworld of our functional organs keeps working for and against one another; a little stillness, a little tabula rasa [blank slate] of the consciousness, so that there will again be room for something new, above all, for the nobler functions and officials, for ruling, thinking ahead, determining what to do (for our organism is arranged as an oligarchy)—that is, as I said, the use of active forgetfulness, a porter at the door, so to speak, a custodian of psychic order, quiet, etiquette. From that we can see at once how, if forgetfulness were not present, there could be no happiness, no cheerfulness, no hoping, no pride, no present. The man in whom this repression apparatus is harmed and not working properly we can compare to a dyspeptic (and not just compare)—he is “finished” with nothing. . . . Now, this particular animal, which

is necessarily forgetful, in which forgetfulness is present as a force, as a form of strong health, has had an opposing capability bred into it, a memory, with the help of which, in certain cases, forgetfulness will cease to function—that is, for those cases where promises are to be made. This is in no way a merely passive inability ever to be rid of an impression once it has been etched into the mind, nor is it merely indigestion over a word one has pledged at a particular time and which one can no longer be over and done with. No, it's an active wish not to be free of the matter again, an ongoing and continuing desire for what one willed at a particular time, a real memory of one's will, so that between the original "I will," "I will do," and the actual discharge of the will, its action, a world of strange w things, circumstances, even acts of the will can be interposed without a second thought and not break this long chain of the will. But how much all that presupposes! In order to organize the future in this manner, human beings must have first learned to separate necessary events from chance events, to think in terms of cause and effect, to see distant events as if they were present, to anticipate them, to set goals and the means to reach them with certainty, to develop a capability for figures and calculations in general—and for that to occur, a human being must necessarily have first himself become something one could predict, something bound by regular rules, even in the way he imagined himself to himself, so that finally he is able to act like someone who makes promises—he can make himself into a pledge for the future!

Precisely that development is the long history of the origin of responsibility. That task of breeding an animal which is permitted to make promises contains within it, as we have already grasped, as a condition and prerequisite, the more precise task of first making a human being necessarily uniform to some extent, one among others like him, regular and consequently predictable. The immense task involved in this, what I have called the "morality of custom" (cf. *Daybreak* 9, 14, 16)—the essential work of a man on his own self in the longest-lasting age of the human race, his entire pre-historical work, derives its meaning, its grand justification, from the following point, no matter how much hardship, tyranny, monotony, and idiocy it also manifested: with the help of the morality of custom and the social strait jacket, the human being was made truly predictable. Let's position ourselves, by contrast, at the end of this immense process, in the place where the tree at last yields its fruit, where society and the morality of custom finally bring to light the end for which they were simply the means: then we find, as the ripest fruit on that tree, the sovereign individual, something which resembles only itself, which has broken loose again from the morality of custom, the autonomous individual beyond morality (for "autonomous" and "moral" are mutually exclusive terms), in short, the

human being who possesses his own independent and enduring will, who is entitled to make promises—and in him a consciousness quivering in every muscle, proud of what has finally been achieved and has become a living embodiment in him, a real consciousness of power and freedom, a feeling of completion for human beings generally. This man who has become free, who really is entitled to make promises, this master of free will, this sovereign—how is he not to realize the superiority he enjoys over everything which is not permitted to make a promise and make pledges on its own behalf, knowing how much trust, how much fear, and how much respect he creates—he “is worthy” of all three—and how, with this mastery over himself, he has necessarily been given in addition mastery over his circumstances, over nature, and over all less reliable creatures with a shorter will? The “free” man, the owner of an enduring unbreakable will, by possessing this, also acquires his own standard of value: he looks out from himself at others and confers respect or contempt. And just as it will be necessary for him to honour those like him, the strong and dependable (who are entitled to make promises)—in other words, everyone who makes promises like a sovereign, seriously, rarely, and slowly, who is sparing with his trust, who honours another when he does trust, who gives his word as something reliable, because he knows he is strong enough to remain upright even when opposed by misfortune, even when “opposed by fate”—in just the same way it will be necessary for him to keep his foot ready to kick the scrawny unreliable men, who make promises without being entitled to, and to hold his cane ready for the liar, who breaks his word in the very moment it comes out of his mouth. The proud knowledge of the extraordinary privilege of responsibility, the consciousness of this rare freedom, of this power over oneself and destiny, has become internalized into the deepest parts of him and grown instinctual, has become an instinct, a dominating instinct:—what will he call it, this dominating instinct, assuming that he finds he needs a word for it? There’s no doubt: the sovereign man calls this instinct his conscience.

His conscience? . . . To begin with, we can conjecture that the idea “conscience,” which we are encountering here in its highest, almost perplexing form, has a long history and changing developmental process behind it already. To be entitled to pledge one’s word, and to do it with pride, and also to be permitted to say “Yes” to oneself—that is a ripe fruit, as I have mentioned, but it is also a late fruit:—for what a long stretch of time this fruit must have hung tart and sour on the tree! And for an even much longer time it was impossible to see any such fruit—no one could have promised it would appear, even if everything about the tree was certainly getting ready for it and growing in that very direction!—“How does one create a memory for the human animal? How does one stamp something like that into this partly dull, partly flickering,

momentary understanding, this living embodiment of forgetfulness, so that it stays current?" . . . This ancient problem, as you can imagine, was not resolved right away with tender answers and methods. Indeed, there is perhaps nothing more fearful and more terrible in the entire prehistory of human beings than the technique for developing his memory. "We burn something in so that it remains in the memory. Only something which never ceases to cause pain remains in the memory"—that is a leading principle of the most ancient (unfortunately also the longest) psychology on earth. We might even say that everywhere on earth nowadays where there is still solemnity, seriousness, mystery, and gloomy colours in the lives of men and people, something of that terror continues its work, the fear with which in earlier times everywhere on earth people made promises, pledged their word, made a vow. The past, the longest, deepest, most severe past, breathes on us and surfaces in us when we become "solemn." When the human being considered it necessary to make a memory for himself, it never happened without blood, martyrs, and sacrifices, the most terrible sacrifices and pledges (among them the sacrifice of the first born), the most repulsive self-mutilations (for example, castration), the cruellest forms of ritual in all the religious cults (and all religions are in their deepest foundations systems of cruelty)—all that originates in that instinct which discovered in pain the most powerful means of helping to develop the memory. In a certain sense all asceticism belongs here: a couple of ideas are to be made indissoluble, omnipresent, unforgettable, "fixed," in order to hypnotize the entire nervous and intellectual system through these "fixed ideas"—and the ascetic procedures and forms of life are the means whereby these ideas are freed from jostling around with all the other ideas, in order to make them "unforgettable." The worse humanity's "memory" was, the more terrible its customs have always appeared. The harshness of the laws of punishment, in particular, provide a standard for measuring how much trouble people went to in order to triumph over forgetfulness and to maintain a present awareness of a few primitive demands of social living together for this slave of momentary feelings and desires. We Germans certainly do not think of ourselves as an especially cruel and hard-hearted people, even less as particularly careless people who live only in the present. But just take a look at our old penal code in order to understand how much trouble it takes on this earth to breed a "People of Thinkers" (by that I mean the European people among whom today we still find a maximum of trust, seriousness, tastelessness, and practicality, and who, with these characteristics, have a right to breed all sorts of European mandarins). These Germans have used terrible means to make themselves a memory in order to attain mastery over their vulgar basic instincts and their brutal crudity: think of the old German punishments, for example, stoning (—the legend even lets the mill stone fall on the head of the guilty person),

breaking on the wheel (the most characteristic invention and specialty of the German genius in the realm of punishment!), impaling on a stake, ripping people apart or stamping them to death with horses ("quartering"), boiling the criminal in oil or wine (still done in the fourteenth and fifteenth centuries), the well-loved practice of flaying ("cutting flesh off in strips"), carving flesh out of the chest, and probably covering the offender with honey and leaving him to the flies in the burning sun. With the help of such images and procedures people finally retained five or six "I will not's" in the memory, and, so far as these precepts were concerned, they gave their word in order to live with the advantages of society—and it's true! With the assistance of this sort of memory people finally came to "reason"—Ah, reason, seriousness, mastery over emotions, this whole gloomy business called reflection, all these privileges and showpieces of human beings: how expensive they were! How much blood and horror is at the bottom of all "good things"! . . .

II.6 — Thus Spoke Zarathustra: Prologue §3-5

THUS SPOKE ZARATHUSTRA, PROLOGUE §3-5 (Translated by Graham Parkes)

II.7 — Thus Spoke Zarathustra: On the Three Metamorphoses

THUS SPOKE ZARATHUSTRA, "ON THE THREE METAMORPHOSES"
(Translated by Graham Parkes)

Three transformations of the spirit I name for you: how the spirit becomes a camel,* and the camel a lion, and the lion at last a child.

There is much that is heavy for the spirit, for the strong, weight-bearing spirit in which reverence dwells: the heavy and the hardest are what its strength desires.

What is heavy? Thus asks the weight-bearing spirit, and thus it kneels down, like the camel, and would be well laden.

What is heaviest, you heroes? Thus asks the weight-bearing spirit. That I may take it upon me and become well pleased with my strength.

Is it not this: lowering oneself, in order to hurt one's haughtiness? Letting one's folly shine forth, in order to mock one's wisdom?

Or is it this: separating from our cause when it celebrates victory? Climbing high mountains in order to tempt the tempter?*

Or is it this: feeding on the acorns and grass of understanding and for the sake of truth suffering hunger of the soul?

Or is it this: being sick and sending the comforters home, and making friends with deaf people who never hear what it is you want?

Or is it this: stepping into filthy waters, as long as they are the waters of truth, and not repelling cold frogs or hot toads?

Or is it this: loving those who despise us, and offering the spectre our hand when it wants to frighten us?

All these heaviest things the weight-bearing spirit takes upon itself: like the camel that presses on well laden into the desert, thus does the spirit press on into its desert.

But in the loneliest desert the second transformation occurs: the spirit here becomes a lion; it will seize freedom for itself and become lord in its own desert.

Its ultimate lord it seeks out here: his enemy it will become and enemy of his ultimate god; it will wrestle for victory with the great dragon.*

What is the great dragon that the spirit no longer likes to call Lord and God? 'Thou shalt' is the name of the great dragon. But the spirit of the lion says 'I will.'

'Thou shalt' lies in its way, sparkling with gold, a scaly beast,* and on every scale there glistens, golden, 'Thou shalt!'

Values thousands of years old glisten on these scales, and thus speaks the mightiest of all dragons: 'All value in things—that glistens on me.'

'All value has already been created, and all created value—that is me. Verily, there shall be no more "I will"!' Thus speaks the dragon.

My brothers, why is the lion needed in the spirit? Why does the beast of burden, which renounces and is reverent, not suffice?

To create new values—that even the lion cannot yet do: but to create for itself freedom for new creation—that is within the power of the lion.

To create freedom for oneself and a sacred Nay even to duty: for that, my brothers, the lion is needed.

To seize the right to new values—that is the most terrible seizure for a weight-bearing and reverent spirit. Verily, a predation it is to such a spirit and a matter for a predatory beast.

Once it loved, as most sacred for it, ‘Thou shalt’: now it must find delusion and caprice even in the most sacred, that it might seize its freedom from its love: for this predation the lion is needed.

But say, my brothers, what can the child yet do that even the lion could not do? Why must the predatory lion yet become a child?

Innocence the child is* and forgetting, a beginning anew, a play, a self-propelling wheel, a first movement, a sacred Yea-saying.

Yes, for the play of creating, my brothers, a sacred Yea-saying is needed: the spirit now wills its own will, the one who had lost the world attains its own world.*

Three transformations of the spirit have I named for you: how the spirit became a camel, and the camel a lion, and the lion at last a child.—

Thus spoke Zarathustra. And at that time he was staying in the town that is called: The Motley Cow.*

Thus Spoke Zarathustra

PART III: Breeding and the Fixation of Type

III.1 — Beyond Good and Evil §262

BEYOND GOOD AND EVIL §262 (Translated by Ian Johnston)

A species arises, a type becomes established and strong, under the long struggle with essentially unchanging, unfavourable conditions. By contrast, we know from the experience of breeders that species which receive an ultra-abundant nourishment and, in general, an increase in protection and care immediately tend towards variety in the type in the strongest manner and are rich in wonders and monstrosities (as well as monstrous vices). Now, let's look at an aristocratic commonwealth—for example, an ancient Greek polis [city state] or Venice—as an organization, whether voluntary or involuntary, for the purpose of breeding. There are men there living together who rely upon one another and who want their species to succeed mainly because it has to succeed or run the fearful risk of being annihilated. Here there is a lack of that advantage, that excess, that protection under which variations are encouraged. The species senses the need for itself as a species, as something which, particularly thanks to its hardness, uniformity, and simplicity of form, can generally succeed and enable itself to keep going in the constant struggles with neighbours or with the rebellious oppressed people or with those who threaten rebellion. The most varied experience teaches them which characteristics they have to thank, above all, for the fact that they are still there, in spite of all the gods and men, that they have always been victorious up to this point. These characteristics they call virtues, and they cultivate only these virtues to any great extent. They do that with severity—in fact, they desire severity. Every aristocratic morality is intolerant in its education of the young, its provisions for women, its marriage customs, its relationships between young and old, and its penal laws (which fix their eyes only on those who are deviants)—it reckons intolerance itself among the virtues, under the name “justice.” A type with few but very strong characteristics, a species of strict, warlike, shrewdly laconic people, close-knit and reserved (and, as such, having the most sophisticated feelings for the charm and nuances of society) in this way establishes itself over and above the changes in the generations. The constant struggle with unvarying, unfavourable conditions is, as mentioned, the factor that makes a type fixed and hard. Finally, however, at some point a fortunate time arises, which lets the immense tension ease. Perhaps there are

no more enemies among the neighbours, and the means for living, even for enjoying life, are there in abundance. With one blow the bond and the compulsion of the old discipline are torn apart: that discipline no longer registers as necessary, as a condition of existence—if it wished to remain in existence, it could do so only as a form of luxury, as an archaic taste. Variation, whether as something abnormal (something higher, finer, and rarer) or as degeneration and monstrosity, suddenly bursts onto the scene in the greatest abundance and splendour; the individual dares to be individual and stand apart. At these historical turning points there appear alongside each other and often involved and mixed up together marvellous, multifaceted, jungle-like growths, an upward soaring, a kind of tropical tempo in competitiveness for growing and an immense annihilation and self-destruction, thanks to the wild egoisms turned against each other and, as it were, exploding, which wrestle with one another “for sun and light” and no longer know how to derive any limit, any restraint, or any consideration from the morality they have had up to that point. This very morality was the one which built up such immense power, which bent the bow in such a threatening manner—now, at this moment, it is and is becoming “outdated.” The dangerous and disturbing point is reached where the greater, more multifaceted, and more comprehensive life lives beyond the old morality; the “individual” stands there, forced to give himself his own laws, his own arts and tricks for self-preservation, self-raising, and self-redemption. Nothing but new what-for’s, nothing but new how-to’s, no common formulas any more, misunderstanding and contempt bound up together, decay, spoilage, and the highest desires tied together in a ghastly way, the genius of the race brimming over from all the horns of plenty with good and bad, an ominous simultaneous presence of spring and autumn, full of new charms and veils, characteristic of young, still unexhausted, still unwearied depravity. Once again there’s danger there, the mother of morality, great danger, this time transferred into the individual, into one’s neighbour and friend, into the alleyways, into one’s own child, into one’s own heart, into all the narrowest and most secret parts of one’s wishes and desires. What will the moral philosophers who emerge at such a time now have to preach? They discover, these keen observers and street loafers, that things are quickly coming to an end, that everything around them is going rotten and spreading corruption, that nothing lasts until the day after tomorrow, except for one kind of person, the incurably mediocre. Only the mediocre have the prospect of succeeding, of reproducing themselves—they are the people of the future, the only survivors, “Be like them! Become mediocre!”—from now on that’s the only morality that still makes sense, that people still hear.—But it is difficult to preach, this morality of mediocrity!—it may never admit what it is and what it wants! It

must speak about restraint and worth and duty and love of one's neighbour—it will have difficulty concealing its irony!

III.2 — On the Genealogy of Morals, Second Essay §16-17

ON THE GENEALOGY OF MORALS, SECOND ESSAY §16-17 (Translated by Ian Johnston)

At this point, I can no longer avoid setting out, in an initial, provisional statement, my own hypothesis about the origin of "bad conscience." It is not easy to get people to attend to it, and it requires them to consider it at length, to guard it, and to sleep on it. I consider bad conscience the profound illness which human beings had to come down with under the pressure of that most fundamental of all the changes which they ever experienced—that change when they finally found themselves locked within the confines of society and peace. Just like the things water animals must have gone through when they were forced either to become land animals or to die off, so events must have played themselves out with this half-beast so happily adapted to the wilderness, war, wandering around, adventure—suddenly all its instincts were devalued and "disengaged." From this point on, these animals were to go on foot and "carry themselves"; whereas previously they had been supported by the water. A terrible heaviness weighed them down. In performing the simplest things they felt ungainly. In dealing with this new unknown world, they no longer had their old leaders, the ruling unconscious drives which guided them safely—these unfortunate creatures were reduced to thinking, inferring, calculating, bringing together cause and effect, reduced to their "consciousness," their most impoverished and error-prone organ! I believe that never on earth has there been such a feeling of misery, such a leaden discomfort—while at the same time those old instincts had not all of a sudden stopped imposing their demands! Only it was difficult and seldom possible to do their bidding. For the most part, they had to find new and, as it were, underground satisfactions for themselves. All instincts which are not discharged to the outside are turned back inside—this is what I call the internalization [Verinnerlichung] of man. From this first grows in man what people later call his "soul." The entire inner world, originally as thin as if stretched between two layers of skin, expanded and extended itself, acquired depth, width, and height, to the extent that what a person discharged out into the world was obstructed. Those frightening fortifications with which the organization of the state protected itself against the old instincts for freedom—punishments belong above all to these fortifications—brought it about that all those instincts of the wild, free, roaming man turned themselves backwards, against man himself. Enmity, cruelty, joy in

pursuit, in attack, in change, in destruction—all those turned themselves against the possessors of such instincts. That is the origin of “bad conscience.” The man who, because of a lack of external enemies and opposition, was forced into an oppressive narrowness and regularity of custom impatiently tore himself apart, persecuted himself, gnawed away at himself, grew upset, and did himself damage—this animal which scraped itself raw against the bars of its cage, which people want to “tame,” this impoverished creature, consumed with longing for the wild, which had to create out of its own self an adventure, a torture chamber, an uncertain and dangerous wilderness—this fool, this yearning and puzzled prisoner, became the inventor of “bad conscience.” But with him was introduced the greatest and weirdest illness, from which humanity up to the present time has not recovered, the suffering of man from man, from himself, a consequence of the forcible separation from his animal past, a leap and, so to speak, a fall into new situations and living conditions, a declaration of war against the old instincts, on which, up to that point, his power, joy, and ability to inspire fear had been based. Let us at once add that, on the other hand, the fact that there was on earth an animal soul turned against itself, taking sides against itself, meant there was something so new, profound, unheard of, enigmatic, contradictory, and full of the future, that with it the picture of the earth was fundamentally changed. In fact, it required divine spectators to appreciate the dramatic performance which then began and whose conclusion is by no means yet in sight—a spectacle too fine, too wonderful, too paradoxical, to be allowed to play itself out senselessly and unobserved on some ridiculous star or other! Since then man has been included among the most unexpected and most thrillingly lucky rolls of the dice in the game played by Heraclitus’ “great child,” whether he’s called Zeus or chance. (7) For himself he arouses a certain interest, a tension, a hope, almost a certainty, as if something is announcing itself with him, something is preparing itself, as if the human being were not the goal but only a way, an episode, a bridge, a great promise . . .

Inherent in this hypothesis about the origin of bad conscience is, firstly, the assumption that the change was not gradual or voluntary and did not manifest itself as an organic growth into new conditions, but as a break, a leap, something forced, an irrefutable disaster, against which there was no struggle, nor even any resentment. Secondly, however, it assumes that the adaptation of a populace hitherto unchecked and shapeless into a fixed form, just as it was initiated by an act of violence, was carried to its conclusion by nothing but acts of violence—that consequently the oldest “State” emerged as a terrible tyranny, as an oppressive and inconsiderate machinery, and continued working until such raw materials of people and half-animals finally were not only thoroughly

kneaded and submissive but also given a shape. I used the word "State": it is self-evident who is meant by that term—some pack of blond predatory animals, a race of conquerors and masters, which, organized for war and with the power to organize, without thinking about it, sets its terrifying paws on a subordinate population which may perhaps be vast in numbers but is still without any form, is still wandering about. That is, in fact, the way the "State" begins on earth. I believe that fantasy has been done away with which sees the beginning of the state in a "contract." The man who can command, who is by nature a "master," who comes forward with violence in his actions and gestures—what has he to do with making contracts! We do not negotiate with such beings. They come like fate, without cause, reason, consideration, or pretext. They are present as lightning is present, too fearsome, too sudden, too convincing, too "different" even to become merely hated. Their work is the instinctive creation of forms, the imposition of forms. They are the most involuntary and most unconscious artists in existence:—where they appear something new is soon present, a power structure which lives, something in which the parts and functions are demarcated and coordinated, in which there is, in general, no place for anything which does not first derive its "meaning" from its relationship to the totality. These men, these born organizers, have no idea what guilt, responsibility, and consideration are. In them that fearsome egotism of the artist is in charge, which stares out like bronze and knows how to justify itself for all time in the "work," just as a mother does in her child. They are not the ones in whom "bad conscience" grew—that point is obvious from the outset. But this hateful plant would not have grown without them. It would have failed if an immense amount of freedom had not been driven from the world under the pressure of their hammer blows, their artistic violence, or at least had not been driven from sight and, as it were made latent. This powerful instinct for freedom, once made latent—we already understand how—this instinct for freedom driven back, repressed, imprisoned inside, and finally still able to discharge and direct itself only against itself—that and that alone is what bad conscience is in its beginning.

III.3 — Twilight of the Idols: The Problem of Socrates §1-11

TWILIGHT OF THE IDOLS, "THE PROBLEM OF SOCRATES" §1-11

(Translated by R.J. Hollingdale)

§1

In every age the wisest have passed the identical judgement on life: it is worthless. ... Everywhere and always their mouths have uttered the same sound – a sound full of doubt, full of melancholy, full of weariness with life, full of opposition to life. Even Socrates said as he died: ‘To live – that means to be a long time sick: I owe a cock to the saviour Asclepius’.* Even Socrates had had enough of it. – What does that prove? What does it point to? – Formerly one would have said (– oh, and did say, and loudly enough, and our pessimists† most of all!): ‘Here at any rate there must be something true! The consensus sapientium ‡ is proof of truth.’ – Shall we still speak thus today? are we allowed to do so? ‘Here at any rate there must be something sick’ – this is our retort: one ought to take a closer look at them, these wisest of every age! Were they all of them perhaps no longer steady on their legs? belated? tottery? *décadents*? Does wisdom perhaps appear on earth as a raven which is inspired by the smell of carrion?...

§2

This irreverent notion that the great sages are declining types first dawned on me in regard to just the case in which learned and unlearned prejudice is most strongly opposed to it: I recognized Socrates and Plato as symptoms of decay, as agents of the dissolution of Greece, as pseudo-Greek, as anti-Greek (*Birth of Tragedy*, 1872)*. That consensus sapientium – I saw more and more clearly – proves least of all that they were right about what they were in accord over: it proves rather that they themselves, these wisest men, were in some way in physiological accord since they stood – had to stand – in the same negative relation to life. Judgements, value judgements concerning life, for or against, can in the last resort never be true: they possess value only as symptoms, they come into consideration only as symptoms – in themselves such judgements are stupidities. One must reach out and try to grasp this astonishing finesse, that the value of life cannot be estimated. Not by a living man, because he is a party to the dispute, indeed its object, and not the judge of it; not by a dead one, for another reason. – For a philosopher to see a problem in the value of life thus even constitutes an objection to him, a question-mark as to his wisdom, a piece of unwisdom. – What? and all these great wise men – they have not only been *décadents*, they have not even been wise? – But I shall get back to the problem of Socrates.

§3

Socrates belonged, in his origins, to the lowest orders: Socrates was rabble. One knows, one sees for oneself, how ugly he was. But ugliness, an objection in itself, is among Greeks almost a refutation. Was Socrates a Greek at all?

Ugliness is frequently enough the sign of a thwarted development, a development retarded by interbreeding. Otherwise it appears as a development in decline. Anthropologists among criminologists tell us the typical criminal is ugly: *monstrum in fronte, monstrum in animo*.† But the criminal is a *décadent*. Was Socrates a typical criminal? – At least that famous physiognomist's opinion which Socrates' friends found so objectionable would not contradict this idea. A foreigner passing through Athens who knew how to read faces told Socrates to his face that he was a *monstrum* – that he contained within him every kind of foul vice and lust. And Socrates answered merely: 'You know me, sir!' –

§4

It is not only the admitted dissoluteness and anarchy of his instincts which indicate *décadence* in Socrates: the superfetation of the logical and that barbed malice which distinguishes him also point in that direction. And let us not forget those auditory hallucinations which, as 'Socrates' demon', have been interpreted in a religious sense. Everything about him is exaggerated, *buffo*, caricature, everything is at the same time hidden, reserved, subterranean. – I seek to understand out of what idiosyncrasy that Socratic equation *reason = virtue = happiness* derives: that bizzarrest of equations and one which has in particular all the instincts of the older Hellenes against it.

§5

With Socrates Greek taste undergoes a change in favour of dialectics: what is really happening when that happens? It is above all the defeat of a nobler taste; with dialectics the rabble gets on top. Before Socrates, the dialectical manner was repudiated in good society: it was regarded as a form of bad manners, one was compromised by it. Young people were warned against it. And all such presentation of one's reasons was regarded with mistrust. Honest things, like honest men, do not carry their reasons exposed in this fashion. It is indecent to display all one's goods. What has first to have itself proved is of little value. Wherever authority is still part of accepted usage and one does not 'give reasons' but commands, the dialectician is a kind of *buffoon*: he is laughed at, he is not taken seriously. – Socrates was the *buffoon* who got himself taken seriously: what was really happening when that happened?

§6

One chooses dialectics only when one has no other expedient. One knows that dialectics inspire mistrust, that they are not very convincing. Nothing is easier to expunge than the effect of a dialectician, as is proved by the experience of

every speech-making assembly. Dialectics can be only a last-ditch weapon in the hands of those who have no other weapon left. One must have to enforce one's rights: otherwise one makes no use of it. That is why the Jews were dialecticians; Reynard the Fox was a dialectician: what? and Socrates was a dialectician too? –

§7

– Is Socrates' irony an expression of revolt? of the resentment of the rabble? does he, as one of the oppressed, enjoy his own form of ferocity in the knife-thrust of the syllogism? does he revenge himself on the aristocrats he fascinates? – As a dialectician one is in possession of a pitiless instrument; with its aid one can play the tyrant; one compromises by conquering. The dialectician leaves it to his opponent to demonstrate he is not an idiot: he enrages, he at the same time makes helpless. The dialectician devitalizes his opponent's intellect. – What? is dialectics only a form of revenge in the case of Socrates?

§8

I have intimated the way in which Socrates could repel: it is therefore all the more necessary to explain the fact that he exercised fascination. – That he discovered a new kind of agon, that he was the first fencing-master in it for the aristocratic circles of Athens, is one reason. He fascinated because he touched on the agonal instinct of the Hellenes – he introduced a variation into the wrestling-matches among the youths and young men. Socrates was also a great erotic.

§9

But Socrates divined even more. He saw behind his aristocratic Athenians; he grasped that his case, the idiosyncrasy of his case, was already no longer exceptional. The same kind of degeneration was everywhere silently preparing itself: the old Athens was coming to an end. – And Socrates understood that all the world had need of him – his expedient, his cure, his personal art of selfpreservation.... Everywhere the instincts were in anarchy; everywhere people were but five steps from excess: the monstrum in animo was the universal danger. 'The instincts want to play the tyrant; we must devise a counter-tyrant who is stronger'. ... When that physiognomist had revealed to Socrates what he was, a cave of every evil lust, the great ironist uttered a phrase that provides the key to him. 'That is true,' he said, 'but I have become

master of them all.' How did Socrates become master of himself? – His case was after all only the extreme case, only the most

obvious instance of what had at that time begun to be the universal exigency: that no one was any longer master of himself, that the instincts were becoming mutually antagonistic. He exercised fascination as this extreme case – his fear-inspiring ugliness expressed it for every eye to see: he fascinated even more, it goes without saying, as the answer, as the solution, as the apparent cure for this case. –

§10

If one needs to make a tyrant of reason, as Socrates did, then there must exist no little danger of something else playing the tyrant. Rationality was at that time divined as a saviour; neither Socrates nor his 'invalids' were free to be rational or not, as they wished – it was *de rigueur*, it was their last expedient. The fanaticism with which the whole of Greek thought throws itself at rationality betrays a state of emergency: one was in peril, one had only one choice: either to perish or – be absurdly rational.... The moralism of the Greek philosophers from Plato downwards is pathologically conditioned: likewise their estimation of dialectics. Reason = virtue = happiness means merely: one must imitate Socrates and counter the dark desires by producing a permanent daylight – the daylight of reason. One must be prudent, clear, bright at any cost: every yielding to the instincts, to the unconscious, leads downwards...

§11

I have intimated the way in which Socrates exercised fascination: he seemed to be a physician, a saviour. Is it necessary to go on to point out the error which lay in his faith in 'rationality at any cost'? – It is self-deception on the part of philosophers and moralists to imagine that by making war on *décadence* they therewith elude *décadence* themselves. This is beyond their powers: what they select as an expedient, as a deliverance, is itself only another expression of *décadence* – they alter its expression, they do not abolish the thing itself. Socrates was a misunderstanding: the entire morality of improvement, the Christian included, has been a misunderstanding.... The harshest daylight, rationality at any cost, life bright, cold, circumspect, conscious, without instinct, in opposition to the instincts, has itself been no more than a form of sickness, another form of sickness – and by no means a way back to 'virtue', to 'health', to happiness.... To have to combat one's instincts – that is the formula for *décadence*: as long as life is ascending, happiness and instinct are one. –

§1

You ask me about the idiosyncrasies of philosophers?... There is their lack of historical sense, their hatred of even the idea of becoming, their Egyptianism. They think they are doing a thing honour when they dehistoricize it, *sub specie aeterni** – when they make a mummy of it. All that philosophers have handled for millennia has been conceptual mummies; nothing actual has escaped from their hands alive. They kill, they stuff, when they worship, these conceptual idolaters – they become a mortal danger to everything when they worship. Death, change, age, as well as procreation and growth, are for them objections – refutations even. What is, does not become; what becomes, is not.... Now they all believe, even to the point of despair, in that which is. But since they cannot get hold of it, they look for reasons why it is being withheld from them. 'It must be an illusion, a deception which prevents us from perceiving that which is: where is the deceiver to be found?' – 'We've got it,' they cry in delight, 'it is the senses! These senses, which are so immoral as well, it is they which deceive us about the real world. Moral: escape from sense-deception, from becoming, from history, from falsehood – history is nothing but belief in the senses, belief in falsehood. Moral: denial of all that believes in the senses, of all the rest of mankind: all of that is mere "people". Be a philosopher, be a mummy, represent monotonism by a gravedigger-mimicry! – And away, above all, with the body, that pitiable *idée fixe* of the senses! infected with every error of logic there is, refuted, impossible even, notwithstanding it is impudent enough to behave as if it actually existed!'

§2

I set apart with high reverence the name of Heraclitus. When the rest of the philosopher crowd rejected the evidence of the senses because these showed plurality and change, he rejected their evidence because they showed things as if they possessed duration and unity. Heraclitus too was unjust to the senses, which lie neither in the way the Eleatics* believe nor as he believed – they do not lie at all. It is what we make of their evidence that first introduces a lie into it, for example the lie of unity, the lie of materiality, of substance, of duration.... 'Reason' is the cause of our falsification of the evidence of the senses. In so far as the senses show becoming, passing away, change, they do not lie.... But Heraclitus will always be right in this, that being is an empty fiction. The 'apparent' world is the only one: the 'real' world has only been lyingly added...

§3

- And what subtle instruments for observation we possess in our senses! This nose, for example, of which no philosopher has hitherto spoken with respect and gratitude, is none the less the most delicate tool we have at our command: it can detect minimal differences in movement which even the spectroscope cannot detect. We possess scientific knowledge today to precisely the extent that we have decided to accept the evidence of the senses - to the extent that we have learned to sharpen and arm them and to think them through to their conclusions. The rest is abortion and not-yet-science: which is to say metaphysics, theology, psychology, epistemology. Or science of formulae, sign-systems: such as logic and that applied logic, mathematics. In these reality does not appear at all, not even as a problem; just as little as does the question what value a system of conventional signs such as constitutes logic can possibly possess.

§4

The other idiosyncrasy of philosophers is no less perilous: it consists in mistaking the last for the first. They put that which comes at the end - unfortunately! for it ought not to come at all! - the 'highest concepts', that is to say the most general, the emptiest concepts, the last fumes of evaporating reality, at the beginning as the beginning. It is again only the expression of their way of doing reverence: the higher must not be allowed to grow out of the lower, must not be allowed to have grown at all.... Moral: everything of the first rank must be *causa sui*. * Origin in something else counts as an objection, as casting a doubt on value. All supreme values are of the first rank, all the supreme concepts - that which is, the unconditioned, the good, the true, the perfect - all that cannot have become, must therefore be *causa sui*. But neither can these supreme concepts be incommensurate with one another, be incompatible with one another.... Thus they acquired their stupendous concept 'God'.... The last, thinnest, emptiest is placed as the first, as cause in itself, as *ens realissimum*.†...That mankind should have taken seriously the brain-sick fancies of morbid cobweb-spinners! - And it has paid dearly for doing so!...

§5

- Let us, in conclusion, set against this the very different way in which we (- I say 'we' out of politeness...) view the problem of error and appearance. Change, mutation, becoming in general were formerly taken as proof of appearance, as a sign of the presence of something which led us astray. Today, on the contrary, we see ourselves as it were entangled in error, necessitated to error, to precisely the

extent that our prejudice in favour of reason compels us to posit unity, identity, duration, substance, cause, materiality, being; however sure we may be, on the basis of a strict reckoning, that error is to be found here. The situation is the same as with the motions of the sun: in that case error has our eyes, in the present case our language as a perpetual advocate. Language belongs in its origin to the age of the most rudimentary form of psychology: we find ourselves in the midst of a rude fetishism when we call to mind the basic presuppositions of the metaphysics of language – which is to say, of reason. It is this which sees everywhere deed and doer; this which believes in will as cause in general; this which believes in the ‘ego’, in the ego as being, in the ego as substance, and which projects its belief in the ego-substance on to all things – only thus does it create the concept ‘thing’.... Being is everywhere thought in, foisted on, as cause; it is only from the conception ‘ego’ that there follows, derivatively, the concept ‘being’.... At the beginning stands the great fateful error that the will is something which produces an effect – that will is a faculty.... Today we know it is merely a word.... Very much later, in a world a thousand times more enlightened, the security, the subjective certainty with which the categories of reason* could be employed came all of a sudden into philosophers’ heads: they concluded that these could not have originated in the empirical world – indeed, the entire empirical world was incompatible with them. Where then do they originate? – And in India as in Greece they committed the same blunder: ‘We must once have dwelt in a higher world’ – instead of in a very much lower one, which would have been the truth! – ‘we must have been divine, for we possess reason!’... Nothing, in fact, has hitherto had a more direct power of persuasion than the error of being as it was formulated by, for example, the Eleatics: for every word, every sentence we utter speaks in its favour! – Even the opponents of the Eleatics were still subject to the seductive influence of their concept of being: Democritus, among others, when he invented his atom.... ‘Reason’ in language: oh what a deceitful old woman! I fear we are not getting rid of God because we still believe in grammar...

§6

It will be a matter for gratitude if I now compress so fundamental and new an insight into four theses: I shall thereby make it easier to understand, I shall thereby challenge contradiction. First proposition. The grounds upon which ‘this’ world has been designated as apparent establish rather its reality – another kind of reality is absolutely undemonstrable. Second proposition. The characteristics which have been assigned to the ‘real being’ of things are the characteristics of non-being, of nothingness – the ‘real

world' has been constructed out of the contradiction to the actual world: an apparent world indeed, in so far as it is no more than a moral-optical illusion. Third proposition. To talk about 'another' world than this is quite pointless, provided that an instinct for slandering, disparaging and accusing life is not strong within us: in the latter case we revenge ourselves on life by means of the phantasmagoria of 'another', a 'better' life. Fourth proposition. To divide the world into a 'real' and an 'apparent' world, whether in the manner of Christianity or in the manner of Kant (which is, after all, that of a cunning Christian -) is only a suggestion of *décadence* - a symptom of declining life.... That the artist places a higher value on appearance than on reality constitutes no objection to this proposition. For 'appearance' here signifies reality once more, only selected, strengthened, corrected.... The tragic artist is not a pessimist - it is precisely he who affirms all that is questionable and terrible in existence, he is Dionysian...

How the 'Real World' at last Became a Myth HISTORY OF AN ERROR 1. The real world, attainable to the wise, the pious, the virtuous man - he dwells in it, he is it. (Oldest form of the idea, relatively sensible, simple, convincing. Transcription of the proposition 'I, Plato, am the truth.')

2. The real world, unattainable for the moment, but promised to the wise, the pious, the virtuous man ('to the sinner who repents'). (Progress of the idea: it grows more refined, more enticing, more incomprehensible - it becomes a woman, it becomes Christian...)

3. The real world, unattainable, undemonstrable, cannot be promised, but even when merely thought of a consolation, a duty, an imperative. (Fundamentally the same old sun, but shining through mist and scepticism; the idea grown sublime, pale, northerly, Königsbergian.)†

4. The real world - unattainable? Unattained, at any rate. And if unattained also unknown. Consequently also no consolation, no redemption, no duty: how could we have a duty towards something unknown? (The grey of dawn. First yawnings of reason. Cockcrow of positivism.)‡

5. The 'real world' - an idea no longer of any use, not even a duty any longer - an idea grown useless, superfluous, consequently a refuted idea: let us abolish it! (Broad daylight; breakfast; return of cheerfulness and *bons sens*; Plato blushes for shame; all free spirits run riot.)

6. We have abolished the real world: what world is left? the apparent world perhaps?... But no! with the real world we have also abolished the apparent world! (Mid-day; moment of the shortest shadow; end of the longest error; zenith of mankind; INCIPIT ZARATHUSTRA)

Morality as Anti-Nature

There is a time with all passions when they are merely fatalities, when they drag their victim down with the weight of their folly – and a later, very much later time when they are wedded with the spirit, when they are ‘spiritualized’. Formerly one made war on passion itself on account of the folly inherent in it: one conspired for its extermination – all the old moral monsters are unanimous that ‘il faut tuer les passions’.* The most famous formula for doing this is contained in the New Testament, in the Sermon on the Mount, where, by the way, things are not at all regarded from a lofty standpoint. There, for example, it is said, with reference to sexuality, ‘if thy eye offend thee, pluck it out’: fortunately no Christian follows this prescription. To exterminate the passions and desires merely in order to do away with their folly and its unpleasant consequences – this itself seems to us today merely an acute form of folly. We no longer admire dentists who pull out the teeth to stop them hurting.... On the other hand, it is only fair to admit that on the soil out of which Christianity grew the concept ‘spiritualization of passion’ could not possibly be conceived. For the primitive Church, as is well known, fought against the ‘intelligent’ in favour of the ‘poor in spirit’: how could one expect from it an intelligent war against passion? – The Church combats the passions with excision in every sense of the word: its practice, its ‘cure’ is castration. It never asks: ‘How can one spiritualize, beautify, deify a desire?’ – it has at all times laid the emphasis of its discipline on extirpation (of sensuality, of pride, of lust for power, of avarice, of revengefulness). – But to attack the passions at their roots means to attack life at its roots: the practice of the Church is hostile to life...

§2

The same expedient – castration, extirpation – is instinctively selected in a struggle against a desire by those who are too weak-willed, too degenerate to impose moderation upon it: by those natures which need La Trappe,* to speak metaphorically (and not metaphorically –), some sort of definitive declaration of hostility, a chasm between themselves and a passion. It is only the degenerate who cannot do without radical expedients; weakness of will, more precisely the inability not to react to a stimulus, is itself merely another form of degeneration. Radical hostility, mortal hostility towards sensuality is always a thought-provoking symptom: it justifies making certain conjectures as to the general condition of one who is excessive in this respect. – That hostility, that hatred reaches its height, moreover, only when such natures are no longer sufficiently sound even for the

radical cure, for the renunciation of their ‘devil’. Survey the entire history of priests and philosophers, and that of artists as well: the most virulent

utterances against the senses have not come from the impotent, nor from ascetics, but from those who found it impossible to be ascetics, from those who stood in need of being ascetics...

§3

The spiritualization of sensuality is called love: it is a great triumph over Christianity. A further triumph is our spiritualization of enmity. It consists in profoundly grasping the value of having enemies: in brief, in acting and thinking in the reverse of the way in which one formerly acted and thought. The Church has at all times desired the destruction of its enemies: we, we immoralists and antiChristians, see that it is to our advantage that the Church exist.... In politics, too, enmity has become much more spiritual – much more prudent, much more thoughtful, much more forbearing. Almost every party grasps that it is in the interest of its own self-preservation that the opposing party should not decay in strength; the same is true of grand politics. A new creation in particular, the new Reich for instance, has more need of enemies than friends: only in opposition does it feel itself necessary, only in opposition does it become necessary.... We adopt the same attitude towards the ‘enemy within’: there too we have spiritualized enmity, there too we have grasped its value. One is fruitful only at the cost of being rich in contradictions; one remains young only on condition the soul does not relax, does not long for peace.... Nothing has grown more alien to us than that desideratum of former times ‘peace of soul’, the Christian desideratum; nothing arouses less envy in us than the moral cow and the fat contentment of the good conscience.... One has renounced grand life when one renounces war.... In many cases, to be sure, ‘peace of soul’ is merely a misunderstanding – something else that simply does not know how to give itself a more honest name. Here, briefly and without prejudice, are a few of them. ‘Peace of soul’ can, for example, be the gentle radiation of a rich animality into the moral (or religious) domain. Or the beginning of weariness, the first of the shadows which evening, every sort of evening, casts. Or a sign that the air is damp, that south winds are on the way. Or unconscious gratitude for a good digestion (sometimes called ‘philanthropy’). Or the quiescence of the convalescent for whom all things have a new taste and who waits.... Or the condition which succeeds a vigorous gratification of our ruling passion, the pleasant feeling of a rare satiety. Or the decrepitude of our will, our desires, our vices. Or laziness persuaded by vanity to deck itself out as morality. Or the appearance of a certainty, even a dreadful certainty, after the protracted tension and torture of uncertainty. Or the expression of ripeness and mastery in the midst of action, creation, endeavour,

volition, a quiet breathing, 'freedom of will' attained.... Twilight of the Idols: who

knows? perhaps that too is only a kind of 'peace of soul'...

§4

- I formulate a principle. All naturalism in morality, that is all healthy morality, is dominated by an instinct of life - some commandment of life is fulfilled through a certain canon of 'shall' and 'shall not', some hindrance and hostile element on life's road is thereby removed. Anti-natural morality, that is virtually every morality that has hitherto been taught, revered and preached, turns on the contrary precisely against the instincts of life - it is a now secret, now loud and impudent condemnation of these instincts. By saying 'God sees into the heart' it denies the deepest and the highest desires of life and takes God for the enemy of life.... The saint in whom God takes pleasure is the ideal castrate.... Life is at an end where the 'kingdom of God' begins...

§5

If one has grasped the blasphemousness of such a rebellion against life as has, in Christian morality, become virtually sacrosanct, one has fortunately therewith grasped something else as well: the uselessness, illusoriness, absurdity, falsity of such a rebellion. For a condemnation of life by the living is after all no more than the symptom of a certain kind of life: the question whether the condemnation is just or unjust has not been raised at all. One would have to be situated outside life, and on the other hand to know it as thoroughly as any, as many, as all who have experienced it, to be permitted to touch on the problem of the value of life at all: sufficient reason for understanding that this problem is for us an inaccessible problem. When we speak of values we do so under the inspiration and from the perspective of life: life itself evaluates through us when we establish values.... From this it follows that even that anti-nature of a morality which conceives God as the contrary concept to and condemnation of life is only a value judgement on the part of life - of what life? of what kind of life? - But I have already given the answer: of declining, debilitated, weary, condemned life. Morality as it has been understood hitherto - as it was ultimately formulated by Schopenhauer as 'denial of the will to life' - is the instinct of *décadence* itself, which makes out of itself an imperative: it says: 'Perish!' - it is the judgement of the judged...

§6

Let us consider finally what naïvety it is to say ‘man ought to be thus and thus!’ Reality shows us an enchanting wealth of types, the luxuriance of a prodigal play and change of forms: and does some pitiful journeyman moralist say at the sight of it: ‘No! man ought to be different’?... He even knows how man ought to be, this

bigoted wretch; he paints himself on the wall and says ‘ecce homo’!*... But even when the moralist merely turns to the individual and says to him: ‘You ought to be thus and thus’ he does not cease to make himself ridiculous. The individual is, in his future and in his past, a piece of fate, one law more, one necessity more for everything that is and everything that will be. To say to him ‘change yourself’ means to demand that everything should change, even in the past.... And there have indeed been consistent moralists who wanted man to be different, namely virtuous, who wanted him in their own likeness, namely that of a bigot: to that end they denied the world! No mean madness! No modest presumption!... In so far as morality condemns as morality and not with regard to the aims and objects of life, it is a specific error with which one should show no sympathy, an idiosyncrasy of the degenerate which has caused an unspeakable amount of harm!... We others, we immoralists, have on the contrary opened wide our hearts to every kind of understanding, comprehension, approval. We do not readily deny, we seek our honour in affirming. We have come more and more to appreciate that economy which needs and knows how to use all that which the holy lunacy of the priest, the diseased reason of the priest rejects; that economy in the law of life which derives advantage even from the repellent species of the bigot, the priest, the virtuous man – what advantage? – But we ourselves, we immoralists, are the answer to that...

The Four Great Errors

§1

The error of confusing cause and consequence. – There is no more dangerous error than that of mistaking the consequence for the cause: I call it reason’s intrinsic form of corruption. None the less, this error is among the most ancient and most recent habits of mankind: it is even sanctified among us, it bears the names ‘religion’ and ‘morality’. Every proposition formulated by religion and morality contains it; priests and moral legislators are the authors of this corruption of reason. – I adduce an example. Everyone knows the book of the celebrated Cornaro in which he recommends his meagre diet as a recipe for a long and happy life – a virtuous one, too. Few books have been so widely read; even now many thousands of copies are printed in England every year. I do not

doubt that hardly any book (the Bible rightly excepted) has done so much harm, has shortened so many lives, as this curiosity, which was so well meant. The reason: mistaking the consequence for the cause. The worthy Italian saw in his diet the cause of his long life: while the prerequisite of long life, an extraordinarily slow metabolism, a small consumption, was the cause of his meagre diet. He was not free to eat much or little as he chose, his frugality was not an act of 'free will': he became ill when he ate more. But if one is not a bony fellow of this sort one does not merely do well, one positively needs to eat properly. A scholar of our day, with his rapid consumption of nervous energy, would kill himself with Cornaro's regimen. Credo experto. -

§2

The most general formula at the basis of every religion and morality is: 'Do this and this, refrain from this and this - and you will be happy! Otherwise....' Every morality, every religion is this imperative - I call it the great original sin of reason, immortal unreason. In my mouth this formula is converted into its reverse - first example of my 'revaluation of all values': a well-constituted human being, a 'happy one', must perform certain actions and instinctively shrinks from other actions, he transports the order of which he is the physiological representative into his relations with other human beings and with things. In a formula: his virtue is the consequence of his happiness.... Long life, a plentiful posterity is not the reward of virtue, virtue itself is rather just that slowing down of the metabolism which also has, among other things, a long life, a plentiful posterity, in short Cornarism, as its outcome. - The Church and morality say: 'A race, a people perishes through vice and luxury'. My restored reason says: when a people is perishing, degenerating physiologically, vice and luxury (that is to say the necessity for stronger and

stronger and more and more frequent stimulants, such as every exhausted nature is acquainted with) follow therefrom. A young man grows prematurely pale and faded. His friends say: this and that illness is to blame. I say: that he became ill, that he failed to resist the illness, was already the consequence of an impoverished life, an hereditary exhaustion. The newspaper reader says: this party will ruin itself if it makes errors like this. My higher politics says: a party which makes errors like this is already finished - it is no longer secure in its instincts. Every error, of whatever kind, is a consequence of degeneration of instinct, disgregation of will: one has thereby virtually defined the bad. Everything good is instinct - and consequently easy, necessary, free. Effort is an objection, the god is typically distinguished from the hero (in my language: light feet are the first attribute of divinity).

The error of a false causality. – We have always believed we know what a cause is: but whence did we derive our knowledge, more precisely our belief we possessed this knowledge? From the realm of the celebrated ‘inner facts’, none of which has up till now been shown to be factual. We believed ourselves to be causal agents in the act of willing; we at least thought we were there catching causality in the act. It was likewise never doubted that all the antecedentia of an action, its causes, were to be sought in the consciousness and could be discovered there if one sought them – as ‘motives’: for otherwise one would not have been free to perform it, responsible for it. Finally, who would have disputed that a thought is caused? that the ego causes the thought?... Of these three ‘inner facts’ through which causality seemed to be guaranteed the first and most convincing was that of will as cause; the conception of a consciousness (‘mind’) as cause and later still that of the ego (the ‘subject’) as cause are merely after-products after causality had, on the basis of will, been firmly established as a given fact, as empiricism.... Meanwhile, we have thought better. Today we do not believe a word of it. The ‘inner world’ is full of phantoms and false lights: the will is one of them. The will no longer moves anything, consequently no longer explains anything – it merely accompanies events, it can also be absent. The so-called ‘motive’: another error. Merely a surface phenomenon of consciousness, an accompaniment to an act, which conceals rather than exposes the antecedentia of the act. And as for the ego! It has become a fable, a fiction, a play on words: it has totally ceased to think, to feel and to will!... What follows from this? There are no spiritual causes at all! The whole of the alleged empiricism which affirmed them has gone to the devil! That is what follows! – And we had made a nice misuse of that ‘empiricism’, we had created the world on the basis of it as a world of causes, as a world of will, as a world of spirit. The oldest and longest-lived psychology was at work here – indeed it has done nothing else:

every event was to it an action, every action the effect of a will, the world became for it a multiplicity of agents, an agent (‘subject’) foisted itself upon every event. Man projected his three ‘inner facts’, that in which he believed more firmly than in anything else, will, spirit, ego, outside himself – he derived the concept ‘being’ only from the concept ‘ego’, he posited ‘things’ as possessing being according to his own image, according to his concept of the ego as cause. No wonder he later always discovered in things only that which he had put into them! –The thing itself, to say it again, the concept ‘thing’ is merely a reflection of the belief in the ego as cause. ... And even your atom, messieurs mechanists and physicists, how much error, how much rudimentary

psychology, still remains in your atom! – To say nothing of the ‘thing in itself’,* that horrendum pudendum† of the metaphysicians! The error of spirit as cause mistaken for reality! And made the measure of reality! And called God! –

§4

The error of imaginary causes. – To start from the dream: on to a certain sensation, the result for example of a distant cannon-shot, a cause is subsequently foisted (often a whole little novel in which precisely the dreamer is the chief character). The sensation, meanwhile, continues to persist, as a kind of resonance: it waits, as it were, until the cause-creating drive permits it to step into the foreground – now no longer as a chance occurrence but as ‘meaning’. The cannon-shot enters in a causal way, in an apparent inversion of time. That which comes later, the motivation, is experienced first, often with a hundred details which pass like lightning, the shot follows.... What has happened? The ideas engendered by a certain condition have been misunderstood as the cause of that condition. – We do just the same thing, in fact, when we are awake. Most of our general feelings – every sort of restraint, pressure, tension, explosion in the play and counter-play of our organs, likewise and especially the condition of the nervus sympathicus – excite our cause-creating drive: we want to have a reason for feeling as we do – for feeling well or for feeling ill. It never suffices us simply to establish the mere fact that we feel as we do: we acknowledge this fact – become conscious of it – only when we have furnished it with a motivation of some kind. – The memory, which in such a case becomes active without our being aware of it, calls up earlier states of a similar kind and the causal interpretations which have grown out of them – not their causality. To be sure, the belief that these ideas, the accompanying occurrences in the consciousness, were causes is also brought up by the memory. Thus there arises an habituation to a certain causal interpretation which in truth obstructs and even prohibits an investigation of the cause.

§5

Psychological explanation. – To trace something unknown back to something known is alleviating, soothing, gratifying and gives moreover a feeling of power. Danger, disquiet, anxiety attend the unknown – the first instinct is to eliminate these distressing states. First principle: any explanation is better than none. Because it is at bottom only a question of wanting to get rid of oppressive ideas, one is not exactly particular about what means one uses to get rid of them: the first idea which explains that the unknown is in fact the known does so much good that one ‘holds it for true’. Proof by pleasure (‘by potency’) as criterion of truth. – The cause-creating drive is thus conditioned

and excited by the feeling of fear. The question 'why?' should furnish, if at all possible, not so much the cause for its own sake as a certain kind of cause - a soothing, liberating, alleviating cause. That something already known, experienced, inscribed in the memory is posited as cause is the first consequence of this need. The new, the unexperienced, the strange is excluded from being cause. - Thus there is sought not only some kind of explanation as cause, but a selected and preferred kind of explanation, the kind by means of which the feeling of the strange, new, unexperienced is most speedily and most frequently abolished - the most common explanations. - Consequence: a particular kind of cause-ascription comes to preponderate more and more, becomes concentrated into a system and finally comes to dominate over the rest, that is to say simply to exclude other causes and explanations. - The banker thinks at once of 'business', the Christian of 'sin', the girl of her love.

§6

The entire realm of morality and religion falls under this concept of imaginary causes. - 'Explanation' of unpleasant general feelings. They arise from beings hostile to us (evil spirits: most celebrated case - hysterics misunderstood as witches). They arise from actions we cannot approve of (the feeling of 'sin', of 'culpability' foisted upon a physiological discomfort - one always finds reasons for being discontented with oneself). They arise as punishments, as payment for something we should not have done, should not have been (generalized in an impudent form by Schopenhauer into a proposition in which morality appears for what it is, the actual poisoner and calumniator of life: 'Every great pain, whether physical or mental, declares what it is we deserve; for it could not have come upon us if we had not deserved it.' *World as Will and Idea* II 666). They arise as the consequences of rash actions which have turned out badly (- the emotions, the senses assigned as 'cause', as 'to blame'; physiological states of distress construed, with the aid of other states of distress, as 'deserved'). - 'Explanation' of pleasant general feelings. They arise from trust in God. They arise from the consciousness of good actions (the so-called 'good conscience', a physiological condition sometimes

so like a sound digestion as to be mistaken for it). They arise from the successful outcome of undertakings (- naïve fallacy: the successful outcome of an undertaking certainly does not produce any pleasant general feelings in a hypochondriac or a Pascal). They arise from faith, hope and charity - the Christian virtues. - In reality all these supposed explanations are consequential states and as it were translations of pleasurable and unpleasurable feelings into a false dialect: one is in a state in which one can experience hope because

the physiological basic feeling is once more strong and ample; one trusts in God because the feeling of plenitude and strength makes one calm. – Morality and religion fall entirely under the psychology of error: in every single case cause is mistaken for effect; or the effect of what is believed true is mistaken for the truth; or a state of consciousness is mistaken for the causation of this state.

§7

The error of free will. – We no longer have any sympathy today with the concept of 'free will': we know only too well what it is – the most infamous of all the arts of the theologian for making mankind 'accountable' in his sense of the word, that is to say for making mankind dependent on him.... I give here only the psychology of making men accountable. – Everywhere accountability is sought, it is usually the instinct for punishing and judging which seeks it. One has deprived becoming of its innocence if being in this or that state is traced back to will, to intentions, to accountable acts: the doctrine of will has been invented essentially for the purpose of punishment, that is of finding guilty. The whole of the old-style psychology, the psychology of will, has as its precondition the desire of its authors, the priests at the head of the ancient communities, to create for themselves a right to ordain punishments – or their desire to create for God a right to do so.... Men were thought of as 'free' so that they could become guilty: consequently, every action had to be thought of as willed, the origin of every action as lying in the consciousness (– whereby the most fundamental falsification in psychologism was made into the very principle of psychology).... Today, when we have started to move in the reverse direction, when we immoralists especially are trying with all our might to remove the concept of guilt and the concept of punishment from the world and to purge psychology, history, nature, the social institutions and sanctions of them, there is in our eyes no more radical opposition than that of the theologians, who continue to infect the innocence of becoming with 'punishment' and 'guilt' by means of the concept of the 'moral world-order'. Christianity is a hangman's metaphysics...

§8

What alone can our teaching be? – That no one gives a human being his qualities: not God, not society, not his parents or ancestors, not he himself (– the nonsensical idea here last rejected was propounded, as 'intelligible freedom', by Kant, and perhaps also by Plato before him). No one is accountable for existing at all, or for being constituted as he is, or for living in the circumstances and surroundings in which he lives. The fatality of his nature

cannot be disentangled from the fatality of all that which has been and will be. He is not the result of a special design, a will, a purpose; he is not the subject of an attempt to attain to an 'ideal of man' or an 'ideal of happiness' or an 'ideal of morality' – it is absurd to want to hand over his nature to some purpose or other. We invented the concept 'purpose': in reality purpose is lacking.... One is necessary, one is a piece of fate, one belongs to the whole, one is in the whole – there exists nothing which could judge, measure, compare, condemn our being, for that would be to judge, measure, compare, condemn the whole.... But nothing exists apart from the whole! – That no one is any longer made accountable, that the kind of being manifested cannot be traced back to a *causa prima** that the world is a unity neither as sensorium nor as 'spirit', this alone is the great liberation – thus alone is the innocence of becoming restored.... The concept 'God' has hitherto been the greatest objection to existence.... We deny God; in denying God, we deny accountability: only by doing that do we redeem the world. –

The 'Improvers' of Mankind

§1

One knows my demand of philosophers that they place themselves beyond good and evil – that they have the illusion of moral judgement beneath them. This demand follows from an insight first formulated by me: that there are no moral facts whatever. Moral judgement has this in common with religious judgement that it believes in realities which do not exist. Morality is only an interpretation of certain phenomena, more precisely a misinterpretation. Moral judgement belongs, as does religious judgement, to a level of ignorance at which even the concept of the real, the distinction between the real and the imaginary, is lacking: so that at such a level 'truth' denotes nothing but things which we today call 'imaginings'. To this extent moral judgement is never to be taken literally: as such it never contains anything but nonsense. But as semeiotics it remains of incalculable value: it reveals, to the informed man at least, the most precious realities of cultures and inner worlds which did not know enough to 'understand' themselves. Morality is merely signlanguage, merely symptomatology: one must already know what it is about to derive profit from it.

§2

A first example, merely as an introduction. In all ages one has wanted to 'improve' men: this above all is what morality has meant. But one word can conceal the most divergent tendencies. Both the taming of the beast man and

the breeding of a certain species of man has been called 'improvement': only these zoological termini express realities - realities, to be sure, of which the typical 'improver', the priest, knows nothing - wants to know nothing.... To call the taming of an animal its 'improvement' is in our ears almost a joke. Whoever knows what goes on in menageries is doubtful whether the beasts in them are 'improved'. They are weakened, they are made less harmful, they become sickly beasts through the depressive emotion of fear, through pain, through injuries, through hunger. - It is no different with the tamed human being whom the priest has 'improved'. In the early Middle Ages, when the Church was in fact above all a menagerie, one everywhere hunted down the fairest specimens of the 'blond beast'* - one 'improved', for example, the noble Teutons. But what did such a Teuton afterwards look like when he had been 'improved' and led into a monastery? Like a caricature of a human being, like an abortion: he had become a 'sinner', he was in a cage, one had imprisoned him behind nothing but sheer terrifying concepts.... There he lay now, sick, miserable, filled with ill-will towards himself; full of hatred for the

impulses towards life, full of suspicion of all that was still strong and happy. In short, a 'Christian'.... In physiological terms: in the struggle with the beast, making it sick can be the only means of making it weak. This the Church understood: it corrupted the human being, it weakened him - but it claimed to have 'improved' him...

§3

Let us take the other aspect of so-called morality, the breeding of a definite race and species. The most grandiose example of this is provided by Indian morality, sanctioned, as the 'Law of Manu', into religion. Here the proposed task is to breed no fewer than four races simultaneously: a priestly, a warrior, and a trading and farming race, and finally a menial race, the Sudras. Here we are manifestly no longer among animal-tamers: a species of human being a hundred times more gentle and rational is presupposed even to conceive the plan of such a breeding. One draws a breath of relief when coming out of the Christian sick-house and dungeon atmosphere into this healthier, higher, wider world. How paltry the 'New Testament' is compared with Manu, how ill it smells! - But this organization too needed to be dreadful - this time in struggle not with the beast but with its antithesis, with the non-bred human being, the hotchpotch human being, the Chandala.* And again it had no means of making him weak and harmless other than making him sick - it was the struggle with the 'great majority'. Perhaps there is nothing which outrages our feelings more than these protective measures of Indian morality. The third edict, for example

(Avadana-Shastra I), that 'concerning unclean vegetables', ordains that the only nourishment permitted the Chandala shall be garlic and onions, in view of the fact that holy scripture forbids one to give them corn or seed-bearing fruits or water or fire. The same edict lays it down that the water they need must not be taken from rivers or springs or pools, but only from the entrances to swamps and holes made by the feet of animals. They are likewise forbidden to wash their clothes or to wash themselves, since the water allowed them as an act of charity must be used only for quenching the thirst. Finally, the Sudra women are forbidden to assist the Chandala women in childbirth, and the latter are likewise forbidden to assist one another.... - The harvest of such hygienic regulations did not fail to appear: murderous epidemics, hideous venereal diseases and, as a consequence, 'the law of the knife' once more, ordaining circumcision for the male and removal of the labia minora for the female children. - Manu himself says: 'The Chandala are the fruit of adultery, incest and crime' (- this being the necessary consequence of the concept 'breeding'). 'They shall have for clothing only rags from corpses, for utensils broken pots, for ornaments old iron, for worship only evil spirits; they shall wander from place to place without rest. They are

forbidden to write from left to right and to use the right hand for writing: the employment of the right hand and of the left-to-right motion is reserved for the virtuous, for people of race.' -

§4

These regulations are instructive enough: in them we find for once Aryan humanity, quite pure, quite primordial - we learn that the concept 'pure blood' is the opposite of a harmless concept. It becomes clear, on the other hand, in which people the hatred, the Chandala hatred for this 'humanity' has been immortalized, where it has become religion, where it has become genius.... From this point of view, the Gospels are documents of the first rank; the Book of Enoch even more so. - Christianity, growing from Jewish roots and comprehensible only as a product of this soil,* represents the reaction against that morality of breeding, of race, of privilege - it is the anti-Aryan religion par excellence: Christianity the revaluation of all Aryan values, the victory of Chandala values, the evangel preached to the poor and lowly, the collective rebellion of everything downtrodden, wretched, illconstituted, under-privileged against the 'race' - undying Chandala revenge as the religion of love...

§5

The morality of breeding and the morality of taming are, in the means they employ to attain their ends, entirely worthy of one another: we may set down as our chief proposition that to make morality one must have the unconditional will to the contrary. This is the great, the uncanny problem which I have pursued furthest: the psychology of the 'improvers' of mankind. A small and really rather modest fact, that of so-called *pia fraus*,[†] gave me my first access to this problem: *pia fraus*, the heritage of all philosophers and priests who have 'improved' mankind. Neither Manu nor Plato, neither Confucius nor the Jewish and Christian teachers, ever doubted their right to tell lies. Nor did they doubt their possession of other rights.... Expressed in a formula one might say: every means hitherto employed with the intention of making mankind moral has been thoroughly immoral. -

What the Germans Lack

§1

Among Germans today it is not enough to possess spirit: one must also possess the presumption to possess it... Perhaps I know the Germans, perhaps I might even venture to address a few words to them. The new Germany represents a great quantity of inherited and inculcated ability, so that it may for a time be allowed even a lavish expenditure of its accumulated store of energy. It is not a high culture that has here gained ascendancy, even less a fastidious taste, a noble 'beauty' of the instincts, but more manly virtues than any other country of Europe can exhibit. A good deal of courage and respect for oneself, a good deal of self-confidence in social dealings and in the performance of reciprocal duties, a good deal of industriousness, a good deal of endurance - and an inherited moderation which requires the goad rather than the brake. I also add that here people can still obey without being humiliated by obeying.... And no one despises his adversary... You will see I want to be just to the Germans: I would not like to be untrue to myself in this - so I must also tell them what I object to. Coming to power is a costly business: power makes stupid.... The Germans - once they were called the nation of thinkers: do they still think at all? Nowadays the Germans are bored with intellect, the Germans mistrust intellect, politics devours all seriousness for really intellectual things - Deutschland, Deutschland über alles was, I fear, the end of German philosophy.... 'Are there any German philosophers? are there any German poets? are there any good German books?' - people ask me abroad. I blush; but with the courage which is mine even in desperate cases I answer: 'Yes, Bismarck!' - Dare I go so far as to confess which books are read nowadays?... Confounded instinct of mediocrity! -

§2

- Who has not pondered sadly over what the German spirit could be! But this nation has deliberately made itself stupid, for practically a thousand years: nowhere else are the two great European narcotics, alcohol and Christianity, so viciously abused. Lately even a third has been added, one which is capable by itself of completely obstructing all delicate and audacious flexibility of spirit: music, our constipated, constipating German music. - How much dreary heaviness, lameness, dampness, sloppiness, how much beer there is in the German intellect! How can it possibly happen that young men who dedicate their existence to the most spiritual goals lack

all sense of the first instinct of spirituality, the spirit's instinct for self-preservation - and drink beer?... The alcoholism of scholarly youth perhaps does not constitute a question mark in regard to their erudition - one can be even a great scholar without possessing any spirit at all - but from any other point of view it remains a problem. - Where does one not find that bland degeneration which beer produces in the spirit! Once, in a case that has become almost famous, I laid my finger on such an instance of degeneration - the degeneration of our first German freethinker, the shrewd David Strauss, into the author of an alehouse gospel and a 'new faith'.... It was no vain vow he made in verse to the 'gracious brunette'* - fidelity unto death...

§3

- I have said of the German spirit that it is growing coarser, that it is growing shallow. Is that sufficient? - Fundamentally, it is something quite different which appals me: how German seriousness, German profundity, German passion in spiritual things is more and more on the decline. It is the pathos and not merely the intellectual aspect which has altered. - I come in contact now and then with German universities: what an atmosphere prevails among its scholars, what a barren spirituality, grown how contented and lukewarm! It would be a profound misunderstanding to adduce German science as an objection here, as well as being proof one had not read a word I have written. For seventeen years I have not wearied of exposing the despiritualizing influence of our contemporary scientific pursuits. The harsh Helot condition to which the tremendous extent of science has condemned every single person today is one of the main reasons why education and educators appropriate to fuller, richer, deeper natures are no longer forthcoming. Our culture suffers from nothing more than it suffers from the superabundance of presumptuous journeymen and fragments of humanity; our universities are, against their will, the actual forcing-houses for this kind of spiritual instinct-atrophy. And all

Europe already has an idea of this – grand politics deceives no one.... Germany counts more and more as Europe's flatland. – I am still looking for a German with whom I could be serious after my fashion – how much more for one with whom I might be cheerful! – Twilight of the Idols: ah, who today could grasp from how profound a seriousness a hermit is here relaxing! – The most incomprehensible thing about us is our cheerfulness...

§4

If one makes a reckoning, it is obvious not only that German culture is declining, the sufficient reason* for it is obvious too. After all, no one can spend more than he has – that is true of individuals, it is also true of nations. If one spends oneself on

power, grand politics, economic affairs, world commerce, parliamentary institutions, military interests – if one expends in this direction the quantum of reason, seriousness, will, self-overcoming that one is, then there will be a shortage in the other direction. Culture and the state – one should not deceive oneself over this – are antagonists: the 'cultural state' is merely a modern idea. The one lives off the other, the one thrives at the expense of the other. All great cultural epochs are epochs of political decline: that which is great in the cultural sense has been unpolitical, even anti-political.... Goethe's heart opened up at the phenomenon Napoleon – it closed up to the 'Wars of Liberation'.... The moment Germany rises as a great power, France gains a new importance as a cultural power. A great deal of current spiritual seriousness and passion has already emigrated to Paris; the question of pessimism, for instance, the Wagner question, virtually every psychological and artistic question, is speculated on with incomparably more subtlety and thoroughness there than in Germany – the Germans are even incapable of this kind of seriousness. – In the history of European culture the rise of the 'Reich' signifies one thing above all: a displacement of the centre of gravity. The fact is known everywhere: in the main thing – and that is still culture – the Germans no longer come into consideration. The question is asked: haven't you so much as one spirit who means something to Europe? in the way your Goethe, your Hegel, your Heinrich Heine, your Schopenhauer meant something? That there is no longer a single German philosopher – there is no end of astonishment at that. –

§5

The essential thing has gone out of the entire system of higher education in Germany: the end, as well as the means to the end. That education, culture, itself is the end – and not 'the Reich' – that educators are required for the

attainment of this end – and not grammar-school teachers and university scholars – that too has been forgotten.... There is a need for educators who are themselves educated; superior, noble spirits, who prove themselves every moment by what they say and by what they do not say: cultures grown ripe and sweet – and not the learned bores which grammar school and university offer youth today as ‘higher nurses’. Educators, the first prerequisite of education, are lacking (except for the exceptions of exceptions): hence the decline of German culture. – One of those rarest of exceptions is my honoured friend Jacob Burckhardt of Basel: it is to him above all that Basel owes its pre-eminence in the humanities. – What the ‘higher schools’ of Germany in fact achieve is a brutal breaking-in with the aim of making, in the least possible time, numberless young men fit to be utilized, utilized to the full and used up, in the state service. ‘Higher education’ and numberless – that is a contradiction to start with. All higher education belongs to the exceptions alone: one must be privileged to

have a right to so high a privilege. Great and fine things can never be common property: *pulchrum est paucorum hominum*.^{*} – What is the cause of the decline of German culture? That ‘higher education’ is no longer a privilege – the democratism of ‘culture’ made ‘universal’ and common.... Not to overlook the fact that military privileges absolutely compel too great attendance at higher schools, which means their ruin. – No one is any longer free in present-day Germany to give his children a noble education: our ‘higher’ schools are one and all adjusted – as regards their teachers, their curricula and their instructional aims – to the most dubious mediocrity. And there reigns everywhere an indecent haste, as if something has been neglected if the young man of twenty-three is not yet ‘finished and ready’, does not yet know the answer to the ‘chief question’: which calling? – A higher kind of human being, excuse me for saying, doesn’t think much of ‘callings’, the reason being he knows himself called.... He takes his time, he has plenty of time, he gives no thought whatsoever to being ‘finished and ready’ – at the age of thirty one is, as regards high culture, a beginner, a child. – Our overcrowded grammar schools, our overloaded, stupified grammar-school teachers, are a scandal: one may perhaps have motives for defending this state of things, as the professors of Heidelberg recently did – there are no grounds for doing so.

§6

To be true to my nature, which is affirmative and has dealings with contradiction and criticism only indirectly and when compelled, I shall straightaway set down the three tasks for the sake of which one requires

educators. One has to learn to see, one has to learn to think, one has to learn to speak and write: the end in all three is a noble culture. – Learning to see – habituating the eye to repose, to patience, to letting things come to it; learning to defer judgement, to investigate and comprehend the individual case in all its aspects. This is the first preliminary schooling in spirituality: not to react immediately to a stimulus, but to have the restraining, stock-taking instincts in one's control. Learning to see, as I understand it, is almost what is called in unphilo-sophical language 'strong will-power': the essence of it is precisely not to 'will', the ability to defer decision. All unspirituality, all vulgarity, is due to the incapacity to resist a stimulus – one has to react, one obeys every impulse. In many instances, such a compulsion is already morbidity, decline, a symptom of exhaustion – almost everything which unphilosophical crudity designates by the name 'vice' is merely this physiological incapacity not to react – A practical application of having learned to see: one will have become slow, mistrustful, resistant as a learner in general. In an attitude of hostile calm one will allow the strange, the novel of every kind to approach one first – one will draw one's hand back from it. To stand with all doors open, to prostrate

oneself submissively before every petty fact, to be ever itching to mingle with, plunge into other people and other things, in short our celebrated modern 'objectivity', is bad taste, is ignoble par excellence. –

§7

Learning to think: our schools no longer have any idea what this means. Even in our universities, even among students of philosophy themselves, the theory, the practice, the vocation of logic is beginning to die out. Read German books: no longer the remotest recollection that a technique, a plan of instruction, a will to mastery is required for thinking – that thinking has to be learned in the way dancing has to be learned, as a form of dancing.... Who among Germans still knows from experience that subtle thrill which the possession of intellectual light feet communicates to all the muscles! – A stiffly awkward air in intellectual matters, a clumsy hand in grasping – this is in so great a degree German that foreigners take it for the German nature in general. The German has no fingers for nuances.... That the Germans have so much as endured their philosophers, above all that most deformed conceptual cripple there has ever been, the great Kant, offers a good idea of German amenableness. For dancing in any form cannot be divorced from a noble education, being able to dance with the feet, with concepts, with words: do I still have to say that one has to be able to dance with the pen – that writing has to be learned? – But at this point I should become a complete enigma to German readers...

§1

My impossibles. – Seneca: or the toreador of virtue. – Rousseau: or the return to nature in *impuris naturalibus** – Schiller: or the Moral-Trumpeter of Säckingen.† – Dante: or the hyena which poetises on graves. – Kant: or cant as intelligible character. – Victor Hugo: or the Pharos in the Sea of Absurdity. – Liszt: or the virtuoso – with women.‡ – George Sand: or *lactea ubertas*,§ in English: the milch cow with the ‘fine style’. – Michelet: or enthusiasm which strips off the jacket. – Carlyle: or pessimism as indigestion. – John Stuart Mill: or offensive clarity. – Les frères de Goncourt: or the two Ajaxes struggling with Homer. Music by Offenbach. Zola: or ‘delight in stinking’. –

§2

Renan. – Theology, or the corruption of reason by ‘original sin’ (Christianity). Witness: Renan, who, whenever he risks a more general Yes or No, misses the point with painful regularity. He would like, for instance, to couple together *la science* and *la noblesse*; but *la science* belongs to democracy, that is patently obvious. He desires, with no little ambitiousness, to represent an aristocratism of the intellect: but at the same time he falls on his knees, and not only his knees, before its opposite, the *évangile des humbles*.... What avails all free thinking, modernity, mockery and wry-necked flexibility, if one is still Christian, Catholic and even priest in one’s bowels! Renan possesses his mode of inventiveness, just like a Jesuit or a father confessor, in devising means of seduction; his intellectuality does not lack the broad priestly smirk – like all priests, he becomes dangerous only when he loves. Nobody can equal him in deadly adoration.... This spirit of Renan, an enervating spirit, is one fatality more for poor, sick, feeble-willed France. –

§3

Sainte-Beuve. – Nothing masculine in him; full of petty sullen wrath against all masculine spirit. Roams about, delicate, inquisitive, bored, eavesdropping – fundamentally a woman, with a woman’s revengefulness and a woman’s sensuousness. As psychologist a genius of, *médisance*;* inexhaustibly rich in means for creating it; no one knows better how to mix poison with praise. Plebeian in the lowest instincts and related to Rousseau’s resentment: consequently a romantic – for beneath all *romantisme* there grunts and thirsts Rousseau’s instinct for revenge. A revolutionary, but kept tolerably in check by fear. Constrained in presence of

everything possessing strength (public opinion, the Academy, the Court, even PortRoyal).† Embittered against all that is great in men and things, against all that believes in itself. Enough of a poet and semi-woman to feel greatness as power; constantly cringing, like the celebrated worm, because he constantly feels himself trodden on. As a critic without standards, steadiness or backbone, possessing the palate for a large variety of things of the cosmopolitan libertin but lacking the courage even to admit his libertinage. As a historian without philosophy, without the power of philosophical vision – for that reason rejecting, in all the main issues, the task of passing judgement, holding up ‘objectivity’ as a mask. He comports himself differently, however, towards questions in which a delicate, experienced taste is the highest court of appeal: there he really does have the courage for himself, takes pleasure in himself – there he is a master. – In some respects a preliminary form of Baudelaire. –

§4

The *Imitatio Christi** is one of the books I cannot hold in my hand without experiencing a physiological resistance: it exhales a parfum of the ‘eternal feminine’† for which one has to be French – or a Wagnerian.... This saint has a way of talking about love that makes even Parisiennes curious. – I am told that cunningest of Jesuits, A. Comte, who wanted to lead his Frenchmen to Rome via the détour of science, inspired himself with this book. I believe it: ‘the religion of the heart’...

§5

G. Eliot. – They have got rid of the Christian God, and now feel obliged to cling all the more firmly to Christian morality: that is English consistency, let us not blame it on little bluestockings à la Eliot. In England, in response to every little emancipation from theology one has to reassert one’s position in a fear-inspiring manner as a moral fanatic. That is the penance one pays there. – With us it is different. When one gives up Christian belief one thereby deprives oneself of the right to Christian morality. For the latter is absolutely not self-evident: one must make this point clear again and again, in spite of English shallowpates. Christianity is a system, a consistently thought out and complete view of things. If one breaks out of it a fundamental idea, the belief in God, one thereby breaks the whole thing to pieces: one has nothing of any consequence left in one’s hands. Christianity presupposes that man does not know, cannot know what is good for him and what evil: he believes in God, who alone knows. Christian morality is a command: its origin is transcendental; it is beyond all criticism, all right to criticize; it possesses truth only if God is truth – it stands or falls with the belief in God. – If the English

really do believe they will know, of their own accord, 'intuitively', what is good and evil; if they consequently think they no longer have need of Christianity as a guarantee of morality; that is merely the consequence of the ascendancy of Christian evaluation and an expression of the strength and depth of this ascendancy: so that the origin of English morality has been forgotten, so that the highly conditional nature of its right to exist is no longer felt. For the Englishman morality is not yet a problem...

§6

George Sand. - I have read the first *Lettres d'un voyageur*: like everything deriving from Rousseau false, artificial, fustian, exaggerated. I cannot endure this colouredwallpaper style; nor the vulgar ambition to possess generous feelings. The worst, to be sure, is the female coquetting with male mannerisms, with the manners of illbred boys. - How cold she must have been withal, this insupportable authoress! She wound herself up like a clock - and wrote.... Cold, like Hugo, like Balzac, like all Romantics as soon as they started writing! And how complacently she liked to lie there, this prolific writing-cow, who had something German in the bad sense about her, like Rousseau her master, and who was in any case possible only with the decline of French taste! - But Renan respects her...

§7

Moral code for psychologists. - No colportage psychology! Never observe for the sake of observing! That produces a false perspective, a squint, something forced and exaggerated. To experience from a desire to experience - that's no good. In experiencing, one must not look back towards oneself, or every glance becomes an 'evil eye'. A born psychologist instinctively guards against seeing for the sake of seeing; the same applies to the born painter. He never works 'from nature' - he leaves it to his instinct, his camera obscura, to sift and strain 'nature', the 'case', the 'experience'.... He is conscious only of the universal, the conclusion, the outcome: he knows nothing of that arbitrary abstraction from the individual case. - What will be the result if one does otherwise? Carries on colportage psychology in, for example, the manner of Parisian romanciers great and small? It is that sort of thing which as it were lies in wait for reality, which brings a handful of curiosities home each evening.... But just see what finally emerges - a pile of daubs, a mosaic at best, in any event something put together, restless, flashy. The worst in this kind is achieved by the Goncourts: they never put three sentences together which are not simply painful to the eye, the psychologist's eye. - Nature, artistically considered, is no model. It exaggerates, it distorts, it leaves gaps. Nature is chance. To study

'from nature' seems to me a bad sign: it betrays subjection, weakness, fatalism
–

this lying in the dust before *petits faits** is unworthy of a complete artist. Seeing what is – that pertains to a different species of spirit, the anti-artistic, the prosaic. One has to know who one is...

§8

Towards a psychology of the artist. – For art to exist, for any sort of aesthetic activity or perception to exist, a certain physiological precondition is indispensable: intoxication. Intoxication must first have heightened the excitability of the entire machine: no art results before that happens. All kinds of intoxication, however different their origin, have the power to do this: above all, the intoxication of sexual excitement, the oldest and most primitive form of intoxication. Likewise the intoxication which comes in the train of all great desires, all strong emotions; the intoxication of feasting, of contest, of the brave deed, of victory, of all extreme agitation; the intoxication of cruelty; intoxication in destruction; intoxication under certain meteorological influences, for example the intoxication of spring; or under the influence of narcotics; finally the intoxication of the will, the intoxication of an overloaded and distended will. – The essence of intoxication is the feeling of plenitude and increased energy. From out of this feeling one gives to things, one compels them to take, one rapes them – one calls this procedure idealizing. Let us get rid of a prejudice here: idealization does not consist, as is commonly believed, in a subtracting or deducting of the petty and secondary. A tremendous expulsion of the principal features rather is the decisive thing, so that thereupon the others too disappear.

§9

In this condition one enriches everything out of one's own abundance: what one sees, what one desires, one sees swollen, pressing, strong, overladen with energy. The man in this condition transforms things until they mirror his power – until they are reflections of his perfection. This compulsion to transform into the perfect is – art. Even all that which he is not becomes for him none the less part of his joy in himself; in art, man takes delight in himself as perfection. – It would be permissible to imagine an antithetical condition, a specific anti-artisticality of instinct – a mode of being which impoverishes and attenuates things and makes them consumptive. And history is in fact rich in such anti-artists, in such starvelings of life, who necessarily have to take things to themselves, impoverish them, make them leaner. This is, for example, the case

with the genuine Christian, with Pascal for example: a Christian who is at the same time an artist does not exist.... Let no one be childish and cite Raphael as an objection, or some homoeopathic Christian of the nineteenth century: Raphael said Yes, Raphael did Yes, consequently Raphael was not a Christian...

§10

What is the meaning of the antithetical concepts Apollinian and Dionysian, both conceived as forms of intoxication, which I introduced into aesthetics?* – Apollinian intoxication alerts above all the eye, so that it acquires power of vision. The painter, the sculptor, the epic poet are visionaries par excellence. In the Dionysian state, on the other hand, the entire emotional system is alerted and intensified: so that it discharges all its powers of representation, imitation, transfiguration, transmutation, every kind of mimicry and playacting, conjointly. The essential thing remains the facility of the metamorphosis, the incapacity not to react (– in a similar way to certain types of hysteric, who also assume any role at the slightest instigation). It is impossible for the Dionysian man not to understand any suggestion of whatever kind, he ignores no signal from the emotions, he possesses to the highest degree the instinct for understanding and divining, just as he possesses the art of communication to the highest degree. He enters into every skin, into every emotion; he is continually transforming himself. – Music, as we understand it today, is likewise a collective arousal and discharging of the emotions, but for all that only a vestige of a much fuller emotional world of expression, a mere residuum of Dionysian histrionicism. To make music possible as a separate art one had to immobilize a number of senses, above all the muscular sense (at least relatively: for all rhythm still speaks to our muscles to a certain extent): so that man no longer straightway imitates and represents bodily everything he feels. None the less, that is the true Dionysian normal condition, at least its original condition: music is the gradually-achieved specialization of this at the expense of the most closely related faculties.

§11

The actor, the mime, the dancer, the musician, the lyric poet are fundamentally related in their instincts and essentially one, only gradually specialized and separated from one another – even to the point of opposition. The lyric poet stayed united longest with the musician, the actor with the dancer. – The architect represents neither a Dionysian nor an Apollinian condition: here it is the mighty act of will, the will which moves mountains, the intoxication of the

strong will, which demands artistic expression. The most powerful men have always inspired the architects; the architect has always been influenced by power. Pride, victory over weight and gravity, the will to power, seek to render themselves visible in a building; architecture is a kind of rhetoric of power, now persuasive, even cajoling in form, now bluntly imperious. The highest feeling of power and security finds

expression in that which possesses grand style. Power which no longer requires proving; which disdains to please; which is slow to answer; which is conscious of no witness around it; which lives oblivious of the existence of any opposition; which reposes in itself, fatalistic, a law among laws: that is what speaks of itself in the form of grand style. –

§1

In conclusion, a word on that world into which I have sought to find a way, into which I have perhaps found a new way – the ancient world. My taste, which may be called the opposite of a tolerant taste, is even here far from uttering a wholesale Yes: in general it dislikes saying Yes, it would rather say No, most of all it prefers to say nothing at all.... This applies to entire cultures, it applies to books – it also applies to towns and countrysides. It is really only quite a small number of books of antiquity which count for anything in my life; the most famous are not among them. My sense of style, of the epigram as style, was awoken almost instantaneously on coming into contact with Sallust. I have not forgotten the astonishment of my honoured teacher Corssen when he had to give top marks to his worst Latin scholar – I had done all in a single blow. Compact, severe, with as much substance as possible, a cold malice towards ‘fine words’, also towards ‘fine feelings’ – in that I knew myself. One will recognize in my writings, even in my Zarathustra, a very serious ambition for Roman style, for the ‘aera perennius’* in style. – I had the same experience on first coming into contact with Horace. From that day to this no poet has given me the same artistic delight as I derived from the very first from an Horatian ode. In certain languages what is achieved here is not even desirable. This mosaic of words in which every word, as sound, as locus, as concept, pours forth its power to left and right and over the whole, this minimum in the range and number of signs which achieves a maximum of energy of these signs – all this is Roman and, if one will believe me, noble par excellence. All other poetry becomes by comparison somewhat too popular – a mere emotional garrulousness...

§2

I received absolutely no such strong impressions from the Greeks; and, not to mince words, they cannot be to us what the Romans are. One does not learn from the Greeks – their manner is too strange, it is also too fluid to produce an imperative, a ‘classical’ effect. Who would ever have learned to write from a Greek! Who would ever have learned it without the Romans!... Let no one offer me Plato as an objection. In respect to Plato I am a thorough sceptic and have always been unable to join in the admiration of Plato the artist which is traditional among scholars. After all, I have here the most refined judges of taste of antiquity themselves on my side. It seems to me that Plato mixes together all forms of style; he is therewith in the matter of style a first *décadent*: he has on his conscience something similar to the Cynics who devised the *Satura Menippea*.^{*} For the Platonic dialogue, that

frightfully self-satisfied and childish kind of dialectics, to operate as a stimulus one must never have read any good French writers – Fontenelle, for example. Plato is boring. – Ultimately my mistrust of Plato extends to the very bottom of him: I find him deviated so far from all the fundamental instincts of the Hellenes, so morally infected, so much an antecedent Christian – he already has the concept ‘good’ as the supreme concept – that I should prefer to describe the entire phenomenon ‘Plato’ by the harsh term ‘higher swindle’ or, if you prefer, ‘idealism’, than by any other. It has cost us dear that this Athenian went to school with the Egyptians (– or with the Jews in Egypt?...). In the great fatality of Christianity, Plato is that ambiguity and fascination called the ‘ideal’ which made it possible for the nobler natures of antiquity to misunderstand themselves and to step on to the bridge which led to the ‘Cross’.... And how much there still is of Plato in the concept ‘Church’, in the structure, system, practice of the Church! – My recreation, my preference, my cure from all Platonism has always been Thucydides. Thucydides, and perhaps the *Principe* of Machiavelli, are related to me closely by their unconditional will not to deceive themselves and not to see reason in reality – not in ‘reason’, still less in ‘morality’.... For the deplorable embellishment of the Greeks with the colours of the ideal which the ‘classically educated’ youth carries away with him into life as the reward of his grammar-school drilling there is no more radical cure than Thucydides. One must turn him over line by line and read his hidden thoughts as clearly as his words: there are few thinkers so rich in hidden thoughts. Sophist culture, by which I mean realist culture, attains in him its perfect expression – this invaluable movement in the midst of the morality-and-ideal swindle of the Socratic schools which was then breaking out everywhere. Greek philosophy as the *décadence* of the Greek instinct; Thucydides as the grand summation, the last manifestation of that strong, stern, hard matter-of-factness instinctive to the older Hellenes. Courage in face of reality ultimately

distinguishes such natures as Thucydides and Plato: Plato is a coward in face of reality – consequently he flees into the ideal; Thucydides has himself under control – consequently he retains control over things...

§3

From scenting out ‘beautiful souls’,* ‘golden means’ and other perfections in the Greeks, from admiring in them such things as their repose in grandeur, their ideal disposition, their sublime simplicity – from this ‘sublime simplicity’, a *niaiserie allemande*† when all is said and done, I was preserved by the psychologist in me. I saw their strongest instinct, the will to power, I saw them trembling at the intractable force of this drive – I saw all their institutions evolve out of protective measures designed for mutual security against the explosive material within them.

The tremendous internal tension then discharged itself in fearful and ruthless external hostility: the city states tore one another to pieces so that the citizens of each of them might find peace within himself. One needed to be strong: danger was close at hand – it lurked everywhere. The splendid supple physique, the reckless realism and immoralism which pertains to the Hellene was a necessity, not a ‘natural quality’. It was produced, it was not there from the beginning. And one employed festivals and arts for no other purpose than to feel oneself dominant, to show oneself dominant: they are means for making oneself feared.... To judge the Greeks by their philosophers, in the German manner, perchance to employ the philistinism of the Socratic schools as a clue to what is fundamentally Hellenic!... But the philosophers are the *décadents* of Hellenism, the counter-movement against the old, the noble taste (– against the agonal instinct, against the polis, against the value of the race, against the authority of tradition). The Socratic virtues were preached because the Greeks had lost them: excitable, timid, fickle, comedians every one, they had more than enough reason to let morality be preached to them. Not that it would have done any good: but big words and fine attitudes are so suited to *décadents*...

§4

I was the first to take seriously that wonderful phenomenon which bears the name Dionysos as a means to understanding the older Hellenic instinct, an instinct still exuberant and even overflowing: it is explicable only as an excess of energy. Whoever has investigated the Greeks, such as that profoundest student of their culture now living, Jacob Burckhardt of Basel, realizes at once the value of this line of approach: Burckhardt inserted a special section on the said phenomenon into his *Culture of the Greeks*. For the opposite of this, one

should take a look at the almost laughable poverty of instinct displayed by German philologists whenever they approach the Dionysian. The celebrated Lobeck especially, who crept into this world of mysterious states with the honest self-confidence of a dried-up bookworm and by being nauseously frivolous and childish persuaded himself he was being scientific – Lobeck intimated, with a great display of erudition, that these curiosities were of no consequence. To be sure, the priests might have communicated a number of valuable pieces of information to the participants in such orgies – that wine arouses desire, for example, that man can live on fruit if need be, that plants bloom in spring and wither in autumn. As regards that strange wealth of rites, symbols and myths of orgiastic origin with which the antique world was quite literally overrun, Lobeck finds in them an occasion for becoming a trifle more ingenious. ‘When the Greeks had nothing else to do,’ he says (*Aglao-phamus* I, 672), ‘they used to laugh, jump, race about, or, since man sometimes feels a desire

for this, they used to sit down and weep and wail. Others later came along and sought some reason for this striking behaviour; and thus those countless myths and legends arose to explain these practices. On the other hand, one believed that the droll activities which now took place on festival days necessarily pertained to festival celebration and retained them as an indispensable part of divine worship.’ – This is contemptible chatter and no one is likely to take a Lobeck seriously for a moment. We are affected quite differently when we probe the concept ‘Greek’ which Winckelmann and Goethe constructed for themselves and find it incompatible with that element out of which Dionysian art evolved – the orgy. I have, in fact, no doubt that Goethe would have utterly excluded anything of this kind from the possibilities of the Greek soul. Consequently Goethe did not understand the Greeks. For it is only in the Dionysian mysteries, in the psychology of the Dionysian condition, that the fundamental fact of the Hellenic instinct expresses itself – its ‘will to life’. What did the Hellene guarantee to himself with these mysteries? Eternal life, the eternal recurrence of life; the future promised and consecrated in the past; the triumphant Yes to life beyond death and change; true life as collective continuation of life through procreation, through the mysteries of sexuality. It was for this reason that the sexual symbol was to the Greeks the symbol venerable as such, the intrinsic profound meaning of all antique piety. Every individual detail in the act of procreation, pregnancy, birth, awoke the most exalted and solemn feelings. In the teachings of the mysteries, pain is sanctified: the ‘pains of childbirth’ sanctify pain in general – all becoming and growing, all that guarantees the future, postulates pain.... For the eternal joy in creating to exist, for the will to life eternally to affirm itself, the ‘torment of

childbirth' must also exist eternally.... All this is contained in the word Dionysos: I know of no more exalted symbolism than this Greek symbolism, the symbolism of the Dionysian. The profoundest instinct of life, the instinct for the future of life, for the eternity of life, is in this word experienced religiously – the actual road to life, procreation, as the sacred road.... It was only Christianity, with ressentiment against life in its foundations, which made of sexuality something impure: it threw filth on the beginning, on the prerequisite of our life...

§5

The psychology of the orgy as an overflowing feeling of life and energy within which even pain acts as a stimulus provided me with the key to the concept of the tragic feeling, which was misunderstood as much by Aristotle as it especially was by our pessimists. Tragedy is so far from providing evidence for pessimism among the Hellenes in Schopenhauer's sense that it has to be considered the decisive repudiation of that idea and the counter-verdict to it. Affirmation of life even in its

strangest and sternest problems, the will to life rejoicing in its own inexhaustibility through the sacrifice of its highest types – that is what I called Dionysian, that is what I recognized as the bridge to the psychology of the tragic poet. Not so as to get rid of pity and terror, not so as to purify oneself of a dangerous emotion through its vehement discharge – it was thus Aristotle understood it – : but, beyond pity and terror, to realize in oneself the eternal joy of becoming – that joy which also encompasses joy in destruction.... And with that I again return to the place from which I set out – Birth of Tragedy was my first revaluation of all values: with that I again plant myself in the soil out of which I draw all that I will and can – I, the last disciple of the philosopher Dionysos – I, the teacher of the eternal recurrence...*

The Hammer Speaks 'Why so hard?' the charcoal once said to the diamond; 'for are we not close relations?' Why so soft? O my brothers, thus I ask you: for are you not – my brothers? Why so soft, unresisting and yielding? Why is there so much denial and abnegation in your hearts? So little fate in your glances? And if you will not be fates, if you will not be inexorable: how can you – conquer with me? And if your hardness will not flash and cut and cut to pieces: how can you one day – create with me? For all creators are hard. And it must seem bliss to you to press your hand upon millennia as upon wax, bliss to write upon the will of millennia as upon metal – harder than metal, nobler than metal. Only the noblest is perfectly hard. This new law-table do I put over you, O my brothers: Become hard!*

THE ANTI-CHRIST

Foreword This book belongs to the very few. Perhaps none of them is even living yet. Possibly they are the readers who understand my Zarathustra: how could I confound myself with those for whom there are ears listening today? – Only the day after tomorrow belongs to me. Some are born posthumously. The conditions under which one understands me and then necessarily understands – I know them all too well. One must be honest in intellectual matters to the point of harshness to so much as endure my seriousness, my passion. One must be accustomed to living on mountains – to seeing the wretched ephemeral chatter of politics and national egoism beneath one. One must have become indifferent, one must never ask whether truth is useful or a fatality.... Strength which prefers questions for which no one today is sufficiently daring; courage for the forbidden; predestination for the labyrinth. An experience out of seven solitudes. New ears for new music. New eyes for the most distant things. A new conscience for truths which have hitherto remained dumb. And the will to economy in the grand style: to keeping one's energy, one's enthusiasm in bounds.... Reverence for oneself; love for oneself; unconditional freedom with respect to oneself... Very well! These alone are my readers, my rightful readers, my predestined readers: what do the rest matter? – The rest are merely mankind. – One must be superior to mankind in force, in loftiness of soul – in contempt... FRIEDRICH NIETZSCHE

§1

– Let us look one another in the face. We are Hyperboreans* – we know well enough how much out of the way we live. 'Neither by land nor by sea shalt thou find the road to the Hyperboreans': Pindar already knew that of us. Beyond the North, beyond the ice, beyond death – our life, our happiness.... We have discovered happiness, we know the road, we have found the exit out of whole millennia of labyrinth. Who else has found it? – Modern man perhaps? – 'I know not which way to turn; I am everything that knows not which way to turn' – sighs modern man.... It was from this modernity that we were ill – from lazy peace, from cowardly compromise, from the whole virtuous uncleanness of modern Yes and No. This tolerance and largeur of heart which 'forgives' everything because it 'Understands' everything is sirocco to us. Better to live among ice than among modern virtues and other south winds!... We were brave enough, we spared neither ourselves nor others: but for long we did not know where to apply our courage. We became gloomy, we were called fatalists. Our fatality – was the plenitude, the tension, the blocking-up of our forces. We thirsted for lightning and action, of all things we kept ourselves furthest from

the happiness of the weaklings, from 'resignation'.... There was a thunderstorm in our air, the nature which we are grew dark - for we had no road. Formula of our happiness: a Yes, a No, a straight line, a goal...

§2

What is good? - All that heightens the feeling of power, the will to power, power itself in man. What is bad? - All that proceeds from weakness. What is happiness? - The feeling that power increases - that a resistance is overcome. Not contentment, but more power; not peace at all, but war; not virtue, but proficiency (virtue in the Renaissance style, virtù, virtue free of moral acid). The weak and ill-constituted shall perish: first principle of our philanthropy. And one shall help them to do so. What is more harmful than any vice? - Active sympathy for the ill-constituted and weak - Christianity...

§3

The problem I raise here is not what ought to succeed mankind in the sequence of

species (- the human being is a conclusion -): but what type of human being one ought to breed, ought to will, as more valuable, more worthy of life, more certain of the future. This more valuable type has existed often enough already: but as a lucky accident, as an exception, never as willed. He has rather been the most feared, he has hitherto been virtually the thing to be feared - and out of fear the reverse type has been willed, bred, achieved: the domestic animal, the herd animal, the sick animal man - the Christian...

§4

Mankind does not represent a development of the better or the stronger or the higher in the way that is believed today. 'Progress' is merely a modern idea, that is to say a false idea. The European of today is of far less value than the European of the Renaissance; onward development is not by any means, by any necessity the same thing as elevation, advance, strengthening. In another sense there are cases of individual success constantly appearing in the most various parts of the earth and from the most various cultures in which a higher type does manifest itself: something which in relation to collective mankind is a sort of superman. Such chance occurrences of great success have always been possible and perhaps always will be possible. And even entire races, tribes, nations can under certain circumstances represent such a lucky hit.

§5

One should not embellish or dress up Christianity: it has waged a war to the death against this higher type of man, it has excommunicated all the fundamental instincts of this type, it has distilled evil, the Evil One, out of these instincts – the strong human being as the type of reprehensibility, as the ‘outcast’. Christianity has taken the side of everything weak, base, ill-constituted, it has made an ideal out of opposition to the preservative instincts of strong life; it has depraved the reason even of the intellectually strongest natures by teaching men to feel the supreme values of intellectuality as sinful, as misleading, as temptations. The most deplorable example: the depraving of Pascal, who believed his reason had been depraved by original sin while it had only been depraved by his Christianity! –

§6

It is a painful, a dreadful spectacle which has opened up before me: I have drawn back the curtain on the depravity of man. In my mouth this word is protected against at any rate one suspicion: that it contains a moral accusation of man. It is – I

should like to underline the fact again – free of any moralic acid: and this to the extent that I find that depravity precisely where hitherto one most consciously aspired to ‘virtue’, to ‘divinity’. I understand depravity, as will already have been guessed, in the sense of *décadence*: my assertion is that all the values in which mankind at present summarizes its highest desideratum are *décadence* values. I call an animal, a species, an individual depraved when it loses its instincts, when it chooses, when it prefers what is harmful to it. A history of the ‘higher feelings’, of the ‘ideals of mankind’ – and it is possible I shall have to narrate it – would almost also constitute an explanation of why man is so depraved. I consider life itself instinct for growth, for continuance, for accumulation of forces, for power: where the will to power is lacking there is decline. My assertion is that this will is lacking in all the supreme values of mankind – that values of decline, nihilistic values hold sway under the holiest names.

§7

Christianity is called the religion of pity. – Pity stands in antithesis to the tonic emotions which enhance the energy of the feeling of life: it has a depressive effect. One loses force when one pities. The loss of force which life has already sustained through suffering is increased and multiplied even further by pity. Suffering itself becomes contagious through pity; sometimes it can bring about a collective loss of life and life-energy which stands in an absurd relation to the

quantum of its cause (- the case of the death of the Nazarene). This is the first aspect; but there is an even more important one. If one judges pity by the value of the reactions which it usually brings about, its mortally dangerous character appears in a much clearer light. Pity on the whole thwarts the law of evolution, which is the law of selection. It preserves what is ripe for destruction; it defends life's disinherited and condemned; through the abundance of the ill-constituted of all kinds which it retains in life it gives life itself a gloomy and questionable aspect. One has ventured to call pity a virtue (- in every noble morality it counts as weakness -); one has gone further, one has made of it the virtue, the ground and origin of all virtue - only, to be sure, from the viewpoint of a nihilistic philosophy which inscribed Denial of Life on its escutcheon - a fact always to be kept in view. Schopenhauer was within his rights in this: life is denied, made more worthy of denial by pity - pity is practical nihilism. To say it again, this depressive and contagious instinct thwarts those instincts bent on preserving and enhancing the value of life: both as a multiplier of misery and as a conservator of everything miserable it is one of the chief instruments for the advancement of *décadence* - pity persuades to nothingness!... One does not say 'nothingness': one says 'the Beyond'; or 'God'; or 'true life'; or Nirvana, redemption, blessedness.... This innocent rhetoric from the domain of religio-moral

idiosyncrasy at once appears much less innocent when one grasps which tendency is here draping the mantle of sublime words about itself: the tendency hostile to life. Schopenhauer was hostile to life: therefore pity became for him a virtue.... Aristotle, as is well known, saw in pity a morbid and dangerous condition which one did well to get at from time to time with a purgative: he understood tragedy as a purgative. From the instinct for life one would indeed have to seek some means of puncturing so morbid and dangerous an accumulation of pity as that represented by the case of Schopenhauer (and unfortunately also by our entire literary and artistic *décadence* from St Petersburg to Paris, from Tolstoy to Wagner), so that it might burst.... Nothing in our unhealthy modernity is more unhealthy than Christian pity. To be physician here, to be inexorable here, to wield the knife here - that pertains to us, that is our kind of philanthropy, with that are we philosophers, we Hyperboreans! -

§8

It is necessary to say whom we feel to be our antithesis - the theologians and all that has theologian blood in its veins - our entire philosophy... One must have seen the fatality from close up, better still one must have experienced it in

oneself, one must have almost perished by it, no longer to find anything funny here (the free-thinking of our naturalists and physiologists is to my mind funny – they lack passion in these things, they do not suffer from them –). That poison extends much further than one thinks: I have discovered the arrogant theologian-instinct wherever anyone today feels himself to be an ‘idealist’ – wherever anyone assumes, by virtue of a higher origin, a right to cast strange and superior looks at actuality.... Just like the priest, the idealist has all the great concepts in his hand (– and not only in his hand!), he plays them out with a benevolent contempt against the ‘understanding’, the ‘senses’, ‘honours’, ‘luxury’, ‘science’, he sees these things as beneath him, as harmful and seductive forces above which ‘the spirit’ soars in pure self-sufficiency – as though humility, chastity, poverty, in a word holiness, had not hitherto done life unutterably more harm than any sort of frightfulness or vice whatever.... Pure spirit is pure lie.... So long as the priest, that denier, calumniator and poisoner of life by profession, still counts as a higher kind of human being, there can be no answer to the question: what is truth? One has already stood truth on its head when the conscious advocate of denial and nothingness counts as the representative of ‘truth’...

§9

I make war on this theologian instinct: I have found traces of it everywhere. Whoever has theologian blood in his veins has a wrong and dishonest attitude

towards all things from the very first. The pathos that develops out of this is called faith: closing one’s eyes with respect to oneself for good and all so as not to suffer from the sight of incurable falsity. Out of this erroneous perspective on all things one makes a morality, a virtue, a holiness for oneself, one unites the good conscience with seeing falsely – one demands that no other kind of perspective shall be accorded any value after one has rendered one’s own sacrosanct with the names ‘God’, ‘redemption’, ‘eternity’. I have dug out the theologian instinct everywhere: it is the most widespread, peculiarly subterranean form of falsity that exists on earth. What a theologian feels to be true must be false: this provides almost a criterion of truth. It is his deepest instinct of self-preservation which forbids any part of reality whatever to be held in esteem or even spoken of. Wherever the influence of the theologian extends value judgement is stood on its head, the concepts ‘true’ and ‘false’ are necessarily reversed: that which is most harmful to life is here called ‘true’, that which enhances, intensifies, affirms, justifies it and causes it to triumph is called ‘false’.... If it happens that, by way of the ‘conscience’ of princes (or of nations –), theologians stretch out their hands after power, let us be in no doubt

what at bottom is taking place every time: the will to the end, the nihilistic will wants power...

§10

Among Germans one will understand immediately when I say that philosophy has been corrupted by theologian blood. The Protestant pastor is the grandfather of German philosophy, Protestantism itself is its peccatum originale.* Definition of Protestantism: the half-sided paralysis of Christianity – and of reason.... One has only to say the words ‘College of Tübingen’† to grasp what German philosophy is at bottom – a cunning theology.... The Swabians are the best liars in Germany, they lie innocently.... Why the rejoicing heard throughout the German academic world – three-quarters composed of the sons of pastors and teachers – at the appearance of Kant? Why the Germans’ conviction, which still finds an echo even today, that with Kant things were taking a turn for the better? The theologian instinct in the German scholar divined what was henceforth possible once again.... A secret path to the old ideal stood revealed, the concept ‘real world’, the concept of morality as the essence of the world (– these two most vicious errors in existence!) were once more, thanks to a crafty-sly scepticism, if not demonstrable yet no longer refutable.... Reason, the right of reason does not extend so far.... One had made of reality an ‘appearance’; one had made a completely fabricated world, that of being, into reality.... Kant’s success is merely a theologian’s success: German integrity was far from firm and Kant, like Luther, like Leibniz, was one more constraint upon it...

§11

A word against Kant as moralist. A virtue has to be our invention, our most personal defence and necessity: in any other sense it is merely a danger. What does not condition our life harms it: a virtue merely from a feeling of respect for the concept ‘virtue’, as Kant desired it, is harmful. ‘Virtue’, ‘duty’, ‘good in itself’, impersonal and universal – phantoms, expressions of decline, of the final exhaustion of life, of Königsbergian Chinadom. The profoundest laws of preservation and growth demand the reverse of this: that each one of us should devise his own virtue, his own categorical imperative. A people perishes if it mistakes its own duty for the concept of duty in general. Nothing works more profound ruin than any ‘impersonal’ duty, any sacrifice to the Moloch of abstraction. – Kant’s categorical imperative* should have been felt as mortally dangerous!... The theologian instinct alone took it under its protection! – An action compelled by the instinct of life has in the joy of performing it the proof it is a right action: and that nihilist with Christian-dogmatic bowels

understands joy as an objection.... What destroys more quickly than to work, to think, to feel without inner necessity, without a deep personal choice, without joy? as an automaton of 'duty'? It is virtually a recipe for *décadence*, even for idiocy.... Kant became an idiot. – And that was the contemporary of Goethe! This fatal spider counted as the German philosopher – still does! I take care not to say what I think of the Germans.... Did Kant not see in the French Revolution the transition from the inorganic form of the state to the organic? Did he not ask himself whether there was an event which could be explained in no other way than by a moral predisposition on the part of mankind, so that with it the 'tendency of man to seek the good' would be proved once and for all? Kant's answer: 'The Revolution is that.' The erring instinct in all and everything, antinaturalness as instinct, German *décadence* as philosophy – that is Kant! –

III.4 — Twilight of the Idols: Skirmishes §33-39

TWILIGHT OF THE IDOLS, "EXPEDITIONS OF AN UNTIMELY MAN" §33-39 (Translated by R.J. Hollingdale)

§33

The natural value of egoism. – The value of egoism depends on the physiological value of him who possesses it: it can be very valuable, it can be worthless and contemptible. Every individual may be regarded as representing the ascending or descending line of life. When one has decided which, one has thereby established a

canon for the value of his egoism. If he represents the ascending line his value is in fact extraordinary – and for the sake of the life-collective, which with him takes a step forward, the care expended on his preservation, on the creation of optimum conditions for him, may even be extreme. For the individual, the 'single man', as people and philosophers have hitherto understood him, is an error: he does not constitute a separate entity, an atom, a 'link in the chain', something merely inherited from the past – he constitutes the entire single line 'man' up to and including himself.... If he represents the descending development, decay, chronic degeneration, sickening (– sickness is, broadly speaking, already a phenomenon consequent upon decay, not the cause of it), then he can be accorded little value, and elementary fairness demands that he takes away as little as possible from the well-constituted. He is not better than a parasite on them...

§34

Christian and anarchist. – When the anarchist, as the mouthpiece of declining strata of society, demands with righteous indignation ‘his rights’, ‘justice’, ‘equal rights’, he is only acting under the influence of his want of culture, which prevents his understanding why he is really suffering – in what respect he is impoverished, in life.... A cause-creating drive is powerful within him: someone must be to blame for his feeling vile.... His ‘righteous indignation’ itself already does him good; every poor devil finds pleasure in scolding – it gives him a little of the intoxication of power. Even complaining and wailing can give life a charm for the sake of which one endures it: there is a small dose of revenge in every complaint, one reproaches those who are different for one’s feeling vile, sometimes even with one’s being vile, as if they had perpetrated an injustice or possessed an impermissible privilege. ‘If I am canaille, you ought to be so too’: on the basis of this logic one makes revolutions. – Complaining is never of any use: it comes from weakness. Whether one attributes one’s feeling vile to others or to oneself – the Socialist does the former, the Christian for example the latter – makes no essential difference. What is common to both, and unworthy in both, is that someone has to be to blame for the fact that one suffers – in short, that the sufferer prescribes for himself the honey of revenge as a medicine for his suffering. The objectives of this thirst for revenge as a thirst for pleasure vary according to circumstances: the sufferer finds occasions everywhere for cooling his petty revengefulness – if he is a Christian, to say it again, he finds them in himself.... The Christian and the anarchist – both are *décadents*. – And when the Christian condemns, calumniates and befouls the ‘world’, he does so from the same instinct from which the Socialist worker condemns, calumniates and befouls society: even the ‘Last Judgement’ is still the sweet consolation of revenge – the revolution, such as the Socialist worker too

anticipates, only conceived of as somewhat more distant.... Even the ‘Beyond’ – why a Beyond if not as a means of befouling the Here-and-Now?...

§35

A criticism of *décadence* morality. – An ‘altruistic’ morality, a morality under which egoism languishes – is under all circumstances a bad sign. This applies to individuals, it applies especially to peoples. The best are lacking when egoism begins to be lacking. To choose what is harmful to oneself, to be attracted by ‘disinterested’ motives, almost constitutes the formula for *décadence*. ‘Not to seek one’s own advantage’ – that is merely a moral figleaf for a quite different, namely physiological fact: ‘I no longer know how to find my advantage’.... Disgregation of the instincts! – Man is finished when he

becomes altruistic. – Instead of saying simply ‘I am no longer worth anything’, the moral lie in the mouth of the *décadent* says: ‘Nothing is worth anything – life is not worth anything’.... Such a judgement represents, after all, a grave danger, it is contagious – on the utterly morbid soil of society it soon grows up luxuriously, now in the form of religion (Christianity), now in that of philosophy (Schopen-hauerism). In some circumstances the vapours of such a poison-tree jungle sprung up out of putrefaction can poison life for years ahead, for thousands of years ahead...

§36

A moral code for physicians. – The invalid is a parasite on society. In a certain state it is indecent to go on living. To vegetate on in cowardly dependence on physicians and medicaments after the meaning of life, the right to life, has been lost ought to entail the profound contempt of society. Physicians, in their turn, ought to be the communicators of this contempt – not prescriptions, but every day a fresh dose of disgust with their patients.... To create a new responsibility, that of the physician, in all cases in which the highest interest of life, of ascending life, demands the most ruthless suppression and sequestration of degenerating life – for example in determining the right to reproduce, the right to be born, the right to live.... To die proudly when it is no longer possible to live proudly. Death of one’s own free choice, death at the proper time, with a clear head and with joyfulness, consummated in the midst of children and witnesses: so that an actual leave-taking is possible while he who is leaving is still there, likewise an actual evaluation of what has been desired and what achieved in life, an adding-up of life – all of this in contrast to the pitiable and horrible comedy Christianity has made of the hour of death. One should never forget of Christianity that it has abused the weakness of the dying to commit conscience-rape and even the mode of death to formulate value judgements on men and the past! – Here, every cowardice of prejudice

notwithstanding, it is above all a question of establishing the correct, that is physiological evaluation of so-called natural death: which is, after all, also only an ‘unnatural’ death, an act of suicide. One perishes by no one but oneself. Only ‘natural’ death is death for the most contemptible reasons, an unfree death, a death at the wrong time, a coward’s death. From love of life one ought to desire to die differently from this: freely, consciously, not accidentally, not suddenly overtaken. ... Finally, a piece of advice for messieurs the pessimists and other *décadents*. We have no power to prevent ourselves being born: but we can rectify this error – for it is sometimes an error. When one does away with oneself one does the most estimable thing possible: one thereby almost

deserves to live.... Society – what am I saying! life itself derives more advantage from that than from any sort of ‘life’ spent in renunciation, green-sickness and other virtues – one has freed others from having to endure one’s sight, one has removed an objection from life.... Pessimism, pur, vert* proves itself only by the self-negation of messieurs the pessimists: one must take their logic a step further, and not deny life merely in ‘will and idea’, as Schopenhauer did – one must first of all deny Schopenhauer.... Pessimism, by the by, however contagious it may be, nevertheless does not add to the morbidity of an age or a race in general: it is the expression of this morbidity. One succumbs to it as one succumbs to cholera: one’s constitution must already be sufficiently morbid. Pessimism does not of itself make a single additional *décadent*, I recall that statistics show that the years in which cholera rages do not differ from other years in the total number of deaths.

§37

Whether we have grown more moral. – As was only to be expected, the whole ferocity of the moral stupidity which, as is well known, is considered morality as such in Germany, has launched itself against my concept ‘beyond good and evil’: I could tell some pretty stories about it. Above all, I was invited to reflect on the ‘undeniable superiority’ of our age in moral judgement, our real advance in this respect: compared with us, a Cesare Borgia was certainly not to be set up as a ‘higher man’, as a kind of superman, in the way I set him up.... A Swiss editor, that of the ‘Bund’, went so far – not without expressing his admiration of the courage for so hazardous an enterprise – as to ‘understand’ that the meaning of my work lay in a proposal to abolish all decent feeling. Much obliged!* – by way of reply I permit myself to raise the question whether we have really grown more moral. That all the world believes so is already an objection to it.... We modern men, very delicate, very vulnerable and paying and receiving consideration in a hundred ways, imagine in fact that this sensitive humanity which we represent, this achieved unanimity in forbearance, in readiness to help, in mutual trust, is a positive advance,

that with this we have gone far beyond the men of the Renaissance. But every age thinks in this way, has to think in this way. What is certain is that we would not dare to place ourselves in Renaissance circumstances, or even imagine ourselves in them: our nerves could not endure that reality, not to speak of our muscles. This incapacity, however, demonstrates, not an advance, but only a different, a more belated constitution, a weaker, more delicate, more vulnerable one, out of which is necessarily engendered a morality which is full of consideration. If we think away our delicacy and belatedness, our

physiological ageing, then our morality of 'humanization' too loses its value at once - no morality has any value in itself - : we would even despise it. On the other hand, let us be in no doubt that we modern men, with our thick padding of humanity which dislikes to give the slightest offence, would provide the contemporaries of Cesare Borgia with a side-splitting comedy. We are, in fact, involuntarily funny beyond all measure, we with our modern 'virtues'.... The decay of our hostile and mistrust-arousing instincts - and that is what constitutes our 'advance' - represents only one of the effects attending our general decay of vitality: it costs a hundred times more effort, more foresight, to preserve so dependent, so late an existence as we are. Here everyone helps everyone else, here everyone is to a certain degree an invalid and everyone a nurse. This is then called 'virtue' - : among men who knew a different kind of life, a fuller, more prodigal, more overflowing life, it would be called something else: 'cowardice', perhaps, 'pitiableness', 'old woman's morality'.... Our softening of customs - this is my thesis, my innovation if you like - is a consequence of decline; stern and frightful customs can, conversely, be a consequence of a superabundance of life. For in the latter case much may be risked, much demanded and much squandered. What was formerly a spice of life would be poison to us.... We are likewise too old, too belated, to be capable of indifference -also a form of strength: our morality of pity, against which I was the first to warn, that which one might call *l'impressionisme morale*, is one more expression of the physiological overexcitability pertaining to everything *décadent*. That movement which with Schopenhauer's morality of pity attempted to present itself as scientific - a very unsuccessful attempt! - is the actual *décadence* movement in morality; as such it is profoundly related to Christian morality. Strong ages, noble cultures, see in pity, in 'love of one's neighbour', in a lack of self and self-reliance, something contemptible. - Ages are to be assessed according to their positive forces - and by this assessment the age of the Renaissance, so prodigal and so fateful, appears as the last great age, and we, we moderns with our anxious care for ourselves and love of our neighbour, with our virtues of work, of unpretentiousness, of fair play, of scientificity - acquisitive, economical, machine-minded - appear as a weak age.... Our virtues are conditioned, are demanded by our weakness.... 'Equality', a certain actual rendering similar of which the theory of 'equal rights' is only the expression,

belongs essentially to decline: the chasm between man and man, class and class, the multiplicity of types, the will to be oneself, to stand out - that which I call *pathos of distance* - characterizes every strong age. The tension, the range between the extremes is today growing less and less - the extremes themselves are finally obliterated to the point of similarity.... All our political theories and

state constitutions, the 'German Reich' certainly not excluded, are consequences, necessary effects of decline; the unconscious influence of *décadence* has gained ascendancy even over the ideals of certain of the sciences. My objection to the whole of sociology in England and France is that it knows from experience only the decaying forms of society and takes its own decaying instincts with perfect innocence as the norm of sociological value judgement. Declining life, the diminution of all organizing power, that is to say the power of separating, of opening up chasms, of ranking above and below, formulates itself in the sociology of today as the ideal.... Our Socialists are *décadents*, but Mr Herbert Spencer is also a *décadent* - he sees in the victory of altruism something desirable!...

§38

My conception of freedom. - The value of a thing sometimes lies not in what one attains with it, but in what one pays for it - what it costs us. I give an example. Liberal institutions immediately cease to be liberal as soon as they are attained: subsequently there is nothing more thoroughly harmful to freedom than liberal institutions. One knows, indeed, what they bring about: they undermine the will to power, they are the levelling of mountain and valley exalted to a moral principle, they make small, cowardly and smug - it is the herd animal which triumphs with them every time. Liberalism: in plain words, reduction to the herd animal.... As long as they are still being fought for, these same institutions produce quite different effects; they then in fact promote freedom mightily. Viewed more closely, it is war which produces these effects, war for liberal institutions which as war permits the illiberal instincts to endure. And war is a training in freedom. For what is freedom? That one has the will to self-responsibility. That one preserves the distance which divides us. That one has become more indifferent to hardship, toil, privation, even to life. That one is ready to sacrifice men to one's cause, oneself not excepted. Freedom means that the manly instincts that delight in war and victory have gained mastery over the other instincts - for example, over the instinct for 'happiness'. The man who has become free - and how much more the mind that has become free - spurns the contemptible sort of well-being dreamed of by shopkeepers, Christians, cows, women, Englishmen and other democrats. The free man is a warrior. - How is freedom measured, in individuals as in nations? By the resistance which has to be overcome, by the effort it costs to stay aloft. One would have to seek the highest

type of free man where the greatest resistance is constantly being overcome: five steps from tyranny, near the threshold of the danger of servitude. This is

true psychologically when one understands by 'tyrants' pitiless and dreadful instincts, to combat which demands the maximum of authority and discipline towards oneself – finest type Julius Caesar –; it is also true politically: one has only to look at history. The nations which were worth something, which became worth something, never became so under liberal institutions: it was great danger which made of them something deserving reverence, danger which first teaches us to know our resources, our virtues, our shield and spear, our spirit – which compels us to be strong.... First principle: one must need strength, otherwise one will never have it. – Those great forcing-houses for strong human beings, for the strongest kind there has ever been, the aristocratic communities of the pattern of Rome and Venice, understood freedom in precisely the sense which I understand the word 'freedom': as something one has and does not have, something one wants, something one conquers...

§39

Criticism of modernity. – Our institutions are no longer fit for anything: everyone is unanimous about that. But the fault lies not in them but in us. Having lost all the instincts out of which institutions grow, we are losing the institutions themselves, because we are no longer fit for them. Democracy has always been the declining form of the power to organize: I have already, in *Human, All Too Human*, characterized modern democracy, together with its imperfect manifestations such as the 'German Reich', as the decaying form of the state. For institutions to exist there must exist the kind of will, instinct, imperative which is anti-liberal to the point of malice: the will to tradition, to authority, to centuries-long responsibility, to solidarity between succeeding generations backwards and forwards in infinitum. If this will is present, there is established something such as the Imperium Romanum: or such as Russia, the only power today which has durability in it, which can wait, which can still promise something – Russia, the antithesis of that pitiable European petty-state politics and nervousness which with the foundation of the German Reich has entered a critical phase.... The entire West has lost those instincts out of which institutions grow, out of which the future grows: perhaps nothing goes so much against the grain of its 'modern spirit' as this. One lives for today, one lives very fast – one lives very irresponsibly: it is precisely this which one calls 'freedom'. That which makes institutions institutions is despised, hated, rejected: whenever the word 'authority' is so much as heard one believes oneself in danger of a new slavery. The *décadence* in the valuating instinct of our politicians, our political parties, goes so deep that they instinctively prefer that which leads to dissolution,

that which hastens the end.... Witness modern marriage. It is obvious that all sense has gone out of modern marriage: which is, however, no objection to marriage but to modernity. The rationale of marriage lay in the legal sole responsibility of the man: marriage thereby had a centre of gravity, whereas now it limps with both legs. The rationale of marriage lay in its indissolubility in principle: it thereby acquired an accent which could make itself heard against the accidents of feeling, passion and the moment. It lay likewise in the responsibility of the families for the selection of mates. With the increasing indulgence of love matches one has simply eliminated the foundation of marriage, that alone which makes it an institution. One never establishes an institution on the basis of an idiosyncrasy, one does not, as aforesaid, establish marriage on the basis of 'love' - one establishes it on the basis of the sexual drive, the drive to own property (wife and child considered as property), the drive to dominate which continually organizes the smallest type of domain, the family, which needs children and heirs so as to retain, in a physiological sense as well, an achieved measure of power, influence, wealth, so as to prepare for protracted tasks, for a solidarity of instinct between the centuries. Marriage as an institution already includes in itself the affirmation of the largest, the most enduring form of organization: if society as a whole cannot stand security for itself to the most distant generations, then marriage has really no meaning. - Modern marriage has lost its meaning - consequently it is being abolished.

§33

In the entire psychology of the 'Gospel' the concept guilt and punishment is lacking; likewise the concept reward. 'Sin', every kind of distancing relationship between God and man, is abolished - precisely this is the 'glad tidings'. Blessedness is not promised, it is not tied to any conditions: it is the only reality - the rest is signs for speaking of it... The consequence of such a condition projects itself into a new practice, the true evangelic practice. It is not a 'belief' which distinguishes the Christian: the Christian acts, he is distinguished by a different mode of acting. Neither by words nor in his heart does he resist the man who does him evil. He makes no distinction between foreigner and native, between Jew and non-Jew ('one's neighbour' is properly one's co-religionist, the Jew). He is not angry with anyone, does not disdain anyone. He neither appears in courts of law nor claims their protection ('not swearing'). Under no circumstances, not even in the case of proved unfaithfulness, does he divorce his wife. - All fundamentally one law, all consequences of one instinct. - The life of the redeemer was nothing else than this practice - his death too was nothing else.... He no longer required any formulas, any rites for communicating with God - not even prayer. He has

settled his accounts with the whole Jewish penance-and-reconciliation doctrine; he knows that it is through the practice of one's life that one feels 'divine', 'blessed', 'evangelic', at all times a 'child of God'. It is not 'penance', not 'prayer for forgiveness' which leads to God: evangelic practice alone leads to God, it is God! – What was abolished with the Evangel was the Judaism of the concepts 'sin', 'forgiveness of sin', 'faith', 'redemption by faith'—the whole of Jewish ecclesiastical teaching was denied in the 'glad tidings'. The profound instinct for how one would have to live in order to feel oneself 'in Heaven', to feel oneself 'eternal', while in every other condition one by no means feels oneself 'in Heaven': this alone is the psychological reality of 'redemption'. – A new way of living, not a new belief...

§34

If I understand anything of this great symbolist it is that he took for realities, for 'truths', only inner realities – that he understood the rest, everything pertaining to nature, time, space, history, only as signs, as occasion for metaphor. The concept 'the Son of Man' is not a concrete person belonging to history, anything at all individual or unique, but an 'eternal' fact, a psychological symbol freed from the

time concept. The same applies supremely to the God of this typical symbolist, to the 'kingdom of God', to the 'kingdom of Heaven', to 'God's children'. Nothing is more un-Christian than the ecclesiastical crudities of a God as a person, of a 'kingdom of God' which comes, of a 'kingdom of Heaven' in the Beyond, of a 'Son of God', the second person of the Trinity. All this – forgive the expression – a fist in the eye* – oh in what an eye! – of the Gospel: world-historical cynicism in the mockery of symbolism.... But it is patently obvious what is alluded to in the symbols 'Father' and 'Son' – not patently obvious to everyone, I grant: in the word 'Son' is expressed the entry into the collective feeling of the transfiguration of all things (blessedness), in the word 'Father' this feeling itself, the feeling of perfection and eternity. – I am ashamed to recall what the Church has made of this symbolism: has it not set an Amphitryon† story at the threshold of Christian 'faith'? And a dogma of 'immaculate conception' into the bargain?... But it has thereby maculated conception– The 'Kingdom of Heaven' is a condition of the heart – not something that comes 'upon the earth' or 'after death'. The entire concept of natural death is lacking in the Gospel: death is not a bridge, not a transition, it is lacking because it belongs to quite another world, a merely apparent world useful only for the purpose of symbolism. The 'hour of death' is not a Christian concept – the 'hour', time, physical life and its crises, simply do not exist for the

teacher of the 'glad tidings'. ... The 'kingdom of God' is not something one waits for; it has no yesterday or tomorrow, it does not come 'in a thousand years' - it is an experience within a heart; it is everywhere, it is nowhere...

§35

This 'bringer of glad tidings' died as he lived, as he taught - not to 'redeem mankind' but to demonstrate how one ought to live. What he bequeathed to mankind is his practice: his bearing before the judges, before the guards, before the accusers and every kind of calumny and mockery - his bearing on the Cross. He does not resist, he does not defend his rights, he takes no steps to avert the worst that can happen to him - more, he provokes it.... And he entreats, he suffers, he loves with those, in those who are doing evil to him. His words to the thief on the Cross contain the whole Evangel. 'That was verily a divine man, a child of God!' - says the thief. 'If thou feelest this' - answers the redeemer - 'thou art in Paradise, thou art a child of God.' Not to defend oneself, not to grow angry, not to make responsible.... But not to resist even the evil man - to love him...

§36

- Only we, we emancipated spirits, possess the prerequisite for understanding something nineteen centuries have misunderstood - that integrity become instinct and passion which makes war on the 'holy lie' even more than on any other lie.... One has been unspeakably far from our benevolent and cautious neutrality, from that discipline of the spirit through which alone the divining of such strange, such delicate things is made possible: at all times one has, with shameless self-seeking, desired only one's own advantage in these things, one constructed the Church out of the antithesis to the Gospel. If anyone were looking for a sign that an ironical divinity was at work behind the great universal drama he would find no small support in the tremendous questionmark called Christianity. That mankind should fall on its knees before the opposite of what was the origin, the meaning, the right of the Gospel, that it should have sanctified in the concept 'Church' precisely what the 'bringer of glad tidings' regarded as beneath him, behind him - one seeks in vain a grander form of worldhistorical irony -

§37

- Our age is proud of its historical sense: how was it able to make itself believe in the nonsensical notion that the crude miracle-worker and redeemer fable

comes at the commencement of Christianity – and that everything spiritual and symbolic is only a subsequent development? On the contrary: the history of Christianity – and that from the very death on the Cross – is the history of progressively cruder misunderstanding of an original symbolism. With every extension of Christianity over even broader, even ruder masses in whom the preconditions out of which it was born were more and more lacking, it became increasingly necessary to vulgarize, to barbarize Christianity – it absorbed the doctrines and rites of every subterranean cult of the Imperium Romanum, it absorbed the absurdities of every sort of morbid reason. The fate of Christianity lies in the necessity for its faith itself to grow as morbid, low and vulgar as the requirements it was intended to satisfy were morbid, low and vulgar. As the Church, this morbid barbarism itself finally assumes power – the Church, that form of mortal hostility to all integrity, to all loftiness of soul, to discipline of spirit, to all open-hearted and benevolent humanity. – Christian values – noble values: it is only we, we emancipated spirits, who have restored this greatest of all value-antitheses! –

§38

– At this point I shall not suppress a sigh. There are days when I am haunted by a feeling blacker than the blackest melancholy – contempt of man. And so as to leave no doubt as to what I despise, whom I despise: it is the man of today, the man with whom I am fatefully contemporary. The man of today – I suffocate of his impure

breath.... With regard to the past I am, like all men of knowledge, of a large tolerance, that is to say a magnanimous self-control: I traverse the madhouse-world of entire millennia, be it called ‘Christianity’, ‘Christian faith’, ‘Christian Church’, with a gloomy circumspection – I take care not to make mankind responsible for its insanities. But my feelings suddenly alter, burst forth, immediately I enter the modern age, our age. Our age knows.... What was formerly merely morbid has today become indecent – it is indecent to be a Christian today. And here is where my disgust commences. – I look around me: there is no longer a word left of what was formerly called ‘truth’, we no longer endure it when a priest so much as utters the word ‘truth’. Even with the most modest claim to integrity one must know today that a theologian, a priest, a pope does not merely err in every sentence he speaks, he lies – that he is no longer free to lie ‘innocently’, out of ‘ignorance’. The priest knows as well as anyone that there is no longer any ‘God’, any ‘sinner’, any ‘redeemer’ – that ‘free will’, ‘moral world-order’ are lies – intellectual seriousness, the profound self-overcoming of the intellect, no longer permits anyone not to know about

these things.... All the concepts of the Church are recognized for what they are: the most malicious false-coinage there is for the purpose of disvaluing nature and natural values; the priest himself is recognized for what he is: the most dangerous kind of parasite, the actual poison-spider of life.... We know, our conscience knows today – what those sinister inventions of priest and Church are worth, what end they serve, with which that state of human self-violation has brought about which is capable of exciting disgust at the sight of mankind – the concepts ‘Beyond’, ‘Last Judgement’, ‘immortality of the soul’, the ‘soul’ itself: they are instruments of torture, they are forms of systematic cruelty by virtue of which the priest has become master, stays master.... Everyone knows this: and everyone none the less remains unchanged. Where have the last feelings of decency and self-respect gone when even our statesmen, in other ways very unprejudiced kind of men and practical anti-Christians through and through, still call themselves Christians today and go to Communion?... A young prince at the head of his regiments, splendid as the expression of his people’s egoism and presumption – but without any shame professing himself a Christian!... Whom then does Christianity deny? what does it call ‘world’? Being a soldier, being a judge, being a patriot; defending oneself; preserving one’s honour; desiring to seek one’s advantage; being proud.... The practice of every hour, every instinct, every valuation which leads to action is today anti-Christian: what a monster of falsity modern man must be that he is none the less not ashamed to be called a Christian!

§39

– To resume, I shall now relate the real history of Christianity. – The word

‘Christianity’ is already a misunderstanding – in reality there has been only one Christian, and he died on the Cross. The ‘Evangel’ died on the Cross. What was called ‘Evangel’ from this moment onwards was already the opposite of what he had lived: ‘bad tidings’, a dysangel. It is false to the point of absurdity to see in a ‘belief, perchance the belief in redemption through Christ, the distinguishing characteristic of the Christian: only Christian practice, a life such as he who died on the Cross lived, is Christian.... Even today, such a life is possible, for certain men even necessary: genuine, primitive Christianity will be possible at all times.... Not a belief but a doing, above all a not-doing of many things, a different being.... States of consciousness, beliefs of any kind, holding something to be true for example – every psychologist knows, this – are a matter of complete indifference and of the fifth rank compared with the value of the instincts: to speak more strictly, the whole concept of spiritual causality is false. To reduce being a Christian, Christianness, to a holding something to

be true, to a mere phenomenality of consciousness, means to negate Christianness. In fact there have been no Christians at all. The 'Christian', that which has been called Christian for two millennia, is merely a psychological self-misunderstanding. Regarded more closely, that which has ruled in him, in spite of all his 'faith', has been merely the instincts – and what instincts! 'Faith' has been at all times, with Luther for instance, only a cloak, a pretext, a screen, behind which the instincts played their game – a shrewd blindness to the dominance of certain instincts.... 'Faith' – I have already called it the true Christian shrewdness – one has always spoken of faith, one has always acted from instinct.... The Christian's world of ideas contains nothing which so much as touches upon actuality: on the other hand, we have recognized in instinctive hatred for actuality the driving element, the only driving element in the roots of Christianity. What follows therefrom? That here, in psychologicis also, error is radical, that is to say determinant of the essence, that is to say substance. One concept removed, a single reality substituted in its place – and the whole of Christianity crumbles to nothing! – From a lofty standpoint, this strangest of all facts, a religion not only determined by errors but inventive and even possessing genius only in harmful, only in life-poisoning and heart-poisoning errors, remains a spectacle for the gods – for those divinities which are at the same time philosophers and which I encountered, for example, during those celebrated dialogues on Naxos. In the hour when their disgust leaves them (– and leaves us!) they become grateful for the spectacle of the Christian: perhaps it is only for the sake of this curious case that the pathetic little star called Earth deserves a divine glance and divine participation.... For let us not undervalue the Christian: the Christian, false to the point of innocence, far surpasses the ape – with respect to Christians a well-known theory of descent becomes a mere compliment...

III.5 — Ecce Homo: Why I Am So Wise §1-8

ECCE HOMO, "WHY I AM SO WISE" §1-8 (Translated by R.J. Hollingdale)

PART IV: The Great Individual and the Flowering of Culture

IV.1 — The Antichrist §57-62

THE ANTICHRIST §57-62 (Translated by R.J. Hollingdale)

This is the single most important passage for the user's inquiry — the Renaissance as the last great culture, destroyed by Luther and the Reformation.

§57

One catches the unholiness of the Christian means in flagranti when one compares the Christian purpose with the purpose of the Manu Law-Book – when one throws a bright light on this greatest of antitheses of purpose. The critic of Christianity cannot be spared the task of making Christianity contemptible. – Such a law-book as that of Manu originates as does every good law-book: it summarizes the experience, policy and experimental morality of long centuries, it settles accounts, it creates nothing new. The precondition for a codification of this sort is the insight that the means of endowing with authority a truth slowly and expensively acquired are fundamentally different from those by which one would demonstrate it. A lawbook never tells of the utility of a law, of the reason for it, of the casuistry which preceded it: for in that way it would lose the imperative tone, the ‘thou shalt’, the precondition of being obeyed. The problem lies precisely in this. – At a certain point in the evolution of a people its most enlightened, that is to say most reflective and far-sighted, class declares the experience in accordance with which the people is to live – that is, can live – to be fixed and settled. Their objective is to bring home the richest and completest harvest from the ages of experimentation and bad experience. What, consequently, is to be prevented above all is the continuation of experimenting, the perpetuation in infinitum of the fluid condition of values, tests, choices, criticizing of values. A two-fold wall is erected against this: firstly revelation, that is the assertion that the reason for these laws is not of human origin, was not sought and found slowly and with many blunders, but, being of divine origin, is whole, perfect, without history, a gift, a miracle, merely communicated.... Then tradition, that is, the assertion that the law has already existed from time immemorial, that it is impious, a crime against the ancestors, to call it in question. The authority of the law is

established by the thesis: God gave it, the ancestors lived it. – The higher rationale of such a procedure lies in the intention of gradually making the way of life recognized as correct (that is demonstrated by a tremendous amount of finely-sifted experience) unconscious: so that a complete automatism of

instinct is achieved – the precondition for any kind of mastery, any kind of perfection in the art of living. To set up a law-book of the kind of Manu means to concede to a people the right henceforth to become masterly, to become perfect – to be ambitious for the highest art of living. To that end the law must be made unconscious: this is the purpose of every holy lie. – The order of castes, the supreme, the dominating law, is only the sanctioning of a natural order, a natural law of the first rank over which no arbitrary caprice, no 'modern idea' has any power. In every healthy society, there can be distinguished three types of man of divergent physiological tendency which mutually condition one another and each of which possesses its own hygiene, its own realm of work, its own sort of mastery and feeling of perfection. Nature, not Manu, separates from one another the predominantly spiritual type, the predominantly muscular and temperamental type, and the third type distinguished neither in the one nor the other, the mediocre type – the last as the great majority, the first as the élite. The highest caste – I call it the very few – possesses, as the perfect caste, also the privileges of the very few: among them is that of representing happiness, beauty, benevolence on earth. Only the most spiritual human beings are permitted beauty, beautiful things: only in their case is benevolence not weakness. *Pulchrum est paucorum hominum*: the good is a privilege. On the other hand, nothing is more strictly forbidden them than ugly manners or a pessimistic outlook, an eye that makes ugly – to say nothing of indignation at the collective aspect of things. Indignation is the privilege of the Chandala; pessimism likewise. 'The world is perfect' – thus speaks the instinct of the most spiritual, the affirmative instinct – : 'imperfection, everything beneath us, distance between man and man, the pathos of this distance, the Chandala themselves pertain to this perfection'. The most spiritual human beings, as the strongest, find their happiness where others would find their destruction: in the labyrinth, in severity towards themselves and others, in attempting; their joy lies in self-constraint: with them asceticism becomes nature, need, instinct. They consider the hard task a privilege, to play with vices which overwhelm others a recreation.... Knowledge – a form of asceticism. – They are the most venerable kind of human being: this does not exclude their being the most cheerful, the most amiable. They rule not because they want to but because they are; they are not free to be second in rank. – The second in rank: these are the guardians of the law, the keepers of order and security; the noble warriors; above all the king as the highest

formula of warrior, judge and upholder of the law. The second in rank are the executives of the most spiritual order, the closest to them who relieve them of everything coarse in the work of ruling – their following, their right hand, their best pupils. – In all this, to say it again, there is nothing capricious, nothing ‘artificial’; whatever is different from this is artificial – nature is then confounded.... The order of castes, order of rank, only formulates the supreme law of life itself; the separation of the three types

is necessary for the preservation of society, for making possible higher and higher types – inequality of rights is the condition for the existence of rights at all. – A right is a privilege. The privilege of each is determined by the nature of his being. Let us not underestimate the privileges of the mediocre. Life becomes harder and harder as it approaches the heights – the coldness increases, the responsibility increases. A high culture is a pyramid: it can stand only on a broad base, its very first prerequisite is a strongly and soundly consolidated mediocrity. The crafts, trade, agriculture, science, the greater part of art, in a word the entire compass of professional activity, are in no way compatible with anything other than mediocrity in ability and desires; these things would be out of place among the élite, the instinct pertaining to them is as much opposed to aristocracy as it is to anarchy. To be a public utility, a cog, a function, is a natural vocation, it is not society, it is the kind of happiness of which the great majority are alone capable, which makes intelligent machines of them. For the mediocre it is happiness to be mediocre; mastery in one thing, specialization, is for them a natural instinct. It would be quite unworthy of a more profound mind to see an objection in mediocrity as such. It is even the prime requirement for the existence of exceptions; a high culture is conditional upon it. When an exceptional human being handles the mediocre more gently than he does himself or his equals, this is not mere politeness of the heart* – it is simply his duty.... Whom among today’s rabble do I hate the most? The Socialist rabble, the Chandala apostles who undermine the worker’s instinct, his pleasure, his feeling of contentment with his little state of being – who make him envious, who teach him revengefulness.... Injustice never lies in unequal rights, it lies in the claim to ‘equal’ rights.... What is bad? But I have already answered that question: everything that proceeds from weakness, from envy, from revengefulness. – The anarchist and the Christian have a common origin...

§58

It does indeed make a difference for what purpose one lies: whether one preserves with a lie or destroys with it. One may assert an absolute equivalence between Christian and anarchist: their purpose, their instinct is set only on

destruction. For the proof of this proposition one has only to read history, which displays it with frightful clarity. If we have just now examined a religious legislation the purpose of which was to 'eternalize' a grand organization of society, the supreme condition for the prosperity of life - Christianity discovered its mission in making an end of just such an organization because life prospered within it. There the revenue of reason from long ages of experimentation and uncertainty was to be employed for the benefit of the most distant future and the biggest, richest, most complete harvest possible brought home: here, on the contrary, the harvest was poisoned overnight....

That which stood aere perennius, the Imperium Romanum, the most grandiose form of organization under difficult conditions which has hitherto been achieved, in comparison with which everything before and everything since is patchwork, bungling, dilettantism - these holy anarchists made it an 'act of piety' to destroy 'the world', that is to say the Imperium Romanum, until not one stone was left standing on another - until even Teutons and other such ruffians could become master of it.... The Christian and the anarchist: both décadents, both incapable of producing anything but dissolution, poisoning, degeneration, both bloodsuckers, both with the instinct of deadly hatred towards everything that stands erect, that towers grandly up, that possesses duration, that promises life a future.... Christianity was the vampire of the Imperium Romanum - the tremendous deed of the Romans in clearing the ground for a great culture which could take its time was undone overnight by Christianity. - Is this still not understood? The Imperium Romanum which we know, which the history of the Roman province teaches us to know better and better, this most admirable of all works of art in the grand style, was a beginning, its structure was calculated to prove itself by millennia - to this day there has never been such building, to build in such a manner sub specie aeterni has never been so much as dreamed of! - This organization was firm enough to endure bad emperors: the accident of persons must have no effect on such things - first principle of all grand architecture. But it was not firm enough to endure the corruptest form of corruption, to endure the Christian.... These stealthy vermin which, shrouded in night, fog and ambiguity crept up to every individual and sucked seriousness for real things, the instinct for realities of any kind, out of him, this cowardly, womanish and honeyed crew gradually alienated the 'souls' of this tremendous structure - those precious, those manly-noble natures who found their own cause, their own seriousness, their own pride in the cause of Rome. This underhanded bigotry, conventicle secrecy, gloomy concepts such as Hell, such as the sacrifice of the innocent, such as the unio mystica in blood-drinking, above all the slowly stirred-up fire of revengefulness, of Chandala revengefulness - that is what became master of

Rome, the same species of religion on whose antecedent form Epicurus had already made war. One must read Lucretius to understand what it was Epicurus opposed: not paganism but 'Christianity', which is to say the corruption of souls through the concept of guilt, punishment and immortality. – He opposed the subterranean cults, the whole of latent Christianity – to deny immortality was already in those days a real redemption. – And Epicurus would have won, every mind of any account in the Roman Empire was an Epicurean: then Paul appeared.... Paul, Chandala hatred against Rome, against 'the world', become flesh and genius, the Jew, the eternal Jew* par excellence.... What he divined was that with the aid of the little sectarian movement on the edge of Judaism one could ignite a 'world conflagration', that with the symbol 'God on the Cross' one could

sum up everything down-trodden, everything in secret revolt, the entire heritage of anarchist agitation in the Empire into a tremendous power. 'Salvation is of the Jews.' – Christianity as the formula for outbidding all the subterranean cults, those of Osiris, of the Great Mother, of Mithras for example – and for summing them up: it is in this insight that the genius of Paul consists. His instinct in this matter was so sure that, doing ruthless violence to the truth, he took the ideas by which those Chandala religions exercised their fascination and placed them in the mouth of the 'Saviour' he had invented, and not only in his mouth – so as to make of him something even a priest of Mithras could understand.... This was his vision on the road to Damascus: he grasped that to disvalue 'the world' he needed the belief in immortality, that the concept 'Hell' will master even Rome – that with the 'Beyond' one kills life.... Nihilist and Christian: they rhyme,* and do not merely rhyme...

§59

The whole labour of the ancient world in vain: I have no words to express my feelings at something so dreadful. – And considering its labour was a preparation, that only the substructure for a labour of millennia had, with granite selfconfidence, been laid, the whole meaning of the ancient world in vain!... Why did the Greeks exist? Why the Romans? – Every prerequisite for an erudite culture, all the scientific methods were already there, the great, the incomparable art of reading well had already been established – the prerequisite for a cultural tradition, for a uniform science; natural science, in concert with mathematics and mechanics, was on the best possible road – the sense for facts, the last-developed and most valuable of all the senses, had its schools and its tradition already centuries old! Is this understood? Everything essential for setting to work had been devised – methods, one must repeat ten

times, are the essential, as well as being the most difficult, as well as being that which has habit and laziness against it longest. What we have won back for ourselves today with an unspeakable amount of self-constraint – for we all still have bad instincts, the Christian instincts, somewhere within us – the free view of reality, the cautious hand, patience and seriousness in the smallest things, the whole integrity of knowledge – was already there! already more than two millennia ago! And good and delicate taste and tact! Not as brain training! Not as ‘German’ culture with the manners of ruffians! But as body, as gesture, as instinct – in a word, as reality.... All in vain! Overnight merely a memory! – Greeks! Romans! nobility of instinct, of taste, methodical investigation, genius for organization and government, the faith in, the will to a future for mankind, the great Yes to all things, visibly present to all the senses as the Imperium Romanum, grand style no longer merely art but become reality, truth, life.... And not overwhelmed overnight by a natural event! Not trampled down by Teutons and other such

clodhoppers! But ruined by cunning, secret, invisible, anaemic vampires! Not conquered – only sucked dry!... Covert revengefulness, petty envy become master ! Everything pitiful, everything suffering from itself, everything tormented by base feelings, the whole ghetto-world of the soul suddenly on top! – One has only to read any of the Christian agitators, Saint Augustine for example, to realize, to smell, what dirty fellows had therewith come out on top. One would be deceiving oneself utterly if one presupposed a lack of intelligence of any sort on the part of the leaders of the Christian movement – oh they are shrewd, shrewd to the point of holiness, these Church Fathers! What they lack is something quite different. Nature was neglectful when she made them – she forgot to endow them with even a modest number of respectable, decent, cleanly instincts.... Between ourselves, they are not even men.... If Islam despises Christianity, it is a thousand times right to do so: Islam presupposes men...

§60

Christianity robbed us of the harvest of the culture of the ancient world, it later went on to rob us of the harvest of the culture of Islam. The wonderful Moorish cultural world of Spain, more closely related to us at bottom, speaking more directly to our senses and taste, than Greece and Rome, was trampled down (– I do not say by what kind of feet –): why? because it was noble, because it owed its origin to manly instincts, because it said Yes to life even in the rare and exquisite treasures of Moorish life!... Later on, the Crusaders fought against something they would have done better to lie down in the dust before – a

culture compared with which even our nineteenth century may well think itself very impoverished and very 'late'. – They wanted booty, to be sure: the Orient was rich.... But let us not be prejudiced! The Crusades – higher piracy, that is all! German knighthood, Viking knighthood at bottom, was there in its element: the Church knew only too well what German knighthood can be had for.... The German knights, always the 'Switzers' of the Church, always in the service of all the bad instincts of the Church – but well paid.... That it is precisely with the aid of German swords, German blood and courage, that the Church has carried on its deadly war against everything noble on earth! A host of painful questions arises at this point. The German aristocracy is virtually missing in the history of higher culture: one can guess the reason.... Christianity, alcohol – the two great means of corruption.... For in itself there should be no choice in the matter when faced with Islam and Christianity, as little as there should when faced with an Arab and a Jew. The decision is given in advance; no one is free to choose here. One either is Chandala or one is not.... 'War to the knife with Rome! Peace, friendship with Islam': this is what that great free spirit, the genius among German emperors, Friedrich the Second, felt, this is what

he did. What? does a German have to be a genius, a free spirit, before he can have decent feelings? How a German could ever have felt Christian escapes me...

§61

Here it is necessary to touch on a memory a hundred times more painful for Germans. The Germans have robbed Europe of the last great cultural harvest Europe had to bring home – of the harvest of Renaissance. Is it at last understood, is there a desire to understand, what the Renaissance was? The revaluation of Christian values, the attempt, undertaken with every expedient, with every instinct, with genius of every kind, to bring about the victory of the opposing values, the noble values.... Up till now this has been the only great war, there has been no more decisive interrogation than that conducted by the Renaissance – the question it asks is the question I ask – : neither has there been a form of attack more fundamental, more direct, and more strenuously delivered on the entire front and at the enemy's centre! To attack at the decisive point, in the very seat of Christianity, to set the noble values on the throne, which is to say to set them into the instincts, the deepest needs and desires of him who sits thereon.... I see in my mind's eye a possibility of a quite unearthly fascination and splendour – it seems to glitter with a trembling of every refinement of beauty, there seems to be at work in it an art so divine, so diabolically divine, that one might scour the millennia in vain for a second such

possibility; I behold a spectacle at once so meaningful and so strangely paradoxical it would have given all the gods of Olympus an opportunity for an immortal roar of laughter – Cesare Borgia as Pope.... Am I understood?... Very well, that would have been a victory of the only sort I desire today – : Christianity would thereby have been abolished! – What happened? A German monk, Luther, went to Rome. This monk, all the vindictive instincts of a failed priest in him, fulminated in Rome against the Renaissance.... Instead of grasping with profound gratitude the tremendous event which had taken place, the overcoming of Christianity in its very seat – his hatred grasped only how to nourish itself on this spectacle. The religious man thinks only of himself. – What Luther saw was the corruption of the Papacy, while precisely the opposite was palpably obvious: the old corruption, the peccatum originale, Christianity no longer sat on the Papal throne! Life sat there instead! the triumph of life! the great Yes to all lofty, beautiful, daring things!... And Luther restored the Church: he attacked it.... The Renaissance – an event without meaning, a great in vain! – Oh these Germans, what they have already cost us! In vain – that has always been the work of the Germans. – The Reformation; Leibniz; Kant and so-called German philosophy; the Wars of ‘Liberation’; the Reich – each time an in vain for something already in existence, for something irretrievable.... They are my enemies, I confess it, these Germans: I

despise in them every kind of uncleanness of concept and value, of cowardice in the face of every honest Yes and No. For almost a millennium they have twisted and tangled everything they have laid their hands on, they have on their conscience all the half-heartedness – three-eighths-heartedness! – from which Europe is sick – they also have on their conscience the uncleanest kind of Christianity there is, the most incurable kind, the kind hardest to refute, Protestantism.... If we never get rid of Christianity, the Germans will be to blame...

§62

– With that I have done and pronounce my judgement. I condemn Christianity, I bring against the Christian Church the most terrible charge any prosecutor has ever uttered. To me it is the extremest thinkable form of corruption, it has had the will to the ultimate corruption conceivably possible. The Christian Church has left nothing untouched by its depravity, it has made of every value a disvalue, of every truth a lie, of every kind of integrity a vileness of soul. People still dare to talk to me of its ‘humanitarian’ blessings! To abolish any state of distress whatever has been profoundly inexpedient to it: it has lived on states of distress, it has created states of distress in order to eternalize itself.... The

worm of sin, for example: it was only the Church which enriched mankind with this state of distress! – ‘Equality of souls before God’, this falsehood, this pretext for the rancune of all the base-minded, this explosive concept which finally became revolution, modern idea and the principle of the decline of the entire social order – is Christian dynamite.... ‘Humanitarian’ blessings of Christianity! To cultivate out of humanitas a self-contradiction, an art of self-violation, a will to falsehood at any price, an antipathy, a contempt for every good and honest instinct! These are the blessings of Christianity! – Parasitism as the sole practice of the Church; with its ideal of green-sickness, of ‘holiness’ draining away all blood, all love, all hope for life; the Beyond as the will to deny reality of every kind; the Cross as the badge of recognition for the most subterranean conspiracy there has ever been – a conspiracy against health, beauty, wellconstitutedness, bravery, intellect, benevolence of soul, against life itself... Wherever there are walls I shall inscribe this eternal accusation against Christianity upon them – I can write in letters which make even the blind see.... I call Christianity the one great curse, the one great intrinsic depravity, the one great instinct for revenge for which no expedient is sufficiently poisonous, secret, subterranean, petty – I call it the one immortal blemish of mankind... And one calculates time from the dies nefastus* on which this fatality arose – from the first day of Christianity! – Why not rather from its last? – From today? – Revaluation of all values!

Glossary of Names ARISTOTLE (384-322 BC) Nietzsche has only a slight interest in Aristotle, and his

main concern with him is to refute his conception of tragedy as catharsis; the ‘magnanimous’ man of the Nicomachean Ethics, however, is very like Nietzsche’s Übermensch. AUGUSTINE (354-430) ‘These have mastered Christianity:... Platonism

(Augustine)....’ (Will to Power 214); utterly unable to live in the manner of Jesus, Augustine employed Christianity as a vehicle for his own ideology in the manner of Paul. BAUDELAIRE, Charles (1821-67) ‘Who was the first intelligent supporter of

Wagner? Charles Baudelaire....’ (Ecce Homo II 5): Nietzsche’s interest in Baudelaire, such as it is, is part of his interest in proving that Wagner was at bottom a French décadent. BORGIA, Cesare (d. 1507) ‘Borgia’ is an ideogram for the man of strong but

unsublimated will to power, the 'blond beast', who is not 'improved' when he is tamed. BUCKLE, Henry Thomas (1821-62) Historian, author of the unfinished History of

Civilization in which he expounds his ideas on the general laws which govern the evolution of human societies. His reputation formerly stood much higher than it does now: in the Genealogy of Morals (1, 4) Nietzsche attacks the 'plebeianism of the modern spirit' as manifested in the 'notorious case of Buckle'. BURCKHARDT, Jacob (1818-97) Historian, best known for his Civilization of the

Renaissance in Italy. He was an elder colleague of Nietzsche's at Basel university and Nietzsche retained a great admiration for him. CAESAR, Julius (101-44 BC) In Nietzsche's works, Caesar is dehistoricized into an

ideogram for the man of sublimated will to power (compare Borgia). Nietzsche does admire Caesar, but not specifically as a general and certainly not because he was a general (compare Napoleon). CARLYLE, Thomas (1795-1881) In an aphorism in Dawn called 'The cult of hero-

worship and its fanatics' (298), Nietzsche says of one who idealizes another that he 'sets this person at so great a distance from himself that he can no longer see him clearly - and then he reinterprets what he still sees into the "beautiful", which is to say the symmetrical, soft-lined, indefinite.' The two men he accuses of doing this, Byron and Carlyle, are both as it happens Scotsmen, and it was another Scotsman, Thomas Campbell, who provided the formula for this kind of

perspective in the lines, "'Tis distance lends enchantment to the view, And robes the mountain in its azure hue' and thereby defined a good part of 'Romanticism'. To Nietzsche, Carlyle was a 'typical Romantic'. CATILINE, Lucius Sergius (c. 109-62 BC) Unsuccessful conspiracy against the Senate 63-2 BC: his feelings towards that body are likened to Caesar's, his

handling of that body contrasted with Caesar's. COMTE, Auguste (1798-1857) French philosopher, author of the Cours de

philosophie positive (1830-42). Comte was for Nietzsche the great 'embracer and conqueror of the pure sciences' who at the end of his life allowed his scientific strictness to evaporate into 'poetical mist and mystic lights' (Dawn 542). CORNARO, Luigi (1467-1566) After surviving a nearly fatal illness at forty, he

advocated a sparing diet as a recipe for health and long life. 'In later life he found one egg a day sufficient solid food.' (Encyclopedia Britannica). His book, *Discorsi sulla vita sobria* (1558), was a best-seller in many languages. DANTE ALIGHIERI (1265–1321) The scattered references to Dante in Nietzsche's

works are highly contradictory. DARWIN, Charles (1809–82) Confrontation with Darwin is a major motif of

Nietzsche's philosophy passim. There are four main points at issue: (i) in so far as 'Darwinism' means the theory of evolution it is 'true but deadly' because it proves that mankind is a continuation of the animals and that human life is therefore deprived of any special significance; Nietzsche's hypothesis of sublimated will to power is designed to restore a distinction between man and animal; (ii) in so far as Darwinism is the theory of evolution by natural selection brought about by a 'struggle for survival' it is, Nietzsche maintains, untrue, because it presupposes a niggardliness and state of chronic distress in nature which does not exist, the state of nature being on the contrary 'one of superfluity and prodigality, even to the point of absurdity' (*The Gay Science* 349: the unconscious influence on Darwin's theory of the condition of nineteenth-century England and of Victorian middle-class thriftiness and money-mindedness in general is now, I think, generally recognized); (iii) in as much as the effects accounted for by the hypothesis of a will to aggrandizement include those accounted for by the hypothesis of a 'will to survive' this latter hypothesis is superfluous; (iv) when a 'struggle for survival' does take place its outcome is not that implied by the theory of natural selection, that is to say it is not a higher type which emerges victorious. DEMOCRITUS (flourished c. 420 BC) Greek philosopher, the founder, with

Leucippus, of atomism. Nietzsche's attitude towards Democritus' atomism is

instructive: he approves of its materialism and of the fact that it can get along without any teleology, but he sees that it is very far from being the complete victory over Parmenides its advocates took it to be: the projection of the notion of a 'subject' from the individual on to the outside world, where it assumes the shape of a 'thing', is certainly not done away with in atomism, for the 'atom' is a 'thing'. The mechanistic idea of atoms as solid objects like billiard balls was instinctively rejected by Nietzsche: and in *Human, All Too Human* (19) he wrote: 'the whole procedure of science has been pursuing the task of resolving everything thing-like (material) into motions.' DESCARTES, René (1596–1650) In his relatively few references to Descartes,

Nietzsche is chiefly concerned to question the validity of Descartes' dictum cogito, ergo sum, mainly by way of analysing the proposition 'I think'. This has less to do with Descartes himself than with Nietzsche's general polemic against 'the foisting on of a "subject"'. DOSTOYEVSKY, Fyodor (1821-81) 'A few weeks ago I did not even know the

name of Dostoyevsky.... A chance reach in a bookshop brought to my notice a work just translated into French, *L' esprit souterrain* [Notes from Underground] ... The instinct of kinship (or what shall I call it?) spoke immediately, my joy was extraordinary: I have to go back to my becoming acquainted with Stendhal's *Rouge et Noir* to recall another such joy.' (Letter of 23 February 1887.) By 7 March he had also read *The House of the Dead* and *The Insulted and Injured*, both likewise in French translation. Whether he read all or any of the four great novels is unknown: in view of his continued enthusiasm for Dostoyevsky his failure to mention any of them in his considerable correspondence of 1887 and 1888 suggests he did not, although one is almost compelled to conclude that the employment of the word 'idiot' to describe Jesus, as well as its rather frequent employment in the works in 1888 in general, derives from a knowledge of Dostoyevsky's *The Idiot*: certainly an awareness of what Dostoyevsky means by that term helps us to understand why Nietzsche should have used it. Since he was twenty-three years younger than Dostoyevsky and produced many of his books after Dostoyevsky was dead, it is important to note how late it was before he came to read him: what suggests Dostoyevsky in Nietzsche's writings before 1887 is not the product of influence or borrowing but of a similarity in psychological acumen. ELIOT, George (Mary Ann Evans, 1819-80) Nietzsche's friend Helene Druscowicz

was a great admirer of George Eliot, wrote about her and talked to Nietzsche about her. Fräulein Druscowicz could read English (she translated Swinburne into German), Nietzsche could not, or only very haltingly, and it seems likely he

knew of George Eliot mainly from her: he clearly thought of Eliot mainly as an English free-thinker. The reference to her in *Twilight* is the only one in Nietzsche's works. EMERSON, Ralph Waldo (1803-82) Aphorism 92 of *The Gay Science*, on the

relation between poetry and prose, names the only four 'masters of prose' of the nineteenth century (Goethe being considered a product of the eighteenth): Leoparthe, Mérimée, Emerson and Landor. Whatever one may think of this judgement, and of its somewhat narrow conception of what constitutes good prose, it provides evidence of Nietzsche's extreme admiration for Emerson. The original edition of *The Gay Science* (1882) is prefaced by a quotation from

Emerson, and he admired Emerson longer and with greater consistency than he did any other contemporary writer: his holiday programme for 1862 included making extracts from all Emerson's essays (no record of whether he actually did so) and his enthusiasm is just as great in 1888. EPICURUS (341-270 BC) Greek philosopher, adopted the physics and the ethical

teaching of Democritus and made of the latter the influential moral doctrine named after him. For Nietzsche, 'the garden god' Epicurus is a mood rather than a man: aphorism 295 of *The Wanderer and his Shadow*, in which Epicurus is called 'one of the greatest human beings, the inventor of an heroic-idyllic mode of philosophizing', is a description of this mood. FONTENELLE, Bernard Le Bovier de (1657-1757) French writer. He appears here

as a representative of the group of six - the others are Montaigne, La Rochefoucauld, La Bruyère, Vauvenargues and Chamfort - of whom Nietzsche says (*The Wanderer and his Shadow* 214) that one is closer to antiquity when reading them than with any similar group of any other nation: 'Their books... contain more actual ideas than all the books of German philosophers put together.' FRIEDRICH THE SECOND (1194-1250) King of Sicily from 1198, king of

Germany from 1212, 'emperor of the West' from 1220; continually in conflict with the Papacy; although excommunicated he took part in the sixth crusade, when he negotiated with the Mohammedans instead of fighting them and gained the city of Jerusalem without bloodshed. His court in Sicily was possibly the most cultured spot in Europe, and Friedrich himself, although the 'German Christian emperor', was more of a Mohammedan than a Christian and more of an Italian than a German. The need to be continually on the defensive against the forces of the Pope produced a deterioration in his character in later years which ended in a species of persecution mania. Nietzsche's admiration for him is unqualified and it is interesting to see why: 'the first European according to my

taste' (*Beyond Good and Evil* 200) he calls him at the end of a discussion of the possibility that higher types of men are produced as a consequence of racial mixture: it is Friedrich's cosmopolitan culture which Nietzsche admires, the 'good European'. (In expressing his admiration for Friedrich the Second Nietzsche is probably also expressing his lack of admiration for the traditionally admired Friedrich the First, called Barbarossa.) GOETHE, Johann Wolfgang (1749-1832) The modern man Nietzsche admired most

and the one who provided him with a yardstick against which he measured the achievements of other men; a type of the Übermensch or 'Dionysian man'. The description of Goethe in 'Expeditions of an Untimely Man' 49 defines the Übermensch more succinctly than any other single passage in Nietzsche's works. GONCOURT, Edmond (1822-96) and Jules (1830-70) French writers of the

naturalist school. 'The second volume of the journal des Goncourts has appeared... in it are described in the most vivid way the celebrated dinners chez Magny, those dinners which brought together every fortnight the wittiest and most sceptical company of Parisian spirits of the time (Sainte-Beuve, Flaubert, Théophile Gautier, Taine, Renan, the Goncourts, Schérer, Gavarni, occasionally Turgenev, etc.). Exasperated pessimism, cynicism, nihilism, alternating with much boisterousness and good humour; I myself wouldn't be at all out of place there - I know these gentlemen inside out, so well that I have really had enough of them already. One has to be more radical: fundamentally they all lack the main thing - "la force".' (Letter of 10 November 1887). HARTMANN, Eduard von (1842-1906) German philosopher, author of Philosophy

of the Unconscious. Often referred to by Nietzsche, always with contempt. HEGEL, Georg Wilhelm Friedrich (1770-1831) Nietzsche's relation to Hegel is

complex and cannot be satisfactorily described in a note. Two things can be noted, however: (i) Nietzsche's basic attitude towards Hegel was that his philosophy was the conceptual basis of modern 'evolutionism' and thus encouraged a habit of mind which ought to be deprecated; (ii) Nietzsche clearly did not study Hegel very profoundly and was in many ways closer to him than he suspected, although he acknowledged that 'we Germans would be Hegelians even if Hegel had never existed, in as much as we instinctively accord a profounder significance and a greater value to becoming and evolution than we do to that which "is"....' (The Gay Science 357.) HEINE, Heinrich (1797-1856) German-Jewish poet and writer. 'The highest

conception of the lyric poet was given me by Heinrich Heine. I seek in vain in all the realms of the millennia for an equally sweet arid passionate music. He

possessed that divine malice without which I cannot conceive the perfect. - I estimate the value of human beings, of races, according to how necessarily they do not know how to understand the god apart from the satyr. - And how he handles German! It will one day be said that Heine and I have been by far the greatest artists of the German language...' (Ecce Homo II 4.) HERACLITUS (c. 500 BC) Greek philosopher. Because of his dynamic view of

nature much admired by Nietzsche. In his pride and isolation, and the sibylline character of his utterances, he is the ultimate model for Zarathustra. HORACE (Quintus Horatius Flaccus, 65–8 BC) Often quoted by Nietzsche,

although sometimes the quotations are only familiar tags, e.g. *aereperennius*. HUGO, Victor (1802–85) ‘Victor Hugo and Richard Wagner – they signify one and

the same thing: that in declining cultures, that wherever the decision comes to rest with the masses, genuineness becomes superfluous, disadvantageous, an encumbrance. Only the actor still arouses great enthusiasm.’ (The Wagner Case II.) KANT, Emmanuel (1724–1804) There are scores of references to Kant in

Nietzsche’s works, and the greater part of them are hostile. What Nietzsche held against Kant can, however, be stated in a single sentence: that Kant believed in and sought to demonstrate the existence of a ‘moral world-order’. LEIBNIZ, Gottfried Wilhelm (1646–1716) Nietzsche credits Leibniz with and

praises him for the discovery that ‘what we call consciousness constitutes only a condition of our spiritual and psychical world (perhaps a morbid condition) and is very far from constituting this world itself’ (The Gay Science 357): the connexion with Nietzsche’s speculations will be clear. Otherwise he has little interest in Leibniz. LISZT, Franz (1811–86), ‘who excels all other musicians in the nobility of his

orchestral tone’ (Ecce Homo II 7) – but because he was Wagner’s father-in-law Nietzsche cannot resist making jokes about him. Liszt was, of course, very much an ‘actor’ in Nietzsche’s sense of the word. LOBECK, Christian August (1781–1860) German philologist and antiquary; a

specialist in the history of the Greek language. He wrote many scholarly works. LUTHER, Martin (1483–1546) The long polemic in The Anti-Christ against ‘faith’

as the distinguishing characteristic of the Christian expresses what lies behind Nietzsche’s long-standing enmity towards Luther: emphasis on ‘faith’ is merely a confession of incapacity for ‘works’. Nietzsche also continually emphasizes Luther’s coarseness and his enmity towards reason.

MACHIAVELLI, Niccolò (1469–1527) Admired by Nietzsche for his ‘realism’; but

Nietzsche refers to him very infrequently and there seems no good reason for linking their names as is sometimes done. MALTHUS, Thomas Robert (1766–1834) 'Population, when unchecked, increases

in a geometrical ratio. Subsistence only increases in an arithmetical ratio... the power of population is indefinitely greater than the power in the earth to produce subsistence for man.' (Essay on the Principle of Population [1798].) MICHELET, Jules (1798–1874) Historian of France and of the Revolution.

Nietzsche links him with Schiller and Carlyle as an idealizing historian. (Will to Power 343.) MILL, John Stuart (1806–74) Very few references to Mill in Nietzsche's works, but

many hostile ones to 'utilitarianism', which was especially Mill's ethical theory. NAPOLEON BONAPARTE (1769–1821) Not, despite occasional suggestions to the

contrary, a type of the Übermensch, but a 'synthesis of Unmensch [monster] and Übermensch' (Genealogy of Morals I 16) – that is to say, a 'problem'. Nietzsche worries this problem of Napoleon from the beginning of his life till the end, but arrives at no definite conclusion. Many of his statements about Napoleon are neutral as regards 'admiration' or 'dislike': they seek to describe. He shows no interest in his military campaigns and his assessment of him does not involve consideration of his generalship. PASCAL, Blaise (1623–62) French mathematician and philosopher. At the age of

sixteen he wrote a treatise on conic sections and at eighteen invented a computer; later he invented, among other things, the calculus of probability and the hydraulic press. On the night of 23 November 1654 he suffered a mystical 'conversion' to religious belief and from then on frequented Port-Royal and devoted himself largely to religious controversy and to introspective philosophizing and meditation (his celebrated *Pensées*). Nietzsche mentions Pascal dozens of times, and always with reference to this religious conversion and its consequences: he is 'the most instructive of all sacrifices to Christianity'. (Ecce Homo II 3.) PETRONIUS, Caius (suicide AD 65) Author of the *Satyricon*, a satire in prose and

verse on the social life of first century Rome. PLATO (428–347 BC) 'Plato against Homer: that is the whole, the genuine

antagonism' (Genealogy of Morals III 25): the former as a slanderer of life, the latter as its glorifier. Nietzsche's attitude becomes comprehensible in the light of his own 'materialism', for in that light Plato becomes a falsifier of reality.

Nietzsche considered Plato's theory of suprasensible forms, his ethical preoccupation and his other-worldly tendency in general as harmful to a healthy appreciation of the present world and as specific errors springing from a false relationship with the actual world: Plato is one of those who need to 'lie themselves out of reality'. RENAN, Ernest (1823-92) French rationalist writer: the type of free-thinker who

has not really freed himself from religion. ROUSSEAU, Jean-Jacques (1712-78) In his essay Schopenhauer as an Educator

(the third of the Untimely Meditations, 1874), Nietzsche offers a comparison between Rousseau and Goethe, the former representing the revolutionary man and the latter the contemplative, and in 'Expeditions of an Untimely Man' 48 and 49 he contrasts them again. Goethe is now, of course, much more than the contemplative man: he is, in fact, the superman, the embodiment of sublimated will to power; and Rousseau too has undergone a change, this time for the worse: from the revolutionary he has declined to the rabble, and is in fact the representative of unsublimated will to power. Nietzsche's long polemic against Rousseau - there are dozens of references to him - can best be understood in the light of this symbolism: Rousseau's 'back to nature' means back to the animals, back to passion uncontrolled. SAINT-SIMON, Claude-Henri, Comte de (1760-1825) Inventor of an economic

theory involving common ownership of property and distribution of goods: the Saint-Simonians acquired rather quickly some of the characteristics of religious fanaticism. SAINTE-BEUVE, Charles-Augustin (1804-69) Very influential literary critic and

historian. Nietzsche criticizes, here and elsewhere, his celebrated 'objectivity'. SALLUST (86-c.35 BC) Latin historian; chronicled the Catiline conspiracy. He

modelled his style on that of Thucydides. SAND, George (Aurore Dupin, Baroness Dudevant, 1804-76) Novelist and writer.

'It betrays corruption of the instincts - quite apart from the fact that it betrays bad taste - when a woman appeals precisely to Madame Roland or Madame de Staël or Monsieur George Sand as if something in favour of "woman as such" were thereby demonstrated. Among men the above-named are the three comic women as such - nothing more! - and precisely the best involuntary counter-arguments against emancipation and female autocracy.' (Beyond Good and Evil 233.) SCHILLER, Friedrich (1759-1805) As a youth Nietzsche was a Schiller enthusiast;

he lost his enthusiasm as he grew older. From that he concluded that Schiller was essentially something for young people (this opinion is expressed several times in

his works). Ultimately he considered Schiller superficial and Romantic. SCHOPENHAUER, Arthur (1788-1860) His World as Will and Idea (1818) was a

major influence on the young Nietzsche, who for many years considered himself a 'Schopenhauerian': but Schopenhauer's pessimism, his duality of will and intellect, his metaphysical preoccupation and his hostility towards the emotions, particularly sexuality, were none of them finally acceptable and Nietzsche's mature philosophy is not indebted to Schopenhauer in any way. His youthful discipleship is, however, the reason for the frequency with which the older Nietzsche makes polemical points against Schopenhauer. SOCRATES (470-399 BC) 'Socrates... stands so close to me that I am almost

always fighting with him', Nietzsche confessed in the notes for an uncompleted essay of 1875 (Wissenschaft und Weisheit in Kampf) and the fight went on until the end. Socrates is the type of 'the philosopher' and in investigating the mind and heart of Socrates Nietzsche is investigating his own: with none of the figures he discusses is the tremendous inner dialectic of Nietzsche's lifelong monologue so clearly displayed as it is in the passages dealing with Socrates (of which there are hundreds). The 'problem' of Socrates is the problem of reason, of the status of reason in the life of man: and Nietzsche finds that problem inexhaustible. SPENCER, Herbert (1820-1903) Philosopher of evolution. Nietzsche never refers to

him without disdain. SPINOZA, Baruch (1632-77) On five main points, Nietzsche says in a letter of 30

July 1881, he finds that he and Spinoza are in agreement: on denying free will, purpose, the moral world-order, the unegoistic and the existence of evil. But he deprecates 'that hocus-pocus of mathematical form with which Spinoza encased his philosophy as if in brass'. (Beyond Good and Evil 5.) STENDHAL (Henri Beyle, 1783-1842) Greatly admired by Nietzsche for his

psychological insight and as an 'honest atheist... Perhaps I am even envious of Stendhal? He has robbed me of the best atheist joke, which precisely I could have made: "God's only excuse is that he does not exist."' (Ecce Homo II 3.) STRAUSS, David (1808-74) His Life of Jesus and The Old Faith and the New were

very popular expositions of the rationalist approach to religion. The first of Nietzsche's *Untimely Meditations* – David Strauss, the Confessor and the Writer (1873) – was a violent attack on him. THUCYDIDES (c. 460–c. 395 BC) Greek historian, author of the *History of the*

Peloponnesian War. TOLSTOY, Leo (1828–1910) *Décadent* because of his emphasis on 'pity'.

(*Genealogy of Morals* III 26, *Will to Power* 1020.) That 'resist not evil' is the key to the Gospel may have been suggested to Nietzsche by Tolstoy (see Tolstoy's *My Religion*, chapter I), but the conclusions he draws from this have nothing to do with Tolstoy. WAGNER, Richard (1813–83) As a youth Nietzsche was deeply under Wagner's

influence; around 1876 he broke away, but the figure of Wagner continued to haunt him and there is an unceasing dialogue between the two in Nietzsche's works almost *passim*. In the mature Nietzsche, Wagner is the type of 'the artist'. He plays a relatively minor role in *Twilight* because an entire book *The Wagner Case*, had just been devoted to him; but later in the year 1888 he comes to the forefront again in Nietzsche *contra* Wagner. WINCKELMANN, Johann Joachim (1717–68) Archaeologist and historian of art

whose conception of ancient Greece became the accepted one for the German world throughout the eighteenth century. Goethe's view of the ancient world derived from Winckelmann, whose writings he studied and whom he celebrated in *Winckelmann and his Century* (1805). ZOLA, Emile (1840–1902) 'There is no such thing as pessimistic art.... Art affirms,

Job affirms. – But Zola? But the Goncourts? – The things they exhibit are ugly: but that they exhibit them comes from pleasure in this ugliness....' (*Will to Power* 821.)

CHRONOLOGY 15 October. Friedrich Wilhelm Nietzsche born in the parsonage at Röcken, near Lützen, Germany, the first of three children of Karl

IV.2 — Twilight of the Idols: What I Owe to the Ancients

§1-5

TWILIGHT OF THE IDOLS, "WHAT I OWE TO THE ANCIENTS" §1-5

(Translated by R.J. Hollingdale)

§1

In every age the wisest have passed the identical judgement on life: it is worthless. ... Everywhere and always their mouths have uttered the same sound – a sound full of doubt, full of melancholy, full of weariness with life, full of opposition to life. Even Socrates said as he died: ‘To live – that means to be a long time sick: I owe a cock to the saviour Asclepius’.* Even Socrates had had enough of it. – What does that prove? What does it point to? – Formerly one would have said (– oh, and did say, and loudly enough, and our pessimists† most of all!): ‘Here at any rate there must be something true! The consensus sapientium ‡ is proof of truth.’ – Shall we still speak thus today? are we allowed to do so? ‘Here at any rate there must be something sick’ – this is our retort: one ought to take a closer look at them, these wisest of every age! Were they all of them perhaps no longer steady on their legs? belated? tottery? *décadents*? Does wisdom perhaps appear on earth as a raven which is inspired by the smell of carrion?...

§2

This irreverent notion that the great sages are declining types first dawned on me in regard to just the case in which learned and unlearned prejudice is most strongly opposed to it: I recognized Socrates and Plato as symptoms of decay, as agents of the dissolution of Greece, as pseudo-Greek, as anti-Greek (*Birth of Tragedy*, 1872)*. That consensus sapientium – I saw more and more clearly – proves least of all that they were right about what they were in accord over: it proves rather that they themselves, these wisest men, were in some way in physiological accord since they stood – had to stand – in the same negative relation to life. Judgements, value judgements concerning life, for or against, can in the last resort never be true: they possess value only as symptoms, they come into consideration only as symptoms – in themselves such judgements are stupidities. One must reach out and try to grasp this astonishing finesse, that the value of life cannot be estimated. Not by a living man, because he is a party to the dispute, indeed its object, and not the judge of it; not by a dead one, for another reason. – For a philosopher to see a problem in the value of life thus even constitutes an objection to him, a question-mark as to his wisdom, a piece of unwisdom. – What? and all these great wise men – they have not only been *décadents*, they have not even been wise? – But I shall get back to the problem of Socrates.

§3

Socrates belonged, in his origins, to the lowest orders: Socrates was rabble. One knows, one sees for oneself, how ugly he was. But ugliness, an objection in itself, is among Greeks almost a refutation. Was Socrates a Greek at all?

Ugliness is frequently enough the sign of a thwarted development, a development retarded by interbreeding. Otherwise it appears as a development in decline. Anthropologists among criminologists tell us the typical criminal is ugly: *monstrum in fronte, monstrum in animo*.† But the criminal is a *décadent*. Was Socrates a typical criminal? – At least that famous physiognomist's opinion which Socrates' friends found so objectionable would not contradict this idea. A foreigner passing through Athens who knew how to read faces told Socrates to his face that he was a *monstrum* – that he contained within him every kind of foul vice and lust. And Socrates answered merely: 'You know me, sir!' –

§4

It is not only the admitted dissoluteness and anarchy of his instincts which indicate *décadence* in Socrates: the superfetation of the logical and that barbed malice which distinguishes him also point in that direction. And let us not forget those auditory hallucinations which, as 'Socrates' demon', have been interpreted in a religious sense. Everything about him is exaggerated, *buffo*, caricature, everything is at the same time hidden, reserved, subterranean. – I seek to understand out of what idiosyncrasy that Socratic equation *reason = virtue = happiness* derives: that bizzarrest of equations and one which has in particular all the instincts of the older Hellenes against it.

§5

With Socrates Greek taste undergoes a change in favour of dialectics: what is really happening when that happens? It is above all the defeat of a nobler taste; with dialectics the rabble gets on top. Before Socrates, the dialectical manner was repudiated in good society: it was regarded as a form of bad manners, one was compromised by it. Young people were warned against it. And all such presentation of one's reasons was regarded with mistrust. Honest things, like honest men, do not carry their reasons exposed in this fashion. It is indecent to display all one's goods. What has first to have itself proved is of little value. Wherever authority is still part of accepted usage and one does not 'give reasons' but commands, the dialectician is a kind of *buffoon*: he is laughed at, he is not taken seriously. – Socrates was the *buffoon* who got himself taken seriously: what was really happening when that happened?

§1

You ask me about the idiosyncrasies of philosophers?... There is their lack of historical sense, their hatred of even the idea of becoming, their Egyptianism. They think they are doing a thing honour when they dehistoricize it, *sub specie*

aeterni* – when they make a mummy of it. All that philosophers have handled for millennia has been conceptual mummies; nothing actual has escaped from their hands alive. They kill, they stuff, when they worship, these conceptual idolaters – they become a mortal danger to everything when they worship. Death, change, age, as well as procreation and growth, are for them objections – refutations even. What is, does not become; what becomes, is not.... Now they all believe, even to the point of despair, in that which is. But since they cannot get hold of it, they look for reasons why it is being withheld from them. 'It must be an illusion, a deception which prevents us from perceiving that which is: where is the deceiver to be found?' – 'We've got it,' they cry in delight, 'it is the senses! These senses, which are so immoral as well, it is they which deceive us about the real world. Moral: escape from sense-deception, from becoming, from history, from falsehood – history is nothing but belief in the senses, belief in falsehood. Moral: denial of all that believes in the senses, of all the rest of mankind: all of that is mere "people". Be a philosopher, be a mummy, represent monotonism by a gravedigger-mimicry! – And away, above all, with the body, that pitiable *idée fixe* of the senses! infected with every error of logic there is, refuted, impossible even, notwithstanding it is impudent enough to behave as if it actually existed!'...

§2

I set apart with high reverence the name of Heraclitus. When the rest of the philosopher crowd rejected the evidence of the senses because these showed plurality and change, he rejected their evidence because they showed things as if they possessed duration and unity. Heraclitus too was unjust to the senses, which lie neither in the way the Eleatics* believe nor as he believed – they do not lie at all. It is what we make of their evidence that first introduces a lie into it, for example the lie of unity, the lie of materiality, of substance, of duration.... 'Reason' is the cause of our falsification of the evidence of the senses. In so far as the senses show becoming, passing away, change, they do not lie.... But Heraclitus will always be right in this, that being is an empty fiction. The 'apparent' world is the only one: the 'real' world has only been lyingly added...

§3

– And what subtle instruments for observation we possess in our senses! This nose, for example, of which no philosopher has hitherto spoken with respect and gratitude, is none the less the most delicate tool we have at our command: it can detect minimal differences in movement which even the spectroscope cannot detect. We possess scientific knowledge today to precisely the extent that we have decided to accept the evidence of the senses – to the extent that

we have learned to sharpen and arm them and to think them through to their conclusions. The rest is abortion and not-yet-science: which is to say metaphysics, theology, psychology, epistemology. Or science of formulae, sign-systems: such as logic and that applied logic, mathematics. In these reality does not appear at all, not even as a problem; just as little as does the question what value a system of conventional signs such as constitutes logic can possibly possess.

§4

The other idiosyncrasy of philosophers is no less perilous: it consists in mistaking the last for the first. They put that which comes at the end – unfortunately! for it ought not to come at all! – the ‘highest concepts’, that is to say the most general, the emptiest concepts, the last fumes of evaporating reality, at the beginning as the beginning. It is again only the expression of their way of doing reverence: the higher must not be allowed to grow out of the lower, must not be allowed to have grown at all.... Moral: everything of the first rank must be *causa sui*. * Origin in something else counts as an objection, as casting a doubt on value. All supreme values are of the first rank, all the supreme concepts – that which is, the unconditioned, the good, the true, the perfect – all that cannot have become, must therefore be *causa sui*. But neither can these supreme concepts be incommensurate with one another, be incompatible with one another.... Thus they acquired their stupendous concept ‘God’.... The last, thinnest, emptiest is placed as the first, as cause in itself, as *ens realissimum*.†...That mankind should have taken seriously the brain-sick fancies of morbid cobweb-spinners! – And it has paid dearly for doing so!...

§5

– Let us, in conclusion, set against this the very different way in which we (– I say ‘we’ out of politeness...) view the problem of error and appearance. Change, mutation, becoming in general were formerly taken as proof of appearance, as a sign of the presence of something which led us astray. Today, on the contrary, we see ourselves as it were entangled in error, necessitated to error, to precisely the

extent that our prejudice in favour of reason compels us to posit unity, identity, duration, substance, cause, materiality, being; however sure we may be, on the basis of a strict reckoning, that error is to be found here. The situation is the same as with the motions of the sun: in that case error has our eyes, in the present case our language as a perpetual advocate. Language belongs in its origin to the age of the most rudimentary form of psychology: we find ourselves

in the midst of a rude fetishism when we call to mind the basic presuppositions of the metaphysics of language – which is to say, of reason. It is this which sees everywhere deed and doer; this which believes in will as cause in general; this which believes in the ‘ego’, in the ego as being, in the ego as substance, and which projects its belief in the ego-substance on to all things – only thus does it create the concept ‘thing’.... Being is everywhere thought in, foisted on, as cause; it is only from the conception ‘ego’ that there follows, derivatively, the concept ‘being’.... At the beginning stands the great fateful error that the will is something which produces an effect – that will is a faculty.... Today we know it is merely a word.... Very much later, in a world a thousand times more enlightened, the security, the subjective certainty with which the categories of reason* could be employed came all of a sudden into philosophers’ heads: they concluded that these could not have originated in the empirical world – indeed, the entire empirical world was incompatible with them. Where then do they originate? – And in India as in Greece they committed the same blunder: ‘We must once have dwelt in a higher world’ – instead of in a very much lower one, which would have been the truth! – ‘we must have been divine, for we possess reason!’... Nothing, in fact, has hitherto had a more direct power of persuasion than the error of being as it was formulated by, for example, the Eleatics: for every word, every sentence we utter speaks in its favour! – Even the opponents of the Eleatics were still subject to the seductive influence of their concept of being: Democritus, among others, when he invented his atom.... ‘Reason’ in language: oh what a deceitful old woman! I fear we are not getting rid of God because we still believe in grammar...

§1

There is a time with all passions when they are merely fatalities, when they drag their victim down with the weight of their folly – and a later, very much later time when they are wedded with the spirit, when they are ‘spiritualized’. Formerly one made war on passion itself on account of the folly inherent in it: one conspired for its extermination – all the old moral monsters are unanimous that ‘il faut tuer les passions’.* The most famous formula for doing this is contained in the New Testament, in the Sermon on the Mount, where, by the way, things are not at all regarded from a lofty standpoint. There, for example, it is said, with reference to sexuality, ‘if thy eye offend thee, pluck it out’: fortunately no Christian follows this prescription. To exterminate the passions and desires merely in order to do away with their folly and its unpleasant consequences – this itself seems to us today merely an acute form of folly. We no longer admire dentists who pull out the teeth to stop them hurting.... On the other hand, it is only fair to admit that on the soil out of which Christianity

grew the concept 'spiritualization of passion' could not possibly be conceived. For the primitive Church, as is well known, fought against the 'intelligent' in favour of the 'poor in spirit': how could one expect from it an intelligent war against passion? – The Church combats the passions with excision in every sense of the word: its practice, its 'cure' is castration. It never asks: 'How can one spiritualize, beautify, deify a desire?' – it has at all times laid the emphasis of its discipline on extirpation (of sensuality, of pride, of lust for power, of avarice, of revengefulness). – But to attack the passions at their roots means to attack life at its roots: the practice of the Church is hostile to life...

§2

The same expedient – castration, extirpation – is instinctively selected in a struggle against a desire by those who are too weak-willed, too degenerate to impose moderation upon it: by those natures which need La Trappe,* to speak metaphorically (and not metaphorically –), some sort of definitive declaration of hostility, a chasm between themselves and a passion. It is only the degenerate who cannot do without radical expedients; weakness of will, more precisely the inability not to react to a stimulus, is itself merely another form of degeneration. Radical hostility, mortal hostility towards sensuality is always a thought-provoking symptom: it justifies making certain conjectures as to the general condition of one who is excessive in this respect. – That hostility, that hatred reaches its height, moreover, only when such natures are no longer sufficiently sound even for the

radical cure, for the renunciation of their 'devil'. Survey the entire history of priests and philosophers, and that of artists as well: the most virulent utterances against the senses have not come from the impotent, nor from ascetics, but from those who found it impossible to be ascetics, from those who stood in need of being ascetics...

§3

The spiritualization of sensuality is called love: it is a great triumph over Christianity. A further triumph is our spiritualization of enmity. It consists in profoundly grasping the value of having enemies: in brief, in acting and thinking in the reverse of the way in which one formerly acted and thought. The Church has at all times desired the destruction of its enemies: we, we immoralists and antiChristians, see that it is to our advantage that the Church exist.... In politics, too, enmity has become much more spiritual – much more prudent, much more thoughtful, much more forbearing. Almost every party grasps that it is in the interest of its own self-preservation that the opposing

party should not decay in strength; the same is true of grand politics. A new creation in particular, the new Reich for instance, has more need of enemies than friends: only in opposition does it feel itself necessary, only in opposition does it become necessary.... We adopt the same attitude towards the 'enemy within': there too we have spiritualized enmity, there too we have grasped its value. One is fruitful only at the cost of being rich in contradictions; one remains young only on condition the soul does not relax, does not long for peace.... Nothing has grown more alien to us than that desideratum of former times 'peace of soul', the Christian desideratum; nothing arouses less envy in us than the moral cow and the fat contentment of the good conscience.... One has renounced grand life when one renounces war.... In many cases, to be sure, 'peace of soul' is merely a misunderstanding - something else that simply does not know how to give itself a more honest name. Here, briefly and without prejudice, are a few of them. 'Peace of soul' can, for example, be the gentle radiation of a rich animality into the moral (or religious) domain. Or the beginning of weariness, the first of the shadows which evening, every sort of evening, casts. Or a sign that the air is damp, that south winds are on the way. Or unconscious gratitude for a good digestion (sometimes called 'philanthropy'). Or the quiescence of the convalescent for whom all things have a new taste and who waits.... Or the condition which succeeds a vigorous gratification of our ruling passion, the pleasant feeling of a rare satiety. Or the decrepitude of our will, our desires, our vices. Or laziness persuaded by vanity to deck itself out as morality. Or the appearance of a certainty, even a dreadful certainty, after the protracted tension and torture of uncertainty. Or the expression of ripeness and mastery in the midst of action, creation, endeavour, volition, a quiet breathing, 'freedom of will' attained.... Twilight of the Idols: who

knows? perhaps that too is only a kind of 'peace of soul'...

§4

- I formulate a principle. All naturalism in morality, that is all healthy morality, is dominated by an instinct of life - some commandment of life is fulfilled through a certain canon of 'shall' and 'shall not', some hindrance and hostile element on life's road is thereby removed. Anti-natural morality, that is virtually every morality that has hitherto been taught, revered and preached, turns on the contrary precisely against the instincts of life - it is a now secret, now loud and impudent condemnation of these instincts. By saying 'God sees into the heart' it denies the deepest and the highest desires of life and takes God for

the enemy of life.... The saint in whom God takes pleasure is the ideal castrate.... Life is at an end where the 'kingdom of God' begins...

§5

If one has grasped the blasphemousness of such a rebellion against life as has, in Christian morality, become virtually sacrosanct, one has fortunately therewith grasped something else as well: the uselessness, illusoriness, absurdity, falsity of such a rebellion. For a condemnation of life by the living is after all no more than the symptom of a certain kind of life: the question whether the condemnation is just or unjust has not been raised at all. One would have to be situated outside life, and on the other hand to know it as thoroughly as any, as many, as all who have experienced it, to be permitted to touch on the problem of the value of life at all: sufficient reason for understanding that this problem is for us an inaccessible problem. When we speak of values we do so under the inspiration and from the perspective of life: life itself evaluates through us when we establish values.... From this it follows that even that anti-nature of a morality which conceives God as the contrary concept to and condemnation of life is only a value judgement on the part of life – of what life? of what kind of life? – But I have already given the answer: of declining, debilitated, weary, condemned life. Morality as it has been understood hitherto – as it was ultimately formulated by Schopenhauer as 'denial of the will to life' – is the instinct of *décadence* itself, which makes out of itself an imperative: it says: 'Perish!' – it is the judgement of the judged...

§1

The error of confusing cause and consequence. – There is no more dangerous error than that of mistaking the consequence for the cause: I call it reason's intrinsic form of corruption. None the less, this error is among the most ancient and most recent habits of mankind: it is even sanctified among us, it bears the names 'religion' and 'morality'. Every proposition formulated by religion and morality contains it; priests and moral legislators are the authors of this corruption of reason. – I adduce an example. Everyone knows the book of the celebrated Cornaro in which he recommends his meagre diet as a recipe for a long and happy life – a virtuous one, too. Few books have been so widely read; even now many thousands of copies are printed in England every year. I do not doubt that hardly any book (the Bible rightly excepted) has done so much harm, has shortened so many lives, as this curiosity, which was so well meant. The reason: mistaking the consequence for the cause. The worthy Italian saw in his diet the cause of his long life: while the prerequisite of long life, an extraordinarily slow metabolism, a small consumption, was the cause of his

meagre diet. He was not free to eat much or little as he chose, his frugality was not an act of 'free will': he became ill when he ate more. But if one is not a bony fellow of this sort one does not merely do well, one positively needs to eat properly. A scholar of our day, with his rapid consumption of nervous energy, would kill himself with Cornaro's regimen. Credo experto. -

§2

The most general formula at the basis of every religion and morality is: 'Do this and this, refrain from this and this - and you will be happy! Otherwise....' Every morality, every religion is this imperative - I call it the great original sin of reason, immortal unreason. In my mouth this formula is converted into its reverse - first example of my 'revaluation of all values': a well-constituted human being, a 'happy one', must perform certain actions and instinctively shrinks from other actions, he transports the order of which he is the physiological representative into his relations with other human beings and with things. In a formula: his virtue is the consequence of his happiness.... Long life, a plentiful posterity is not the reward of virtue, virtue itself is rather just that slowing down of the metabolism which also has, among other things, a long life, a plentiful posterity, in short Cornarism, as its outcome. - The Church and morality say: 'A race, a people perishes through vice and luxury'. My restored reason says: when a people is perishing, degenerating physiologically, vice and luxury (that is to say the necessity for stronger and

stronger and more and more frequent stimulants, such as every exhausted nature is acquainted with) follow therefrom. A young man grows prematurely pale and faded. His friends say: this and that illness is to blame. I say: that he became ill, that he failed to resist the illness, was already the consequence of an impoverished life, an hereditary exhaustion. The newspaper reader says: this party will ruin itself if it makes errors like this. My higher politics says: a party which makes errors like this is already finished - it is no longer secure in its instincts. Every error, of whatever kind, is a consequence of degeneration of instinct, disgregation of will: one has thereby virtually defined the bad. Everything good is instinct - and consequently easy, necessary, free. Effort is an objection, the god is typically distinguished from the hero (in my language: light feet are the first attribute of divinity).

§3

The error of a false causality. - We have always believed we know what a cause is: but whence did we derive our knowledge, more precisely our belief we possessed this knowledge? From the realm of the celebrated 'inner facts', none

of which has up till now been shown to be factual. We believed ourselves to be causal agents in the act of willing; we at least thought we were there catching causality in the act. It was likewise never doubted that all the antecedentia of an action, its causes, were to be sought in the consciousness and could be discovered there if one sought them – as ‘motives’: for otherwise one would not have been free to perform it, responsible for it. Finally, who would have disputed that a thought is caused? that the ego causes the thought?... Of these three ‘inner facts’ through which causality seemed to be guaranteed the first and most convincing was that of will as cause; the conception of a consciousness (‘mind’) as cause and later still that of the ego (the ‘subject’) as cause are merely after-products after causality had, on the basis of will, been firmly established as a given fact, as empiricism.... Meanwhile, we have thought better. Today we do not believe a word of it. The ‘inner world’ is full of phantoms and false lights: the will is one of them. The will no longer moves anything, consequently no longer explains anything – it merely accompanies events, it can also be absent. The so-called ‘motive’: another error. Merely a surface phenomenon of consciousness, an accompaniment to an act, which conceals rather than exposes the antecedentia of the act. And as for the ego! It has become a fable, a fiction, a play on words: it has totally ceased to think, to feel and to will!... What follows from this? There are no spiritual causes at all! The whole of the alleged empiricism which affirmed them has gone to the devil! That is what follows! – And we had made a nice misuse of that ‘empiricism’, we had created the world on the basis of it as a world of causes, as a world of will, as a world of spirit. The oldest and longest-lived psychology was at work here – indeed it has done nothing else:

every event was to it an action, every action the effect of a will, the world became for it a multiplicity of agents, an agent (‘subject’) foisted itself upon every event. Man projected his three ‘inner facts’, that in which he believed more firmly than in anything else, will, spirit, ego, outside himself – he derived the concept ‘being’ only from the concept ‘ego’, he posited ‘things’ as possessing being according to his own image, according to his concept of the ego as cause. No wonder he later always discovered in things only that which he had put into them! –The thing itself, to say it again, the concept ‘thing’ is merely a reflection of the belief in the ego as cause. ... And even your atom, messieurs mechanists and physicists, how much error, how much rudimentary psychology, still remains in your atom! – To say nothing of the ‘thing in itself’,* that horrendum pudendum† of the metaphysicians! The error of spirit as cause mistaken for reality! And made the measure of reality! And called God! –

The error of imaginary causes. – To start from the dream: on to a certain sensation, the result for example of a distant cannon-shot, a cause is subsequently foisted (often a whole little novel in which precisely the dreamer is the chief character). The sensation, meanwhile, continues to persist, as a kind of resonance: it waits, as it were, until the cause-creating drive permits it to step into the foreground – now no longer as a chance occurrence but as ‘meaning’. The cannon-shot enters in a causal way, in an apparent inversion of time. That which comes later, the motivation, is experienced first, often with a hundred details which pass like lightning, the shot follows.... What has happened? The ideas engendered by a certain condition have been misunderstood as the cause of that condition. – We do just the same thing, in fact, when we are awake. Most of our general feelings – every sort of restraint, pressure, tension, explosion in the play and counter-play of our organs, likewise and especially the condition of the nervus sympathicus – excite our cause-creating drive: we want to have a reason for feeling as we do – for feeling well or for feeling ill. It never suffices us simply to establish the mere fact that we feel as we do: we acknowledge this fact – become conscious of it – only when we have furnished it with a motivation of some kind. – The memory, which in such a case becomes active without our being aware of it, calls up earlier states of a similar kind and the causal interpretations which have grown out of them – not their causality. To be sure, the belief that these ideas, the accompanying occurrences in the consciousness, were causes is also brought up by the memory. Thus there arises an habituation to a certain causal interpretation which in truth obstructs and even prohibits an investigation of the cause.

§5

Psychological explanation. – To trace something unknown back to something known is alleviating, soothing, gratifying and gives moreover a feeling of power. Danger, disquiet, anxiety attend the unknown – the first instinct is to eliminate these distressing states. First principle: any explanation is better than none. Because it is at bottom only a question of wanting to get rid of oppressive ideas, one is not exactly particular about what means one uses to get rid of them: the first idea which explains that the unknown is in fact the known does so much good that one ‘holds it for true’. Proof by pleasure (‘by potency’) as criterion of truth. – The cause-creating drive is thus conditioned and excited by the feeling of fear. The question ‘why?’ should furnish, if at all possible, not so much the cause for its own sake as a certain kind of cause – a soothing, liberating, alleviating cause. That something already known, experienced, inscribed in the memory is posited as cause is the first consequence of this need. The new, the unexperienced, the strange is excluded

from being cause. – Thus there is sought not only some kind of explanation as cause, but a selected and preferred kind of explanation, the kind by means of which the feeling of the strange, new, unexperienced is most speedily and most frequently abolished – the most common explanations. – Consequence: a particular kind of cause-ascription comes to preponderate more and more, becomes concentrated into a system and finally comes to dominate over the rest, that is to say simply to exclude other causes and explanations. – The banker thinks at once of ‘business’, the Christian of ‘sin’, the girl of her love.

§1

One knows my demand of philosophers that they place themselves beyond good and evil – that they have the illusion of moral judgement beneath them. This demand follows from an insight first formulated by me: that there are no moral facts whatever. Moral judgement has this in common with religious judgement that it believes in realities which do not exist. Morality is only an interpretation of certain phenomena, more precisely a misinterpretation. Moral judgement belongs, as does religious judgement, to a level of ignorance at which even the concept of the real, the distinction between the real and the imaginary, is lacking: so that at such a level ‘truth’ denotes nothing but things which we today call ‘imaginings’. To this extent moral judgement is never to be taken literally: as such it never contains anything but nonsense. But as semeiotics it remains of incalculable value: it reveals, to the informed man at least, the most precious realities of cultures and inner worlds which did not know enough to ‘understand’ themselves. Morality is merely signlanguage, merely symptomatology: one must already know what it is about to derive profit from it.

§2

A first example, merely as an introduction. In all ages one has wanted to ‘improve’ men: this above all is what morality has meant. But one word can conceal the most divergent tendencies. Both the taming of the beast man and the breeding of a certain species of man has been called ‘improvement’: only these zoological termini express realities – realities, to be sure, of which the typical ‘improver’, the priest, knows nothing – wants to know nothing.... To call the taming of an animal its ‘improvement’ is in our ears almost a joke. Whoever knows what goes on in menageries is doubtful whether the beasts in them are ‘improved’. They are weakened, they are made less harmful, they become sickly beasts through the depressive emotion of fear, through pain, through injuries, through hunger. – It is no different with the tamed human being whom the priest has ‘improved’. In the early Middle Ages, when the Church was in

fact above all a menagerie, one everywhere hunted down the fairest specimens of the 'blond beast'* - one 'improved', for example, the noble Teutons. But what did such a Teuton afterwards look like when he had been 'improved' and led into a monastery? Like a caricature of a human being, like an abortion: he had become a 'sinner', he was in a cage, one had imprisoned him behind nothing but sheer terrifying concepts.... There he lay now, sick, miserable, filled with ill-will towards himself; full of hatred for the

impulses towards life, full of suspicion of all that was still strong and happy. In short, a 'Christian'.... In physiological terms: in the struggle with the beast, making it sick can be the only means of making it weak. This the Church understood: it corrupted the human being, it weakened him - but it claimed to have 'improved' him...

§3

Let us take the other aspect of so-called morality, the breeding of a definite race and species. The most grandiose example of this is provided by Indian morality, sanctioned, as the 'Law of Manu', into religion. Here the proposed task is to breed no fewer than four races simultaneously: a priestly, a warrior, and a trading and farming race, and finally a menial race, the Sudras. Here we are manifestly no longer among animal-tamers: a species of human being a hundred times more gentle and rational is presupposed even to conceive the plan of such a breeding. One draws a breath of relief when coming out of the Christian sick-house and dungeon atmosphere into this healthier, higher, wider world. How paltry the 'New Testament' is compared with Manu, how ill it smells! - But this organization too needed to be dreadful - this time in struggle not with the beast but with its antithesis, with the non-bred human being, the hotchpotch human being, the Chandala.* And again it had no means of making him weak and harmless other than making him sick - it was the struggle with the 'great majority'. Perhaps there is nothing which outrages our feelings more than these protective measures of Indian morality. The third edict, for example (Avadana-Shastra I), that 'concerning unclean vegetables', ordains that the only nourishment permitted the Chandala shall be garlic and onions, in view of the fact that holy scripture forbids one to give them corn or seed-bearing fruits or water or fire. The same edict lays it down that the water they need must not be taken from rivers or springs or pools, but only from the entrances to swamps and holes made by the feet of animals. They are likewise forbidden to wash their clothes or to wash themselves, since the water allowed them as an act of charity must be used only for quenching the thirst. Finally, the Sudra women are forbidden to assist the Chandala women in childbirth, and the latter are

likewise forbidden to assist one another.... - The harvest of such hygienic regulations did not fail to appear: murderous epidemics, hideous venereal diseases and, as a consequence, 'the law of the knife' once more, ordaining circumcision for the male and removal of the labia minora for the female children. - Manu himself says: 'The Chandala are the fruit of adultery, incest and crime' (- this being the necessary consequence of the concept 'breeding'). 'They shall have for clothing only rags from corpses, for utensils broken pots, for ornaments old iron, for worship only evil spirits; they shall wander from place to place without rest. They are

forbidden to write from left to right and to use the right hand for writing: the employment of the right hand and of the left-to-right motion is reserved for the virtuous, for people of race.' -

§4

These regulations are instructive enough: in them we find for once Aryan humanity, quite pure, quite primordial - we learn that the concept 'pure blood' is the opposite of a harmless concept. It becomes clear, on the other hand, in which people the hatred, the Chandala hatred for this 'humanity' has been immortalized, where it has become religion, where it has become genius.... From this point of view, the Gospels are documents of the first rank; the Book of Enoch even more so. - Christianity, growing from Jewish roots and comprehensible only as a product of this soil,* represents the reaction against that morality of breeding, of race, of privilege - it is the anti-Aryan religion par excellence: Christianity the revaluation of all Aryan values, the victory of Chandala values, the evangel preached to the poor and lowly, the collective rebellion of everything downtrodden, wretched, illconstituted, under-privileged against the 'race' - undying Chandala revenge as the religion of love...

§5

The morality of breeding and the morality of taming are, in the means they employ to attain their ends, entirely worthy of one another: we may set down as our chief proposition that to make morality one must have the unconditional will to the contrary. This is the great, the uncanny problem which I have pursued furthest: the psychology of the 'improvers' of mankind. A small and really rather modest fact, that of so-called *pia fraus*,† gave me my first access to this problem: *pia fraus*, the heritage of all philosophers and priests who have 'improved' mankind. Neither Manu nor Plato, neither Confucius nor the Jewish and Christian teachers, ever doubted their right to tell lies. Nor did they doubt their possession of other rights.... Expressed in a formula one might say: every

means hitherto employed with the intention of making mankind moral has been thoroughly immoral. -

What the Germans Lack

§1

Among Germans today it is not enough to possess spirit: one must also possess the presumption to possess it... Perhaps I know the Germans, perhaps I might even venture to address a few words to them. The new Germany represents a great quantity of inherited and inculcated ability, so that it may for a time be allowed even a lavish expenditure of its accumulated store of energy. It is not a high culture that has here gained ascendancy, even less a fastidious taste, a noble 'beauty' of the instincts, but more manly virtues than any other country of Europe can exhibit. A good deal of courage and respect for oneself, a good deal of self-confidence in social dealings and in the performance of reciprocal duties, a good deal of industriousness, a good deal of endurance - and an inherited moderation which requires the goad rather than the brake. I also add that here people can still obey without being humiliated by obeying.... And no one despises his adversary... You will see I want to be just to the Germans: I would not like to be untrue to myself in this - so I must also tell them what I object to. Coming to power is a costly business: power makes stupid.... The Germans - once they were called the nation of thinkers: do they still think at all? Nowadays the Germans are bored with intellect, the Germans mistrust intellect, politics devours all seriousness for really intellectual things - Deutschland, Deutschland über alles was, I fear, the end of German philosophy.... 'Are there any German philosophers? are there any German poets? are there any good German books?' - people ask me abroad. I blush; but with the courage which is mine even in desperate cases I answer: 'Yes, Bismarck!' - Dare I go so far as to confess which books are read nowadays?... Confounded instinct of mediocrity! -

§2

- Who has not pondered sadly over what the German spirit could be! But this nation has deliberately made itself stupid, for practically a thousand years: nowhere else are the two great European narcotics, alcohol and Christianity, so viciously abused. Lately even a third has been added, one which is capable by itself of completely obstructing all delicate and audacious flexibility of spirit: music, our constipated, constipating German music. - How much dreary heaviness, lameness, dampness, sloppiness, how much beer there is in the

German intellect! How can it possibly happen that young men who dedicate their existence to the most spiritual goals lack

all sense of the first instinct of spirituality, the spirit's instinct for self-preservation – and drink beer?... The alcoholism of scholarly youth perhaps does not constitute a question mark in regard to their erudition – one can be even a great scholar without possessing any spirit at all – but from any other point of view it remains a problem. – Where does one not find that bland degeneration which beer produces in the spirit! Once, in a case that has become almost famous, I laid my finger on such an instance of degeneration – the degeneration of our first German freethinker, the shrewd David Strauss, into the author of an alehouse gospel and a 'new faith'.... It was no vain vow he made in verse to the 'gracious brunette'* – fidelity unto death...

§3

– I have said of the German spirit that it is growing coarser, that it is growing shallow. Is that sufficient? – Fundamentally, it is something quite different which appals me: how German seriousness, German profundity, German passion in spiritual things is more and more on the decline. It is the pathos and not merely the intellectual aspect which has altered. – I come in contact now and then with German universities: what an atmosphere prevails among its scholars, what a barren spirituality, grown how contented and lukewarm! It would be a profound misunderstanding to adduce German science as an objection here, as well as being proof one had not read a word I have written. For seventeen years I have not wearied of exposing the despiritualizing influence of our contemporary scientific pursuits. The harsh Helot condition to which the tremendous extent of science has condemned every single person today is one of the main reasons why education and educators appropriate to fuller, richer, deeper natures are no longer forthcoming. Our culture suffers from nothing more than it suffers from the superabundance of presumptuous journeymen and fragments of humanity; our universities are, against their will, the actual forcing-houses for this kind of spiritual instinct-atrophy. And all Europe already has an idea of this – grand politics deceives no one.... Germany counts more and more as Europe's flatland. – I am still looking for a German with whom I could be serious after my fashion – how much more for one with whom I might be cheerful! – Twilight of the Idols: ah, who today could grasp from how profound a seriousness a hermit is here relaxing! – The most incomprehensible thing about us is our cheerfulness...

§4

If one makes a reckoning, it is obvious not only that German culture is declining, the sufficient reason* for it is obvious too. After all, no one can spend more than he has – that is true of individuals, it is also true of nations. If one spends oneself on

power, grand politics, economic affairs, world commerce, parliamentary institutions, military interests – if one expends in this direction the quantum of reason, seriousness, will, self-overcoming that one is, then there will be a shortage in the other direction. Culture and the state – one should not deceive oneself over this – are antagonists: the ‘cultural state’ is merely a modern idea. The one lives off the other, the one thrives at the expense of the other. All great cultural epochs are epochs of political decline: that which is great in the cultural sense has been unpolitical, even anti-political.... Goethe’s heart opened up at the phenomenon Napoleon – it closed up to the ‘Wars of Liberation’.... The moment Germany rises as a great power, France gains a new importance as a cultural power. A great deal of current spiritual seriousness and passion has already emigrated to Paris; the question of pessimism, for instance, the Wagner question, virtually every psychological and artistic question, is speculated on with incomparably more subtlety and thoroughness there than in Germany – the Germans are even incapable of this kind of seriousness. – In the history of European culture the rise of the ‘Reich’ signifies one thing above all: a displacement of the centre of gravity. The fact is known everywhere: in the main thing – and that is still culture – the Germans no longer come into consideration. The question is asked: haven’t you so much as one spirit who means something to Europe? in the way your Goethe, your Hegel, your Heinrich Heine, your Schopenhauer meant something? That there is no longer a single German philosopher – there is no end of astonishment at that. –

§5

The essential thing has gone out of the entire system of higher education in Germany: the end, as well as the means to the end. That education, culture, itself is the end – and not ‘the Reich’ – that educators are required for the attainment of this end – and not grammar-school teachers and university scholars – that too has been forgotten.... There is a need for educators who are themselves educated; superior, noble spirits, who prove themselves every moment by what they say and by what they do not say: cultures grown ripe and sweet – and not the learned boors which grammar school and university offer youth today as ‘higher nurses’. Educators, the first prerequisite of education, are lacking (except for the exceptions of exceptions): hence the decline of German culture. – One of those rarest of exceptions is my honoured friend

Jacob Burckhardt of Basel: it is to him above all that Basel owes its pre-eminence in the humanities. – What the ‘higher schools’ of Germany in fact achieve is a brutal breaking-in with the aim of making, in the least possible time, numberless young men fit to be utilized, utilized to the full and used up, in the state service. ‘Higher education’ and numberless – that is a contradiction to start with. All higher education belongs to the exceptions alone: one must be privileged to

have a right to so high a privilege. Great and fine things can never be common property: *pulchrum est paucorum hominum*.* – What is the cause of the decline of German culture? That ‘higher education’ is no longer a privilege – the democratism of ‘culture’ made ‘universal’ and common.... Not to overlook the fact that military privileges absolutely compel too great attendance at higher schools, which means their ruin. – No one is any longer free in present-day Germany to give his children a noble education: our ‘higher’ schools are one and all adjusted – as regards their teachers, their curricula and their instructional aims – to the most dubious mediocrity. And there reigns everywhere an indecent haste, as if something has been neglected if the young man of twenty-three is not yet ‘finished and ready’, does not yet know the answer to the ‘chief question’: which calling? – A higher kind of human being, excuse me for saying, doesn’t think much of ‘callings’, the reason being he knows himself called.... He takes his time, he has plenty of time, he gives no thought whatsoever to being ‘finished and ready’ – at the age of thirty one is, as regards high culture, a beginner, a child. – Our overcrowded grammar schools, our overloaded, stupified grammar-school teachers, are a scandal: one may perhaps have motives for defending this state of things, as the professors of Heidelberg recently did – there are no grounds for doing so.

§1

My impossibles. – Seneca: or the toreador of virtue. – Rousseau: or the return to nature in *impuris naturalibus** – Schiller: or the Moral-Trumpeter of Säckingen.† – Dante: or the hyena which poetises on graves. – Kant: or cant as intelligible character. – Victor Hugo: or the Pharos in the Sea of Absurdity. – Liszt: or the virtuoso – with women.‡ – George Sand: or *lactea ubertas*,§ in English: the milch cow with the ‘fine style’. – Michelet: or enthusiasm which strips off the jacket. – Carlyle: or pessimism as indigestion. – John Stuart Mill: or offensive clarity. – Les frères de Goncourt: or the two Ajaxes struggling with Homer. Music by Offenbach. Zola: or ‘delight in stinking’. –

§2

Renan. – Theology, or the corruption of reason by ‘original sin’ (Christianity). Witness: Renan, who, whenever he risks a more general Yes or No, misses the point with painful regularity. He would like, for instance, to couple together la science and la noblesse; but la science belongs to democracy, that is patently obvious. He desires, with no little ambitiousness, to represent an aristocratism of the intellect: but at the same time he falls on his knees, and not only his knees, before its opposite, the évangile des humbles.... What avails all free thinking, modernity, mockery and wry-necked flexibility, if one is still Christian, Catholic and even priest in one’s bowels! Renan possesses his mode of inventiveness, just like a Jesuit or a father confessor, in devising means of seduction; his intellectuality does not lack the broad priestly smirk – like all priests, he becomes dangerous only when he loves. Nobody can equal him in deadly adoration.... This spirit of Renan, an enervating spirit, is one fatality more for poor, sick, feeble-willed France. –

§3

Sainte-Beuve. – Nothing masculine in him; full of petty sullen wrath against all masculine spirit. Roams about, delicate, inquisitive, bored, eavesdropping – fundamentally a woman, with a woman’s revengefulness and a woman’s sensuousness. As psychologist a genius of, *médiance*;* inexhaustibly rich in means for creating it; no one knows better how to mix poison with praise. Plebeian in the lowest instincts and related to Rousseau’s resentment: consequently a romantic – for beneath all romantisme there grunts and thirsts Rousseau’s instinct for revenge. A revolutionary, but kept tolerably in check by fear. Constrained in presence of

everything possessing strength (public opinion, the Academy, the Court, even PortRoyal).† Embittered against all that is great in men and things, against all that believes in itself. Enough of a poet and semi-woman to feel greatness as power; constantly cringing, like the celebrated worm, because he constantly feels himself trodden on. As a critic without standards, steadiness or backbone, possessing the palate for a large variety of things of the cosmopolitan libertin but lacking the courage even to admit his libertinage. As a historian without philosophy, without the power of philosophical vision – for that reason rejecting, in all the main issues, the task of passing judgement, holding up ‘objectivity’ as a mask. He comports himself differently, however, towards questions in which a delicate, experienced taste is the highest court of appeal: there he really does have the courage for himself, takes pleasure in himself – there he is a master. – In some respects a preliminary form of Baudelaire. –

§4

The *Imitatio Christi** is one of the books I cannot hold in my hand without experiencing a physiological resistance: it exhales a parfum of the 'eternal feminine'† for which one has to be French – or a Wagnerian.... This saint has a way of talking about love that makes even Parisiennes curious. – I am told that cunningest of Jesuits, A. Comte, who wanted to lead his Frenchmen to Rome via the *détour* of science, inspired himself with this book. I believe it: 'the religion of the heart'...

§5

G. Eliot. – They have got rid of the Christian God, and now feel obliged to cling all the more firmly to Christian morality: that is English consistency, let us not blame it on little bluestockings à la Eliot. In England, in response to every little emancipation from theology one has to reassert one's position in a fear-inspiring manner as a moral fanatic. That is the penance one pays there. – With us it is different. When one gives up Christian belief one thereby deprives oneself of the right to Christian morality. For the latter is absolutely not self-evident: one must make this point clear again and again, in spite of English shallowpates. Christianity is a system, a consistently thought out and complete view of things. If one breaks out of it a fundamental idea, the belief in God, one thereby breaks the whole thing to pieces: one has nothing of any consequence left in one's hands. Christianity presupposes that man does not know, cannot know what is good for him and what evil: he believes in God, who alone knows. Christian morality is a command: its origin is transcendental; it is beyond all criticism, all right to criticize; it possesses truth only if God is truth – it stands or falls with the belief in God. – If the English

really do believe they will know, of their own accord, 'intuitively', what is good and evil; if they consequently think they no longer have need of Christianity as a guarantee of morality; that is merely the consequence of the ascendancy of Christian evaluation and an expression of the strength and depth of this ascendancy: so that the origin of English morality has been forgotten, so that the highly conditional nature of its right to exist is no longer felt. For the Englishman morality is not yet a problem...

§1

In conclusion, a word on that world into which I have sought to find a way, into which I have perhaps found a new way – the ancient world. My taste, which may be called the opposite of a tolerant taste, is even here far from uttering a wholesale Yes: in general it dislikes saying Yes, it would rather say No, most of all it prefers to say nothing at all.... This applies to entire cultures, it applies to

books – it also applies to towns and countrysides. It is really only quite a small number of books of antiquity which count for anything in my life; the most famous are not among them. My sense of style, of the epigram as style, was awoken almost instantaneously on coming into contact with Sallust. I have not forgotten the astonishment of my honoured teacher Corssen when he had to give top marks to his worst Latin scholar – I had done all in a single blow. Compact, severe, with as much substance as possible, a cold malice towards ‘fine words’, also towards ‘fine feelings’ – in that I knew myself. One will recognize in my writings, even in my Zarathustra, a very serious ambition for Roman style, for the ‘aera perennius’* in style. – I had the same experience on first coming into contact with Horace. From that day to this no poet has given me the same artistic delight as I derived from the very first from an Horatian ode. In certain languages what is achieved here is not even desirable. This mosaic of words in which every word, as sound, as locus, as concept, pours forth its power to left and right and over the whole, this minimum in the range and number of signs which achieves a maximum of energy of these signs – all this is Roman and, if one will believe me, noble par excellence. All other poetry becomes by comparison somewhat too popular – a mere emotional garrulousness...

§2

I received absolutely no such strong impressions from the Greeks; and, not to mince words, they cannot be to us what the Romans are. One does not learn from the Greeks – their manner is too strange, it is also too fluid to produce an imperative, a ‘classical’ effect. Who would ever have learned to write from a Greek! Who would ever have learned it without the Romans!... Let no one offer me Plato as an objection. In respect to Plato I am a thorough sceptic and have always been unable to join in the admiration of Plato the artist which is traditional among scholars. After all, I have here the most refined judges of taste of antiquity themselves on my side. It seems to me that Plato mixes together all forms of style; he is therewith in the matter of style a first decadent: he has on his conscience something similar to the Cynics who devised the Satura Menippea.* For the Platonic dialogue, that

frightfully self-satisfied and childish kind of dialectics, to operate as a stimulus one must never have read any good French writers – Fontenelle, for example. Plato is boring. – Ultimately my mistrust of Plato extends to the very bottom of him: I find him deviated so far from all the fundamental instincts of the Hellenes, so morally infected, so much an antecedent Christian – he already has the concept ‘good’ as the supreme concept – that I should prefer to

describe the entire phenomenon 'Plato' by the harsh term 'higher swindle' or, if you prefer, 'idealism', than by any other. It has cost us dear that this Athenian went to school with the Egyptians (- or with the Jews in Egypt?...). In the great fatality of Christianity, Plato is that ambiguity and fascination called the 'ideal' which made it possible for the nobler natures of antiquity to misunderstand themselves and to step on to the bridge which led to the 'Cross'.... And how much there still is of Plato in the concept 'Church', in the structure, system, practice of the Church! - My recreation, my preference, my cure from all Platonism has always been Thucydides. Thucydides, and perhaps the Principe of Machiavelli, are related to me closely by their unconditional will not to deceive themselves and not to see reason in reality - not in 'reason', still less in 'morality'.... For the deplorable embellishment of the Greeks with the colours of the ideal which the 'classically educated' youth carries away with him into life as the reward of his grammar-school drilling there is no more radical cure than Thucydides. One must turn him over line by line and read his hidden thoughts as clearly as his words: there are few thinkers so rich in hidden thoughts. Sophist culture, by which I mean realist culture, attains in him its perfect expression - this invaluable movement in the midst of the morality-and-ideal swindle of the Socratic schools which was then breaking out everywhere. Greek philosophy as the *décadence* of the Greek instinct; Thucydides as the grand summation, the last manifestation of that strong, stern, hard matter-of-factness instinctive to the older Hellenes. Courage in face of reality ultimately distinguishes such natures as Thucydides and Plato: Plato is a coward in face of reality - consequently he flees into the ideal; Thucydides has himself under control - consequently he retains control over things...

§3

From scenting out 'beautiful souls',* 'golden means' and other perfections in the Greeks, from admiring in them such things as their repose in grandeur, their ideal disposition, their sublime simplicity - from this 'sublime simplicity', a *niaiserie allemande*† when all is said and done, I was preserved by the psychologist in me. I saw their strongest instinct, the will to power, I saw them trembling at the intractable force of this drive - I saw all their institutions evolve out of protective measures designed for mutual security against the explosive material within them.

The tremendous internal tension then discharged itself in fearful and ruthless external hostility: the city states tore one another to pieces so that the citizens of each of them might find peace within himself. One needed to be strong: danger was close at hand - it lurked everywhere. The splendid *supplé physique*,

the reckless realism and immoralism which pertains to the Hellene was a necessity, not a 'natural quality'. It was produced, it was not there from the beginning. And one employed festivals and arts for no other purpose than to feel oneself dominant, to show oneself dominant: they are means for making oneself feared.... To judge the Greeks by their philosophers, in the German manner, perchance to employ the philistinism of the Socratic schools as a clue to what is fundamentally Hellenic!... But the philosophers are the *décadents* of Hellenism, the counter-movement against the old, the noble taste (- against the agonal instinct, against the polis, against the value of the race, against the authority of tradition). The Socratic virtues were preached because the Greeks had lost them: excitable, timid, fickle, comedians every one, they had more than enough reason to let morality be preached to them. Not that it would have done any good: but big words and fine attitudes are so suited to *décadents*...

§4

I was the first to take seriously that wonderful phenomenon which bears the name Dionysos as a means to understanding the older Hellenic instinct, an instinct still exuberant and even overflowing: it is explicable only as an excess of energy. Whoever has investigated the Greeks, such as that profoundest student of their culture now living, Jacob Burckhardt of Basel, realizes at once the value of this line of approach: Burckhardt inserted a special section on the said phenomenon into his *Culture of the Greeks*. For the opposite of this, one should take a look at the almost laughable poverty of instinct displayed by German philologists whenever they approach the Dionysian. The celebrated Lobeck especially, who crept into this world of mysterious states with the honest self-confidence of a dried-up bookworm and by being nauseously frivolous and childish persuaded himself he was being scientific - Lobeck intimated, with a great display of erudition, that these curiosities were of no consequence. To be sure, the priests might have communicated a number of valuable pieces of information to the participants in such orgies - that wine arouses desire, for example, that man can live on fruit if need be, that plants bloom in spring and wither in autumn. As regards that strange wealth of rites, symbols and myths of orgiastic origin with which the antique world was quite literally overrun, Lobeck finds in them an occasion for becoming a trifle more ingenious. 'When the Greeks had nothing else to do,' he says (*Aglao-phamus* I, 672), 'they used to laugh, jump, race about, or, since man sometimes feels a desire

for this, they used to sit down and weep and wail. Others later came along and sought some reason for this striking behaviour; and thus those countless myths

and legends arose to explain these practices. On the other hand, one believed that the droll activities which now took place on festival days necessarily pertained to festival celebration and retained them as an indispensable part of divine worship.' – This is contemptible chatter and no one is likely to take a Lobeck seriously for a moment. We are affected quite differently when we probe the concept 'Greek' which Winckelmann and Goethe constructed for themselves and find it incompatible with that element out of which Dionysian art evolved – the orgy. I have, in fact, no doubt that Goethe would have utterly excluded anything of this kind from the possibilities of the Greek soul. Consequently Goethe did not understand the Greeks. For it is only in the Dionysian mysteries, in the psychology of the Dionysian condition, that the fundamental fact of the Hellenic instinct expresses itself – its 'will to life'. What did the Hellene guarantee to himself with these mysteries? Eternal life, the eternal recurrence of life; the future promised and consecrated in the past; the triumphant Yes to life beyond death and change; true life as collective continuation of life through procreation, through the mysteries of sexuality. It was for this reason that the sexual symbol was to the Greeks the symbol venerable as such, the intrinsic profound meaning of all antique piety. Every individual detail in the act of procreation, pregnancy, birth, awoke the most exalted and solemn feelings. In the teachings of the mysteries, pain is sanctified: the 'pains of childbirth' sanctify pain in general – all becoming and growing, all that guarantees the future, postulates pain.... For the eternal joy in creating to exist, for the will to life eternally to affirm itself, the 'torment of childbirth' must also exist eternally.... All this is contained in the word Dionysos: I know of no more exalted symbolism than this Greek symbolism, the symbolism of the Dionysian. The profoundest instinct of life, the instinct for the future of life, for the eternity of life, is in this word experienced religiously – the actual road to life, procreation, as the sacred road.... It was only Christianity, with resentment against life in its foundations, which made of sexuality something impure: it threw filth on the beginning, on the prerequisite of our life...

§5

The psychology of the orgy as an overflowing feeling of life and energy within which even pain acts as a stimulus provided me with the key to the concept of the tragic feeling, which was misunderstood as much by Aristotle as it especially was by our pessimists. Tragedy is so far from providing evidence for pessimism among the Hellenes in Schopenhauer's sense that it has to be considered the decisive repudiation of that idea and the counter-verdict to it. Affirmation of life even in its

strangest and sternest problems, the will to life rejoicing in its own inexhaustibility through the sacrifice of its highest types – that is what I called Dionysian, that is what I recognized as the bridge to the psychology of the tragic poet. Not so as to get rid of pity and terror, not so as to purify oneself of a dangerous emotion through its vehement discharge – it was thus Aristotle understood it – : but, beyond pity and terror, to realize in oneself the eternal joy of becoming – that joy which also encompasses joy in destruction.... And with that I again return to the place from which I set out – Birth of Tragedy was my first revaluation of all values: with that I again plant myself in the soil out of which I draw all that I will and can – I, the last disciple of the philosopher Dionysos – I, the teacher of the eternal recurrence...*

The Hammer Speaks ‘Why so hard?’ the charcoal once said to the diamond; ‘for are we not close relations?’ Why so soft? O my brothers, thus I ask you: for are you not – my brothers? Why so soft, unresisting and yielding? Why is there so much denial and abnegation in your hearts? So little fate in your glances? And if you will not be fates, if you will not be inexorable: how can you – conquer with me? And if your hardness will not flash and cut and cut to pieces: how can you one day – create with me? For all creators are hard. And it must seem bliss to you to press your hand upon millennia as upon wax, bliss to write upon the will of millennia as upon metal – harder than metal, nobler than metal. Only the noblest is perfectly hard. This new law-table do I put over you, O my brothers: Become hard!*

THE ANTI-CHRIST

Foreword This book belongs to the very few. Perhaps none of them is even living yet. Possibly they are the readers who understand my Zarathustra: how could I confound myself with those for whom there are ears listening today? – Only the day after tomorrow belongs to me. Some are born posthumously. The conditions under which one understands me and then necessarily understands – I know them all too well. One must be honest in intellectual matters to the point of harshness to so much as endure my seriousness, my passion. One must be accustomed to living on mountains – to seeing the wretched ephemeral chatter of politics and national egoism beneath one. One must have become indifferent, one must never ask whether truth is useful or a fatality.... Strength which prefers questions for which no one today is sufficiently daring; courage for the forbidden; predestination for the labyrinth. An experience out of seven solitudes. New ears for new music. New eyes for the most distant things. A new conscience for truths which have hitherto remained dumb. And the will to economy in the grand style: to keeping one’s energy, one’s enthusiasm in bounds.... Reverence for oneself; love for oneself; unconditional freedom with

respect to oneself... Very well! These alone are my readers, my rightful readers, my predestined readers: what do the rest matter? – The rest are merely mankind. – One must be superior to mankind in force, in loftiness of soul – in contempt... FRIEDRICH NIETZSCHE

§1

– Let us look one another in the face. We are Hyperboreans* – we know well enough how much out of the way we live. ‘Neither by land nor by sea shalt thou find the road to the Hyperboreans’: Pindar already knew that of us. Beyond the North, beyond the ice, beyond death – our life, our happiness.... We have discovered happiness, we know the road, we have found the exit out of whole millennia of labyrinth. Who else has found it? – Modern man perhaps? – ‘I know not which way to turn; I am everything that knows not which way to turn’ – sighs modern man.... It was from this modernity that we were ill – from lazy peace, from cowardly compromise, from the whole virtuous uncleanliness of modern Yes and No. This tolerance and largeness of heart which ‘forgives’ everything because it ‘Understands’ everything is sirocco to us. Better to live among ice than among modern virtues and other south winds!... We were brave enough, we spared neither ourselves nor others: but for long we did not know where to apply our courage. We became gloomy, we were called fatalists. Our fatality – was the plenitude, the tension, the blocking-up of our forces. We thirsted for lightning and action, of all things we kept ourselves furthest from the happiness of the weaklings, from ‘resignation’.... There was a thunderstorm in our air, the nature which we are grew dark – for we had no road. Formula of our happiness: a Yes, a No, a straight line, a goal...

§2

What is good? – All that heightens the feeling of power, the will to power, power itself in man. What is bad? – All that proceeds from weakness. What is happiness? – The feeling that power increases – that a resistance is overcome. Not contentment, but more power; not peace at all, but war; not virtue, but proficiency (virtue in the Renaissance style, virtù, virtue free of moral acid). The weak and ill-constituted shall perish: first principle of our philanthropy. And one shall help them to do so. What is more harmful than any vice? – Active sympathy for the ill-constituted and weak – Christianity...

§3

The problem I raise here is not what ought to succeed mankind in the sequence of

species (– the human being is a conclusion –): but what type of human being one ought to breed, ought to will, as more valuable, more worthy of life, more certain of the future. This more valuable type has existed often enough already: but as a lucky accident, as an exception, never as willed. He has rather been the most feared, he has hitherto been virtually the thing to be feared – and out of fear the reverse type has been willed, bred, achieved: the domestic animal, the herd animal, the sick animal man – the Christian...

§4

Mankind does not represent a development of the better or the stronger or the higher in the way that is believed today. 'Progress' is merely a modern idea, that is to say a false idea. The European of today is of far less value than the European of the Renaissance; onward development is not by any means, by any necessity the same thing as elevation, advance, strengthening. In another sense there are cases of individual success constantly appearing in the most various parts of the earth and from the most various cultures in which a higher type does manifest itself: something which in relation to collective mankind is a sort of superman. Such chance occurrences of great success have always been possible and perhaps always will be possible. And even entire races, tribes, nations can under certain circumstances represent such a lucky hit.

§5

One should not embellish or dress up Christianity: it has waged a war to the death against this higher type of man, it has excommunicated all the fundamental instincts of this type, it has distilled evil, the Evil One, out of these instincts – the strong human being as the type of reprehensibility, as the 'outcast'. Christianity has taken the side of everything weak, base, ill-constituted, it has made an ideal out of opposition to the preservative instincts of strong life; it has depraved the reason even of the intellectually strongest natures by teaching men to feel the supreme values of intellectuality as sinful, as misleading, as temptations. The most deplorable example: the depraving of Pascal, who believed his reason had been depraved by original sin while it had only been depraved by his Christianity! –

IV.3 – Beyond Good and Evil: Selected Aphorisms

BEYOND GOOD AND EVIL §269, §270, §274, §276, §278 (Translated by Ian Johnston)

The more a psychologist—a born and inevitable psychologist and diviner of the soul—turns himself towards exceptional examples and human beings, the greater the danger to him of suffocation from pity. He has to be hard and cheerful, more so than another man. For the corruption and destruction of loftier men, of the stranger type of soul, is the rule: it is terrible to have such a rule always before one's eyes. The multifaceted torment of the psychologist who has uncovered this destructiveness, who once discovers and then almost always rediscovers throughout all history this entire inner "hopelessness" of the loftier people, this eternal "too late!" in every sense—this torment can perhaps one day become the reason he turns with bitterness against his own lot, attempts self-destruction—and "corrupts" himself. With almost every psychologist we will see a revealing inclination for and delight in associating with ordinary and well-adjusted people: that indicates that he always needs healing, that he requires some sort of refuge and forgetting, far from what his insights and incisions, his "trade," have laid on his conscience. Fear of his memory is characteristic of him. He is easily reduced to silence before the judgments of others; he listens with an unmoving face as people revere, admire, love, and transfigure where he has seen, or he even hides his silence, while he expressly agrees with some foreground point of view or other. Perhaps the paradox of his situation gets so terrible that precisely where he has learned great pity as well as great contempt, the crowd, the educated, and the enthusiasts have for their part learned great admiration—the admiration for "great men" and miraculous animals for whose sake people bless and honour the fatherland, the earth, the value of humanity, and themselves, those to whom they draw the attention of the young and whom they use as role models in their education . . . And who knows whether in all great examples up to this point the very same thing has not happened: the crowd worshipped a god—and the "god" was only a poor sacrificial animal! Success has always been the greatest liar, and the "work" itself a success; the great statesman, the conqueror, or the discoverer is disguised in his creation to the point where he is unrecognizable; the "work" of the artist and of the philosopher first invents the man who has created it or is supposed to have created it; the "great men," as they are honoured, are small inferior works of fiction written later; in the world of historical values counterfeit is king. These great poets, for example, this Byron, Musset, Poe, Leopardi, Kleist, Gogol(2)—as they now are and perhaps had to be: men of the moment, enthusiastic, sensuous, childish, careless and sudden with trust and mistrust; with souls in which some fracture or other normally has to be concealed; often taking revenge in their works for an inner slur, often seeking with their flights upward to forget some all-too-true

memory, often lost in the mud and almost infatuated, until they become like will o' the wisps around a swamp and pretend that they are stars—then the populace may well call them idealists—often struggling against a long disgust, with a recurring ghost of unbelief which makes them cold and forces them to yearn for gloria [glory] and to feed on “inherent faith” from the hands of intoxicated flatterers—what torture are these great artists and the loftier human beings in general for the man who has once guessed who they are! It is thus understandable that they should so readily experience from woman—who is clairvoyant in the world of suffering and who unfortunately also seeks to help and to save far beyond her powers—those eruptions of unlimited and most devoted pity which the crowd, above all the worshipping masses, does not understand and which it overwhelms with curious and complacent interpretations. This pity regularly deceives itself about its power; woman may believe that love can do everything—that's a belief essential to her. Alas, anyone who knows about the heart can guess how poor, stupid, helpless, presumptuous, mistaken, more easily destructive than saving even the best and deepest love is! It is possible that beneath the sacred story and charade of the life of Jesus there lies hidden one of the most painful examples of the martyrdom of knowledge about love: the martyrdom of the most innocent and most desiring heart, which was never satisfied with any human love, which demanded love, to be loved and nothing else, with hardness, with madness, with fearful outbreaks against those who denied him love; the history of a poor man unsatisfied and insatiable with love, who had to invent hell in order to send there those who did not wish to love him—and who finally, having grown to understand human love, had to invent a God who is entirely love, who is entirely capable of love—who takes pity on human love because it is so pathetic, so unknowing! Anyone who feels this way, who knows about love in this way—seeks death.—But why dwell on such painful things? Assuming we don't have to.—

§270

The spiritual arrogance and disgust of every man who has suffered deeply—how profoundly men can suffer almost determines their order of rank—his chilling certainty, with which he is thoroughly soaked and coloured, that thanks to his suffering he knows more than the cleverest and wisest can know, that he has experienced and at some point been “at home” in many terrible far-off worlds, about which “you know nothing!” . . . this spiritual and silent arrogance of the sufferer, this pride of the one chosen to know, of the “initiate,” of the one who has almost been sacrificed, finds all kinds of disguise necessary to protect itself from contact with prying and compassionate hands and, in general, from

everything which is not its equal in pain. Profound suffering ennobles; it separates. One of the most sophisticated forms of disguise is Epicureanism and a certain continuing courageousness in taste adopted as a show, which takes suffering lightly and resists everything sad and deep. There are “cheerful men” who use cheerfulness because it makes them misunderstood—they want to be misunderstood. There are “scientific people” who use science because that provides a cheerful appearance and because being scientific enables one to infer that the person is superficial—they want to seduce people to a false conclusion. There are free, impudent spirits who would like to hide and deny that they are broken, proud, incurable hearts; and now and then even foolishness is a mask for a disastrous, all-too-certain knowledge.(3) Hence, it follows that it’s part of a more sophisticated humanity to have reverence “for the mask” and not to pursue psychology and curiosity in the wrong place.

§274

The problem of those who wait.—For a higher man in whom the solution to a problem lies asleep, strokes of luck and all sorts of unpredictable things are necessary for him to swing into action at just the right time—“for an eruption,” as we could say. Ordinarily it does not happen, and in all the corners of the earth people sit waiting, who hardly know to what extent they are waiting, but even less that they are waiting in vain. From time to time the call to wake up, that chance which provides “permission” for action, comes too late—at a time when their best youth and power for action have already been used up in sitting still. And many a man, in the very moment he “sprang up,” has found to his horror that his limbs have gone to sleep and his spirit is already too heavy! “It is too late,” he has said to himself, having lost faith in himself, and is now forever useless. —In the realm of genius, could “Raphael without hands,” taking that phrase in the widest sense, perhaps not be the exception but the rule?(4)—Genius is perhaps not really so rare, but rather the five hundred hands needed to tyrannize the *kairos*, “the right time,” to seize chance by the forelock!(5)

§276

With all kinds of injury and loss the lower and cruder soul is better off than the more noble one: the dangers for the latter must be greater; the probability that it will go wrong and die is even immense, given the multifaceted nature of its living conditions.—With a lizard a finger which has been lost grows back: not so with a man.

Wanderer, who are you? I see you going on your way, without scorn, without love, with unfathomable eyes, damp and sad, like a lead sinker which has come back unsatisfied from every depth into the light—what was it looking for down there?—with a breast which does not sigh, with a lip which hides its disgust, with a hand which grasps only slowly: Who are you? What have you been doing? Have a rest here: this place is hospitable to everyone—relax! And whoever you happen to be, what would you like now? What do you need to recuperate? Just name it: what I have I'll offer you! "For relaxation? For recuperation? O you inquisitive man, what are you talking about! But give me, I beg . . ." What? What? Say it!—"One more mask! A second mask!"

IV.4 — The Birth of Tragedy §1-2 (Apollonian and Dionysian)

THE BIRTH OF TRAGEDY §1-2 (Translated by Ian Johnston)

IV.5 — The Birth of Tragedy §15-16 (The Death of Tragedy)

THE BIRTH OF TRAGEDY §15-16 (Translated by Ian Johnston)

IV.6 — Thus Spoke Zarathustra: On the Tarantulas

THUS SPOKE ZARATHUSTRA, "ON THE TARANTULAS" (Translated by Graham Parkes)

Look, there is the tarantula's hole! Do you want to see her in person? Here is her web: touch it so that it trembles.

Now she comes willingly: Welcome, tarantula! Your triangle and omen sits black upon your back; and I know too what sits within your soul.

Revenge sits within your soul: wherever you bite, there grow black scabs; with revenge your poison makes the soul whirl round!

Thus I talk to you in a parable, you who make people's souls whirl round, you preachers of equality! Tarantulas you are to me, and hidden vengeance-seekers!

But now I want to bring your hiding-places to light: therefore I laugh in your visages my laughter of the heights.

Therefore I rake your webs, that your rage might bring you out of your holes of lies, and your revenge jump out from behind your word 'justice'.

For that humanity might be redeemed from revenge: that is for me the bridge to the highest hope and a rainbow after lasting storms.

But of course the tarantulas want it otherwise. 'This precisely is what justice is for us, that the world be filled with the storms of our revenge'-thus they talk among themselves.

'Revenge we will practise and defamation of all who are not the same as us'-thus the tarantula-hearts vow to themselves.

'And "will to equality"-just that shall henceforth be the name for virtue; and against all that has power we will raise our outcry!'

You preachers of equality, the tyrants' madness of impotence cries out of you thus for 'equality': your most secret tyrants' desires disguise themselves thus in words of virtue!

Soured arrogance, repressed envy, perhaps the arrogance and envy of your fathers: they burst forth from you as flames and the madness of revenge.

What the father kept silent, that comes in the son to be spoken; and often I found the son to be the father's unveiled secret.

Enthusiasts they resemble: yet it is not the heart that inspires them-but rather revenge. And if they become refined and cold, it is not the spirit, but rather envy, that makes them refined and cold.

Their jealousy even leads them onto thinkers' paths; and this is the real mark of their jealousy-they always go too far: so that their weariness at last has to lie down to sleep, even on snow.

From each of their complaints sounds revenge, in their every eulogy is an infliction of pain; and to be judges seems to them the highest bliss.

Thus, however, I counsel you, my friends: Mistrust all in whom the drive to punish is powerful!

They are folk of poor breed and stock; out of their faces leer the executioner and the bloodhound.

Mistrust all those who talk much about their justice! Verily, it is not only honey that their souls are lacking.

And when they call themselves 'the good and the righteous', do not forget that nothing is lacking to make them Pharisees—except power!

My friends, I do not want to be confused and confounded with others.

There are some who preach my teaching of life: and at the same time they are preachers of equality, and tarantulas.

That they talk in favour of life even though they sit in their holes, these poison-spiders, turned away from life: this means they want thereby to cause pain.

They want to cause pain in those who now have power: for among these is the preaching of death still most at home.

Were it otherwise, the tarantulas would then teach otherwise: and they themselves were formerly the best world-slanderers and heretic-burners.

With these preachers of equality I will not be confused and confounded. For thus does justice talk to me: 'Human beings are not equal.'

And they shall not become so either! For what would my love for the Overhuman be if I spoke otherwise?

On a thousand bridges and footpaths they shall throng toward the future, and more and more shall war and inequality be set amongst them: thus does my great love make me talk!

Devisers of images and spectres they shall become in their enmities, and with their images and spectres they shall yet fight the highest fight against themselves!

Good and evil, and rich and poor, and high and lowly, and all the names of values: weapons they shall be and clashing signs that life must itself overcome itself again and again!

Into the heights life wants to build itself with pillars and steps, this life itself: into far distances it will gaze, and out toward blissful sights of beauty—therefore it needs the heights!

And because it needs the heights it needs steps and opposition among steps and climbers! To climb is what life wills, and in climbing to overcome itself.

And now please look, my friends! Here, where the tarantula's hole is, the ruins of an ancient temple rise upward—look now for me with enlightened eyes!

Verily, whoever once towered up his thoughts in stone here knew about the secret of all life as much as the wisest!

That struggle and inequality are present even in beauty, and war for power and over-power: this he teaches us here in the clearest allegory.

How divinely vaults and arches break through each other here, as if in a wrestling-ring: how they strive against each other with light and shadow, these divine strivers—

Assured and beautiful as these, let us be enemies too, my friends! Divinely we want to strive against each other!—

Alas! The tarantula just bit me, my old enemy! Divinely assured and beautiful, she bit me on the finger!

'Punishment must there be and justice'—thus she thinks: 'not in vain shall he sing songs here in honour of enmity!'

Yes, she has just avenged herself ! And alas! now she will make my soul too whirl round with revenge!

But so that I do not whirl round, my friends, tie me fast to this column here! Rather would I even be a stylite than a whirlpool of vengeance!*

Verily, no turning whirlwind is Zarathustra; and if he is a dancer, then never a tarantella-dancer!—

Thus spoke Zarathustra.

Thus Spoke Zarathustra

IV.7 — Thus Spoke Zarathustra: On the Famous Wise Men

THUS SPOKE ZARATHUSTRA, "ON THE FAMOUS WISE MEN" (Translated by Graham Parkes)

The people you have served and the people's superstitions, all you famous wise men!—and not the truth! And for just that reason they paid you reverence.

And for that reason too they tolerated your unbelief, because it was for the people a joke and detour. Thus the master indulges his slaves and even takes delight in their exuberance.

But the one who is hateful to the people as a wolf is to dogs: that is the free spirit, enemy of fetters, the non-worshipper, the dweller in forests.

To hound him out of his lair—that has always been for the people ‘the sense for what is right’: and against him they still always set their sharpest-toothed dogs.

‘For the truth is already here: for after all, the people is here! Woe, woe to those who seek!’—thus has it echoed through the ages.

You wanted to justify your people in their revering: that you called ‘will to truth’, you famous wise men!

And your hearts always said to themselves: ‘From the people I have come: from there came to me also the voice of God.’*

Stubborn and clever, like the ass, you have always been the people’s advocates.

And many a powerful man who wanted to fare well with the people harnessed in front of his steeds—a little ass, a famous wise man.

And now I would like for you, famous wise men, at long last to throw off the lion’s skin altogether!

The skin of the beast of prey, brightly mottled, and the matted locks of the explorer, the seeker, the conqueror!

Ah, for me to believe in your ‘truthfulness’ you would first have to break your reverential will.

Truthful—thus I call the one who goes into Godless deserts and has broken his reverential heart.

In the yellow sands and burned by the sun he will squint thirstily at the islands rich in springs, where living beings repose beneath dark trees.

But his thirst does not persuade him to become like those comfortable creatures: for where there are oases, there are also images of idols.

Ravenous, violent, solitary, Godless: thus does the lion-will want itself.

Free from the happiness of vassals, redeemed from Gods and adorations, fearless and fearsome, great and solitary: such is the will of him who is truthful.

It is always in deserts that the truthful have dwelt, the free spirits, as the desert's masters; but it is in cities that the well-nourished, famous wise men dwell-the draught animals.

For they always draw, as asses-the people's cart!

Not that I am angry with them for that: but servants they remain for me, in harness, however brightly their golden harnesses may shine.

And often were they good servants and praiseworthy. For thus speaks virtue: 'If you have to serve, then seek the one to whom your service is of most use!

'The spirit and virtue of your master shall thrive through your being his servant: then you yourself will thrive with his spirit and his virtue!'

And verily, you famous wise men, you servants of the people! You yourselves have thrived with the people's spirit and virtue-and the people through you! To your own honour I say this!

But you are still of the people even with your virtues, a people with weakened eyes-a people that does not know what spirit is!

Spirit is the life that itself cuts into life: through its own torment it increases its own knowledge-did you already know that?

And the spirit's happiness is this: to be anointed and consecrated through tears as a sacrificial animal-did you already know that?

And the blindness of the blind man and his seeking and tapping shall yet bear witness to the power of the sun into which he gazed*- did you already know that?

And with mountains shall the one who understands learn to build! A small thing it is for the spirit to move mountains*-did you already know that?

You know only the spirit's sparks: you do not see the anvil that it is, nor the ferocity of its hammer!

Verily, you do not know the spirit's pride! But even less could you bear the spirit's modesty, should it ever want to talk!

And never yet could you cast your spirit into a pit of snow: you are not hot enough for that! Hence you know not the raptures of its coldness either.

But in all things you behave too familiarly with the spirit; and you have often made of wisdom a poorhouse and hospital for wretched poets.

You are no eagles: hence you have not experienced the happiness in terror that the spirit enjoys. And whoever is not a bird should not settle over abysses.

To me you are lukewarm:* whereas all deep understanding streams cold. Ice-cold are the innermost springs of the spirit: refreshment for hot hands and doers.

Honourable you stand there stiffly and with straight backs, you famous wise men!-not driven by any strong wind and will.

Have you never seen a sail going across the sea, rounded and swollen and trembling from the violence of the wind?

Like a sail, trembling from the violence of the spirit, my wisdom goes across the sea-my Wild Wisdom!

But you servants of the people, you famous wise men-how could you go with me!-

Thus spoke Zarathustra.

Thus Spoke Zarathustra

PART V: Decadence vs. Ascending Life

V.1 — The Antichrist §1-7

THE ANTICHRIST §1-7 (Translated by R.J. Hollingdale)

§1

In every age the wisest have passed the identical judgement on life: it is worthless. ... Everywhere and always their mouths have uttered the same sound – a sound full of doubt, full of melancholy, full of weariness with life, full of opposition to life. Even Socrates said as he died: ‘To live – that means to be a long time sick: I owe a cock to the saviour Asclepius’.* Even Socrates had had enough of it. – What does that prove? What does it point to? – Formerly one would have said (– oh, and did say, and loudly enough, and our pessimists† most of all!): ‘Here at any rate there must be something true! The consensus sapientium ‡ is proof of truth.’ – Shall we still speak thus today? are we allowed to do so? ‘Here at any rate there must be something sick’ – this is our retort: one ought to take a closer look at them, these wisest of every age! Were they all of them perhaps no longer steady on their legs? belated? tottery? décadents? Does wisdom perhaps appear on earth as a raven which is inspired by the smell of carrion?...

§2

This irreverent notion that the great sages are declining types first dawned on me in regard to just the case in which learned and unlearned prejudice is most strongly opposed to it: I recognized Socrates and Plato as symptoms of decay, as agents of the dissolution of Greece, as pseudo-Greek, as anti-Greek (Birth of Tragedy, 1872)*. That consensus sapientium – I saw more and more clearly – proves least of all that they were right about what they were in accord over: it proves rather that they themselves, these wisest men, were in some way in physiological accord since they stood – had to stand – in the same negative relation to life. Judgements, value judgements concerning life, for or against, can in the last resort never be true: they possess value only as symptoms, they come into consideration only as symptoms – in themselves such judgements are stupidities. One must reach out and try to grasp this astonishing finesse, that the value of life cannot be estimated. Not by a living man, because he is a party to the dispute, indeed its object, and not the judge of it; not by a dead one, for

another reason. – For a philosopher to see a problem in the value of life thus even constitutes an objection to him, a question-mark as to his wisdom, a piece of unwisdom. – What? and all these great wise men – they have not only been *décadents*, they have not even been wise? – But I shall get back to the problem of Socrates.

§3

Socrates belonged, in his origins, to the lowest orders: Socrates was rabble. One knows, one sees for oneself, how ugly he was. But ugliness, an objection in itself, is among Greeks almost a refutation. Was Socrates a Greek at all? Ugliness is frequently enough the sign of a thwarted development, a development retarded by interbreeding. Otherwise it appears as a development in decline. Anthropologists among criminologists tell us the typical criminal is ugly: *monstrum in fronte, monstrum in animo*.† But the criminal is a *décadent*. Was Socrates a typical criminal? – At least that famous physiognomist's opinion which Socrates' friends found so objectionable would not contradict this idea. A foreigner passing through Athens who knew how to read faces told Socrates to his face that he was a *monstrum* – that he contained within him every kind of foul vice and lust. And Socrates answered merely: 'You know me, sir!' –

§4

It is not only the admitted dissoluteness and anarchy of his instincts which indicate *décadence* in Socrates: the superfetation of the logical and that barbed malice which distinguishes him also point in that direction. And let us not forget those auditory hallucinations which, as 'Socrates' demon', have been interpreted in a religious sense. Everything about him is exaggerated, buffo, caricature, everything is at the same time hidden, reserved, subterranean. – I seek to understand out of what idiosyncrasy that Socratic equation reason = virtue = happiness derives: that bizarrest of equations and one which has in particular all the instincts of the older Hellenes against it.

§5

With Socrates Greek taste undergoes a change in favour of dialectics: what is really happening when that happens? It is above all the defeat of a nobler taste; with dialectics the rabble gets on top. Before Socrates, the dialectical manner was repudiated in good society: it was regarded as a form of bad manners, one was compromised by it. Young people were warned against it. And all such presentation of one's reasons was regarded with mistrust. Honest things, like honest men, do not carry their reasons exposed in this fashion. It is indecent to

display all one's goods. What has first to have itself proved is of little value. Wherever authority is still part of accepted usage and one does not 'give reasons' but commands, the dialectician is a kind of buffoon: he is laughed at, he is not taken seriously. – Socrates was the buffoon who got himself taken seriously: what was really happening when that happened?

§6

One chooses dialectics only when one has no other expedient. One knows that dialectics inspire mistrust, that they are not very convincing. Nothing is easier to expunge than the effect of a dialectician, as is proved by the experience of every speech-making assembly. Dialectics can be only a last-ditch weapon in the hands of those who have no other weapon left. One must have to enforce one's rights: otherwise one makes no use of it. That is why the Jews were dialecticians; Reynard the Fox was a dialectician: what? and Socrates was a dialectician too? –

§7

– Is Socrates' irony an expression of revolt? of the resentment of the rabble? does he, as one of the oppressed, enjoy his own form of ferocity in the knife-thrust of the syllogism? does he revenge himself on the aristocrats he fascinates? – As a dialectician one is in possession of a pitiless instrument; with its aid one can play the tyrant; one compromises by conquering. The dialectician leaves it to his opponent to demonstrate he is not an idiot: he enrages, he at the same time makes helpless. The dialectician devitalizes his opponent's intellect. – What? is dialectics only a form of revenge in the case of Socrates?

§1

You ask me about the idiosyncrasies of philosophers?... There is their lack of historical sense, their hatred of even the idea of becoming, their Egyptianism. They think they are doing a thing honour when they dehistoricize it, *sub specie aeterni** – when they make a mummy of it. All that philosophers have handled for millennia has been conceptual mummies; nothing actual has escaped from their hands alive. They kill, they stuff, when they worship, these conceptual idolaters – they become a mortal danger to everything when they worship. Death, change, age, as well as procreation and growth, are for them objections – refutations even. What is, does not become; what becomes, is not.... Now they all believe, even to the point of despair, in that which is. But since they cannot get hold of it, they look for reasons why it is being withheld from them. 'It must

be an illusion, a deception which prevents us from perceiving that which is: where is the deceiver to be found?' – 'We've got it,' they cry in delight, 'it is the senses! These senses, which are so immoral as well, it is they which deceive us about the real world. Moral: escape from sense-deception, from becoming, from history, from falsehood – history is nothing but belief in the senses, belief in falsehood. Moral: denial of all that believes in the senses, of all the rest of mankind: all of that is mere "people". Be a philosopher, be a mummy, represent monotonism by a gravedigger-mimicry! – And away, above all, with the body, that pitiable *idée fixe* of the senses! infected with every error of logic there is, refuted, impossible even, notwithstanding it is impudent enough to behave as if it actually existed!'...

§2

I set apart with high reverence the name of Heraclitus. When the rest of the philosopher crowd rejected the evidence of the senses because these showed plurality and change, he rejected their evidence because they showed things as if they possessed duration and unity. Heraclitus too was unjust to the senses, which lie neither in the way the Eleatics* believe nor as he believed – they do not lie at all. It is what we make of their evidence that first introduces a lie into it, for example the lie of unity, the lie of materiality, of substance, of duration.... 'Reason' is the cause of our falsification of the evidence of the senses. In so far as the senses show becoming, passing away, change, they do not lie.... But Heraclitus will always be right in this, that being is an empty fiction. The 'apparent' world is the only one: the 'real' world has only been lyingly added...

§3

– And what subtle instruments for observation we possess in our senses! This nose, for example, of which no philosopher has hitherto spoken with respect and gratitude, is none the less the most delicate tool we have at our command: it can detect minimal differences in movement which even the spectroscope cannot detect. We possess scientific knowledge today to precisely the extent that we have decided to accept the evidence of the senses – to the extent that we have learned to sharpen and arm them and to think them through to their conclusions. The rest is abortion and not-yet-science: which is to say metaphysics, theology, psychology, epistemology. Or science of formulae, sign-systems: such as logic and that applied logic, mathematics. In these reality does not appear at all, not even as a problem; just as little as does the question what value a system of conventional signs such as constitutes logic can possibly possess.

§4

The other idiosyncrasy of philosophers is no less perilous: it consists in mistaking the last for the first. They put that which comes at the end – unfortunately! for it ought not to come at all! – the ‘highest concepts’, that is to say the most general, the emptiest concepts, the last fumes of evaporating reality, at the beginning as the beginning. It is again only the expression of their way of doing reverence: the higher must not be allowed to grow out of the lower, must not be allowed to have grown at all.... Moral: everything of the first rank must be *causa sui*. * Origin in something else counts as an objection, as casting a doubt on value. All supreme values are of the first rank, all the supreme concepts – that which is, the unconditioned, the good, the true, the perfect – all that cannot have become, must therefore be *causa sui*. But neither can these supreme concepts be incommensurate with one another, be incompatible with one another.... Thus they acquired their stupendous concept ‘God’.... The last, thinnest, emptiest is placed as the first, as cause in itself, as *ens realissimum*.†...That mankind should have taken seriously the brain-sick fancies of morbid cobweb-spinners! – And it has paid dearly for doing so!...

§5

– Let us, in conclusion, set against this the very different way in which we (– I say ‘we’ out of politeness...) view the problem of error and appearance. Change, mutation, becoming in general were formerly taken as proof of appearance, as a sign of the presence of something which led us astray. Today, on the contrary, we see ourselves as it were entangled in error, necessitated to error, to precisely the

extent that our prejudice in favour of reason compels us to posit unity, identity, duration, substance, cause, materiality, being; however sure we may be, on the basis of a strict reckoning, that error is to be found here. The situation is the same as with the motions of the sun: in that case error has our eyes, in the present case our language as a perpetual advocate. Language belongs in its origin to the age of the most rudimentary form of psychology: we find ourselves in the midst of a rude fetishism when we call to mind the basic presuppositions of the metaphysics of language – which is to say, of reason. It is this which sees everywhere deed and doer; this which believes in will as cause in general; this which believes in the ‘ego’, in the ego as being, in the ego as substance, and which projects its belief in the ego-substance on to all things – only thus does it create the concept ‘thing’.... Being is everywhere thought in, foisted on, as cause; it is only from the conception ‘ego’ that there follows, derivatively, the concept ‘being’.... At the beginning stands the great fateful error that the will is

something which produces an effect – that will is a faculty.... Today we know it is merely a word.... Very much later, in a world a thousand times more enlightened, the security, the subjective certainty with which the categories of reason* could be employed came all of a sudden into philosophers' heads: they concluded that these could not have originated in the empirical world – indeed, the entire empirical world was incompatible with them. Where then do they originate? – And in India as in Greece they committed the same blunder: 'We must once have dwelt in a higher world' – instead of in a very much lower one, which would have been the truth! – 'we must have been divine, for we possess reason!'... Nothing, in fact, has hitherto had a more direct power of persuasion than the error of being as it was formulated by, for example, the Eleatics: for every word, every sentence we utter speaks in its favour! – Even the opponents of the Eleatics were still subject to the seductive influence of their concept of being: Democritus, among others, when he invented his atom.... 'Reason' in language: oh what a deceitful old woman! I fear we are not getting rid of God because we still believe in grammar...

§6

It will be a matter for gratitude if I now compress so fundamental and new an insight into four theses: I shall thereby make it easier to understand, I shall thereby challenge contradiction. First proposition. The grounds upon which 'this' world has been designated as apparent establish rather its reality – another kind of reality is absolutely undemonstrable. Second proposition. The characteristics which have been assigned to the 'real being' of things are the characteristics of non-being, of nothingness – the 'real

world' has been constructed out of the contradiction to the actual world: an apparent world indeed, in so far as it is no more than a moral-optical illusion. Third proposition. To talk about 'another' world than this is quite pointless, provided that an instinct for slandering, disparaging and accusing life is not strong within us: in the latter case we revenge ourselves on life by means of the phantasmagoria of 'another', a 'better' life. Fourth proposition. To divide the world into a 'real' and an 'apparent' world, whether in the manner of Christianity or in the manner of Kant (which is, after all, that of a cunning Christian –) is only a suggestion of *décadence* – a symptom of declining life.... That the artist places a higher value on appearance than on reality constitutes no objection to this proposition. For 'appearance' here signifies reality once more, only selected, strengthened, corrected.... The tragic artist is not a pessimist – it is precisely he who affirms all that is questionable and terrible in existence, he is Dionysian...

How the 'Real World' at last Became a Myth HISTORY OF AN ERROR 1. The real world, attainable to the wise, the pious, the virtuous man – he dwells in it, he is it. (Oldest form of the idea, relatively sensible, simple, convincing. Transcription of the proposition 'I, Plato, am the truth.')

2. The real world, unattainable for the moment, but promised to the wise, the pious, the virtuous man ('to the sinner who repents'). (Progress of the idea: it grows more refined, more enticing, more incomprehensible – it becomes a woman, it becomes Christian...)

3. The real world, unattainable, undemonstrable, cannot be promised, but even when merely thought of a consolation, a duty, an imperative. (Fundamentally the same old sun, but shining through mist and scepticism; the idea grown sublime, pale, northerly, Königsbergian.)†

4. The real world – unattainable? Unattained, at any rate. And if unattained also unknown. Consequently also no consolation, no redemption, no duty: how could we have a duty towards something unknown? (The grey of dawn. First yawnings of reason. Cockcrow of positivism.)‡

5. The 'real world' – an idea no longer of any use, not even a duty any longer – an idea grown useless, superfluous, consequently a refuted idea: let us abolish it! (Broad daylight; breakfast; return of cheerfulness and *bons sens*; Plato blushes for shame; all free spirits run riot.)

6. We have abolished the real world: what world is left? the apparent world perhaps?... But no! with the real world we have also abolished the apparent world! (Mid-day; moment of the shortest shadow; end of the longest error; zenith of mankind; INCIPIT ZARATHUSTRA)

Morality as Anti-Nature

§1

There is a time with all passions when they are merely fatalities, when they drag their victim down with the weight of their folly – and a later, very much later time when they are wedded with the spirit, when they are 'spiritualized'. Formerly one made war on passion itself on account of the folly inherent in it: one conspired for its extermination – all the old moral monsters are unanimous that 'il faut tuer les passions'.* The most famous formula for doing this is contained in the New Testament, in the Sermon on the Mount, where, by the way, things are not at all regarded from a lofty standpoint. There, for example, it is said, with reference to sexuality, 'if thy eye offend thee, pluck it out': fortunately no Christian follows this prescription. To exterminate the passions and desires merely in order to do away with their folly and its unpleasant consequences – this itself seems to us today merely an acute form of folly. We no longer admire dentists who pull out the teeth to stop them hurting.... On the other hand, it is only fair to admit that on the soil out of which Christianity

grew the concept 'spiritualization of passion' could not possibly be conceived. For the primitive Church, as is well known, fought against the 'intelligent' in favour of the 'poor in spirit': how could one expect from it an intelligent war against passion? – The Church combats the passions with excision in every sense of the word: its practice, its 'cure' is castration. It never asks: 'How can one spiritualize, beautify, deify a desire?' – it has at all times laid the emphasis of its discipline on extirpation (of sensuality, of pride, of lust for power, of avarice, of revengefulness). – But to attack the passions at their roots means to attack life at its roots: the practice of the Church is hostile to life...

§2

The same expedient – castration, extirpation – is instinctively selected in a struggle against a desire by those who are too weak-willed, too degenerate to impose moderation upon it: by those natures which need La Trappe,* to speak metaphorically (and not metaphorically –), some sort of definitive declaration of hostility, a chasm between themselves and a passion. It is only the degenerate who cannot do without radical expedients; weakness of will, more precisely the inability not to react to a stimulus, is itself merely another form of degeneration. Radical hostility, mortal hostility towards sensuality is always a thought-provoking symptom: it justifies making certain conjectures as to the general condition of one who is excessive in this respect. – That hostility, that hatred reaches its height, moreover, only when such natures are no longer sufficiently sound even for the

radical cure, for the renunciation of their 'devil'. Survey the entire history of priests and philosophers, and that of artists as well: the most virulent utterances against the senses have not come from the impotent, nor from ascetics, but from those who found it impossible to be ascetics, from those who stood in need of being ascetics...

§3

The spiritualization of sensuality is called love: it is a great triumph over Christianity. A further triumph is our spiritualization of enmity. It consists in profoundly grasping the value of having enemies: in brief, in acting and thinking in the reverse of the way in which one formerly acted and thought. The Church has at all times desired the destruction of its enemies: we, we immoralists and antiChristians, see that it is to our advantage that the Church exist.... In politics, too, enmity has become much more spiritual – much more prudent, much more thoughtful, much more forbearing. Almost every party grasps that it is in the interest of its own self-preservation that the opposing

party should not decay in strength; the same is true of grand politics. A new creation in particular, the new Reich for instance, has more need of enemies than friends: only in opposition does it feel itself necessary, only in opposition does it become necessary.... We adopt the same attitude towards the 'enemy within': there too we have spiritualized enmity, there too we have grasped its value. One is fruitful only at the cost of being rich in contradictions; one remains young only on condition the soul does not relax, does not long for peace.... Nothing has grown more alien to us than that desideratum of former times 'peace of soul', the Christian desideratum; nothing arouses less envy in us than the moral cow and the fat contentment of the good conscience.... One has renounced grand life when one renounces war.... In many cases, to be sure, 'peace of soul' is merely a misunderstanding - something else that simply does not know how to give itself a more honest name. Here, briefly and without prejudice, are a few of them. 'Peace of soul' can, for example, be the gentle radiation of a rich animality into the moral (or religious) domain. Or the beginning of weariness, the first of the shadows which evening, every sort of evening, casts. Or a sign that the air is damp, that south winds are on the way. Or unconscious gratitude for a good digestion (sometimes called 'philanthropy'). Or the quiescence of the convalescent for whom all things have a new taste and who waits.... Or the condition which succeeds a vigorous gratification of our ruling passion, the pleasant feeling of a rare satiety. Or the decrepitude of our will, our desires, our vices. Or laziness persuaded by vanity to deck itself out as morality. Or the appearance of a certainty, even a dreadful certainty, after the protracted tension and torture of uncertainty. Or the expression of ripeness and mastery in the midst of action, creation, endeavour, volition, a quiet breathing, 'freedom of will' attained.... Twilight of the Idols: who

knows? perhaps that too is only a kind of 'peace of soul'...

§4

- I formulate a principle. All naturalism in morality, that is all healthy morality, is dominated by an instinct of life - some commandment of life is fulfilled through a certain canon of 'shall' and 'shall not', some hindrance and hostile element on life's road is thereby removed. Anti-natural morality, that is virtually every morality that has hitherto been taught, revered and preached, turns on the contrary precisely against the instincts of life - it is a now secret, now loud and impudent condemnation of these instincts. By saying 'God sees into the heart' it denies the deepest and the highest desires of life and takes God for

the enemy of life.... The saint in whom God takes pleasure is the ideal castrate.... Life is at an end where the 'kingdom of God' begins...

§5

If one has grasped the blasphemousness of such a rebellion against life as has, in Christian morality, become virtually sacrosanct, one has fortunately therewith grasped something else as well: the uselessness, illusoriness, absurdity, falsity of such a rebellion. For a condemnation of life by the living is after all no more than the symptom of a certain kind of life: the question whether the condemnation is just or unjust has not been raised at all. One would have to be situated outside life, and on the other hand to know it as thoroughly as any, as many, as all who have experienced it, to be permitted to touch on the problem of the value of life at all: sufficient reason for understanding that this problem is for us an inaccessible problem. When we speak of values we do so under the inspiration and from the perspective of life: life itself evaluates through us when we establish values.... From this it follows that even that anti-nature of a morality which conceives God as the contrary concept to and condemnation of life is only a value judgement on the part of life – of what life? of what kind of life? – But I have already given the answer: of declining, debilitated, weary, condemned life. Morality as it has been understood hitherto – as it was ultimately formulated by Schopenhauer as 'denial of the will to life' – is the instinct of *décadence* itself, which makes out of itself an imperative: it says: 'Perish!' – it is the judgement of the judged...

§6

Let us consider finally what naïvety it is to say 'man ought to be thus and thus!' Reality shows us an enchanting wealth of types, the luxuriance of a prodigal play and change of forms: and does some pitiful journeyman moralist say at the sight of it: 'No! man ought to be different'?... He even knows how man ought to be, this

bigoted wretch; he paints himself on the wall and says 'ecce homo'!*... But even when the moralist merely turns to the individual and says to him: 'You ought to be thus and thus' he does not cease to make himself ridiculous. The individual is, in his future and in his past, a piece of fate, one law more, one necessity more for everything that is and everything that will be. To say to him 'change yourself' means to demand that everything should change, even in the past.... And there have indeed been consistent moralists who wanted man to be different, namely virtuous, who wanted him in their own likeness, namely that of a bigot: to that end they denied the world! No mean madness! No modest

presumption!... In so far as morality condemns as morality and not with regard to the aims and objects of life, it is a specific error with which one should show no sympathy, an idiosyncrasy of the degenerate which has caused an unspeakable amount of harm!... We others, we immoralists, have on the contrary opened wide our hearts to every kind of understanding, comprehension, approval. We do not readily deny, we seek our honour in affirming. We have come more and more to appreciate that economy which needs and knows how to use all that which the holy lunacy of the priest, the diseased reason of the priest rejects; that economy in the law of life which derives advantage even from the repellent species of the bigot, the priest, the virtuous man – what advantage? – But we ourselves, we immoralists, are the answer to that...

The Four Great Errors

§1

The error of confusing cause and consequence. – There is no more dangerous error than that of mistaking the consequence for the cause: I call it reason's intrinsic form of corruption. None the less, this error is among the most ancient and most recent habits of mankind: it is even sanctified among us, it bears the names 'religion' and 'morality'. Every proposition formulated by religion and morality contains it; priests and moral legislators are the authors of this corruption of reason. – I adduce an example. Everyone knows the book of the celebrated Cornaro in which he recommends his meagre diet as a recipe for a long and happy life – a virtuous one, too. Few books have been so widely read; even now many thousands of copies are printed in England every year. I do not doubt that hardly any book (the Bible rightly excepted) has done so much harm, has shortened so many lives, as this curiosity, which was so well meant. The reason: mistaking the consequence for the cause. The worthy Italian saw in his diet the cause of his long life: while the prerequisite of long life, an extraordinarily slow metabolism, a small consumption, was the cause of his meagre diet. He was not free to eat much or little as he chose, his frugality was not an act of 'free will': he became ill when he ate more. But if one is not a bony fellow of this sort one does not merely do well, one positively needs to eat properly. A scholar of our day, with his rapid consumption of nervous energy, would kill himself with Cornaro's regimen. Credo experto. –

§2

The most general formula at the basis of every religion and morality is: 'Do this and this, refrain from this and this – and you will be happy! Otherwise....' Every

morality, every religion is this imperative – I call it the great original sin of reason, immortal unreason. In my mouth this formula is converted into its reverse – first example of my ‘revaluation of all values’: a well-constituted human being, a ‘happy one’, must perform certain actions and instinctively shrinks from other actions, he transports the order of which he is the physiological representative into his relations with other human beings and with things. In a formula: his virtue is the consequence of his happiness.... Long life, a plentiful posterity is not the reward of virtue, virtue itself is rather just that slowing down of the metabolism which also has, among other things, a long life, a plentiful posterity, in short Cornarism, as its outcome. – The Church and morality say: ‘A race, a people perishes through vice and luxury’. My restored reason says: when a people is perishing, degenerating physiologically, vice and luxury (that is to say the necessity for stronger and

stronger and more and more frequent stimulants, such as every exhausted nature is acquainted with) follow therefrom. A young man grows prematurely pale and faded. His friends say: this and that illness is to blame. I say: that he became ill, that he failed to resist the illness, was already the consequence of an impoverished life, an hereditary exhaustion. The newspaper reader says: this party will ruin itself if it makes errors like this. My higher politics says: a party which makes errors like this is already finished – it is no longer secure in its instincts. Every error, of whatever kind, is a consequence of degeneration of instinct, disgregation of will: one has thereby virtually defined the bad. Everything good is instinct – and consequently easy, necessary, free. Effort is an objection, the god is typically distinguished from the hero (in my language: light feet are the first attribute of divinity).

§3

The error of a false causality. – We have always believed we know what a cause is: but whence did we derive our knowledge, more precisely our belief we possessed this knowledge? From the realm of the celebrated ‘inner facts’, none of which has up till now been shown to be factual. We believed ourselves to be causal agents in the act of willing; we at least thought we were there catching causality in the act. It was likewise never doubted that all the antecedentia of an action, its causes, were to be sought in the consciousness and could be discovered there if one sought them – as ‘motives’: for otherwise one would not have been free to perform it, responsible for it. Finally, who would have disputed that a thought is caused? that the ego causes the thought?... Of these three ‘inner facts’ through which causality seemed to be guaranteed the first and most convincing was that of will as cause; the conception of a

consciousness ('mind') as cause and later still that of the ego (the 'subject') as cause are merely after-products after causality had, on the basis of will, been firmly established as a given fact, as empiricism.... Meanwhile, we have thought better. Today we do not believe a word of it. The 'inner world' is full of phantoms and false lights: the will is one of them. The will no longer moves anything, consequently no longer explains anything - it merely accompanies events, it can also be absent. The so-called 'motive': another error. Merely a surface phenomenon of consciousness, an accompaniment to an act, which conceals rather than exposes the antecedentia of the act. And as for the ego! It has become a fable, a fiction, a play on words: it has totally ceased to think, to feel and to will!... What follows from this? There are no spiritual causes at all! The whole of the alleged empiricism which affirmed them has gone to the devil! That is what follows! - And we had made a nice misuse of that 'empiricism', we had created the world on the basis of it as a world of causes, as a world of will, as a world of spirit. The oldest and longest-lived psychology was at work here - indeed it has done nothing else:

every event was to it an action, every action the effect of a will, the world became for it a multiplicity of agents, an agent ('subject') foisted itself upon every event. Man projected his three 'inner facts', that in which he believed more firmly than in anything else, will, spirit, ego, outside himself - he derived the concept 'being' only from the concept 'ego', he posited 'things' as possessing being according to his own image, according to his concept of the ego as cause. No wonder he later always discovered in things only that which he had put into them! -The thing itself, to say it again, the concept 'thing' is merely a reflection of the belief in the ego as cause. ... And even your atom, messieurs mechanists and physicists, how much error, how much rudimentary psychology, still remains in your atom! - To say nothing of the 'thing in itself',* that horrendum pudendum† of the metaphysicians! The error of spirit as cause mistaken for reality! And made the measure of reality! And called God! -

§4

The error of imaginary causes. - To start from the dream: on to a certain sensation, the result for example of a distant cannon-shot, a cause is subsequently foisted (often a whole little novel in which precisely the dreamer is the chief character). The sensation, meanwhile, continues to persist, as a kind of resonance: it waits, as it were, until the cause-creating drive permits it to step into the foreground - now no longer as a chance occurrence but as 'meaning'. The cannon-shot enters in a causal way, in an apparent inversion of time. That which comes later, the motivation, is experienced first, often with a

hundred details which pass like lightning, the shot follows.... What has happened? The ideas engendered by a certain condition have been misunderstood as the cause of that condition. – We do just the same thing, in fact, when we are awake. Most of our general feelings – every sort of restraint, pressure, tension, explosion in the play and counter-play of our organs, likewise and especially the condition of the nervus sympathicus – excite our cause-creating drive: we want to have a reason for feeling as we do – for feeling well or for feeling ill. It never suffices us simply to establish the mere fact that we feel as we do: we acknowledge this fact – become conscious of it – only when we have furnished it with a motivation of some kind. – The memory, which in such a case becomes active without our being aware of it, calls up earlier states of a similar kind and the causal interpretations which have grown out of them – not their causality. To be sure, the belief that these ideas, the accompanying occurrences in the consciousness, were causes is also brought up by the memory. Thus there arises an habituation to a certain causal interpretation which in truth obstructs and even prohibits an investigation of the cause.

§5

Psychological explanation. – To trace something unknown back to something known is alleviating, soothing, gratifying and gives moreover a feeling of power. Danger, disquiet, anxiety attend the unknown – the first instinct is to eliminate these distressing states. First principle: any explanation is better than none. Because it is at bottom only a question of wanting to get rid of oppressive ideas, one is not exactly particular about what means one uses to get rid of them: the first idea which explains that the unknown is in fact the known does so much good that one ‘holds it for true’. Proof by pleasure (‘by potency’) as criterion of truth. – The cause-creating drive is thus conditioned and excited by the feeling of fear. The question ‘why?’ should furnish, if at all possible, not so much the cause for its own sake as a certain kind of cause – a soothing, liberating, alleviating cause. That something already known, experienced, inscribed in the memory is posited as cause is the first consequence of this need. The new, the unexperienced, the strange is excluded from being cause. – Thus there is sought not only some kind of explanation as cause, but a selected and preferred kind of explanation, the kind by means of which the feeling of the strange, new, unexperienced is most speedily and most frequently abolished – the most common explanations. – Consequence: a particular kind of cause-ascription comes to preponderate more and more, becomes concentrated into a system and finally comes to dominate over the rest, that is to say simply to exclude other causes and explanations. – The banker thinks at once of ‘business’, the Christian of ‘sin’, the girl of her love.

§6

The entire realm of morality and religion falls under this concept of imaginary causes. – ‘Explanation’ of unpleasant general feelings. They arise from beings hostile to us (evil spirits: most celebrated case – hysterics misunderstood as witches). They arise from actions we cannot approve of (the feeling of ‘sin’, of ‘culpability’ foisted upon a physiological discomfort – one always finds reasons for being discontented with oneself). They arise as punishments, as payment for something we should not have done, should not have been (generalized in an impudent form by Schopenhauer into a proposition in which morality appears for what it is, the actual poisoner and calumniator of life: ‘Every great pain, whether physical or mental, declares what it is we deserve; for it could not have come upon us if we had not deserved it.’ *World as Will and Idea* II 666). They arise as the consequences of rash actions which have turned out badly (– the emotions, the senses assigned as ‘cause’, as ‘to blame’; physiological states of distress construed, with the aid of other states of distress, as ‘deserved’). – ‘Explanation’ of pleasant general feelings. They arise from trust in God. They arise from the consciousness of good actions (the so-called ‘good conscience’, a physiological condition sometimes

so like a sound digestion as to be mistaken for it). They arise from the successful outcome of undertakings (– naïve fallacy: the successful outcome of an undertaking certainly does not produce any pleasant general feelings in a hypochondriac or a Pascal). They arise from faith, hope and charity – the Christian virtues. – In reality all these supposed explanations are consequential states and as it were translations of pleasurable and unpleasurable feelings into a false dialect: one is in a state in which one can experience hope because the physiological basic feeling is once more strong and ample; one trusts in God because the feeling of plenitude and strength makes one calm. – Morality and religion fall entirely under the psychology of error: in every single case cause is mistaken for effect; or the effect of what is believed true is mistaken for the truth; or a state of consciousness is mistaken for the causation of this state.

§7

The error of free will. – We no longer have any sympathy today with the concept of ‘free will’: we know only too well what it is – the most infamous of all the arts of the theologian for making mankind ‘accountable’ in his sense of the word, that is to say for making mankind dependent on him.... I give here only the psychology of making men accountable. – Everywhere accountability is sought, it is usually the instinct for punishing and judging which seeks it. One

has deprived becoming of its innocence if being in this or that state is traced back to will, to intentions, to accountable acts: the doctrine of will has been invented essentially for the purpose of punishment, that is of finding guilty. The whole of the old-style psychology, the psychology of will, has as its precondition the desire of its authors, the priests at the head of the ancient communities, to create for themselves a right to ordain punishments – or their desire to create for God a right to do so.... Men were thought of as ‘free’ so that they could become guilty: consequently, every action had to be thought of as willed, the origin of every action as lying in the consciousness (– whereby the most fundamental falsification in psychology was made into the very principle of psychology).... Today, when we have started to move in the reverse direction, when we immoralists especially are trying with all our might to remove the concept of guilt and the concept of punishment from the world and to purge psychology, history, nature, the social institutions and sanctions of them, there is in our eyes no more radical opposition than that of the theologians, who continue to infect the innocence of becoming with ‘punishment’ and ‘guilt’ by means of the concept of the ‘moral world-order’. Christianity is a hangman’s metaphysics...

§1

One knows my demand of philosophers that they place themselves beyond good and evil – that they have the illusion of moral judgement beneath them. This demand follows from an insight first formulated by me: that there are no moral facts whatever. Moral judgement has this in common with religious judgement that it believes in realities which do not exist. Morality is only an interpretation of certain phenomena, more precisely a misinterpretation. Moral judgement belongs, as does religious judgement, to a level of ignorance at which even the concept of the real, the distinction between the real and the imaginary, is lacking: so that at such a level ‘truth’ denotes nothing but things which we today call ‘imaginings’. To this extent moral judgement is never to be taken literally: as such it never contains anything but nonsense. But as semeiotics it remains of incalculable value: it reveals, to the informed man at least, the most precious realities of cultures and inner worlds which did not know enough to ‘understand’ themselves. Morality is merely signlanguage, merely symptomatology: one must already know what it is about to derive profit from it.

§2

A first example, merely as an introduction. In all ages one has wanted to ‘improve’ men: this above all is what morality has meant. But one word can

conceal the most divergent tendencies. Both the taming of the beast man and the breeding of a certain species of man has been called 'improvement': only these zoological termini express realities – realities, to be sure, of which the typical 'improver', the priest, knows nothing – wants to know nothing.... To call the taming of an animal its 'improvement' is in our ears almost a joke. Whoever knows what goes on in menageries is doubtful whether the beasts in them are 'improved'. They are weakened, they are made less harmful, they become sickly beasts through the depressive emotion of fear, through pain, through injuries, through hunger. – It is no different with the tamed human being whom the priest has 'improved'. In the early Middle Ages, when the Church was in fact above all a menagerie, one everywhere hunted down the fairest specimens of the 'blond beast'* – one 'improved', for example, the noble Teutons. But what did such a Teuton afterwards look like when he had been 'improved' and led into a monastery? Like a caricature of a human being, like an abortion: he had become a 'sinner', he was in a cage, one had imprisoned him behind nothing but sheer terrifying concepts.... There he lay now, sick, miserable, filled with ill-will towards himself; full of hatred for the

impulses towards life, full of suspicion of all that was still strong and happy. In short, a 'Christian'.... In physiological terms: in the struggle with the beast, making it sick can be the only means of making it weak. This the Church understood: it corrupted the human being, it weakened him – but it claimed to have 'improved' him...

§3

Let us take the other aspect of so-called morality, the breeding of a definite race and species. The most grandiose example of this is provided by Indian morality, sanctioned, as the 'Law of Manu', into religion. Here the proposed task is to breed no fewer than four races simultaneously: a priestly, a warrior, and a trading and farming race, and finally a menial race, the Sudras. Here we are manifestly no longer among animal-tamers: a species of human being a hundred times more gentle and rational is presupposed even to conceive the plan of such a breeding. One draws a breath of relief when coming out of the Christian sick-house and dungeon atmosphere into this healthier, higher, wider world. How paltry the 'New Testament' is compared with Manu, how ill it smells! – But this organization too needed to be dreadful – this time in struggle not with the beast but with its antithesis, with the non-bred human being, the hotchpotch human being, the Chandala.* And again it had no means of making him weak and harmless other than making him sick – it was the struggle with the 'great majority'. Perhaps there is nothing which outrages our feelings more

than these protective measures of Indian morality. The third edict, for example (Avadana-Shastra I), that 'concerning unclean vegetables', ordains that the only nourishment permitted the Chandala shall be garlic and onions, in view of the fact that holy scripture forbids one to give them corn or seed-bearing fruits or water or fire. The same edict lays it down that the water they need must not be taken from rivers or springs or pools, but only from the entrances to swamps and holes made by the feet of animals. They are likewise forbidden to wash their clothes or to wash themselves, since the water allowed them as an act of charity must be used only for quenching the thirst. Finally, the Sudra women are forbidden to assist the Chandala women in childbirth, and the latter are likewise forbidden to assist one another.... - The harvest of such hygienic regulations did not fail to appear: murderous epidemics, hideous venereal diseases and, as a consequence, 'the law of the knife' once more, ordaining circumcision for the male and removal of the labia minora for the female children. - Manu himself says: 'The Chandala are the fruit of adultery, incest and crime' (- this being the necessary consequence of the concept 'breeding'). 'They shall have for clothing only rags from corpses, for utensils broken pots, for ornaments old iron, for worship only evil spirits; they shall wander from place to place without rest. They are

forbidden to write from left to right and to use the right hand for writing: the employment of the right hand and of the left-to-right motion is reserved for the virtuous, for people of race.' -

§4

These regulations are instructive enough: in them we find for once Aryan humanity, quite pure, quite primordial - we learn that the concept 'pure blood' is the opposite of a harmless concept. It becomes clear, on the other hand, in which people the hatred, the Chandala hatred for this 'humanity' has been immortalized, where it has become religion, where it has become genius.... From this point of view, the Gospels are documents of the first rank; the Book of Enoch even more so. - Christianity, growing from Jewish roots and comprehensible only as a product of this soil,* represents the reaction against that morality of breeding, of race, of privilege - it is the anti-Aryan religion par excellence: Christianity the revaluation of all Aryan values, the victory of Chandala values, the evangel preached to the poor and lowly, the collective rebellion of everything downtrodden, wretched, illconstituted, under-privileged against the 'race' - undying Chandala revenge as the religion of love...

§5

The morality of breeding and the morality of taming are, in the means they employ to attain their ends, entirely worthy of one another: we may set down as our chief proposition that to make morality one must have the unconditional will to the contrary. This is the great, the uncanny problem which I have pursued furthest: the psychology of the 'improvers' of mankind. A small and really rather modest fact, that of so-called *pia fraus*,[†] gave me my first access to this problem: *pia fraus*, the heritage of all philosophers and priests who have 'improved' mankind. Neither Manu nor Plato, neither Confucius nor the Jewish and Christian teachers, ever doubted their right to tell lies. Nor did they doubt their possession of other rights.... Expressed in a formula one might say: every means hitherto employed with the intention of making mankind moral has been thoroughly immoral. -

What the Germans Lack

§1

Among Germans today it is not enough to possess spirit: one must also possess the presumption to possess it... Perhaps I know the Germans, perhaps I might even venture to address a few words to them. The new Germany represents a great quantity of inherited and inculcated ability, so that it may for a time be allowed even a lavish expenditure of its accumulated store of energy. It is not a high culture that has here gained ascendancy, even less a fastidious taste, a noble 'beauty' of the instincts, but more manly virtues than any other country of Europe can exhibit. A good deal of courage and respect for oneself, a good deal of self-confidence in social dealings and in the performance of reciprocal duties, a good deal of industriousness, a good deal of endurance - and an inherited moderation which requires the goad rather than the brake. I also add that here people can still obey without being humiliated by obeying.... And no one despises his adversary... You will see I want to be just to the Germans: I would not like to be untrue to myself in this - so I must also tell them what I object to. Coming to power is a costly business: power makes stupid.... The Germans - once they were called the nation of thinkers: do they still think at all? Nowadays the Germans are bored with intellect, the Germans mistrust intellect, politics devours all seriousness for really intellectual things - Deutschland, Deutschland über alles was, I fear, the end of German philosophy.... 'Are there any German philosophers? are there any German poets? are there any good German books?' - people ask me abroad. I blush; but with the courage which is mine even in desperate cases I answer: 'Yes, Bismarck!' - Dare I go so far as to confess which books are read nowadays?... Confounded instinct of mediocrity! -

§2

- Who has not pondered sadly over what the German spirit could be! But this nation has deliberately made itself stupid, for practically a thousand years: nowhere else are the two great European narcotics, alcohol and Christianity, so viciously abused. Lately even a third has been added, one which is capable by itself of completely obstructing all delicate and audacious flexibility of spirit: music, our constipated, constipating German music. - How much dreary heaviness, lameness, dampness, sloppiness, how much beer there is in the German intellect! How can it possibly happen that young men who dedicate their existence to the most spiritual goals lack

all sense of the first instinct of spirituality, the spirit's instinct for self-preservation - and drink beer?... The alcoholism of scholarly youth perhaps does not constitute a question mark in regard to their erudition - one can be even a great scholar without possessing any spirit at all - but from any other point of view it remains a problem. - Where does one not find that bland degeneration which beer produces in the spirit! Once, in a case that has become almost famous, I laid my finger on such an instance of degeneration - the degeneration of our first German freethinker, the shrewd David Strauss, into the author of an alehouse gospel and a 'new faith'.... It was no vain vow he made in verse to the 'gracious brunette'* - fidelity unto death...

§3

- I have said of the German spirit that it is growing coarser, that it is growing shallow. Is that sufficient? - Fundamentally, it is something quite different which appals me: how German seriousness, German profundity, German passion in spiritual things is more and more on the decline. It is the pathos and not merely the intellectual aspect which has altered. - I come in contact now and then with German universities: what an atmosphere prevails among its scholars, what a barren spirituality, grown how contented and lukewarm! It would be a profound misunderstanding to adduce German science as an objection here, as well as being proof one had not read a word I have written. For seventeen years I have not wearied of exposing the despiritualizing influence of our contemporary scientific pursuits. The harsh Helot condition to which the tremendous extent of science has condemned every single person today is one of the main reasons why education and educators appropriate to fuller, richer, deeper natures are no longer forthcoming. Our culture suffers from nothing more than it suffers from the superabundance of presumptuous journeymen and fragments of humanity; our universities are, against their will, the actual forcing-houses for this kind of spiritual instinct-atrophy. And all

Europe already has an idea of this – grand politics deceives no one.... Germany counts more and more as Europe's flatland. – I am still looking for a German with whom I could be serious after my fashion – how much more for one with whom I might be cheerful! – Twilight of the Idols: ah, who today could grasp from how profound a seriousness a hermit is here relaxing! – The most incomprehensible thing about us is our cheerfulness...

§4

If one makes a reckoning, it is obvious not only that German culture is declining, the sufficient reason* for it is obvious too. After all, no one can spend more than he has – that is true of individuals, it is also true of nations. If one spends oneself on

power, grand politics, economic affairs, world commerce, parliamentary institutions, military interests – if one expends in this direction the quantum of reason, seriousness, will, self-overcoming that one is, then there will be a shortage in the other direction. Culture and the state – one should not deceive oneself over this – are antagonists: the 'cultural state' is merely a modern idea. The one lives off the other, the one thrives at the expense of the other. All great cultural epochs are epochs of political decline: that which is great in the cultural sense has been unpolitical, even anti-political.... Goethe's heart opened up at the phenomenon Napoleon – it closed up to the 'Wars of Liberation'.... The moment Germany rises as a great power, France gains a new importance as a cultural power. A great deal of current spiritual seriousness and passion has already emigrated to Paris; the question of pessimism, for instance, the Wagner question, virtually every psychological and artistic question, is speculated on with incomparably more subtlety and thoroughness there than in Germany – the Germans are even incapable of this kind of seriousness. – In the history of European culture the rise of the 'Reich' signifies one thing above all: a displacement of the centre of gravity. The fact is known everywhere: in the main thing – and that is still culture – the Germans no longer come into consideration. The question is asked: haven't you so much as one spirit who means something to Europe? in the way your Goethe, your Hegel, your Heinrich Heine, your Schopenhauer meant something? That there is no longer a single German philosopher – there is no end of astonishment at that. –

§5

The essential thing has gone out of the entire system of higher education in Germany: the end, as well as the means to the end. That education, culture, itself is the end – and not 'the Reich' – that educators are required for the

attainment of this end – and not grammar-school teachers and university scholars – that too has been forgotten.... There is a need for educators who are themselves educated; superior, noble spirits, who prove themselves every moment by what they say and by what they do not say: cultures grown ripe and sweet – and not the learned bores which grammar school and university offer youth today as ‘higher nurses’. Educators, the first prerequisite of education, are lacking (except for the exceptions of exceptions): hence the decline of German culture. – One of those rarest of exceptions is my honoured friend Jacob Burckhardt of Basel: it is to him above all that Basel owes its pre-eminence in the humanities. – What the ‘higher schools’ of Germany in fact achieve is a brutal breaking-in with the aim of making, in the least possible time, numberless young men fit to be utilized, utilized to the full and used up, in the state service. ‘Higher education’ and numberless – that is a contradiction to start with. All higher education belongs to the exceptions alone: one must be privileged to

have a right to so high a privilege. Great and fine things can never be common property: *pulchrum est paucorum hominum*.* – What is the cause of the decline of German culture? That ‘higher education’ is no longer a privilege – the democratism of ‘culture’ made ‘universal’ and common.... Not to overlook the fact that military privileges absolutely compel too great attendance at higher schools, which means their ruin. – No one is any longer free in present-day Germany to give his children a noble education: our ‘higher’ schools are one and all adjusted – as regards their teachers, their curricula and their instructional aims – to the most dubious mediocrity. And there reigns everywhere an indecent haste, as if something has been neglected if the young man of twenty-three is not yet ‘finished and ready’, does not yet know the answer to the ‘chief question’: which calling? – A higher kind of human being, excuse me for saying, doesn’t think much of ‘callings’, the reason being he knows himself called.... He takes his time, he has plenty of time, he gives no thought whatsoever to being ‘finished and ready’ – at the age of thirty one is, as regards high culture, a beginner, a child. – Our overcrowded grammar schools, our overloaded, stupified grammar-school teachers, are a scandal: one may perhaps have motives for defending this state of things, as the professors of Heidelberg recently did – there are no grounds for doing so.

§6

To be true to my nature, which is affirmative and has dealings with contradiction and criticism only indirectly and when compelled, I shall straightaway set down the three tasks for the sake of which one requires

educators. One has to learn to see, one has to learn to think, one has to learn to speak and write: the end in all three is a noble culture. – Learning to see – habituating the eye to repose, to patience, to letting things come to it; learning to defer judgement, to investigate and comprehend the individual case in all its aspects. This is the first preliminary schooling in spirituality: not to react immediately to a stimulus, but to have the restraining, stock-taking instincts in one's control. Learning to see, as I understand it, is almost what is called in unphilo-sophical language 'strong will-power': the essence of it is precisely not to 'will', the ability to defer decision. All unspirituality, all vulgarity, is due to the incapacity to resist a stimulus – one has to react, one obeys every impulse. In many instances, such a compulsion is already morbidity, decline, a symptom of exhaustion – almost everything which unphilosophical crudity designates by the name 'vice' is merely this physiological incapacity not to react – A practical application of having learned to see: one will have become slow, mistrustful, resistant as a learner in general. In an attitude of hostile calm one will allow the strange, the novel of every kind to approach one first – one will draw one's hand back from it. To stand with all doors open, to prostrate

oneself submissively before every petty fact, to be ever itching to mingle with, plunge into other people and other things, in short our celebrated modern 'objectivity', is bad taste, is ignoble par excellence. –

§7

Learning to think: our schools no longer have any idea what this means. Even in our universities, even among students of philosophy themselves, the theory, the practice, the vocation of logic is beginning to die out. Read German books: no longer the remotest recollection that a technique, a plan of instruction, a will to mastery is required for thinking – that thinking has to be learned in the way dancing has to be learned, as a form of dancing.... Who among Germans still knows from experience that subtle thrill which the possession of intellectual light feet communicates to all the muscles! – A stiffly awkward air in intellectual matters, a clumsy hand in grasping – this is in so great a degree German that foreigners take it for the German nature in general. The German has no fingers for nuances.... That the Germans have so much as endured their philosophers, above all that most deformed conceptual cripple there has ever been, the great Kant, offers a good idea of German amenableness. For dancing in any form cannot be divorced from a noble education, being able to dance with the feet, with concepts, with words: do I still have to say that one has to be able to dance with the pen – that writing has to be learned? – But at this point I should become a complete enigma to German readers...

§1

My impossibles. – Seneca: or the toreador of virtue. – Rousseau: or the return to nature in *impuris naturalibus** – Schiller: or the Moral-Trumpeter of Säckingen.† – Dante: or the hyena which poetises on graves. – Kant: or cant as intelligible character. – Victor Hugo: or the Pharos in the Sea of Absurdity. – Liszt: or the virtuoso – with women.‡ – George Sand: or *lactea ubertas*,§ in English: the milch cow with the ‘fine style’. – Michelet: or enthusiasm which strips off the jacket. – Carlyle: or pessimism as indigestion. – John Stuart Mill: or offensive clarity. – Les frères de Goncourt: or the two Ajaxes struggling with Homer. Music by Offenbach. Zola: or ‘delight in stinking’. –

§2

Renan. – Theology, or the corruption of reason by ‘original sin’ (Christianity). Witness: Renan, who, whenever he risks a more general Yes or No, misses the point with painful regularity. He would like, for instance, to couple together *la science* and *la noblesse*; but *la science* belongs to democracy, that is patently obvious. He desires, with no little ambitiousness, to represent an aristocratism of the intellect: but at the same time he falls on his knees, and not only his knees, before its opposite, the *évangile des humbles*.... What avails all free thinking, modernity, mockery and wry-necked flexibility, if one is still Christian, Catholic and even priest in one’s bowels! Renan possesses his mode of inventiveness, just like a Jesuit or a father confessor, in devising means of seduction; his intellectuality does not lack the broad priestly smirk – like all priests, he becomes dangerous only when he loves. Nobody can equal him in deadly adoration.... This spirit of Renan, an enervating spirit, is one fatality more for poor, sick, feeble-willed France. –

§3

Sainte-Beuve. – Nothing masculine in him; full of petty sullen wrath against all masculine spirit. Roams about, delicate, inquisitive, bored, eavesdropping – fundamentally a woman, with a woman’s revengefulness and a woman’s sensuousness. As psychologist a genius of, *médiance*;* inexhaustibly rich in means for creating it; no one knows better how to mix poison with praise. Plebeian in the lowest instincts and related to Rousseau’s resentment: consequently a romantic – for beneath all *romantisme* there grunts and thirsts Rousseau’s instinct for revenge. A revolutionary, but kept tolerably in check by fear. Constrained in presence of

everything possessing strength (public opinion, the Academy, the Court, even PortRoyal).† Embittered against all that is great in men and things, against all that believes in itself. Enough of a poet and semi-woman to feel greatness as power; constantly cringing, like the celebrated worm, because he constantly feels himself trodden on. As a critic without standards, steadiness or backbone, possessing the palate for a large variety of things of the cosmopolitan libertin but lacking the courage even to admit his libertinage. As a historian without philosophy, without the power of philosophical vision – for that reason rejecting, in all the main issues, the task of passing judgement, holding up ‘objectivity’ as a mask. He comports himself differently, however, towards questions in which a delicate, experienced taste is the highest court of appeal: there he really does have the courage for himself, takes pleasure in himself – there he is a master. – In some respects a preliminary form of Baudelaire. –

§4

The *Imitatio Christi** is one of the books I cannot hold in my hand without experiencing a physiological resistance: it exhales a parfum of the ‘eternal feminine’† for which one has to be French – or a Wagnerian.... This saint has a way of talking about love that makes even Parisiennes curious. – I am told that cunningest of Jesuits, A. Comte, who wanted to lead his Frenchmen to Rome via the détour of science, inspired himself with this book. I believe it: ‘the religion of the heart’...

§5

G. Eliot. – They have got rid of the Christian God, and now feel obliged to cling all the more firmly to Christian morality: that is English consistency, let us not blame it on little bluestockings à la Eliot. In England, in response to every little emancipation from theology one has to reassert one’s position in a fear-inspiring manner as a moral fanatic. That is the penance one pays there. – With us it is different. When one gives up Christian belief one thereby deprives oneself of the right to Christian morality. For the latter is absolutely not self-evident: one must make this point clear again and again, in spite of English shallowpates. Christianity is a system, a consistently thought out and complete view of things. If one breaks out of it a fundamental idea, the belief in God, one thereby breaks the whole thing to pieces: one has nothing of any consequence left in one’s hands. Christianity presupposes that man does not know, cannot know what is good for him and what evil: he believes in God, who alone knows. Christian morality is a command: its origin is transcendental; it is beyond all criticism, all right to criticize; it possesses truth only if God is truth – it stands or falls with the belief in God. – If the English

really do believe they will know, of their own accord, 'intuitively', what is good and evil; if they consequently think they no longer have need of Christianity as a guarantee of morality; that is merely the consequence of the ascendancy of Christian evaluation and an expression of the strength and depth of this ascendancy: so that the origin of English morality has been forgotten, so that the highly conditional nature of its right to exist is no longer felt. For the Englishman morality is not yet a problem...

§6

George Sand. - I have read the first *Lettres d'un voyageur*: like everything deriving from Rousseau false, artificial, fustian, exaggerated. I cannot endure this colouredwallpaper style; nor the vulgar ambition to possess generous feelings. The worst, to be sure, is the female coquetting with male mannerisms, with the manners of illbred boys. - How cold she must have been withal, this insupportable authoress! She wound herself up like a clock - and wrote.... Cold, like Hugo, like Balzac, like all Romantics as soon as they started writing! And how complacently she liked to lie there, this prolific writing-cow, who had something German in the bad sense about her, like Rousseau her master, and who was in any case possible only with the decline of French taste! - But Renan respects her...

§7

Moral code for psychologists. - No colportage psychology! Never observe for the sake of observing! That produces a false perspective, a squint, something forced and exaggerated. To experience from a desire to experience - that's no good. In experiencing, one must not look back towards oneself, or every glance becomes an 'evil eye'. A born psychologist instinctively guards against seeing for the sake of seeing; the same applies to the born painter. He never works 'from nature' - he leaves it to his instinct, his camera obscura, to sift and strain 'nature', the 'case', the 'experience'.... He is conscious only of the universal, the conclusion, the outcome: he knows nothing of that arbitrary abstraction from the individual case. - What will be the result if one does otherwise? Carries on colportage psychology in, for example, the manner of Parisian romanciers great and small? It is that sort of thing which as it were lies in wait for reality, which brings a handful of curiosities home each evening.... But just see what finally emerges - a pile of daubs, a mosaic at best, in any event something put together, restless, flashy. The worst in this kind is achieved by the Goncourts: they never put three sentences together which are not simply painful to the eye, the psychologist's eye. - Nature, artistically considered, is no model. It exaggerates, it distorts, it leaves gaps. Nature is chance. To study

'from nature' seems to me a bad sign: it betrays subjection, weakness, fatalism
-

this lying in the dust before *petits faits** is unworthy of a complete artist. Seeing what is - that pertains to a different species of spirit, the anti-artistic, the prosaic. One has to know who one is...

§1

In conclusion, a word on that world into which I have sought to find a way, into which I have perhaps found a new way - the ancient world. My taste, which may be called the opposite of a tolerant taste, is even here far from uttering a wholesale Yes: in general it dislikes saying Yes, it would rather say No, most of all it prefers to say nothing at all.... This applies to entire cultures, it applies to books - it also applies to towns and countrysides. It is really only quite a small number of books of antiquity which count for anything in my life; the most famous are not among them. My sense of style, of the epigram as style, was awoken almost instantaneously on coming into contact with Sallust. I have not forgotten the astonishment of my honoured teacher Corsen when he had to give top marks to his worst Latin scholar - I had done all in a single blow. Compact, severe, with as much substance as possible, a cold malice towards 'fine words', also towards 'fine feelings' - in that I knew myself. One will recognize in my writings, even in my Zarathustra, a very serious ambition for Roman style, for the '*aera perennius*'* in style. - I had the same experience on first coming into contact with Horace. From that day to this no poet has given me the same artistic delight as I derived from the very first from an Horatian ode. In certain languages what is achieved here is not even desirable. This mosaic of words in which every word, as sound, as locus, as concept, pours forth its power to left and right and over the whole, this minimum in the range and number of signs which achieves a maximum of energy of these signs - all this is Roman and, if one will believe me, noble par excellence. All other poetry becomes by comparison somewhat too popular - a mere emotional garrulousness...

§2

I received absolutely no such strong impressions from the Greeks; and, not to mince words, they cannot be to us what the Romans are. One does not learn from the Greeks - their manner is too strange, it is also too fluid to produce an imperative, a 'classical' effect. Who would ever have learned to write from a Greek! Who would ever have learned it without the Romans!... Let no one offer me Plato as an objection. In respect to Plato I am a thorough sceptic and have

always been unable to join in the admiration of Plato the artist which is traditional among scholars. After all, I have here the most refined judges of taste of antiquity themselves on my side. It seems to me that Plato mixes together all forms of style; he is therewith in the matter of style a first decadent: he has on his conscience something similar to the Cynics who devised the Satura Menippea.* For the Platonic dialogue, that

frightfully self-satisfied and childish kind of dialectics, to operate as a stimulus one must never have read any good French writers – Fontenelle, for example. Plato is boring. – Ultimately my mistrust of Plato extends to the very bottom of him: I find him deviated so far from all the fundamental instincts of the Hellenes, so morally infected, so much an antecedent Christian – he already has the concept ‘good’ as the supreme concept – that I should prefer to describe the entire phenomenon ‘Plato’ by the harsh term ‘higher swindle’ or, if you prefer, ‘idealism’, than by any other. It has cost us dear that this Athenian went to school with the Egyptians (– or with the Jews in Egypt?...). In the great fatality of Christianity, Plato is that ambiguity and fascination called the ‘ideal’ which made it possible for the nobler natures of antiquity to misunderstand themselves and to step on to the bridge which led to the ‘Cross’.... And how much there still is of Plato in the concept ‘Church’, in the structure, system, practice of the Church! – My recreation, my preference, my cure from all Platonism has always been Thucydides. Thucydides, and perhaps the Principe of Machiavelli, are related to me closely by their unconditional will not to deceive themselves and not to see reason in reality – not in ‘reason’, still less in ‘morality’.... For the deplorable embellishment of the Greeks with the colours of the ideal which the ‘classically educated’ youth carries away with him into life as the reward of his grammar-school drilling there is no more radical cure than Thucydides. One must turn him over line by line and read his hidden thoughts as clearly as his words: there are few thinkers so rich in hidden thoughts. Sophist culture, by which I mean realist culture, attains in him its perfect expression – this invaluable movement in the midst of the morality-and-ideal swindle of the Socratic schools which was then breaking out everywhere. Greek philosophy as the decadence of the Greek instinct; Thucydides as the grand summation, the last manifestation of that strong, stern, hard matter-of-factness instinctive to the older Hellenes. Courage in face of reality ultimately distinguishes such natures as Thucydides and Plato: Plato is a coward in face of reality – consequently he flees into the ideal; Thucydides has himself under control – consequently he retains control over things...

From scenting out 'beautiful souls',* 'golden means' and other perfections in the Greeks, from admiring in them such things as their repose in grandeur, their ideal disposition, their sublime simplicity – from this 'sublime simplicity', a *niaiserie allemande*† when all is said and done, I was preserved by the psychologist in me. I saw their strongest instinct, the will to power, I saw them trembling at the intractable force of this drive – I saw all their institutions evolve out of protective measures designed for mutual security against the explosive material within them.

The tremendous internal tension then discharged itself in fearful and ruthless external hostility: the city states tore one another to pieces so that the citizens of each of them might find peace within himself. One needed to be strong: danger was close at hand – it lurked everywhere. The splendid supple physique, the reckless realism and immoralism which pertains to the Hellene was a necessity, not a 'natural quality'. It was produced, it was not there from the beginning. And one employed festivals and arts for no other purpose than to feel oneself dominant, to show oneself dominant: they are means for making oneself feared.... To judge the Greeks by their philosophers, in the German manner, perchance to employ the philistinism of the Socratic schools as a clue to what is fundamentally Hellenic!... But the philosophers are the *décadents* of Hellenism, the counter-movement against the old, the noble taste (– against the agonal instinct, against the polis, against the value of the race, against the authority of tradition). The Socratic virtues were preached because the Greeks had lost them: excitable, timid, fickle, comedians every one, they had more than enough reason to let morality be preached to them. Not that it would have done any good: but big words and fine attitudes are so suited to *décadents*...

§4

I was the first to take seriously that wonderful phenomenon which bears the name Dionysos as a means to understanding the older Hellenic instinct, an instinct still exuberant and even overflowing: it is explicable only as an excess of energy. Whoever has investigated the Greeks, such as that profoundest student of their culture now living, Jacob Burckhardt of Basel, realizes at once the value of this line of approach: Burckhardt inserted a special section on the said phenomenon into his *Culture of the Greeks*. For the opposite of this, one should take a look at the almost laughable poverty of instinct displayed by German philologists whenever they approach the Dionysian. The celebrated Lobeck especially, who crept into this world of mysterious states with the honest self-confidence of a dried-up bookworm and by being nauseously frivolous and childish persuaded himself he was being scientific – Lobeck

intimated, with a great display of erudition, that these curiosities were of no consequence. To be sure, the priests might have communicated a number of valuable pieces of information to the participants in such orgies – that wine arouses desire, for example, that man can live on fruit if need be, that plants bloom in spring and wither in autumn. As regards that strange wealth of rites, symbols and myths of orgiastic origin with which the antique world was quite literally overrun, Lobeck finds in them an occasion for becoming a trifle more ingenious. ‘When the Greeks had nothing else to do,’ he says (*Aglaophamus* I, 672), ‘they used to laugh, jump, race about, or, since man sometimes feels a desire

for this, they used to sit down and weep and wail. Others later came along and sought some reason for this striking behaviour; and thus those countless myths and legends arose to explain these practices. On the other hand, one believed that the droll activities which now took place on festival days necessarily pertained to festival celebration and retained them as an indispensable part of divine worship.’ – This is contemptible chatter and no one is likely to take a Lobeck seriously for a moment. We are affected quite differently when we probe the concept ‘Greek’ which Winckelmann and Goethe constructed for themselves and find it incompatible with that element out of which Dionysian art evolved – the orgy. I have, in fact, no doubt that Goethe would have utterly excluded anything of this kind from the possibilities of the Greek soul. Consequently Goethe did not understand the Greeks. For it is only in the Dionysian mysteries, in the psychology of the Dionysian condition, that the fundamental fact of the Hellenic instinct expresses itself – its ‘will to life’. What did the Hellene guarantee to himself with these mysteries? Eternal life, the eternal recurrence of life; the future promised and consecrated in the past; the triumphant Yes to life beyond death and change; true life as collective continuation of life through procreation, through the mysteries of sexuality. It was for this reason that the sexual symbol was to the Greeks the symbol venerable as such, the intrinsic profound meaning of all antique piety. Every individual detail in the act of procreation, pregnancy, birth, awoke the most exalted and solemn feelings. In the teachings of the mysteries, pain is sanctified: the ‘pains of childbirth’ sanctify pain in general – all becoming and growing, all that guarantees the future, postulates pain.... For the eternal joy in creating to exist, for the will to life eternally to affirm itself, the ‘torment of childbirth’ must also exist eternally.... All this is contained in the word Dionysos: I know of no more exalted symbolism than this Greek symbolism, the symbolism of the Dionysian. The profoundest instinct of life, the instinct for the future of life, for the eternity of life, is in this word experienced religiously – the actual road to life, procreation, as the sacred road.... It was only Christianity,

with resentment against life in its foundations, which made of sexuality something impure: it threw filth on the beginning, on the prerequisite of our life...

§5

The psychology of the orgy as an overflowing feeling of life and energy within which even pain acts as a stimulus provided me with the key to the concept of the tragic feeling, which was misunderstood as much by Aristotle as it especially was by our pessimists. Tragedy is so far from providing evidence for pessimism among the Hellenes in Schopenhauer's sense that it has to be considered the decisive repudiation of that idea and the counter-verdict to it. Affirmation of life even in its

strangest and sternest problems, the will to life rejoicing in its own inexhaustibility through the sacrifice of its highest types – that is what I called Dionysian, that is what I recognized as the bridge to the psychology of the tragic poet. Not so as to get rid of pity and terror, not so as to purify oneself of a dangerous emotion through its vehement discharge – it was thus Aristotle understood it – : but, beyond pity and terror, to realize in oneself the eternal joy of becoming – that joy which also encompasses joy in destruction.... And with that I again return to the place from which I set out – Birth of Tragedy was my first revaluation of all values: with that I again plant myself in the soil out of which I draw all that I will and can – I, the last disciple of the philosopher Dionysos – I, the teacher of the eternal recurrence...*

The Hammer Speaks 'Why so hard?' the charcoal once said to the diamond; 'for are we not close relations?' Why so soft? O my brothers, thus I ask you: for are you not – my brothers? Why so soft, unresisting and yielding? Why is there so much denial and abnegation in your hearts? So little fate in your glances? And if you will not be fates, if you will not be inexorable: how can you – conquer with me? And if your hardness will not flash and cut and cut to pieces: how can you one day – create with me? For all creators are hard. And it must seem bliss to you to press your hand upon millennia as upon wax, bliss to write upon the will of millennia as upon metal – harder than metal, nobler than metal. Only the noblest is perfectly hard. This new law-table do I put over you, O my brothers: Become hard!*

THE ANTI-CHRIST

Foreword This book belongs to the very few. Perhaps none of them is even living yet. Possibly they are the readers who understand my Zarathustra: how

could I confound myself with those for whom there are ears listening today? – Only the day after tomorrow belongs to me. Some are born posthumously. The conditions under which one understands me and then necessarily understands – I know them all too well. One must be honest in intellectual matters to the point of harshness to so much as endure my seriousness, my passion. One must be accustomed to living on mountains – to seeing the wretched ephemeral chatter of politics and national egoism beneath one. One must have become indifferent, one must never ask whether truth is useful or a fatality.... Strength which prefers questions for which no one today is sufficiently daring; courage for the forbidden; predestination for the labyrinth. An experience out of seven solitudes. New ears for new music. New eyes for the most distant things. A new conscience for truths which have hitherto remained dumb. And the will to economy in the grand style: to keeping one's energy, one's enthusiasm in bounds.... Reverence for oneself; love for oneself; unconditional freedom with respect to oneself... Very well! These alone are my readers, my rightful readers, my predestined readers: what do the rest matter? – The rest are merely mankind. – One must be superior to mankind in force, in loftiness of soul – in contempt... FRIEDRICH NIETZSCHE

§1

– Let us look one another in the face. We are Hyperboreans* – we know well enough how much out of the way we live. 'Neither by land nor by sea shalt thou find the road to the Hyperboreans': Pindar already knew that of us. Beyond the North, beyond the ice, beyond death – our life, our happiness.... We have discovered happiness, we know the road, we have found the exit out of whole millennia of labyrinth. Who else has found it? – Modern man perhaps? – 'I know not which way to turn; I am everything that knows not which way to turn' – sighs modern man.... It was from this modernity that we were ill – from lazy peace, from cowardly compromise, from the whole virtuous uncleanness of modern Yes and No. This tolerance and largeness of heart which 'forgives' everything because it 'Understands' everything is sirocco to us. Better to live among ice than among modern virtues and other south winds!... We were brave enough, we spared neither ourselves nor others: but for long we did not know where to apply our courage. We became gloomy, we were called fatalists. Our fatality – was the plenitude, the tension, the blocking-up of our forces. We thirsted for lightning and action, of all things we kept ourselves furthest from the happiness of the weaklings, from 'resignation'.... There was a thunderstorm in our air, the nature which we are grew dark – for we had no road. Formula of our happiness: a Yes, a No, a straight line, a goal...

§2

What is good? – All that heightens the feeling of power, the will to power, power itself in man. What is bad? – All that proceeds from weakness. What is happiness? – The feeling that power increases – that a resistance is overcome. Not contentment, but more power; not peace at all, but war; not virtue, but proficiency (virtue in the Renaissance style, virtù, virtue free of moral acid). The weak and ill-constituted shall perish: first principle of our philanthropy. And one shall help them to do so. What is more harmful than any vice? – Active sympathy for the ill-constituted and weak – Christianity...

§3

The problem I raise here is not what ought to succeed mankind in the sequence of

species (– the human being is a conclusion –): but what type of human being one ought to breed, ought to will, as more valuable, more worthy of life, more certain of the future. This more valuable type has existed often enough already: but as a lucky accident, as an exception, never as willed. He has rather been the most feared, he has hitherto been virtually the thing to be feared – and out of fear the reverse type has been willed, bred, achieved: the domestic animal, the herd animal, the sick animal man – the Christian...

§4

Mankind does not represent a development of the better or the stronger or the higher in the way that is believed today. 'Progress' is merely a modern idea, that is to say a false idea. The European of today is of far less value than the European of the Renaissance; onward development is not by any means, by any necessity the same thing as elevation, advance, strengthening. In another sense there are cases of individual success constantly appearing in the most various parts of the earth and from the most various cultures in which a higher type does manifest itself: something which in relation to collective mankind is a sort of superman. Such chance occurrences of great success have always been possible and perhaps always will be possible. And even entire races, tribes, nations can under certain circumstances represent such a lucky hit.

§5

One should not embellish or dress up Christianity: it has waged a war to the death against this higher type of man, it has excommunicated all the fundamental instincts of this type, it has distilled evil, the Evil One, out of these

instincts – the strong human being as the type of reprehensibility, as the ‘outcast’. Christianity has taken the side of everything weak, base, ill-constituted, it has made an ideal out of opposition to the preservative instincts of strong life; it has depraved the reason even of the intellectually strongest natures by teaching men to feel the supreme values of intellectuality as sinful, as misleading, as temptations. The most deplorable example: the depraving of Pascal, who believed his reason had been depraved by original sin while it had only been depraved by his Christianity! –

§6

It is a painful, a dreadful spectacle which has opened up before me: I have drawn back the curtain on the depravity of man. In my mouth this word is protected against at any rate one suspicion: that it contains a moral accusation of man. It is – I

should like to underline the fact again – free of any moralic acid: and this to the extent that I find that depravity precisely where hitherto one most consciously aspired to ‘virtue’, to ‘divinity’. I understand depravity, as will already have been guessed, in the sense of *décadence*: my assertion is that all the values in which mankind at present summarizes its highest desideratum are *décadence* values. I call an animal, a species, an individual depraved when it loses its instincts, when it chooses, when it prefers what is harmful to it. A history of the ‘higher feelings’, of the ‘ideals of mankind’ – and it is possible I shall have to narrate it – would almost also constitute an explanation of why man is so depraved. I consider life itself instinct for growth, for continuance, for accumulation of forces, for power: where the will to power is lacking there is decline. My assertion is that this will is lacking in all the supreme values of mankind – that values of decline, nihilistic values hold sway under the holiest names.

§7

Christianity is called the religion of pity. – Pity stands in antithesis to the tonic emotions which enhance the energy of the feeling of life: it has a depressive effect. One loses force when one pities. The loss of force which life has already sustained through suffering is increased and multiplied even further by pity. Suffering itself becomes contagious through pity; sometimes it can bring about a collective loss of life and life-energy which stands in an absurd relation to the quantum of its cause (– the case of the death of the Nazarene). This is the first aspect; but there is an even more important one. If one judges pity by the value of the reactions which it usually brings about, its mortally dangerous character

appears in a much clearer light. Pity on the whole thwarts the law of evolution, which is the law of selection. It preserves what is ripe for destruction; it defends life's disinherited and condemned; through the abundance of the ill-constituted of all kinds which it retains in life it gives life itself a gloomy and questionable aspect. One has ventured to call pity a virtue (- in every noble morality it counts as weakness -); one has gone further, one has made of it the virtue, the ground and origin of all virtue - only, to be sure, from the viewpoint of a nihilistic philosophy which inscribed Denial of Life on its escutcheon - a fact always to be kept in view. Schopenhauer was within his rights in this: life is denied, made more worthy of denial by pity - pity is practical nihilism. To say it again, this depressive and contagious instinct thwarts those instincts bent on preserving and enhancing the value of life: both as a multiplier of misery and as a conservator of everything miserable it is one of the chief instruments for the advancement of *décadence* - pity persuades to nothingness!... One does not say 'nothingness': one says 'the Beyond'; or 'God'; or 'true life'; or Nirvana, redemption, blessedness.... This innocent rhetoric from the domain of religio-moral

idiosyncrasy at once appears much less innocent when one grasps which tendency is here draping the mantle of sublime words about itself: the tendency hostile to life. Schopenhauer was hostile to life: therefore pity became for him a virtue.... Aristotle, as is well known, saw in pity a morbid and dangerous condition which one did well to get at from time to time with a purgative: he understood tragedy as a purgative. From the instinct for life one would indeed have to seek some means of puncturing so morbid and dangerous an accumulation of pity as that represented by the case of Schopenhauer (and unfortunately also by our entire literary and artistic *décadence* from St Petersburg to Paris, from Tolstoy to Wagner), so that it might burst.... Nothing in our unhealthy modernity is more unhealthy than Christian pity. To be physician here, to be inexorable here, to wield the knife here - that pertains to us, that is our kind of philanthropy, with that are we philosophers, we Hyperboreans! -

V.2 — Twilight of the Idols: Maxims and Arrows

TWILIGHT OF THE IDOLS, "MAXIMS AND ARROWS" (Translated by R.J. Hollingdale)

Selected maxims (§8, §12, §14, §31, §36, §38, §44)

§8. I have intimated the way in which Socrates could repel: it is therefore all the more necessary to explain the fact that he exercised fascination. – That he discovered a new kind of agon, that he was the first fencing-master in it for the aristocratic circles of Athens, is one reason. He fascinated because he touched on the agonal instinct of the Hellenes – he introduced a variation into the wrestling-matches among the youths and young men. Socrates was also a great erotic.

§12. – Did he himself grasp that, this shrewdest of all self-deceivers? Did he at last say that to himself in the wisdom of his courage for death?... Socrates wanted to die – it

was not Athens, it was he who handed himself the poison cup, who compelled Athens to hand him the poison cup.... ‘Socrates is no physician,’ he said softly to himself: ‘death alone is a physician here.... Socrates himself has only been a long time sick...’

‘Reason’ in Philosophy

§8. What alone can our teaching be? – That no one gives a human being his qualities: not God, not society, not his parents or ancestors, not he himself (– the nonsensical idea here last rejected was propounded, as ‘intelligible freedom’, by Kant, and perhaps also by Plato before him). No one is accountable for existing at all, or for being constituted as he is, or for living in the circumstances and surroundings in which he lives. The fatality of his nature cannot be disentangled from the fatality of all that which has been and will be. He is not the result of a special design, a will, a purpose; he is not the subject of an attempt to attain to an ‘ideal of man’ or an ‘ideal of happiness’ or an ‘ideal of morality’ – it is absurd to want to hand over his nature to some purpose or other. We invented the concept ‘purpose’: in reality purpose is lacking.... One is necessary, one is a piece of fate, one belongs to the whole, one is in the whole – there exists nothing which could judge, measure, compare, condemn our being, for that would be to judge, measure, compare, condemn the whole.... But nothing exists apart from the whole! – That no one is any longer made accountable, that the kind of being manifested cannot be traced back to a *causa prima** that the world is a unity neither as sensorium nor as ‘spirit’, this alone is the great liberation – thus alone is the innocence of becoming restored.... The concept ‘God’ has hitherto been

the greatest objection to existence.... We deny God; in denying God, we deny accountability: only by doing that do we redeem the world. –

The 'Improvers' of Mankind

§8. Towards a psychology of the artist. – For art to exist, for any sort of aesthetic activity or perception to exist, a certain physiological precondition is indispensable: intoxication. Intoxication must first have heightened the excitability of the entire machine: no art results before that happens. All kinds of intoxication, however different their origin, have the power to do this: above all, the intoxication of sexual excitement, the oldest and most primitive form of intoxication. Likewise the intoxication which comes in the train of all great desires, all strong emotions; the intoxication of feasting, of contest, of the brave deed, of victory, of all extreme agitation; the intoxication of cruelty; intoxication in destruction; intoxication under certain meteorological influences, for example the intoxication of spring; or under the influence of narcotics; finally the intoxication of the will, the intoxication of an overloaded and distended will. – The essence of intoxication is the feeling of plenitude and increased energy. From out of this feeling one gives to things, one compels them to take, one rapes them – one calls this procedure idealizing. Let us get rid of a prejudice here: idealization does not consist, as is commonly believed, in a subtracting or deducting of the petty and secondary. A tremendous expulsion of the principal features rather is the decisive thing, so that thereupon the others too disappear.

§12. I have read the life of Thomas Carlyle, that unwitting and involuntary farce, that heroical-moralistical interpretation of dyspepsia. – Carlyle, a man of strong words and attitudes, a rhetorician from necessity, continually agitated by the desire for a strong faith and the feeling of incapacity for it (– in this a typical Romantic!) The desire for a strong faith is not the proof of a strong faith, rather the opposite. If one has it one may permit oneself the beautiful luxury of scepticism: one is secure enough, firm enough, fixed enough for it. Carlyle deafens something within him by the fortissimo of his reverence for men of strong faith and by his rage against the less single-minded: he requires noise. A continual passionate dishonesty towards himself – that is his proprium, because of that he is and will remain interesting. – To be sure, in England he is admired precisely on account of his honesty.... Well, that is English; and, considering the English are the nation of consummate cant, even appropriate and not merely

understandable. Fundamentally, Carlyle is an English atheist who wants to be honoured for not being one.

§14. Anti-Darwin. – As regards the celebrated ‘struggle for life’, it seems to me for the present to have been rather asserted than proved. It does occur, but as the exception;

the general aspect of life is not hunger and distress, but rather wealth, luxury, even absurd prodigality – where there is a struggle it is a struggle for power.... One should not mistake Malthus for nature. – Supposing, however, that this struggle exists – and it does indeed occur – its outcome is the reverse of that desired by the school of Darwin, of that which one ought perhaps to desire with them: namely, the defeat of the stronger, the more privileged, the fortunate exceptions. Species do not grow more perfect: the weaker dominate the strong again and again – the reason being they are the great majority, and they are also cleverer.... Darwin forgot the mind (– that is English!): the weak possess more mind.... To acquire mind one must need mind – one loses it when one no longer needs it. He who possesses strength divests himself of mind (– ‘let it depart!’ they think today in Germany, ‘– the Reich will still be ours.’...)* One will see that under mind I include foresight, patience, dissimulation, great self-control, and all that is mimicry (this last includes a great part of what is called virtue).

§31. Another problem of diet. – The means by which Julius Caesar defended himself against sickliness and headache: tremendous marches, the simplest form of living, uninterrupted sojourn in the open air, continuous toil – these, broadly speaking, are the universal preservative and protective measures against the extreme vulnerability of that subtle machine working at the highest pressure which is called genius. –

§36. A moral code for physicians. – The invalid is a parasite on society. In a certain state it is indecent to go on living. To vegetate on in cowardly dependence on physicians and medicaments after the meaning of life, the right to life, has been lost ought to entail the profound contempt of society. Physicians, in their turn, ought to be the communicators of this contempt – not prescriptions, but every day a fresh dose of disgust with their patients.... To create a new responsibility, that of the physician, in all cases in which the highest interest of life, of ascending life, demands the most ruthless suppression and sequestration of degenerating life – for example in determining the right to reproduce, the

right to be born, the right to live.... To die proudly when it is no longer possible to live proudly. Death of one's own free choice, death at the proper time, with a clear head and with joyfulness, consummated in the midst of children and witnesses: so that an actual leave-taking is possible while he who is leaving is still there, likewise an actual evaluation of what has been desired and what achieved in life, an adding-up of life - all of this in contrast to the pitiable and horrible comedy Christianity has made of the hour of death. One should never forget of Christianity that it has abused the weakness of the dying to commit conscience-rape and even the mode of death to formulate value judgements on men and the past! - Here, every cowardice of prejudice

notwithstanding, it is above all a question of establishing the correct, that is physiological evaluation of so-called natural death: which is, after all, also only an 'unnatural' death, an act of suicide. One perishes by no one but oneself. Only 'natural' death is death for the most contemptible reasons, an unfree death, a death at the wrong time, a coward's death. From love of life one ought to desire to die differently from this: freely, consciously, not accidentally, not suddenly overtaken. ... Finally, a piece of advice for messieurs the pessimists and other *décadents*. We have no power to prevent ourselves being born: but we can rectify this error - for it is sometimes an error. When one does away with oneself one does the most estimable thing possible: one thereby almost deserves to live.... Society - what am I saying! life itself derives more advantage from that than from any sort of 'life' spent in renunciation, green-sickness and other virtues - one has freed others from having to endure one's sight, one has removed an objection from life.... Pessimism, *pur, vert** proves itself only by the self-negation of messieurs the pessimists: one must take their logic a step further, and not deny life merely in 'will and idea', as Schopenhauer did - one must first of all deny Schopenhauer.... Pessimism, by the by, however contagious it may be, nevertheless does not add to the morbidity of an age or a race in general: it is the expression of this morbidity. One succumbs to it as one succumbs to cholera: one's constitution must already be sufficiently morbid. Pessimism does not of itself make a single additional *décadent*, I recall that statistics show that the years in which cholera rages do not differ from other years in the total number of deaths.

§38. My conception of freedom. - The value of a thing sometimes lies not in what one attains with it, but in what one pays for it - what it costs us. I give an

example. Liberal institutions immediately cease to be liberal as soon as they are attained: subsequently there is nothing more thoroughly harmful to freedom than liberal institutions. One knows, indeed, what they bring about: they undermine the will to power, they are the levelling of mountain and valley exalted to a moral principle, they make small, cowardly and smug – it is the herd animal which triumphs with them every time. Liberalism: in plain words, reduction to the herd animal.... As long as they are still being fought for, these same institutions produce quite different effects; they then in fact promote freedom mightily. Viewed more closely, it is war which produces these effects, war for liberal institutions which as war permits the illiberal instincts to endure. And war is a training in freedom. For what is freedom? That one has the will to self-responsibility. That one preserves the distance which divides us. That one has become more indifferent to hardship, toil, privation, even to life. That one is ready to sacrifice men to one's cause, oneself not excepted. Freedom means that the manly instincts that delight in war and victory have gained mastery over the other instincts – for example, over the instinct for 'happiness'. The man who has become free – and how much more the mind that has become free – spurns the contemptible sort of well-being dreamed of by shopkeepers, Christians, cows, women, Englishmen and other democrats. The free man is a warrior. – How is freedom measured, in individuals as in nations? By the resistance which has to be overcome, by the effort it costs to stay aloft. One would have to seek the highest

type of free man where the greatest resistance is constantly being overcome: five steps from tyranny, near the threshold of the danger of servitude. This is true psychologically when one understands by 'tyrants' pitiless and dreadful instincts, to combat which demands the maximum of authority and discipline towards oneself – finest type Julius Caesar –; it is also true politically: one has only to look at history. The nations which were worth something, which became worth something, never became so under liberal institutions: it was great danger which made of them something deserving reverence, danger which first teaches us to know our resources, our virtues, our shield and spear, our spirit – which compels us to be strong.... First principle: one must need strength, otherwise one will never have it. – Those great forcing-houses for strong human beings, for the strongest kind there has ever been, the aristocratic communities of the pattern of Rome and Venice, understood freedom in precisely the sense which I

understand the word 'freedom': as something one has and does not have, something one wants, something one conquers...

§44. My conception of the genius. – Great men, like great epochs, are explosive material in whom tremendous energy has been accumulated; their prerequisite has always been, historically and physiologically, that a protracted assembling, accumulating, economizing and preserving has preceded them – that there has been no explosion for a long time. If the tension in the mass has grown too great the merest accidental stimulus suffices to call the 'genius', the 'deed', the great destiny, into the world. Of what account then are circumstances, the epoch, the Zeitgeist, public opinion! – Take the case of Napoleon. The France of the Revolution, and even more preRevolution France, would have brought forth the type antithetical to Napoleon: it did bring it forth, moreover. And because Napoleon was different, the heir of a stronger, longer, older civilization than that which was going up in dust and smoke in France, he became master here, he alone was master here. Great human beings are necessary, the epoch in which they appear is accidental; that they almost always become master of their epoch is only because they are stronger, because they are older, because a longer assembling of force has preceded them. The relationship between a genius and his epoch is the same as that between strong and weak, and as that between old and young: the epoch is always relatively much younger, less substantial, more immature, less sure of itself, more childish. – That they have very different ideas on this subject in France today (in Germany too, but that is of no consequence), that there the theory of milieu, a real neurotic's theory, has become sacrosanct and almost scientific and finds credence even among physiologists – that fact has an 'ill odour' and gives one sadly to think. – The same ideas are believed in England too, but no one will lose any sleep over that. The Englishman has only two possible ways of coming to terms with the genius and 'great man': either the democratic way in the manner of Buckle or the religious way in the manner of Carlyle. – The danger which lies in great human beings and great epochs is extraordinary; sterility, exhaustion of every kind follow in their footsteps. The great human being is a terminus; the great epoch, the Renaissance for example, is a terminus. The genius – in his works, in his deeds – is necessarily a prodigal: his greatness lies in the fact that he expends himself.... The instinct of self-preservation is as it were suspended; the overwhelming pressure of the energies which emanate from him forbids him any such care and prudence. One calls this 'sacrifice'; one praises his 'heroism' therein, his indifference to his own interests,

his devotion to an idea, a great cause, a fatherland: all misunderstandings.... He flows out, he overflows, he uses himself up, he does not spare himself – with inevitability, fatefully, involuntarily, as a river's bursting its banks is involuntary. But because

one owes a great deal to such explosive beings one has bestowed a great deal upon them in return, for example a species of higher morality.... For that is the nature of human gratitude: it misunderstands its benefactors. –

§8. It is necessary to say whom we feel to be our antithesis – the theologians and all that has theologian blood in its veins – our entire philosophy.... One must have seen the fatality from close up, better still one must have experienced it in oneself, one must have almost perished by it, no longer to find anything funny here (the free-thinking of our naturalists and physiologists is to my mind funny – they lack passion in these things, they do not suffer from them –). That poison extends much further than one thinks: I have discovered the arrogant theologian-instinct wherever anyone today feels himself to be an 'idealist' – wherever anyone assumes, by virtue of a higher origin, a right to cast strange and superior looks at actuality.... Just like the priest, the idealist has all the great concepts in his hand (– and not only in his hand!), he plays them out with a benevolent contempt against the 'understanding', the 'senses', 'honours', 'luxury', 'science', he sees these things as beneath him, as harmful and seductive forces above which 'the spirit' soars in pure self-sufficiency – as though humility, chastity, poverty, in a word holiness, had not hitherto done life unutterably more harm than any sort of frightfulness or vice whatever.... Pure spirit is pure lie.... So long as the priest, that denier, calumniator and poisoner of life by profession, still counts as a higher kind of human being, there can be no answer to the question: what is truth? One has already stood truth on its head when the conscious advocate of denial and nothingness counts as the representative of 'truth'...

§12. I exclude a few sceptics, the decent type in the history of philosophy: but the rest are ignorant of the first requirements of intellectual integrity. These great visionaries and prodigies behave one and all like little women – they consider 'fine feelings' arguments, the 'heaving bosom' the bellows of divinity, conviction the criterion of truth. Finally Kant, in his 'German' innocence, tried to give this form of corruption, this lack of intellectual conscience, a scientific

colouring with the concept 'practical reason': he designed a reason specifically for the case in which one was supposed not to have to bother about reason, namely when morality, when the sublime demand 'thou shalt' makes itself heard. If one considers that the philosopher is, in virtually all nations, only the further development of the priestly type, one is no longer surprised to discover this heirloom of the priest, self-deceptive fraudulence. If one has sacred tasks, for example that of improving, saving, redeeming mankind

- if one carries the divinity in one's bosom, is the mouthpiece of an other-world imperative, such a mission already places one outside all merely reasonable valuations - one is already sanctified by such a task, one is already the type of a higher order!... What does a priest care about science! He is above it! - And the priest has hitherto ruled! - He has determined the concept 'true' and 'untrue'!...

§14. We have learned better. We have become more modest in every respect. We no longer trace the origin of man in the 'spirit', in the 'divinity', we have placed him back among the animals. We consider him the strongest animal because he is the most cunning: his spirituality is a consequence of this. On the other hand, we guard ourselves against a vanity which would like to find expression even here: the vanity that man is the great secret objective of animal evolution. Man is absolutely not the crown of creation: every creature stands beside him at the same stage of perfection. ... And even in asserting that we assert too much: man is, relatively speaking, the most unsuccessful animal, the sickliest, the one most dangerously strayed from its instincts - with all that, to be sure, the most interesting! - As regards the animals, Descartes was the first who, with a boldness worthy of reverence, ventured to think of the animal as a machine: our whole science of physiology is devoted to proving this proposition. Nor, logically, do we exclude man, as even Descartes did: our

knowledge of man today is real knowledge precisely to the extent that it is knowledge of him as a machine. Formerly man was presented with 'free will' as a dowry from a higher order: today we have taken even will away from him, in the sense that will may no longer be understood as a faculty. The old word 'will' only serves to designate a resultant, a kind of individual reaction which necessarily follows a host of partly contradictory, partly congruous stimuli - the will no longer 'effects' anything, no longer 'moves' anything.... Formerly one saw in man's consciousness, in his 'spirit', the proof of his higher origin, his divinity; to

make himself perfect man was advised to draw his senses back into himself in the manner of the tortoise, to cease to have any traffic with the earthly, to lay aside his mortal frame: then the chief part of him would remain behind, 'pure spirit'. We have thought better of this too: becoming-conscious, 'spirit', is to us precisely a symptom of a relative imperfection of the organism, as an attempting, fumbling, blundering, as a toiling in which an unnecessarily large amount of nervous energy is expended – we deny that anything can be made perfect so long as it is still made conscious. 'Pure spirit' is pure stupidity: if we deduct the nervous system and the senses, the 'mortal frame', we miscalculate – that's all!...

§31. I have anticipated my answer to the problem. Its presupposition is that the type of the redeemer has been preserved to us only in a very distorted form. That this

distortion should have occurred is in itself very probable: there are several reasons why such a type could not remain pure, whole, free of accretions. The milieu in which this strange figure moved must have left its mark upon him, as must even more the history, the fate of the first Christian community: from this the type was retrospectively enriched with traits which become comprehensible only with reference to warfare and the aims of propaganda. That strange and sick world to which the Gospels introduce us – a world like that of a Russian novel, in which refuse of society, neurosis and 'childlike' idiocy seem to make a rendezvous – must in any case have coarsened the type: the first disciples in particular had to translate a being immersed entirely in symbols and incomprehensibilities into their own crudity in order to understand anything of it at all – for them such a type could not exist until it had been reduced to more familiar forms.... The prophet, the Messiah, the judge who is to come, the moral preacher, the miracle-worker, John the Baptist – so many opportunities for misunderstanding the type.... Finally, let us not underestimate the *proprium** of all extreme, and in particular sectarian veneration: it extinguishes the original often painfully unfamiliar traits and idiosyncrasies in the revered being – it even fails to see them. One has to regret that no Dostoyevsky lived in the neighbourhood of this most interesting *décadent*; I mean someone who could feel the thrilling fascination of such a combination of the sublime, the sick and the childish. One final viewpoint: the type, as a *décadence* type, could in fact have been of a peculiar multiplicity and contradictoriness: such a possibility cannot be entirely excluded. But everything speaks against it: for if it were so

the tradition would have to have been remarkably faithful and objective: and we have reasons for assuming the opposite. In the meantime, there yawns a contradiction between the mountain, lake and field preacher, whose appearance strikes one as that of a Buddha on a soil very little like that of India, and the aggressive fanatic, the mortal enemy of theologian and priest, which Renan has wickedly glorified as 'le grand maitre en ironie'. I myself have no doubt that this plentiful measure of gall (and even of esprit) has only overflowed on to the type of the Master out of the excited condition of Christian propaganda: for one knows very well how resolutely all sectarians adjust their Master into an apologia of themselves. When the first community had need of a censuring theologian to oppose the theologians they created their 'God' according to their requirements: just as they unhesitatingly put into his mouth those totally unevangelic concepts which they could not now do without, 'Second Coming', 'Last Judgement', every kind of temporal promise and expectation. -

§36. - Only we, we emancipated spirits, possess the prerequisite for understanding

something nineteen centuries have misunderstood - that integrity become instinct and passion which makes war on the 'holy lie' even more than on any other lie.... One has been unspeakably far from our benevolent and cautious neutrality, from that discipline of the spirit through which alone the divining of such strange, such delicate things is made possible: at all times one has, with shameless self-seeking, desired only one's own advantage in these things, one constructed the Church out of the antithesis to the Gospel. If anyone were looking for a sign that an ironical divinity was at work behind the great universal drama he would find no small support in the tremendous questionmark called Christianity. That mankind should fall on its knees before the opposite of what was the origin, the meaning, the right of the Gospel, that it should have sanctified in the concept 'Church' precisely what the 'bringer of glad tidings' regarded as beneath him, behind him - one seeks in vain a grander form of worldhistorical irony -

§38. - At this point I shall not suppress a sigh. There are days when I am haunted by a feeling blacker than the blackest melancholy - contempt of man. And so as to leave no doubt as to what I despise, whom I despise: it is the man of

today, the man with whom I am fatefully contemporary. The man of today - I suffocate of his impure

breath.... With regard to the past I am, like all men of knowledge, of a large tolerance, that is to say a magnanimous self-control: I traverse the madhouse-world of entire millennia, be it called 'Christianity', 'Christian faith', 'Christian Church', with a gloomy circumspection - I take care not to make mankind responsible for its insanities. But my feelings suddenly alter, burst forth, immediately I enter the modern age, our age. Our age knows.... What was formerly merely morbid has today become indecent - it is indecent to be a Christian today. And here is where my disgust commences. - I look around me: there is no longer a word left of what was formerly called 'truth', we no longer endure it when a priest so much as utters the word 'truth'. Even with the most modest claim to integrity one must know today that a theologian, a priest, a pope does not merely err in every sentence he speaks, he lies - that he is no longer free to lie 'innocently', out of 'ignorance'. The priest knows as well as anyone that there is no longer any 'God', any 'sinner', any 'redeemer' - that 'free will', 'moral world-order' are lies - intellectual seriousness, the profound self-overcoming of the intellect, no longer permits anyone not to know about these things.... All the concepts of the Church are recognized for what they are: the most malicious false-coinage there is for the purpose of devaluing nature and natural values; the priest himself is recognized for what he is: the most dangerous kind of parasite, the actual poison-spider of life.... We know, our conscience knows today - what those sinister inventions of priest and Church are worth, what end they serve, with which that state of human self-violation has brought about which is capable of exciting disgust at the sight of mankind - the concepts 'Beyond', 'Last Judgement', 'immortality of the soul', the 'soul' itself: they are instruments of torture, they are forms of systematic cruelty by virtue of which the priest has become master, stays master.... Everyone knows this: and everyone none the less remains unchanged. Where have the last feelings of decency and self-respect gone when even our statesmen, in other ways very unprejudiced kind of men and practical anti-Christians through and through, still call themselves Christians today and go to Communion?... A young prince at the head of his regiments, splendid as the expression of his people's egoism and presumption - but without any shame professing himself a Christian!... Whom then does Christianity deny? what does it call 'world'? Being a soldier, being a judge, being a patriot; defending oneself; preserving one's honour; desiring to

seek one's advantage; being proud.... The practice of every hour, every instinct, every valuation which leads to action is today anti-Christian: what a monster of falsity modern man must be that he is none the less not ashamed to be called a Christian!

§44. - The Gospels are invaluable as evidence of the already irresistible corruption within the first community. What Paul later carried to its conclusion with the cynical logic of a rabbi was none the less merely the process of decay which commenced with the death of the redeemer. - One cannot read these Gospels too warily; there are difficulties behind every word. I hope I shall be pardoned for confessing that they are for that very reason a pleasure of the first rank to a psychologist - as the opposite of all kinds of naïve depravity, as refinement par excellence, as artistry in psychological depravity. The Gospels are in a class by themselves. The Bible in general admits of no comparison. One is among Jews: first consideration if one is not to lose the thread completely. This self-pretence of 'holiness', which here becomes downright genius and which has not since been even approximately equalled among books and men, this false-coinage of word and attitude as an art, is not the chance product of some individual talent, some exceptional nature. Race is required for it. In Christianity, as the art of holy lying, the whole of Judaism, a schooling and technique pursued with the utmost seriousness for hundreds of years, attains its ultimate perfection. The Christian, that ultima ratio of the lie, is the Jew once more - even thrice more.... The will to employ as a matter of principle only concepts, symbols, attitudes manifested in the practice of the priest, the instinctive rejection of every other practice, every other kind of perspective in the realm of values and practical application - that is not tradition, it is inheritance: only as inheritance does it have the effect of a natural quality. The whole of mankind, even the finest heads of the finest epochs (with one exception, who is perhaps merely a monster -) have allowed themselves to be

deceived. The Gospel has been read as the Book of Innocence.... no small pointer to the degree of histrionic mastery displayed in it. - If we got to see them, to be sure, even if only in passing, all these singular bigots and artificial saints, it would be the end of them - and it is precisely because I never read a word without seeing an attitude that I make an end of them.... They have a way of raising their eyes to Heaven which I cannot endure. - Fortunately books are for most people merely literature. - One must not let oneself be misled: they say

'Judge not!' but they send to Hell everything that stands in their way. By allowing God to judge they themselves judge; by glorifying God they glorify themselves; by demanding precisely those virtues of which they themselves are capable – more, which they are in need of to stay on top at all – they present a great appearance of contending for virtue, of struggling for the triumph of virtue. 'We live, we die, we sacrifice ourselves for the good' (– 'truth', 'the light', the 'kingdom of God'): in reality they do what they cannot help doing. By making their way in a sneaking fashion, sitting in corners, living out shadowy lives in the shadows, they make a duty of it: their life of humility appears to be a duty, as humility it is one more proof of piety.... Ah this humble, chaste, compassionate mode of mendaciousness! 'For us virtue itself shall bear witness'.... Read the Gospels as books of seduction by means of morality: these petty people have placed a restraint on morality – they know what use it can be put to! Mankind can best be led by the nose with morality! – The reality is that here the most conscious arrogance of the elect is posing as modesty: one has placed oneself, the 'community', the 'good and just', once and for all on one side, on the side of 'truth' – and the rest, 'the world', on the other.... That has been the most fateful kind of megalomania that has ever existed on earth: little abortions of bigots and liars began to lay claim to the concepts 'God', 'truth', 'light', 'spirit', 'love', 'wisdom', 'life', as if these were synonyms of themselves so as to divide themselves off from the 'world'; little superlatives of Jews, ripe for every kind of madhouse, twisted values in general to suit themselves, as if only the 'Christian' were the meaning, the salt, the measure and also the ultimate tribunal of all the rest. ... The whole fatality was possible only because there was already in the world a related, racially-related megalomania, the Jewish: once the chasm between Jews and Jewish Christians opened up, the latter were left with no alternative but to employ against the Jews the very self-preservative procedures counselled by the Jewish instinct, while the Jews had previously employed them only against everything nonJewish. The Christian is only a Jew of a 'freer' confession. –

V.3 — On the Genealogy of Morals, Third Essay §11-13

ON THE GENEALOGY OF MORALS, THIRD ESSAY §11-13 (Translated by Ian Johnston)

Only now that we have taken a look at the ascetic priest can we seriously get at our problem: What does the ascetic ideal mean—only now does it become “serious.” From this point on we confront the actual representative of seriousness. “What does all seriousness mean?”—this even more fundamental question perhaps lies already on our lips, a question for physiologists, naturally, but nonetheless one which we will still evade for the moment. In that ideal, the ascetic priest preserves, not merely his faith, but also his will, his power, his interest. His right to existence stands and falls with that ideal. No wonder that here we run into a fearful opponent, given, of course, that we were people antagonistic to that ideal?—an opponent of the sort who fights for his existence against those who deny the ideal. . . . On the other hand, it is from the outset improbable that such an interesting stance to our problem will be particularly beneficial to it. The ascetic priest will hardly in himself prove the most successful defender of his ideal, for the same reason that a woman habitually fails when it’s a matter of defending “woman as such”—to say nothing of his being able to provide the most objective assessment of and judgment about the controversy we are dealing with here. Rather than having to fear that he will refute us too well—this much is clear enough—it’s more likely we’ll still have to help him defend himself against us. . . . The idea being contested at this point is the value of our lives in the eyes of ascetic priests: this same life (along with what belongs to it, “nature,” “the world,” the whole sphere of becoming and transience) they set up in relation to an existence of a totally different kind, a relationship characterized by opposition and mutual exclusion, except where life somehow turns against itself, denies itself. In this case, the case of an ascetic life, living counts as a bridge over to that other existence. The ascetic treats life as an incorrect road, where we must finally go backwards, right to the place where it begins, or as a misconception which man refutes by his actions—or should refute. For he demands that people go with him. Where he can, he enforces his evaluation of existence. What’s the meaning of that? Such a monstrous way of assessing value does not stand inscribed in human history as something exceptional and curious. It is one of the most widespread and enduring extant facts. If read from a distant star, the block capital script of our earthly existence might perhaps lead one to conclude that the earth is the inherently ascetic star, a corner for discontented, arrogant, and repellent creatures, incapable of ridding themselves of a deep dissatisfaction with themselves, with the earth, with all living, creatures who inflict as much harm on themselves as possible for the pleasure of inflicting harm—probably their single pleasure. We should consider how regularly, how commonly, how in almost all ages the ascetic priest makes an appearance. He does not belong to one single race. He flourishes everywhere. He grows from all levels of society. And it’s not the case that he breeds and replants his way of assessing value

somehow through biological inheritance: the opposite the case—generally speaking, a deep instinct forbids him from reproducing. There must be a high-order necessity which makes this species hostile to life always grow again and flourish—it must be in the interest of life itself not to have such a type of self-contradiction die out. For an ascetic life is a self-contradiction. Here a resentment without equal is in control, something with an insatiable instinct and will to power, which wants to become master, not over something in life but over life itself, over its deepest, strongest, most basic conditions; here an attempt is being made to use one's power to block up the sources of that power; here one directs one's green and malicious gaze against one's inherent physiological health, particularly against its means of expression—beauty, joy—while one experiences and seeks for a feeling of pleasure in mistrust, atrophy, pain, accident, ugliness, voluntary loss, self-denial, self-flagellation, self-sacrifice.⁽¹⁰⁾ All this is paradoxical to the highest degree. Here we stand in front of a dichotomy which essentially wants a dichotomy, which enjoys itself in this suffering and always gets even more self-aware and more triumphant in proportion to the decrease in its own prerequisite, the physiological capacity for life. "Triumph precisely in the ultimate agony"—under this supreme sign the ascetic ideal has fought from time immemorial. Inside this riddle of seduction, in this picture of delight and torment, it sees its highest light, its salvation, its final victory. *Crux, nux, lux* [cross, nut, light]—for the ascetic ideal these are all one thing.

Given that such a living desire for contradiction and hostility to nature is used to practise philosophy, on what will it discharge its most inner arbitrary power? It will do that on something it perceives, with the greatest certainty, as true, as real. It will seek out error precisely where the essential instinct for life has established its most unconditional truth. For example, it will demote physical life to an illusion, as the ascetics of the Vedanta philosophy did. Similarly it will treat pain, the multiplicity of things, the whole ideational opposition between "subject" and "object" as error, nothing but error! To deny faith in one's own self, to deny one's own "reality"—what a triumph!—and not just over the senses, over appearances, but a much loftier kind of triumph, an overpowering of and act of cruelty against reason: a process in which the highest peak of delight occurs when ascetic self-contempt and self-mockery of reason proclaims: "There is a kingdom of truth and being, but reason is expressly excluded from it" . . . (By the way, even in the Kantian idea of the "intelligible character of things" there still remains something of this lecherous ascetic dichotomy, which loves to turn reason against reason: for the "intelligible character" with Kant means a sort of composition of things about which the intellect understands just enough to know that for the intellect it is—wholly and

completely unintelligible).—But precisely because we are people who seek knowledge, we should finally not be ungrateful for such determined reversals of customary perspectives and evaluations with which the spirit has for so long raged against itself with such apparent wickedness and futility. To use this for once to see differently, the will to see things differently, is no small discipline and preparation of the intellect for its coming “objectivity”—the latter meant not in the sense of “disinterested contemplation” (which is inconceivable nonsense), but as the capability of having power over one’s positive and negative arguments and of raising them and disposing of them so that one knows how to make the very variety of perspectives and interpretations of emotions useful for knowledge. From now on, my philosophical gentlemen, let us protect ourselves better from the dangerous old conceptual fantasy which posits a “pure, will-less, painless, timeless subject of cognition”; let’s guard ourselves against the tentacles of such contradictory ideas as “pure reason,” “absolute spirituality,” “knowledge in itself”—those things which demand that we think of an eye which simply cannot be imagined, an eye which is to have no direction at all, in which the active and interpretative forces are supposed to stop or be absent—the very things through which seeing first becomes seeing something. Hence, these things always demand from the eye something conceptually absurd and incomprehensible. The only seeing we have is seeing from a perspective; the only knowledge we have is knowledge from a perspective; and the more emotions we allow to be expressed in words concerning something, the more eyes, different eyes, we know how to train on the same thing, the more complete our “idea” of this thing, our “objectivity,” will be. But to eliminate the will in general, to suspend all our emotions without exception—even if we were capable of that—what would that be? Wouldn’t we call that castrating the intellect?

But let’s go back to our problem. The sort of self-contradiction which seems to be present in ascetic people, “life opposing life,” is—this much is clear—physiologically (and not only physiologically) considered—simply absurd. It can only be apparent. It must be some kind of temporary expression, an interpretation, formula, make up, a psychological misunderstanding of something whose real nature could not be understood for a long time, could not for a long time be described in itself—a mere word, caught in an old gap in human understanding. So let me counter that briefly with the facts of the matter: the ascetic ideal arises out of the instinct for protection and salvation in a degenerating life, which seeks to keep itself going by any means and struggles for its existence. It indicates a partial physiological inhibition and exhaustion, against which those deepest instincts for living which still remain intact continuously fight on with new methods and innovations. The ascetic

ideal is one such method. The facts are thus precisely the opposite of what those who honour this ideal claim—life is struggling in that ideal and by means of that ideal with death and against death: the ascetic ideal is a manoeuvre for the preservation of life. As history teaches us, to the extent that this ideal could prevail over men and become powerful, particularly wherever civilization and the taming of humans have been successfully implemented, it expresses an important fact: the pathological nature of the earlier form of human beings, at least of those human beings who had been tamed, the physiological struggle of men against death (more precisely, against weariness with life, against exhaustion, against desire for the “end”). The ascetic priest is the incarnation of the desire for another state of being, an existence somewhere else—indeed, the highest stage of this desire, its characteristic zeal and passion. But the very power of this desire is the chain which binds him here. That’s simply what turns him into a tool which has to work to create more favourable conditions for living here and for living as a human being—with this very power he keeps the whole herd of failures, discontents, delinquents, unfortunates, all sorts of people who inherently suffer, focussed on existence, because instinctively he goes ahead of them as their herdsman. You understand already what I mean: this ascetic priest, this apparent enemy of living, this man who denies—he belongs precisely with all the great conserving and affirming forces of life. . . .

To what can we ascribe this pathology? For the human being is more ill, less certain, more changeable, more insecure than any other animal—there’s no doubt about that. He is the sick animal. Where does that come from? To be sure, he has also dared more, innovated more, defied more, and demanded more from fate than all the other animals combined. He is the great experimenter with himself, unhappy, dissatisfied, who struggles for ultimate mastery with animals, nature, and gods—still unconquered, always a man of the future, who no longer gets any rest from the force of his own powers, so that his future relentlessly burrows like a thorn into the flesh of his entire present:—how should such a brave and rich animal not also be the animal in most danger, the one which, of all sick animals, suffers the most lengthy and most profound illness? Human beings, often enough, get fed up: there are entire epidemics of this process of getting fed up (—for example, around 1348, at the time of the dance of death): but even this very disgust, this exhaustion, this dissatisfaction with himself—all this comes out of him so powerfully that it immediately becomes a new chain. The No which he speaks to life brings to light, as if through a magic spell, an abundance of more tender Yeses; in fact, when he injures himself, this master of destruction, of self-destruction —it is the wound itself which later forces him to live on. . . .

V.4 — Ecce Homo: Why I Am So Clever §9-10

ECCE HOMO, "WHY I AM SO CLEVER" §9-10 (Translated by R.J. Hollingdale)

V.5 — The Use and Abuse of History for Life §1-3

THE USE AND ABUSE OF HISTORY FOR LIFE §1-3 (Translated by Ian Johnston)

V.6 — The Gay Science §108 and §125

THE GAY SCIENCE §108 AND §125 (Translated by Adrian Del Caro / Josefine Nauckhoff)

§108

108 New battles. — After Buddha was dead, they still showed his shadow in a cave for centuries — a tremendous, gruesome shadow. God is dead; but given the way people are, there may still for millennia be caves in which they show his shadow. — And we — we must still defeat his shadow as well!

§125

125 The madman. — Haven't you heard of that madman who in the bright morning lit a lantern and ran around the marketplace crying incessantly, 'I'm looking for God! I'm looking for God!' Since many of those who did not believe in God were standing around together just then, he caused great laughter. Has he been lost, then? asked one. Did he lose his way like a child? asked another. Or is he hiding? Is he afraid of us? Has he gone to sea? Emigrated? - Thus they shouted and laughed, one interrupting the other. The madman jumped into their midst and pierced them with his eyes. 'Where is God?' he cried; 'I'll tell you! We 11g

The Gay Science have killed him — you and I! We are all his murderers. But how did we do this? How were we able to drink up the sea? Who gave us the sponge to wipe away the entire horizon? What were we doing when we unchained this earth from its sun? Where is it moving to now? Where are we moving to? Away from all suns? Are we not continually falling? And backwards, sideways, forwards, in all directions? Is there still an up and a down? Aren't we straying as though through an infinite nothing? Isn't empty space breathing at us? Hasn't it got colder? Isn't night and more night coming again and again?

Don't lanterns have to be lit in the morning? Do we still hear nothing of the noise of the grave-diggers who are burying God? Do we still smell nothing of the divine decomposition? — Gods, too, decompose! God is dead! God remains dead! And we have killed him! How can we console ourselves, the murderers of all murderers! The holiest and the mightiest thing the world has ever possessed has bled to death under our knives: who will wipe this blood from us? With what water could we clean ourselves? What festivals of atonement, what holy games will we have to invent for ourselves? Is the magnitude of this deed not too great for us? Do we not ourselves have to become gods merely to appear worthy of it? There was never a greater deed — and whoever is born after us will on account of this deed belong to a higher history than all history up to now!' Here the madman fell silent and looked again at his listeners; they too were silent and looked at him disconcertedly. Finally he threw his lantern on the ground so that it broke into pieces and went out. 'I come too early', he then said; 'my time is not yet. This tremendous event is still on its way, wandering; it has not yet reached the ears of men. Lightning and thunder need time; the light of the stars needs time; deeds need time, even after they are done, in order to be seen and heard. This deed is still more remote to them than the remotest stars — and yet they have done it themselves! It is still recounted how on the same day the madman forced his way into several churches and there started singing his requiem aeternam deo.' Led out and called to account, he is said always to have replied nothing but, 'What then are these churches now if not the tombs and sepulchres of God?' 10 'Grant God eternal rest.' A transformation of that part of the service for the dead which reads 'Requiem aeternam dona eis {scilicet, mortuis}, Domine' ('Lord, grant them [the dead] eternal rest') 120

Book Three

V.7 — The Gay Science §341-342 (Eternal Recurrence)

THE GAY SCIENCE §341-342 (Translated by Adrian Del Caro / Josefine Nauckhoff)

§341

341 The heaviest weight. — What if some day or night a demon were to steal into your loneliest loneliness and say to you: 'This life as you now live it and have lived it you will have to live once again and innumerable times again; and there will be nothing new in it, but every pain and every joy and every thought and sigh and everything unspeakably small or great in your life must return to

you, all in the same succession and sequence — even this spider and this moonlight between the trees, and even this moment and I myself. The eternal hourglass of existence is turned over again and again, and you with it, speck of dust!’ Would you not throw yourself down and gnash your teeth and curse the demon who spoke thus? Or have you once experienced a tremendous moment when you would have answered him: ‘You are a god, and never have I heard anything more divine.’ If this thought gained power over you, as you are it would transform and possibly crush you; the question in each and every thing, ‘Do you want this again and innumerable times again?’ would lie on your actions as the heaviest weight! Or how well disposed would you have 31 See Plato, *Phaedo* 116–18, esp. 118a.5–8. Asclepius was the god of healing and a rooster would have been a usual thank-offering to him from someone whom he had cured of an illness. Nietzsche’s interpretation of what Socrates said was not standard in the ancient world, and became common only in the Renaissance. It is rejected by some modern scholars. 194

Book Four: St Januarius to become to yourself and to life to long for nothing more fervently than for this ultimate eternal confirmation and seal?

§342

342 Incipit tragoedia.* — When Zarathustra? was thirty years old, he left his homeland and Lake Urmi and went into the mountains. There he enjoyed his spirit and solitude, and did not tire of that for ten years. But at last his heart changed — and one morning he arose with rosy dawn, stepped before the sun, and spoke to it thus: ‘You great heavenly body! What would your happiness be if you did not have those for whom you shine! For ten years you have climbed up to my cave; without me, my eagle, and my snake, you would have become tired of your light and of this road; but we awaited you every morning, relieved you of your overabundance, and blessed you for it. Behold, I am sick of my wisdom, like a bee that has collected too much honey; I need outstretched hands; I would like to give away and distribute until the wise among humans once again enjoy their folly and the poor once again their riches. For that I must step into the depths, as you do in the evening when you go behind the sea and bring light even to the underworld, you over-rich heavenly body! Like you I must go under, as it is called by the human beings to whom I want to descend. So bless me then, you calm eye that can look without envy upon all-too-great happiness! Bless the cup that wants to overflow in order that the water may flow golden from it and everywhere carry the reflection of your bliss! Behold, this cup wants to become empty again, and Zarathustra wants to become human again.’ Thus began Zarathustra’s going under. 32 ‘The tragedy begins’.

At this point, on completing Book iv, Nietzsche went on to write *Also Sprach Zarathustra* (Thus Spoke Zarathustra), the most prophetic in style among his philosophical works, in 1883-5. He added Book v to *The Gay Science* in 1887. 33 Nietzsche takes the name from that of the Persian religious thinker of the seventh/sixth century BC who propagated a strongly dualistic doctrine, sharply distinguishing between good and evil. 195

Book Five We Fearless Ones Carcasse, tu trembles? Tu tremblerais bien davantage, si tu savais où je te mène. Turenne 'Carcass, you tremble? You'd tremble even more if you knew where I'm taking you.' Henri de Latour d'Auvergne, Vicomte de Turenne (1611~75) was one of the most successful generals of the French King Louis XIV.

Book Five: We Fearless Ones

PART VI: The Noble Soul — Final Aphorisms

VI.1 — Beyond Good and Evil §287-296

BEYOND GOOD AND EVIL §287-296 (Translated by Ian Johnston)

Especially §287 ("The noble soul has reverence for itself"), §290, §293, §295 ("The genius of the heart"), and §296 (the final aphorism).

§287

What is noble? What does the word "noble" still mean to us nowadays? What reveals the noble human being, how do people recognize him, under this heavy, oppressive sky at the beginning of the rule of the rabble, which is making everything opaque and leaden?—It is not the actions that prove him—actions are always ambiguous, always inscrutable—; nor is it the "works." Among artists and scholars today we find a sufficient number of those who through their works reveal how a profound desire for what is noble drives them: but this very need for what is noble is fundamentally different from the needs of the noble soul itself and is really the eloquent and dangerous indication that such a soul is lacking. It's not the works; it's the belief which decides here, which here establishes the order of rank, to take up once more an old religious formula with a new and more profound meaning: some basic certainty that a noble soul has about itself, something that does not allow itself to be sought out or found or perhaps even to be lost. The noble soul has reverence for itself.—

§290

Every deep thinker is more afraid of being understood than of being misunderstood. In the latter case, perhaps his vanity suffers, but the former hurts his heart, his sympathy, which always says, "Alas, why do you want to have it as hard as I did?"

§293

A man who says, "That pleases me. I take that for my own and will protect it and defend it against everyone," a man who can lead a cause, put a decision into effect, remain true to an idea, hold on to a woman, punish and cast down an insolent person, a man who has his anger and his sword and to whom the

weak, the suffering, the distressed, and even the animals are happy to go and belong to by nature—in short, a man who is naturally a master—when such a man has pity, well, this pity is worth something! But what is there in the pity of those who suffer! Or even of those who preach pity! Today in almost all of Europe there is a pathological susceptibility and sensitivity to pain, as well as a nasty lack of restraint in complaining, a mollycoddling, which likes to dress itself up with religion and philosophical bits and pieces as something loftier—there is a formal culture of suffering. In my view, the unmanliness of what is christened “pity” in such enthusiastic circles is what always strikes the eye first.—We must excommunicate this latest form of bad taste, powerfully and thoroughly; and finally I wish that people would set against their hearts and throats the good amulet “gai saber,”—“gay science,” to clarify this matter for the Germans.

§295

The genius of the heart, as that great hidden presence possesses it, the tempter-god and born pied piper of the conscience, whose voice knows how to climb down into the underworld of every soul, who does not say a word or cast a glance in which there does not lie some concern with and trace of temptation, whose mastery includes the fact that he understands how to seem—and not what he is, but what for those who follow him is one more compulsion to press themselves always closer to him, to follow him ever more inwardly and completely:—that genius of the heart who makes all noise and self-satisfaction fall silent and teaches it to listen, who smoothes out the rough souls and gives them a new desire to taste,—to lie still as a mirror so that the deep heaven reflects itself in them—; the genius of the heart who teaches the foolish and over-hasty hand to hesitate and reach out more delicately; who senses the hidden and forgotten treasure, the drop of goodness and sweet spirituality under the thick cloudy ice and is a divining rod for every grain of gold that has lain buried a long time in a dungeon crammed with mud and sand; the genius of the heart, at whose touch everyone goes forward richer, not divinely gifted and surprised, not as if delighted and oppressed with some foreign good, but richer in his own self, newer to himself than previously, broken open, blown upon and sounded out by a thawing wind, more uncertain perhaps, more tender, more fragile, more broken, but full of hopes that as yet have no names, full of new will and flowing, full of new irritations and opposing currents . . . But what am I doing, my friends? Whom am I speaking to you about? Have I forgotten myself so much that I have not once named him to you? Unless you have already guessed for yourselves who this questionable spirit and god is who wants to be praised in such a way. For just as things go with anyone who

from the time he walked on childish legs has always been on the move and in alien territory, so many strange and not un-dangerous spirits have crossed my path, too, above all the one I have just been speaking about, who has come again and again, namely, no less a spirit than the god Dionysus, that enormously ambiguous and tempter god, to whom in earlier times, as you know, I offered up my first born, in all secrecy and reverence—as the last person, so I thought, who had offered a sacrifice to him: for I found no one who understood what I was doing then.(7) Meanwhile I learned a great deal, much too much, about the philosophy of this god, and, as mentioned, from mouth to mouth—I, the last disciple and initiate of the god Dionysus: and perhaps I can at last begin to give you, my friends, a little taste of this philosophy, as much as I am permitted? In a hushed voice, as is reasonable, for this concerns a number of things that are secret, new, strange, odd, and mysterious. Even the fact that Dionysus is a philosopher and that the gods also carry on philosophy seems to me a novelty that is not harmless and that perhaps might excite mistrust precisely among philosophers—among you, my friends it has less against it, although it could be that it comes too late and not at the right moment: for it has been revealed to me that nowadays you are not happy to believe in god and gods. Also perhaps the fact that in my explanation I must proceed with more candour than is always pleasing to the strict habits of your ears? Certainly the god under discussion went further, very much further, in conversations like this and was always several steps ahead of me . . . In fact, if it were permitted, I would, following human practices, attach to him beautifully solemn names of splendour and virtue; I would have to lavish a great deal of praise on him for his courage as an explorer and discoverer, for his daring honesty, truthfulness, and love of wisdom. But such a god has no idea how to begin with all this venerable rubbish and pageantry. “Keep that,” he would say, “for yourself and people like you and anyone else who needs it! I have no reason to cover my nakedness!”—Do people sense that this type of divinity and philosopher perhaps lacks shame? He said it this way once, “In some circumstances, I love human beings”—and in saying that, he was alluding to Ariadne, who was present—“for me a human being is a pleasant, brave, inventive animal that has no equal on earth; it finds the right path even in every labyrinth.(8) I like him: I often reflect how I could bring him further forwards and make him stronger, more evil, and more profound than he is.”—“Stronger, more evil, and more profound?” I asked shocked. “Yes,” he said once more, “stronger, more evil, and more profound, also more beautiful”—and with that the tempter god smiled with his halcyon smile, as if he had just uttered an enchanting compliment. We see here also that it is not just shame this divinity lacks—; and in general there are good reasons to suppose that in some things the gods collectively could learn from us human beings. We human beings are—more human. . .

Alas, what are you then, my written and painted thoughts! It's not so long ago that you were still so colourful, young, and malicious, full of stings and secret seasonings, that you made me sneeze and laugh.—And now? You have already stripped off your novelty and some of you, I fear, are ready to become truths: you already look so immortal, so heartbreakingly honest, so boring! And was it ever different? What things we transcribe in our writing and painting, we mandarins with a Chinese brush, we immortalizers of things which let themselves be written—what are the only things we are capable of painting? Alas, only what is about to fade and is beginning to lose its fragrance! Alas, only storms which are worn out and withdrawing and old yellow feelings! Alas, only birds which have exhausted themselves flying and lost their way and now let themselves be caught by hand—by our hand! We immortalize what can no longer live and fly, only tired and crumbling things! And it is only your afternoon, my written and painted thoughts, for which I alone have colours, many colours perhaps, many colourful caresses and fifty yellows and browns and greens and reds:—but no one will sense from me how you looked in your dawn, you sudden sparks and miracles of my solitude, you, my old loved ones—my wicked thoughts! NOTES (1) Quintus Horatius Flaccus (65-8 BC) an important poet in classical Rome. [Back to Text] (2) The 1900 German edition adds here: "(I don't dare mention greater names, but I have them in mind). [Back to Text] (3) The German edition of 1900 adds after the words "incurable hearts" the parenthetical comment: "(the cynicism of Hamlet, the case of Galiani)." [Back to Text] (4) Raphael (1483-1520): major Italian painter of the Renaissance. [Back to Text] (5) Nietzsche uses Greek letters here: $\kappa\alpha\iota\rho\acute{o}\varsigma$. [Back to Text] (6) Harpies: mythological winged monsters who steal food. [Back to Text] (7) The "first work" Nietzsche is referring to is his *Birth of Tragedy*, published in 1872, in which he proposes the struggle between the Apollonian and Dionysian. [Back to Text] (8) Ariadne: in Greek mythology the daughter of Minos, king of Crete. She helped Theseus kill the Minotaur in the Labyrinth and escaped with him. When Theseus abandoned Ariadne, Dionysus fell in love with her. [Back to Text]

End of *Beyond Good and Evil* (translated by Ian Johnston)

VI.2 — Thus Spoke Zarathustra: On the Gift-Giving Virtue

THUS SPOKE ZARATHUSTRA, "ON THE GIFT-GIVING VIRTUE"
(Translated by Graham Parkes)

VI.3 — On the Genealogy of Morals, First Essay §16-17 (Conclusion)

ON THE GENEALOGY OF MORALS, FIRST ESSAY §16-17 (Translated by Ian Johnston)

Let's bring this to a conclusion. The two opposing values "good and bad" and "good and evil" have fought a fearful battle on earth for thousands of years. And if it's true that the second value has for a long time had the upper hand, even now there is still no lack of places where the battle goes on without a final decision. We could even say that in the intervening time the battle has been constantly drawn to greater heights and, in the process, to constantly greater depths and has become constantly more spiritual, so that nowadays there is perhaps no more decisive mark of a "higher nature," a more spiritual nature, than that it is split in that sense and is truly still a battleground for those opposites. The symbol of this battle, written in a script which has remained legible through all human history up to the present, is called "Rome against Judea, Judea against Rome." To this point there has been no greater event than this war, this posing of a question, this contradiction between deadly enemies. Rome felt that the Jew was like something contrary to nature itself, its monstrous polar opposite, as it were. In Rome the Jew was considered "convicted of hatred against the entire human race." And that view was correct, to the extent that we are right to link the health and the future of the human race to the unconditional rule of aristocratic values, to Roman values. By contrast, how did the Jews feel about Rome? We can guess that from a thousand signs, but it is sufficient to treat ourselves again to the Apocalypse of John, that wildest of all written outbursts which vengeance has on its conscience. (Incidentally, we must not underestimate the deep consistency of the Christian instinct when it ascribed this particular book of hate to the name of the disciple of love, the same man to whom it attributed that enthusiastic amorous gospel—: there is some truth to this, no matter how much literary counterfeiting may have been necessary for this purpose). The Romans were indeed strong and noble men, stronger and nobler than any people who had lived on earth up until then or even than any people who had ever been dreamed up. Everything they left as remains, every inscription, is delightful, provided that we can guess what is doing the writing there. By contrast, the Jews were par excellence that priestly people of resentment, who possessed an unparalleled genius for popular morality. Just compare people with related talents—say, the Chinese or the Germans—with the Jews, in order to understand which is ranked first and which is ranked fifth. Which of them has

proved victorious for the time being, Rome or Judea? Surely there's not the slightest doubt. Just think of who it is people bow down to today in Rome itself as the personification of all the highest values—and not only in Rome, but in almost half the earth, all the places where people have become merely tame or want to become tame—in front of three Jews, as we know, and one Jewess (in front of Jesus of Nazareth, the fisherman Peter, the carpet maker Paul, and the mother of the first-mentioned Jesus, named Mary). This is very remarkable: without doubt Rome has been conquered. It is true that in the Renaissance there was an incredibly brilliant reawakening of the classical ideal, of the noble way of evaluating everything. Rome itself behaved like someone who had woken up from a coma induced by the pressure of the new Jewish Rome built over it, which looked like an ecumenical synagogue and was called "Church." But Judea immediately triumphed again, thanks to that thoroughly vulgar (German and English) movement of resentment we call the Reformation, together with what had to follow as a result, the re-establishment of the church—as well as the re-establishment of the old grave-like tranquillity of classical Rome. In what is an even more decisive and deeper sense than that, Judea once again was victorious over the classical ideal with the French Revolution. The last political nobility which there was in Europe, in seventeenth and eighteenth century France, broke apart under the instincts of popular resentment—never on earth has there been heard a greater rejoicing, a noisier enthusiasm! It's true that in the midst of all this the most dreadful and most unexpected events took place: the old ideal itself stepped physically and with unheard of splendour before the eyes and the conscience of humanity—and once again stronger, simpler, and more urgently than ever rang out, in opposition to the old lying slogan of resentment about the privileged rights of the majority, in opposition to that will for a low condition, for abasement, for equality, for the decline and twilight of mankind—in opposition to all that there rang out the fearsome and delightful counter-slogan about the privilege of the very few! As a last signpost to a different road, Napoleon appeared, that most singular and late-born man there ever was, and in him the problem of the noble ideal itself was made flesh—we should consider well what a problem that is: Napoleon, this synthesis of monster [Unmensch] and superman [Übermensch] . . .

—Did that end it? Was that greatest of all oppositions of ideals thus set ad acta [aside] for all time? Or was it merely postponed, postponed indefinitely? . . . Someday would there not have to be an even more fearful blaze from the old fire, one which would take much longer to prepare? More than that: would this not be exactly what we should hope for with all our strength? Even will it? Even demand it? Anyone who, like my readers, begins to reflect on these points, to think further, will have difficulty coming to a quick conclusion—reason enough

for me to come to a conclusion myself, provided that it has been sufficiently clear for a long time what I want, precisely what I want with that dangerous slogan which is written on the body of my last book: "Beyond Good and Evil" . . . At least this does not mean "Beyond Good and Bad."—

Note

I am taking the opportunity provided to me by this essay publicly and formally to state a desire which I have expressed up to now only in occasional conversations with scholars, namely, that some faculty of philosophy might set up a series of award-winning academic essays in order to serve the advancement of studies into the history of morality. Perhaps this book could serve to provide a forceful push in precisely such a direction. Bearing in mind a possibility of this sort, let me propose the following question—it merits the attention of philologists and historians as much as of truly professional philosophical scholars:

What suggestions does the scientific study of language, especially etymological research, provide for the history of the development of moral concepts?

—On the other hand, it is, of course, just as necessary to attract the participation of physiologists and doctors to these problems (of the value of all methods of evaluating up to now). Also for this task it might be left to the professional philosophers in this particular case to become advocates and mediators, after they have completely succeeded in converting the relationships between philosophy, physiology, and medicine, originally so aloof and so mistrusting, into the most friendly and most fruitful exchange. In fact, all the tables of value, all examples of "thou shalt" that history or ethnological research knows about, need, first and foremost, illumination and interpretation from physiology—at any rate before one from psychology. All of them similarly await a critique from the point of view of medical science. The question "What is this or that table of values and 'morality' worth?" needs to be viewed from the most varied perspectives. For we cannot analyze the question "Value for what?" too finely. Something, for example, that would have an apparent value with respect to the longest possible capacity for the survival of a race (or to an increase in its power to adapt to a certain climate or to the preservation of the greatest number) would have nothing like the same value, if the issue were one of developing a stronger type. The well-being of the greatest number and the well-being of the smallest number are opposing viewpoints where values are concerned. We wish to leave it to the naïveté of English biologists to take the first as already the one of inherently higher value. . . . All the sciences from now on have to do the preparatory work for the future job of the philosopher,

understanding that the philosopher's task is to solve the problem of value, that he has to determine the rank order of values.

ENDNOTES

(1) Herbert Spencer (1820-1903), English philosopher and liberal political theorist, who extended Darwin's evolutionary theories into sociology. [Back to Text]

(2) Thirty Years War: a prolonged, devastating, and inconclusive European war over religion (1618-1648). [Back to Text]

(3) Buckle: Henry Thomas Buckle (1821-1862), English historian, author of *The History of Civilization in England*. Buckle's attempt to explain historical events as the results of certain mathematically precise laws generated a great deal of controversy. [Back to Text]

(4)

Theogonis: a Greek poet from Megara in the sixth century BC. [Back to Text]

(5)

Virchow: Rudolf Virchow (1821-1902), German doctor and anthropologist. [Back to Text]

(6) Achilles: the warrior hero of Homer's *Iliad*, one of the greatest Greek heroes. [Back to Text]

(7)

Weir-Mitchell: Silas Weir-Mitchell (1829-1914), American doctor and writer, well known for his rest cure for nervous diseases. [Back to Text]

(8)

Beyond Good and Evil: Nietzsche published this work in 1886. [Back to Text]

(9) . . . resentment: Nietzsche uses this French word, which since his writing, and largely because of it, has entered the English language as an important term in psychology: a short definition is as follows: "deep-seated resentment, frustration, and hostility, accompanied by a sense of being powerless to express these feelings directly" (Merriam-Webster). Resentment is thus significantly different in meaning from resentment. [Back to Text]

(10)

Mirabeau: Honore Gabriel Riqueti, Comte de Mirabeau (1749-1791), French politician and writer at the time of the French Revolution. [Back to Text]

(11) Pericles (495-429 BC), political leader and general in Athens at the outbreak of the Peloponnesian War. He delivered his famous funeral oration at the end of the first year of the war. The Goths: tribes from Eastern Germany who attacked the Roman Empire in the third and fourth centuries. Later (as the Visigoths and Ostrogoths) they gained political dominance in parts of Europe, once the Roman Empire collapsed; Vandals: Eastern Germanic tribes, allied to the Goths, who invaded the Roman Empire. [Back to Text]

(12)

Hesiod (c. 700 BC), Greek poet. [Back to Text]

(13)

Nietzsche's point here is that Hesiod broke the last of his ages into two: a Heroic Age, symbolized by the legendary heroes of Troy and Thebes, and an Iron Age. The latter was, in effect, the same as the Heroic Age except it was that era as seen by the suffering and oppressed (i.e., not a heroic and glorious period, but one full of wretchedness). Hesiod (in *Works and Days*) describes five ages: Gold, Silver, Bronze, Heroic, and Iron. Nietzsche's German word *Erz* can mean ore, bronze, or iron.

[Back to Text]

(14)

Dante: Dante Alighieri (1265-1321), a Florentine poet who wrote *The Divine Comedy*. The phrase Nietzsche quotes comes from the first book, *The Inferno*, and stands over the gateway to hell. [Back to Text]

(15)

Thomas Aquinas (1225-1274), Catholic saint, one of the great Catholic theologians. Nietzsche quotes the Latin, as follows: "Beati in regno coelesti videbunt poenas damnatorum, ut beatitudo illis magis complaceat."

[Back to Text]

(16)

The "triumphant father of the church" is Tertullian (c. 155-230), an important figure in the early church and a fierce Christian apologist. [Back to Text]

(17)

Rhadamanthus or Minos: These were the names of the judges in the pagan underworld. [Back to Text]

(18)

Nietzsche's Latin quotation of Tertullian contains in this sentence a slight misquote: "vivos" [living] rather than visos [seen]. The English text above uses visos (Tertullian's word).

[Back to Text]

(19)

praetor or consul or quaestor: important Roman political officials. [Back to Text]

(20)

Nietzsche quotes the Latin and inserts some of his own comments, as follows: "At enim supersunt alia spectacula, ille ultimus et perpetuus iudicii dies, ille nationibus insperatus, ille derisus, cum tanta saeculi vetustas et tot eius nativitates uno igne haurientur. Quae tunc spectaculi latitudo! Quid admirer! Quid rideam! Ubi gaudeam! Ubi exultem, spectans tot et tantos reges, qui in coelum recepti nuntiabantur, cum ipso Jove et ipsis suis testibus in imis tenebris congemescerent! Item praesides" (die Provinzialstatthalter) "persecutores dominici nominis saevioribus quam ipsi flammis saevierunt insultantibus contra Christianos liquescentes! Quos praeterea sapientes illos philosophos coram discipulis suis una conflagrantibus erubescerent, quibus nihil ad deum pertinere suadebant, quibus animas aut nullas aut non in pristina corpora redituras affirmabant! Etiam poetas non ad Rhadamanti nec ad Minois, sed ad inopinati Christi tribunal palpitantes! Tunc magis tragoedi audiendi, magis scilicet vocales" (besser bei Stimme, noch ärgere Schreier) "in sua propria calamitate; tunc histriones cognoscendi, solutiores multo per ignem; tunc spectandus auriga in flammea rota totus rubens, tunc xysticis contemplandi non in gymnasiis, sed in igne jaculati, nisi quod ne tunc quidem illos velim vivos, ut qui malim ad eos potius conspectum insatiabilem conferre, qui in dominum desaevierunt. Hic est ille," dicam, "fabri aut quaestuariae filius" (wie alles Folgende und insbesondere auch diese aus dem Talmud bekannte Bezeichnung der Mutter Jesu zeigt, meint Tertullian von hier ab die Juden), "'sabbati destructor, Samaritanes et daemonium habens. Hic est, quem a Juda redemistis, hic est ille arundine et colaphis diverberatus, sputamentis dedecoratus, felle et

aceto potatus. Hic est, quem clam discentes subriperunt, ut resurrexisse dicatur vel hortulanus detraxit, ne lactucae suae frequentia commeantium laederentur.' Ut talia spectes, uttalibus exultes, quis tibi praetor aut consul aut quaestor aut sacerdos de sua liberalitate praestabit? Et tamen haec jam habemus quodammodo per fidem spiritu imaginante repraesentata. Ceterum qualia illa sunt, quae nec oculus vidit nec auris audivit nec in cor hominis ascenderunt?" (1. Cor. 2, 9.) "Credo circo et utraque cavea" (erster und vierter Rang oder, nach anderen, komische und tragische Bühne) "et omni stadio gratiora."

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[On the Genealogy of Morals A Polemical Tract](#)

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Appendix I: Reading Guide

Work	Recommended Edition	ISBN	Translator Note
Beyond Good and Evil	Johnston (public domain)	—	Clear, readable, preserves Nietzsche's paragraph breaks and italics. Occasionally smooths over German wordplay. Reliable for general use.
On the Genealogy of Morals	Johnston (public domain)	—	Similar strengths to his BGE. Footnotes are helpful. The translation is idiomatic without being loose.
Twilight of the Idols	Hollingdale (Penguin Classics)	978-0140445145	Masterful rendering of Nietzsche's late style — the aphoristic punch and sarcasm come through brilliantly. The standard English edition.
The Antichrist	Hollingdale (Penguin Classics)	978-0140445145	Same volume as Twilight. Hollingdale captures the polemical fire. Essential for the Renaissance passages.
Ecce Homo	Hollingdale (Penguin Classics)	978-0140445152	The definitive English translation. Handles Nietzsche's self-mythologizing with appropriate flair.
Thus Spoke Zarathustra	Parkes (Oxford World's Classics)	978-0199537082	The most scholarly English translation. Parkes preserves Nietzsche's wordplay and alliteration better than any other version. The introduction is excellent.

Work	Recommended Edition	ISBN	Translator Note
The Gay Science	Del Caro / Nauckhoff (Cambridge)	978-0521636454	The standard academic translation. Reliable and precise. Some readers find it slightly less elegant than the Kaufmann version, but more accurate.
The Birth of Tragedy	Johnston (public domain)	—	Solid, readable translation. Good for the Apollonian/Dionysian passages.
Use and Abuse of History	Johnston (public domain)	—	Competent translation of an early work. The second Untimely Meditation.

A Note on Editions

For serious study, the Hollingdale translations of the later works (Twilight, Antichrist, Ecce Homo) published by Penguin are preferred for their fidelity to Nietzsche's tone. The Johnston translations of BGE and Genealogy are public domain and widely available online; they are reliable but lack the critical apparatus of academic editions. The Parkes Zarathustra (Oxford) is the most textually accurate English version available.

Appendix II: Key Sources on Historical Civilizations

Nietzsche's understanding of great cultures was profoundly shaped by his Basel colleague Jacob Burckhardt. The following works are essential reading alongside Nietzsche:

Jacob Burckhardt, *The Civilization of the Renaissance in Italy*

Burckhardt's masterpiece (1860) portrays the Italian Renaissance as the birth of modern individuality — the emergence of "the subjective man" from the corporate structures of the Middle Ages. Nietzsche drew heavily on this work for his understanding of the Renaissance as the last great flowering of pagan, aristocratic culture. The passages in *The Antichrist* (§57–62) praising Cesare Borgia and lamenting the Reformation's destruction of the Renaissance are directly indebted to Burckhardt's vision. Read this alongside Nietzsche to understand what "great culture" looked like in concrete historical terms: the state as a work of art, the cultivation of individual excellence, and the unfettered expression of all human capacities.

Recommended edition: Penguin Classics, translated by S.G.C. Middlemore, ISBN 978-0140445343

Jacob Burckhardt, *Griechische Kulturgeschichte* (Greek Cultural History)

Less well known in the English-speaking world than the Renaissance work, this four-volume history of Greek civilization (published 1898–1902, after Burckhardt's death) was delivered as lectures while Nietzsche was Burckhardt's colleague in Basel. Its influence on Nietzsche's understanding of Greek culture — particularly the agonistic spirit, the pessimism behind the artistic achievement, and the role of slavery in enabling high culture — is evident throughout the *Genealogy* and *Twilight*. Burckhardt's emphasis on the Greek "agonal" (competitive) principle directly shaped Nietzsche's thinking about rank, breeding, and cultural excellence.

Note: There is no complete English translation. The German original is available from C.H. Beck (ISBN 978-3406545449). For English readers, the most accessible Burckhardt work on Greece is *The Greeks and Greek Civilization* (St. Martin's Press, 1998, ISBN 978-0312244477), which collects the essential passages.

Why Read Burckhardt Alongside Nietzsche

Burckhardt provides the historical evidence for Nietzsche's physiological claims. Where Nietzsche diagnoses the conditions of great culture in the language of the physician, Burckhardt documents their actual manifestation in history. Together, they offer a complete picture: Nietzsche gives you the diagnostic framework, Burckhardt the historical case studies. The reader who studies both will understand that Nietzsche's "pathos of distance" is not a metaphor but a description of actual social arrangements that produced actual great individuals.